

Literature in English

Senior Five

5



Student's Book

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

Senior Five



Student's Book

Experimental Version

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FOREWORD

Dear Learner,

The Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) is pleased to present this Senior Five Literature in English Student's Book, developed in accordance with the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC). The book is intended to support you in developing the knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes needed for lifelong learning, further education, responsible citizenship, and the world of work.

Literature in English provides opportunities to explore human experiences, appreciate diverse cultures and perspectives, and develop critical, creative and innovative thinking. Through the study of Oral Literature, prose, poetry, drama, and other literary forms, you will develop the ability to interpret texts, communicate ideas effectively, express informed opinions, solve problems creatively, and connect literary experiences with real-life situations. These competences will contribute to your personal development and your ability to participate responsibly in society.

This textbook has been designed to support active and meaningful learning. It provides a range of activities that encourage you to read, investigate, discuss, interpret, analyse, evaluate, create, perform, and reflect both individually and collaboratively. Through these activities, you will construct knowledge, strengthen literary and language skills, and develop positive values and attitudes.

In the Competence-Based Curriculum, learning is an active process in which you are expected to take responsibility for your own learning. Concepts and skills are introduced through relevant situations and engaging activities that enable you to connect new knowledge with your experiences, interact with others, and apply what you learn in different contexts.

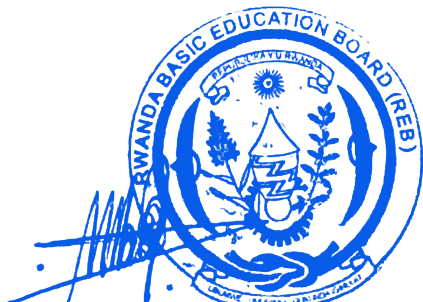
For effective use of this textbook, you are expected to:

- Participate actively in learning and application activities to develop literary and language competences.
- Read, interpret, analyse, and evaluate literary texts using appropriate literary concepts and evidence from the texts.
- Exchange ideas and learn collaboratively through discussions, debates, presentations, dramatic performances, role plays, projects, and other learner-centred activities.
- Conduct research using libraries, digital resources, and relevant community sources to broaden your understanding of literary works and related issues.
- Demonstrate creativity through composing and performing literary works, including poems, short stories, plays, and other forms of literary expression. Apply the knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes acquired through the study of literature to everyday situations and community life.
- Reflect on your learning and make well-reasoned conclusions based on evidence and experiences gained from learning activities.

The Rwanda Basic Education Board appreciates the contribution of all those who

participated in the development of this textbook. Their professional commitment and collaboration have contributed to the quality and relevance of this learning resource.

Comments and suggestions that may contribute to improving future editions of this textbook are highly appreciated. <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ByZNRUHBmHSe6JPPY9dCpAXJ0-RF9eGE>



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Director General, REB

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Finally, I extend my sincere appreciation to everyone who contributed directly or indirectly to the completion of this textbook. Your dedication and commitment to improving the quality of teaching and learning are sincerely valued.



Ms. MURUNGI Joan

Head of Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department, REB

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UNIT 1

EUROPEAN LITERARY TRADITIONS ONE



Key Unit Competence:

To analyse key literary works and themes in European literature in relation to their historical, cultural, and philosophical contexts across different genres and periods.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

- ✓ Identify key European authors, texts, genres, and literary movements from classical to modern periods.
- ✓ Explain the historical, cultural, and philosophical foundations of European prose traditions.
- ✓ Describe how European literature reflects societal changes, belief systems, and artistic values.

Skills

2

- ✓ Analyze themes, symbols, and narrative techniques in European prose texts.
- ✓ Compare classical and modern European prose in terms of style and purpose.
- ✓ Develop reasoned oral and written interpretations of European texts supported by evidence.

Attitudes and values

3

- ✓ Appreciate the richness and diversity of European literary heritage and respect different cultural perspectives.
- ✓ Demonstrate open-mindedness toward differing worldviews within European traditions.
- ✓ Demonstrate confident, curious, and responsible engagement with literary texts through critical analysis, interpretation, and ethical reflection.

1.0. Introduction to the Unit

Have you ever read a story, watched a play, or seen a film that made you reflect deeply on life or society? Many such powerful stories come from European literary traditions. In this unit, you will learn about important European literary works and themes in different genres such as poetry, drama, and prose. You will also explore how these works reflect the historical, cultural, and philosophical ideas of their time.

Introductory activity



Observe the map below and answer the questions that follow.



Questions

1. Locate the countries that make up the continent of Europe.
2. What do you understand by European literature?
3. What do you understand by European literary traditions?
4. Discuss the different European literary traditions.

1.1. Introduction to European Literature

Learning activity 1.1.1



In groups of five, read the following extracts and discuss the questions that follow

Extract 1

OEDIPUS: That child he mentioned — did you give it to him?

SERVANT: I did. How I wish I'd died that day!

OEDIPUS: Well, you are going to die if you don't speak the truth

SERVANT: And if I do, the death I suffer will be even worse.

OEDIPUS: It seems to me the man is trying to stall.

SERVANT: No, no, I'm not. I've already told you — I did give him the child.

OEDIPUS: Where did you get it? Did it come from your home or somewhere else?

SERVANT: It was not mine — I got it from someone.

OEDIPUS: Which of our citizens? Whose home was it? **SERVANT:** In the name of the gods, my lord, don't ask! Please, no more questions!

OEDIPUS: If I have to ask again, then you will die.

SERVANT: The child was born in Laius' house.

OEDIPUS: From a slave or from some relative of his?

SERVANT: Alas, what I'm about to say now . . . it's horrible.

OEDIPUS: It may be horrible, but nonetheless I have to hear it. **SERVANT:** If you must know, they said the child was his. But your wife inside the palace is the one who could best tell you what was going on.

OEDIPUS: You mean she gave the child to you?

SERVANT: Yes, my lord.

OEDIPUS: Why did she do that?

SERVANT: So I would kill it.

OEDIPUS: That wretched woman was the mother?

SERVANT: Yes. She was afraid of dreadful prophecies.

OEDIPUS: What sort of prophecies?

SERVANT: The story went that the child would kill his father. **OEDIPUS:** If that was true, why did you give the child to this old man? **SERVANT:** I pitied the boy, master, and I thought he'd take the child off to a foreign land where he was from. But he rescued him, only to save him for the greatest grief of all.

For if you are who this man says you are you know your birth carried an awful fate.
OEDIPUS: Ah, so it all came true. It's so clear now. O light, let me look at you one final time, a man who stands revealed as cursed by birth, cursed by my own family, and cursed by murder where I should not kill.**From the play "Oedipus the King" by Sophocles**

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. The idea that Oedipus cannot escape his destiny is an example of:
A. Fate B. Irony C. Comedy D. Satire
2. The suffering of Oedipus mainly illustrates the concept of:
A. Heroism B. Tragic flaw C. Comedy of manners D. Epic journey
3. The dialogue form used in this extract is typical of:
A. Narrative novels B. Essays C. Lyric poetry D. Dramatic texts

ii. Open-ended questions

Discuss how this extract demonstrates the characteristics of a Greek tragedy. How does the use of dialogue contribute to revealing truth and tension in the play? Analyze the role of prophecy in shaping the events of the play and its importance in European literature?

European Literary Tradition

a) Introduction to European Literary Tradition

Literary traditions are the common styles, themes, beliefs, and forms of literature shared by a group of people in a particular place and time. It refers to all written and oral literary works produced in Europe from ancient times to the present. It includes poems, myths, plays, novels, essays, folktales, and speeches.

They help us understand how societies express their culture, values, and experiences through literature.

Literary traditions differ from one society to another. For example:

- African traditions differ from European traditions
- Asian literary traditions differ from American literary traditions
- Rwandan traditions differ from Ugandan traditions

However, many literary traditions share common themes such as love, justice, leadership, freedom, identity, and morality.

b) Major European literary traditions developed in:

- Ancient Greece
- Ancient Rome
- England

- France
- Germany
- Spain
- Italy

c) Oral Tradition in European Literature

The European literary tradition refers to the shared styles, themes, values, beliefs, and forms of literature that developed across Europe over different historical periods, beginning with oral traditions such as myths, legends, folktales, songs, and epics that were passed down by word of mouth before being written down.

Examples include:

- *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey* by Homer
- *Beowulf*, an early English oral epic
- Medieval ballads sung before being written down

Like African oral literature, European oral tradition used repetition, rhythm, and performance to preserve history and moral lessons.

d) Evolution of European Literature

European literature began in Ancient Greece around 800 BC. Early stories focused on gods, heroes, wars, and human struggles. These stories were first oral and later written down.

Greek literature influenced Roman literature, which later spread across Europe. Over time, European literature developed through periods such as:

- Christianity
- Renaissance
- Enlightenment
- Romanticism
- Modernism

Each period introduced new themes and literary styles.

a) Why Do We Study European literary traditions?

We study European literature because it:

- helps us understand history and culture,
- raises important questions about life and society,
- develops critical thinking,
- improves language and writing skills,
- and connects us to world literature.

It also helps us understand the literary influences that shaped modern African literature.

a) Major Periods of European Literature

Period	Time	Main Characteristics
Classical Period	800 BC – 500 AD	Heroes, mythology, fate, philosophy
Medieval Period	500 AD – 1400 AD	Christianity, morality, faith, chivalry
Renaissance	1400 AD – 1600 AD	Humanism, rebirth of learning, creativity
Enlightenment	1600 AD – 1800 AD	Reason, science, freedom, questioning authority
Romanticism	1800 AD – 1850 AD	Emotion, imagination, nature, individualism
Modernism	1900 AD – present	War, alienation, identity, uncertainty

b) Examples from English Literature

Important examples of English literature include:

- ✓ *Hamlet* and *Macbeth* by William Shakespeare
- ✓ *Paradise Lost* by John Milton
- ✓ *Oliver Twist* by Charles Dickens
- ✓ *Pride and Prejudice* by Jane Austen
- ✓ *Beowulf*

These works explore themes such as love, power, justice, ambition, and human suffering.

c) Connection Between European and African Literature

African literature developed mainly through oral tradition, while European literature became written earlier. However, both traditions value storytelling, morality, and human experience.

Application activity 1.1.2



Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow

Achilles was the greatest warrior in the Greek army. He was strong, fast, and fearless. But he had one weakness, his pride. When the Greek commander Agamemnon took away his war prize, Achilles refused to fight. He sat in his tent while his fellow soldiers were dying on the battlefield.

His best friend Patroclus begged him: "Let me wear your armour and fight in your place. The soldiers need hope." Achilles agreed. But Patroclus was killed by the Trojan hero Hector. When Achilles heard the news, he cried out in grief. His mother came to comfort him. She said: "If you go to fight Hector, you will win but you will die soon after."

Achilles looked at her and said: "Then I will go. A short life with glory is better than a long life without honour." He went to the battlefield. He found Hector and killed him. The Greeks celebrated. But Achilles knew his own death was coming. He had chosen glory over life.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Who is the greatest warrior in the Greek army?
A) Hector B) Patroclus C) Achilles D) Agamemnon
2. Why did Achilles refuse to fight at the beginning?
A) He was sick B) He was afraid C) His pride was hurt D) He had no weapons
3. What did Patroclus ask Achilles to do?
A) Run away B) Let him wear his armour and fight C) Go home to Greece D) Speak to Agamemnon
4. Who killed Patroclus?
A) Achilles B) Agamemnon C) Zeus D) Hector
5. What did Achilles' mother warn him about?
A) He would lose the battle B) He would die soon after killing Hector C) Hector was too strong D) The Greek army would betray him
6. What did Achilles choose in the end?
A) A long peaceful life B) To run away from battle C) A short life with glory and honour D) To forgive Agamemnon
7. To which Literary Tradition does this story belong?
A) African Literature B) Medieval European literature C) Classical Greek literature D) Modern Literature

ii. Open-ended questions

1. In your own words explain why Achilles was a great but flawed hero.
2. What does Achilles' choice — *"a short life with glory is better than a long life without honour"* — tell you about the values of Ancient Greek society?
3. Does this story remind you of any African story or hero in African Literary Tradition that you know? Explain your answer.

B. Oral Presentation

Do you believe in prophecy or destiny? Share with your classmates an experience, belief, or situation from your daily life or culture where people think events are controlled by fate rather than personal choice. Explain your opinion (orally).

1.2. Classical Ancient Greek and Roman Literature

Learning activity 1.2.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

The Iliad

Sing, O goddess, the anger of Achilles son of Peleus,
that brought countless ills upon the Achaeans.
Many a brave soul did it send hurrying down to Hades,
and many a hero did it yield a prey to dogs and vultures,
for so were the counsels of Jove fulfilled
from the day on which the son of Atreus, king of men,
and great Achilles, first fell out with one another.
And which of the gods was it that set them on to quarrel?
It was the son of Jove and Leto; for he was angry with the king
and sent a pestilence upon the host to plague the people,
because the son of Atreus had dishonoured Chryses his priest.

by Homer

A. Comprehension Questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Who is the poem addressing at the very beginning?
A) Achilles B) The king C) Jove D) A goddess
2. Whose anger is the poem mainly about?
A) Hades B) The son of Atreus C) Achilles D) Leto
3. What did the anger of Achilles bring upon the Achaeans?
A) Victory and glory B) Countless suffering and death
C) Peace and rest D) Wealth and power
4. Where were the brave souls sent after dying?
A) Heaven B) The battlefield C) The temple D) Hades
5. Who caused the quarrel between Achilles and the son of Atreus?
A) Leto B) Chryses C) The son of Jove and Leto D) The Achaeans
6. Why was the god angry with the king?
A) The king dishonored Chryses the priest B) The king refused to fight C) The king ran away from battle D) The king insulted Achilles

7. What did the angry god send upon the people?
A) A great storm B) A pestilence to plague them
C) A great army D) Darkness and drought
8. What does the word "pestilence" mean in this poem?
A) A dangerous disease that spreads and kills many people B) A blessing
C) A great battle D) A harsh punishment from the king.
9. To which European Literary Tradition does this poem belong
A) Pre-colonial African Literature B) Classical Ancient Greek and Roman Literature
C) Roman Literature D) Classical Ancient Greek
10. Who is author of this poem?
A) Virgil B) Sophocles C) Dante D) Homer

ii. Open-ended questions

1. In your own words explain what this poem is about.
2. What does this poem tell you about the role of gods in the lives of people in Ancient Greece?
3. "What does the poem suggest about the consequences of dishonouring a priest or a religious figure in Ancient Greece?"
4. The poet begins by asking a goddess to help him sing the story. What does this tell you about how the Ancient Greece viewed poetry and storytelling?
5. In your opinion does the theme of anger and its consequences still apply to life in Africa and Rwanda today? Give ONE example to support your answer.

Classical Ancient Greek and Roman Literature (800 BC — 500 AD)

This is the earliest foundation of European literature, developed in ancient Greece and Rome.

Key characteristics

- Focus on mythology, heroism, fate, and moral lessons.
- Development of major literary forms such as epic poetry, tragedy, comedy, and philosophical writings.
- People believed in many gods such as Zeus, Athena, Apollo, and Poseidon
- Life was controlled by fate, the idea that your destiny is already decided
- Heroes were the greatest figures in society, men of strength, courage, and wisdom
- War and glory were central to how men proved their worth
- Strong influence on later European writers and literary styles

Major Genres

Genre	What it means	Example
Epic Poetry	A long poem about a great hero's journey	The Odyssey
Tragedy	A play where the hero falls due to a fatal flaw	Oedipus Rex
Comedy	A play that mocks human weakness humorously	Aristophanes' plays
Philosophy	Writing about big ideas and how to live	Plato's Republic

Key Authors and Works

Author	Origin & Period	Key Works	Main Ideas / Description
Homer	Greek — around 800 BC	The Iliad; The Odyssey	Wrote two great epic poems. The Iliad is about the Trojan War and Achilles. The Odyssey is about Odysseus returning home.
Sophocles	Greek — 496 BC	Oedipus Rex	Wrote tragedies about fate and suffering. Oedipus Rex is about a king who unknowingly killed his father and married his mother.

Key Themes

- Fate vs. Free Will: can humans control their own destiny?
- Pride and its consequences: heroes often fall because of arrogance
- The journey as a symbol of life: going away and coming home
- Loyalty, honour, and sacrifice

Connection to Africa

- African oral traditions also feature great heroes, gods, and epic journeys
- Stories like *Sundiata* from West Africa share many features with *The Odyssey*
- Both traditions use storytelling to teach values and preserve history.

Application activity 1.2.2



Read the excerpt from “The Odyssey” by Homer and answer the questions that follow.

The story of Odysseus's “Odyssey” from Troy to Calypso's island, told by him in “flashback” to Alkinoos: they avoid the dangers of the land of the Lotus-eaters and reach the Island of the one-eyed Cyclops Polyphemus, son of Poseidon. They enter the cave in which he pens his sheep, not realizing what a monster he is. Finding them there, he makes them his prisoners and begins to eat them. Fortunately, Odysseus sees a way of escape. First, he prepares a sharp stake of wood, then he makes Polyphemus drunk with wine. He tells Polyphemus that his name is ‘Nobody’.

And now it was I drove the stake under a heap of ashes,
to bring it to a heat, and with my words
emboldened all my men, that none might flinch through fear.
Then when the olive stake, green though it was, was ready to take fire,
and through and through was all aglow, I snatched it from the fire,
while my men stood around
and Heaven inspired us with great courage.
Seizing the olive stake, sharp at the tip, they plunged it in his eye,
and I, perched up above, whirled it around.
As when a man bores ship beams with a drill,
and those below keep it in motion with a strap held by the ends,
and steadily it runs; even so we seized the fire-pointed stake
and whirled it in his eye. Blood bubbled round the heated thing.
The vapor singed off all the lids around the eye, and even the brows,
as the ball burned and its roots crackled in the flame.
As when a smith dips a great axe or adze into cold water,
hissing loud, to temper it, for that is strength to steel,
so hissed his eye about the olive stake.
A hideous roar he raised; the rock resounded; we hurried off in terror.
He wrenched the stake from out his eye, all dabbled with the blood,
and flung it from his hands in frenzy.
Then he called loudly on the Cyclops who dwelt about him in the caves,
along the windy heights. They heard his cry, and ran from every side,
and standing by the cave they asked what ailed him:
"What has come on you, Polyphemus,
that you scream so in the immortal night,
and keep us thus from sleeping?
Is a man driving off your Hocks in spite of you?
Is a man murdering you by craft or force?'
"Then in his turn from out the cave big Polyphemus answered:

'Friends, Nobody is murdering me by craft. Force there is none.'

"But answering him in winged words they said:

"If nobody harms you when you are left alone,
illness which comes from mighty Zeus you cannot fly.

But make your prayer to your father, lord Poseidon.'

Odysseus and his companions tie themselves under the bellies of the sheep.

"Soon as the early rosy-fingered dawn appeared,

the rams hastened to pasture,

but the ewes bleated unmilked about the pens,

for their udders were well nigh bursting.

Their master, racked with grievous pains,

felt over the backs of all the sheep as they stood up,

but foolishly did not notice how under the breasts of the woolly sheep
men had been fastened.

Comprehension questions

i. multiple choice questions

1. When did Classical Greek and Roman literature begin?
A) 1800 AD B) 1400 AD C) 800 BC D) 500 BC
2. Who is Polyphemus?
A) A one-eyed giant B) A Greek soldier C) A god D) Odysseus's friend
3. How did Odysseus trick Polyphemus?
A) He fought him B) He ran away C) He prayed to Zeus D) He gave a false name and blinded him
4. Which other famous work did Homer write?
A) Candide B) The Iliad C) The Divine Comedy D) Oliver Twist
5. What is an epic poem?
A) A short love poem B) A funny story
C) A long story about a great hero's journey D) A religious text

ii. Open-ended questions

1. How did Odysseus and his men escape from the cave?
2. Why did Odysseus call himself "Nobody"? Was it a good idea? Why?

3. Name ONE Roman author and write ONE sentence about their work.
4. What is ONE difference between Greek and Roman literature?
5. What lesson do you learn from this story?

1.3. Medieval literature

Learning activity 1.3.1



Imagine you live in Europe in the year 1200 AD. There are no schools for ordinary people. The church controls everything you believe. The king controls everything you do. If you question the church, you can be punished or killed. The only books that exist are in churches and monasteries. The only people who can read and write are priests and monks. One day a monk sits down and writes a story about a man who travels through Hell and Heaven to learn how to live a good life.

DISCUSS THESE QUESTIONS

1. *What do you think people believed in most during this time?*
2. *Why do you think the church controlled what people wrote and read?*
3. *Do we have stories in Africa that also teach people how to live a good life?*
4. *What do you think the word "Medieval" means?*

Application activity 1.3.2



READ THE PASSAGE CAREFULLY

Dante Alighieri, *The Divine Comedy*

In the middle of the journey of my life. I found myself in a dark forest where the straight path was lost. It was a wild, harsh, and difficult place just thinking about it still fills me with fear. But to reach the good that I found there I must tell you about the other things I saw.

My guide was the great Roman poet, Virgil. He led me first through Hell where I saw sinners being punished for their crimes. I saw the proud, the greedy, the violent, and the liars — each one suffering a punishment that fitted their sin.

Then Virgil led me through Purgatory a place between Hell and Heaven where souls suffer to become clean before entering Heaven. Finally, I reached Heaven itself — a place of pure light, joy, and the presence of God.

This journey taught me one thing above all: every choice a person makes in life has a consequence. Good leads to glory. Evil leads to suffering.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Where does the narrator find himself at the beginning?

- A) In a dark forest B) In Heaven C) In a temple D) On a battlefield

2. Who guides the narrator through Hell?

- A) God B) Virgil C) Dante D) Chaucer

3. What is one key feature of Medieval literature shown in this passage?

- A) It focuses on nature and emotion B) It mocks kings and the church
C) B) It is based on faith, sin, and salvation D) It celebrates individual freedom

4. What is Purgatory according to the passage?

- A) Another name for Hell B) A place where heroes fight
C) A place between Hell and Heaven where souls are cleansed
D) The garden of God

5. What is the main lesson of this passage?

- A) Every choice has a consequence B) Life is short so enjoy it
C) Only kings go to Heaven D) Priests are the most important people in society

6. Which of these is another famous work of Medieval literature?

- A) The Odyssey B) The Canterbury Tales by Chaucer C) Candide D) Frankenstein

7. What does the word "Medieval" refer to?

- A) Ancient Greek times B) The time of the Roman Empire
C) The modern period D) The period in Europe between 500 AD and 1400 AD

ii. Open-ended questions

1. In your own words describe the journey the narrator takes in this passage.
2. What does this passage tell you about what people believed in during the Medieval period?
3. Name ONE key feature of Medieval literature and show how it appears in this passage.
4. Name ONE author of Medieval literature and write ONE sentence about their work.

B. Language skills

Summarize the **Dante Alighieri's "The Divine Comedy"** in only 2 sentences and make sure that your summary is clear and understandable?

C: Oral presentation

Does this story remind you of any African story that teaches people how to live a good life? Explain your answer orally?

1.4. Renaissance literature

Learning activity 1.4.1



Below is a short extract (dialogue) from Act III, Scene I of "Hamlet" by William Shakespeare followed by questions

Extract: Act III, Scene I

HAMLET: To be, or not to be: that is the question:
Whether 'tis nobler in the mind to suffer
The slings and arrows of outrageous fortune,
Or to take arms against a sea of troubles
And by opposing end them.

OPHELIA: Good my lord,
How does your honour for this many a day?

HAMLET: I humbly thank you; well, well, well.

OPHELIA: My lord, I have remembrances of yours
That I have longed long to re-deliver.
I pray you, now receive them.

HAMLET: No, not I;
I never gave you aught.

Comprehension questions

1. The play "*Hamlet*" was written during the Renaissance period. What is meant by Renaissance literature?
2. How does Hamlet's speech show the Renaissance interest in human thoughts and emotions?
3. Identify one feature of Renaissance literature shown in Hamlet's speech.
4. Who is the author of "*Hamlet*"?

RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

1. Meaning

Renaissance literature refers to literary works produced during the Renaissance, a period of cultural rebirth in Europe after the Middle Ages. The Renaissance began in Italy and later spread across Europe.

The word *Renaissance* means "rebirth." Writers and scholars renewed interest in classical Greek and Roman ideas, art, science, and learning. Renaissance literature focused more on human life, creativity, and individual achievement.

2. Characteristics of Renaissance Literature

- Emphasis on humanism and individualism
- Interest in classical Greek and Roman culture
- Focus on human nature, beauty, and knowledge
- Growth of creativity and imagination
- Use of local languages instead of only Latin

3. Features

Feature	Simple Meaning
1.Humanism	Literature focuses on human beings not just God
2.Individualism	Personal feelings and identity matter
3.Questioning authority	Writers challenge kings and the church
4.Rich language	Beautiful and creative use of words and poetry
5.Classical influence	Inspired by Ancient Greek and Roman writing
6.Love and tragedy	Human emotions are the central themes

4. Key Authors and Works

Full Name	Country	Famous Work	About
William Shakespeare	England	Romeo and Juliet, Hamlet, Macbeth	Love, ambition, and tragedy
Miguel de Cervantes Saavedra	Spain	Don Quixote	Dreams, reality, and imagination
Niccolò di Bernardo dei Machiavelli	Italy	The Prince	Power and political leadership
Christopher Marlowe	England	Doctor Faustus	Ambition and its consequences
Francesco Petrarch	Italy	Canzoniere	Love poetry and humanism
Giovanni Boccaccio	Italy	The Decameron	Human society and storytelling

Application activity 1.4.2



Read the dialogue below from “*Doctor Faustus*” written by Christopher Marlowe and answer questions that follow

Act 1, Scene 3 – Faustus meets Mephistopheles

Characters:

Doctor Faustus

Mephistopheles

Faustus: I charge thee to return and change thy shape;
Thou art too ugly to attend on me.
Go, and return an old Franciscan friar;
That holy shape becomes a devil best.

(Mephistopheles exits and returns dressed as a friar.)

Mephistopheles: Now, Faustus, what wouldst thou have me do?

Faustus: I charge thee wait upon me whilst I live,
To do whatever Faustus shall command.
Be it to make the moon drop from her sphere,
Or the ocean to overwhelm the world.

Mephistopheles: I am a servant to great Lucifer,
And may not follow thee without his leave.
No more than he commands must we perform.

Faustus: Did not he charge thee to appear to me?

Mephistopheles: No, I came hither of mine own accord.

Faustus: Did not my conjuring speeches raise thee? Speak.

Mephistopheles: That was the cause, but yet per accidens;
For when we hear one rack the name of God,
Abjure the Scriptures and his Saviour Christ,
We fly in hope to get his glorious soul.

Faustus: So Faustus hath already done it then?
And holds this principle: there is no chief but only Belzebub.

Mephistopheles: Think'st thou that I, who saw the face of God,
And tasted the eternal joys of heaven,
Am not tormented with ten thousand hells
In being deprived of everlasting bliss?

Faustus: Learn thou of Faustus manly fortitude,
And scorn those joys thou never shalt possess.

Comprehension questions

Multiple choice questions

1. What does Faustus want most?
A. Power and knowledge B. Money C. Friends D. A family
2. Faustus' desire to learn many things shows the spirit of the:
A. Renaissance period B. Stone Age C. Industrial Age D. Modern Age
3. Which theme is shown when Faustus chooses magic instead of good advice?
A. Good vs evil B. Farming C. Travel D. Friendship
4. Faustus is called a tragic hero because he:
A. Makes a bad decision B. Becomes a king C. Wins a war D. Helps everyone
5. The story of Faustus mainly teaches that:
A. Ambition without wisdom is dangerous B. Magic is always good
C. Knowledge is useless D. Power brings happiness

1.5. Enlightenment & Neoclassicism

Learning activity 1.5.1



Read Excerpt below from "Candide" by Voltaire and answer the following questions

In the castle of the Baron of Thunder-ten-tronckh lived a young boy called Candide. He had a gentle and honest nature. The tutor of the castle, Pangloss, taught that this world is the best of all possible worlds and that everything happens for the best.

Candide listened carefully and believed Pangloss completely. One day, he was caught kissing the beautiful Cunégonde behind a screen. The Baron became very angry and ordered Candide to be thrown out of the castle.

Poor Candide wandered away, confused and hungry, wondering how such a misfortune could happen in the best of all possible worlds.

Comprehension questions

Multiple choice questions

1. Why was Candide expelled from the castle?
A. He stole money B. He fought with the Baron
C. He kissed Cunégonde D. He ran away
2. What kind of person is Candide at the beginning of the story?
3. Where did Candide live at the beginning of the story?
A. In a village B. In a castle C. In a forest D. In a city
4. Who taught Candide that everything happens for the best?
A. The Baron B. Cunégonde C. Martin D. Pangloss

Enlightenment & Neoclassicism

1. Meaning

Enlightenment: Also called the "Age of Reason" (17th–18th century).

- It was a European intellectual movement that emphasized:
- Reason and logic as the basis for knowledge.
- Scientific thinking over superstition or blind faith.
- Social reform: improving government, society, and human rights.
- Writers and philosophers questioned tradition, monarchy, and the church, promoting freedom, equality, and rational thought.

Example: Voltaire criticized injustice and blind optimism in "*Candide*"; Jonathan Swift satirized social problems in "*A Modest Proposal*".

Neoclassicism:

A literary and artistic movement inspired by classical Greek and Roman literature.

It emphasized:

- Order, harmony, and balance in writing.
- Rules of style and structure, such as clear plots and moral lessons.
- Reason and rationality, avoiding excessive emotion or imagination.
- Often overlaps with Enlightenment thinking because both value logic, clarity, and social purpose.

Example: Alexander Pope's *An Essay on Criticism* follows strict rules and teaches moral lessons, reflecting classical ideals.

2. Features of Enlightenment & Neoclassical Literature

Feature	Explanation	Example
Reason and Logic	Ideas are explained clearly using rational arguments	Swift's essay uses logical reasoning to expose poverty
Satire & Social Critique	Using humor or exaggeration to criticize society	Voltaire satirizes blind optimism in <i>Candide</i>
Moral Instruction	Literature teaches lessons about human behavior	Pope's works encourage virtue and proper conduct
Clarity & Order	Writing is structured, concise, and well-organized	Addison and Steele's essays in <i>The Spectator</i>
Influence of Classical Literature	Follows Greek/Roman models for style, plot, and themes	Neoclassical plays follow Aristotle's rules of drama
Focus on Society	Addresses social, political, and ethical issues	Rousseau and Locke write on government and rights

3. Key Authors and Their Works

Author	Nationality	Key Work	Contribution/Feature
Voltaire	French	<i>Candide</i>	Satire, criticism of optimism, reason over superstition
Jonathan Swift	Irish	<i>A Modest Proposal</i>	Extreme satire to criticize social injustice
Jean-Jacques Rousseau	Swiss	<i>The Social Contract</i>	Political philosophy, social reform ideas
John Locke	English	<i>Two Treatises of Government</i>	Reason, natural rights, influence on democracy
Alexander Pope	English	<i>An Essay on Criticism</i>	Neoclassical poetry, moral and aesthetic rules
Denis Diderot	French	<i>Encyclopédie</i>	Knowledge dissemination, rational thinking

Application activity 1.5.2



Read excerpt below from “A Modest Proposal” by Jonathan Swift and answer questions that follow

I think it is agreed by all parties that this prodigious number of children in the arms, or on the backs, or at the heels of their mothers is a very great additional grievance; and therefore whoever could find out a fair, cheap, and easy method of making these children sound and useful members of the commonwealth would deserve so well of the public as to have his statue set up for a preserver of the nation.

But my intention is very far from being confined to provide only for the children of professed beggars; it is of a much greater extent.

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. The main literary technique used by Swift in this essay is:
A. Satire B. Romance C. Tragedy D. Myth
2. The **social problem discussed in the excerpt mainly concerns**:
A. Poverty and overpopulation B. War C. Education D. Technology
3. Which literary period does “A Modest Proposal” belong to?
A. Romanticism B. Enlightenment C. Medieval literature D. Modernism

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Why do Enlightenment writers like Swift discuss social problems in their works?
2. How does this passage show the Enlightenment interest in improving society?
3. Identify one feature of Enlightenment literature shown in the excerpt.

4. How does satire help Swift criticize society?
5. Why did Neoclassical writers use logic and reason to discuss social issues?

1.6. Modernism

Learning activity 1.6.1



William and his Grandson

In a small village lived an elderly man named William, a devoted guardian of tradition and cultural values. He strongly believed that customs inherited from ancestors were essential in preserving identity and social harmony. Every evening, he shared stories with his family and taught them the importance of respecting established beliefs and maintaining the practices that had guided generations before them.

William's grandson, Daniel, grew up during a period of remarkable social transformation in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. Unlike his grandfather, Daniel became increasingly fascinated by the rapid changes occurring beyond the village. He heard stories about expanding cities, industrial development, and technological innovations that were reshaping society. Motivated by curiosity and ambition, he eventually left his village and moved to the city in search of employment and new opportunities.

Upon arriving in the city, Daniel encountered a completely different reality. The streets were crowded, factories operated continuously, and modern inventions seemed to influence every aspect of life. Scientific progress and technological advancement were transforming people's understanding of the world. However, the devastating effects of the two World Wars also created widespread uncertainty and dissatisfaction with traditional systems and values.

As time passed, Daniel began questioning many of the beliefs he had accepted during his childhood. Although he respected the traditions that had shaped his family and community, he wondered whether old ideas were sufficient to explain the complexities of modern life. Increasingly, people focused on individual experiences, personal emotions, and new perspectives on human existence.

These social transformations also had a profound influence on literature. Writers no longer concentrated exclusively on heroic figures, ideal societies, or fixed moral principles. Instead, they explored themes such as isolation, psychological conflict, confusion, and the complicated nature of human experience. They experimented with innovative literary techniques in order to represent reality more authentically.

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple-Choice Questions

1. Which of the following can strongly influence changes in people's lives?
A. Sleeping habits
B. Daily weather conditions
C. Scientific discoveries and technology
D. Favorite colors
2. Why do many people move from villages to cities?
A. To follow traditions only
B. To look for work and opportunities
C. To avoid education
D. To reduce communication with others
2. What can happen when societies experience major changes?
A. People may begin to think differently B. People stop learning new things
C. People's lives remain unchanged D. People always keep the same beliefs
3. Which factor can influence people's ideas and perspectives?
A. Daily routines only B. The shape of buildings
C. Types of clothing D. New experiences and education
4. What may happen when old and new ideas exist together in society?
A. Everyone automatically agrees B. Traditions disappear immediately
C. People may develop different opinions D. Society completely stops changing

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Explain how people's lifestyles can change over time.
2. Describe some differences between the lives of older generations and young people today.
3. How can technology and new discoveries affect people's daily lives?
4. Why do some people prefer traditional ways while others accept new ideas?
5. Imagine you lived during a period of major social changes. How would those changes affect your life and thinking?
6. Based on their attitudes and experiences, what do William and Daniel symbolize, and how do their different perspectives reflect changes in society?
7. What differences can you identify between traditional literature and modernist literature? Explain your answer using ideas from the text.

1. Meaning of Modern Literature

Modern literature is a literary movement that developed mainly in Europe during the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries (around 1900–1945). It emerged as writers reacted to major social and historical changes such as:

- industrialization;
- urbanization;
- scientific discoveries;
- technological development;
- World War I and World War II;
- changing social values.

Modern writers believed that traditional forms of writing could no longer fully express the realities of modern life. Therefore, they experimented with new themes, styles, and literary techniques.

2. Common Themes in Modern Literature

Theme	Explanation
Alienation	Feeling disconnected from society
Identity	Search for self-understanding
Social Change	Transformation of society and culture
Power and Corruption	Abuse of authority
Oppression	Unfair control over individuals
Injustice	Unequal treatment in society
War and Destruction	Effects of conflict and violence
Fear and Anxiety	Emotional insecurity in modern life
Loneliness	Emotional and social isolation
Disillusionment	Loss of hope and ideals
Freedom	Desire for independence
Psychological Conflict	Internal emotional struggles

3. Major European Modern authors and Their Works

Writer	Life Span	Nationality	Famous Work	Publication Year
James Joyce	1882–1941	Irish	Ulysses	1922
Virginia Woolf	1882–1941	British	Mrs Dalloway	1925
T. S. Eliot	1888–1965	American/ British	The Waste Land	1922
Franz Kafka	1883–1924	Czech	The Metamorphosis	1915

Marcel Proust	1871–1922	French	In Search of Lost Time	1913–1927
D. H. Lawrence	1885–1930	British	Sons and Lovers	1913
Samuel Beckett	1906–1989	Irish	Waiting for Godot	1953
George Orwell	1903–1950	British	Animal Farm	1945
Aldous Huxley	1894–1963	British	Brave New World	1932
Joseph Conrad	1857–1924	Polish-British	Heart of Darkness	1899
Albert Camus	1913–1960	French-Algerian	The Stranger	1942
Jean-Paul Sartre	1905–1980	French	Nausea	1938
Thomas Mann	1875–1955	German	Death in Venice	1912
W. B. Yeats	1865–1939	Irish	The Tower	1928
Ezra Pound	1885–1972	American	The Cantos	1917–1962
Ernest Hemingway	1899–1961	American	The Old Man and the Sea	1952
William Faulkner	1897–1962	American	The Sound and the Fury	1929
F. Scott Fitzgerald	1896–1940	American	The Great Gatsby	1925
Sylvia Plath	1932–1963	American	The Bell Jar	1963
Chinua Achebe	1930–2013	Nigerian	Things Fall Apart	1958

4. Importance of Modern Literature

Modern literature is important because it:

- reflects social and historical changes;
- explores human psychology and emotions;
- questions traditional beliefs and systems;
- develops critical thinking;
- presents realistic human struggles;
- encourages creativity and experimentation in writing.

Modern literature reflects the uncertainties, transformations, and challenges of modern society. Modern writers explored themes such as alienation, fear, injustice, identity, social inequality, psychological conflict, and political oppression.

Unlike traditional literature, modern literature focuses more on individual experiences and experimental ways of presenting reality.

European modern literature greatly influenced world literature and continues to shape contemporary writing today.

Application activity 1.6.2



In a small group read excerpt below from “Animal Farm” by George Orwell and answer the questions that follow

MR. Jones, of the Manor Farm, had locked the henhouses for the night, but was too drunk to remember to shut the pop-holes. With the ring of light from his lantern dancing from side to side, he lurched across the yard, kicked off his boots at the back door, drew himself a last glass of beer from the barrel in the scullery, and made his way up to bed, where Mrs. Jones was already snoring. As soon as the light in the bedroom went out there was a stirring and a fluttering all through the farm buildings. Word had gone round during the day that old Major, the prize Middle White boar, had had a strange dream on the previous night and wished to communicate it to the other

animals. It had been agreed that they should all meet in the big barn as soon as Mr. Jones was safely out of the way. Old Major (so he was always called, though the name under which he had been exhibited was Willingdon Beauty) was so highly regarded on the farm that everyone was quite ready to lose an hour's sleep in order to hear what he had to say. At one end of the big barn, on a sort of raised platform, Major was already ensconced on his bed of straw, under a lantern which hung from a beam. He was twelve years old and had lately grown rather stout, but he was still a majestic-looking pig, with a wise and benevolent appearance in spite of the fact that his tusks had never been cut. Before long the other animals began to arrive and make themselves comfortable after their different fashions. First came the three dogs, Bluebell, Jessie, and Pincher, and then the pigs, who settled down in the straw immediately in front of the platform. The hens perched themselves on the window-sills, the pigeons fluttered up to the rafters, the sheep and cows lay down behind the pigs and began to chew the cud.

The two cart-horses, Boxer and Clover, came in together, walking very slowly and setting down their vast hairy hoofs with great care lest there should be some small animal concealed in the straw. Clover was a stout motherly mare approaching middle life, who had never quite got her figure back after her fourth foal. Boxer was an enormous beast, nearly eighteen hands high, and as strong as any two ordinary horses put together. A white stripe down his nose gave him a somewhat stupid appearance, and in fact he was not of first-rate intelligence, but he was universally respected for his steadiness of character and tremendous powers of work.

After the horses came Muriel, the white goat, and Benjamin, the donkey. Benjamin was the oldest animal on the farm, and the worst tempered. He seldom talked, and when he did, it was usually to make some cynical remark—for instance, he would say that God had given him a tail to keep the flies off, but that he would sooner have had no tail and no flies. Alone among the animals on the farm he never laughed. If asked why, he would say that he saw nothing to laugh at. Nevertheless, without openly admitting it, he was devoted to Boxer; the two of them usually spent their Sundays together in the small paddock beyond the orchard, grazing side by side and never speaking.

The two horses had just lain down when a brood of ducklings, which had lost their mother, filed into the barn, cheeping feebly and wandering from side to side to find some place where they would not be trodden on. Clover made a sort of wall round them with her great foreleg, and the ducklings nestled down inside it and promptly fell asleep. At the last moment Mollie, the foolish, pretty white mare who drew Mr. Jones's trap, came mincing daintily in, chewing at a lump of sugar. She took a place near the front and began flirting her white mane, hoping to draw attention to the red ribbons it was plaited with.

Last of all came the cat, who looked round, as usual, for the warmest place, and finally squeezed herself in between Boxer and Clover; there she purred contentedly throughout Major's speech without listening to a word of what he was saying. All the animals were now present except Moses, the tame raven, who slept on a perch behind the back door. When Major saw that they had all made themselves comfortable and were waiting attentively, he cleared his throat and began: "Comrades, you have heard already about the strange dream that I had last night. But I will come to the dream later. I have something else to say first. I do not think, comrades, that I shall be with you for many months longer, and before I die, I feel it my duty to pass on to you such wisdom as I have acquired. I have had a long life, I have had much time for thought as I lay alone in my stall, and I think I may say that I understand the nature of life on this earth as well as any animal now living. It is about this that I wish to speak to you.

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple Choice Questions

1. The main event that triggers the animals' meeting in the barn is:
A. A fight between animals
B. The arrival of new animals
C. Mr. Jones forgetting to lock the hens
D. Old Major's strange dream and message
2. Old Major is best described as:
A. A violent and aggressive pig
B. A wise and respected leader
C. A careless farmer
D. A young inexperienced animal
3. Which animal is portrayed as cynical and pessimistic?
A. Boxer
B. Mollie
C. Clover
D. Benjamin
4. Boxer is mainly characterized by:
A. Strength and hard work
B. Intelligence and leadership
C. Trickery and manipulation
D. Laziness and selfishness
5. Mollie is mainly interested in:
A. Political change
B. Sugar, ribbons, and attention
C. Listening to Old Major's speech
D. Work on the farm

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Describe the atmosphere in the barn when the animals gather to hear Old Major.
2. Explain how George Orwell presents hierarchy among the animals in this extract.
3. What does Benjamin's attitude reveal about his character and worldview?
4. Identify two features of modern literature visible in this extract and give evidence
5. Modern literature often includes: Political criticism ,Symbolism ,Realism mixed with satire Social injustice .Discuss how **two of these features** appear in the extract

1.7. Language focus: Gerund and infinitive

Learning activity 1.7.1



Text: The WhatsApp Funeral

People in Kigarama village enjoyed using WhatsApp and Facebook for sharing news, exchanging ideas, and communicating with friends. Many villagers liked spending evenings reading messages and watching funny videos online. Among them was a woman called Tereza, who loved spreading gossip and pretending to know everything happening in the village. She preferred typing rumours to doing housework and enjoyed making people believe her stories.

One morning, Tereza decided to post a shocking message in the village WhatsApp group: "Sad news! Our village leader has died. Let us start contributing money for supporting the funeral."

After sending the message, she enjoyed waiting for replies and reading emotional comments. Villagers began contributing money, food, and chickens immediately. Some people wanted to help by donating beans and rice, while others hoped to comfort the family by sending mobile money.

Since Tereza claimed to know the family closely, villagers agreed to allow her to keep the collected money. She enjoyed receiving mobile money notifications and continued posting updates with sad **RIP** captions on WhatsApp and Facebook.

People kept sending her money, hoping she had truly lost a family member. Some villagers liked writing comforting messages such as, "*May the soul continue resting in peace,*" while others promised to continue supporting the funeral arrangements. Tereza loved reading the comments and pretending to organize the burial ceremony.

Soon, villagers started preparing themselves for attending the funeral after one week. Some women practised singing funeral songs, while one man avoided shaving in order to appear sorrowful.

On Saturday morning, mourners began walking slowly to the village leader's home. Some people carried food for feeding visitors, while others continued discussing how to comfort the grieving family.

When they reached the compound, everyone stopped moving.

Instead of hearing people crying, they saw the village leader alive and happily clearing bushes around the home while singing loudly.

The villagers stared at Tereza without speaking. One child started laughing and shouted:

"She enjoys spreading rumours instead of telling the truth!"

People became angry and began demanding to know what happened to the collected money. Tereza tried pretending to faint to avoid answering questions, but nobody wanted to help her.

Meanwhile, the village leader continued laughing at the confused mourners.

Tereza felt ashamed for misleading the community and for using social media carelessly. From that day onward, villagers learned to avoid believing every message without verifying the truth first. They also agreed to stop allowing Tereza to keep community money again and removed her from the WhatsApp group.

By REB's Literature in English Content Developer Team (2026).

A. Comprehension Questions

1. What was Tereza's habit? Use examples from the text.
2. What made people start contributing money so quickly?
3. What mistake did the villagers make when they received the message?
4. Why is it important to verify a message before taking action?
5. What messages could you give to anyone using social media irresponsibly?
6. What did you learn from the text about using social media?

B. Language skills

1. Look carefully at the underlined ideas from the story.
 - Enjoy spending evenings reading messages
 - I loved spreading gossip
 - started contributing money
 - I wanted to help by donating food
 - avoided shaving their beards
 - learned to avoid believing rumours

2. Think and Answer

1. Which words come after **enjoy, love, start, avoid**?
2. Which words come after **want, learn**?
3. Do these verbs use the same form or different forms?
4. Can you group the words into two patterns?
5. Which pattern uses **-ing**?
1. Which pattern uses **to + verb**?
2. Do you think English verbs always use the same form after every verb? Why or why not?
3. Can you guess why some verbs are followed by **-ing** and others by **to + verb**?

Gerund and Infinitive

Gerunds and infinitives are important verb forms in English used to talk about actions in different ways. A gerund is formed by adding **-ing** to a verb, while an infinitive is formed using **to + base verb**. They often follow certain verbs and help us express activities, intentions, and purposes.

1. Gerund (verb + -ing)

A **gerund** is a verb form ending in **-ing** that works like a noun.

Examples from the text:

- Spreading rumours (Tereza enjoyed spreading rumours on WhatsApp)
- Using WhatsApp (people enjoyed using WhatsApp to share news)
- Reading messages (villagers liked reading messages in the group)
- Sending money (people kept sending money for the "funeral")
- Waiting for replies (Tereza enjoyed waiting for replies on her phone)
- Receiving mobile money (she enjoyed receiving mobile money notifications)
- Communicating with friends (people liked communicating through WhatsApp)

Key idea: Gerunds are used after verbs like **enjoy, like, love, keep, avoid, finish, mind, suggest, recommend, consider, admit, deny, miss, postpone, risk, imagine, appreciate, dislike, quit, stop** (when it means giving up an activity).

2. Infinitive (to + verb)

An infinitive is formed using **to + base verb**.

Examples from the text:

- to contribute money for the funeral
- to support the funeral arrangements

- to know the family closely
- to believe the message from WhatsApp
- to verify information before acting
- to attend the funeral ceremony
- to organize the burial ceremony
- to stop believing rumours

Key idea to note: Infinitives are used after verbs like want, decide, hope, agree, refuse, need, learn, plan, expect, promise, choose, manage, fail, afford, offer, attempt, prepare, aim, wish, intend, ask, seem.

3. Difference between Gerund and Infinitive

- ✓ **Gerund (verb + -ing)** → focuses on an activity
Example: *reading messages is fun*
- ✓ **Infinitive (to + verb)** → shows purpose or intention
Example: *to verify the message before acting*

4. Simple Rule to Remember

- ✓ Use **gerund** when talking about activities you enjoy or do regularly
- ✓ Use **infinitive** when talking about purpose, plans, or decisions

Application activity 1.7.2



A. Choose the correct form : Gerund or Infinitive

1. The students avoided _____ (**cheat / cheating**) during the exam.
2. She promised _____ (**to submit / submitting**) her assignment on time.
3. He enjoys _____ (**play / playing**) football after school.
4. The teacher encouraged us _____ (**to read / reading**) more novels.
5. They risked _____ (**losing / to lose**) marks by arriving late.
6. They risked _____ (**losing / to lose**) marks by arriving late.
7. I decided _____ (**to join / joining**) the science club.
8. The boys kept _____ (**talking / to talk**) during the lesson.
9. She refused _____ (**to copy / copying**) her friend's answers.

B. Error Correction (Rewrite correctly)

1. The students suggested to revise together before the test. → _____
2. He enjoyed to play video games all night. → _____

3. They decided going on a school trip. → _____
4. She stopped to listen when the teacher entered. → _____
5. I want learning new computer skills. → _____

C. Instructions

Listen carefully and fill in the blanks with the correct form of the words in the box:
organize • work • bring • touch • help • finish • talk • feel • repeat • invite

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



1. Comprehension question

Movement Four

Night of the Skull

Lerema's home at the shrine. Open courtyard 'spitting' round the bridal chamber, where Mkumbu, watched by Lerema, prepares Letie, the skull, for the arrival of his bride. The drums from the end of Movement Three rise up to a peak of intensity then gradually subside.

Mkumbu: I will wash you in fresh millet beer, little man, to toughen your limbs for your night: this is the night of your manhood.

1. Read the passage carefully and answer all questions.

Clarissa Dalloway was walking through the streets of London on a bright June morning. She was going to buy flowers for the party she was hosting that evening. As she walked, her mind moved back and forth between the present moment and distant memories of her youth a summer long ago, a young man she had once loved, choices she had made, and roads she had never taken.

The sounds of the city surrounded her the roar of cars, the voices of strangers, the noise of modern life. Yet inside, she felt strangely alone. The city was full of people, but Clarissa carried her thoughts and memories like a private world that no one else could enter.

She thought: *"This is what I love — life, London, this moment in June."* And yet beneath that love was something she could not name a shadow, a feeling that time was passing, that life was fragile, that everything beautiful would one day end.

Extract adapted from "Mrs Dalloway" by Virginia Woolf

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. How does Clarissa feel despite being surrounded by people in a busy city?
A) Excited and joyful B) Angry and frustrated C) Proud and confident
D) Strangely alone and isolated
2. Which Modernist technique is clearly shown when the reader directly accesses Clarissa's inner thoughts?
A) Allegory B) Satire C) Stream of consciousness D) Epic narration

ii. Open-ended questions

1. In your own words, describe what Clarissa is thinking and feeling as she walks through London.
2. Identify two features of Modernist literature in the passage. For each feature, quote evidence from the text and explain how it illustrates that feature.
3. Clarissa carries her thoughts *"like a private world no one else could enter."* In African literary traditions, storytelling is usually a communal and shared experience.
4. Using this contrast: Identify one way European and African literary traditions are similar, identify one way they are different

B. Fill in the Gaps Form of Questions

Fill in the blanks with the correct answers.

1. European literature first started in _____.
2. The _____ period mainly focused on gods, heroes, and fate.
3. The _____ period mainly emphasized religion and strong belief in the Church.
4. The _____ period focused on emotions, imagination, and nature.
5. The _____ period deals with themes such as war, identity, and modern life problems.

C. Answer True or False

1. The Classical period focused on gods, heroes, and fate.
2. The Medieval period emphasized faith and religion.
3. Romanticism mainly focused on reason and logic.
4. Modernism deals with themes like war and identity.

5. African literature was mainly written while European literature was mainly oral.
6. Studying European literature helps improve reading and writing skills.

D. Language skills

1. What is a gerund? Give three examples of verbs always followed by a gerund and write a sentence for each.
2. Identify and correct the errors in the sentences below, and explain why each correction is necessary.
a) *"She enjoys to read novels."*
a) *"He decided leaving early."*
b) *"I am good at to cook."*
3. Explain the difference in meaning between these two sentences and state what grammar rule causes the difference:
a) *"I stopped smoking."*
b) *"I stopped to smoke."*
4. Choose one correct answer
 - i. Which verb is always followed by a gerund?
A) want B) hope C) enjoy D) decide
 - ii. Choose the correct form: "She is interested in _____ French."
A) learn B) to learn C) learning D) learned

E. Project: Creative writing and oral performance

Choose ONE. Write a well-organized essay with a clear introduction, body, and conclusion.

EITHER

1. "European and African literary traditions are more similar than they are different."

Using examples from at least two European literary periods and one African literary tradition you know, discuss the points where these two traditions meet in themes, storytelling techniques, moral lessons, or the use of heroes and where they differ. Conclude with your own reasoned judgment on whether you agree or disagree with the statement. OR

Do research on internet or from using library and read one excerpt from a European literary text and present it orally.

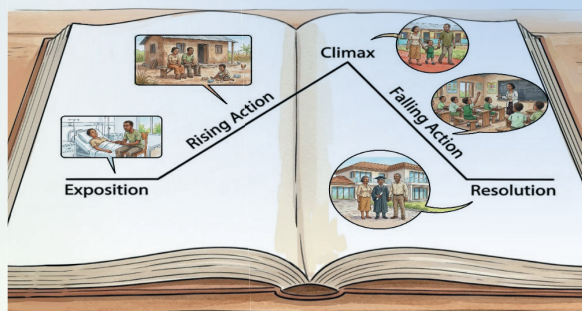
UNIT 2

UNDERSTANDING PROSE



Key Unit Competence:

To be able to analyse prose texts critically by identifying narrative elements, literary techniques, and themes, evaluate how structure, style, and modal verbs affect meaning.



Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

- ✓ Explain prose and distinguish it from poetry and drama.
- ✓ List the types of prose and describe the functions of narrative elements: plot, character, setting, and theme.
- ✓ Identify literary devices such as dialogue, flashback, foreshadowing, narrative voice, diction, symbolism, and irony, and explain the uses of modal verbs.

Skills

2

- ✓ Analyze prose texts to identify narrative elements, literary devices, and stylistic features.
- ✓ Interpret the meaning of plot, character, setting, theme, and authorial choices, and compare and contrast different prose genres and cultural contexts.
- ✓ Apply modal verbs accurately in both discussion and writing, and articulate personal and critical responses supported by relevant textual evidence.

Attitudes and values

3

- ✓ Appreciate prose as a reflection of human experience and cultural heritage.
- ✓ Develop empathy and respect for diverse perspectives and cultures, and demonstrate critical thinking when exploring themes such as justice, identity, and morality.
- ✓ Value ethical reflection on character decisions and societal dilemmas, and find joy in analyzing, interpreting, and creating narratives.

2.0. Introduction to the unit

You have already encountered many forms of prose in stories, novels, newspapers, and other texts. In this unit, you will deepen your understanding by exploring how writers use elements such as plot, character, setting, and theme to create meaning. You will also examine literary devices like flashback, foreshadowing, symbolism, and dialogue, while strengthening your Language enhancement through the use of modal verbs such as would, should, and could. By the end of the unit, you will be able to analyze prose texts with greater confidence and appreciate how stories reflect human experiences and the world around us.

Introductory activity



Discuss the following questions.

- What is the difference between a short story and a novel? Which do you prefer and why?
- Think about a story you have read that taught you something about life. What did you learn?
- Why do you think writers choose to tell stories with a lessons or morals rather than simply state lessons directly for people to learn?
- Look at the titles of the stories you will study: *"Sandra Street"*, *"When the Sun Goes Down"*, *"Twilight Trek"* and *"Leaving"*. What do these titles suggest about the possible themes or subjects of the stories?
- How might reading stories from different cultures help us understand people who live different from us?
- What questions do you hope this unit will answer about prose and how to understand it better?

2.1. Review the key aspects of prose and their effects in the prose

2.1.1. Characters, Characterization, and Point of View

Learning activity 2.1.1



Read the Extract below "Sandra Street" by Michael Anthony and answer questions that follow

Mr. Blades, the new teacher, was delighted with the composition we wrote about Sandra Street. He read some aloud to the class. He seemed particularly pleased when he read what was written by one of the boys from the other side of the town.

"Sandra Street is dull and uninteresting," the boy wrote. "For one half of its length, there are a few houses and a private school (which we go to) but the other half is nothing but a wilderness of a big tree." Mr. Blades smiled from the corners of his mouth and looked at those of us who belonged to Sandra Street. "In fact," the boy wrote, "it is the only street in our town that has big trees, and I do not think it is a part of our town at all because it is so far and so different from our other streets."

The boy went on to speak of the gay attractions on the other side of the town, some of which, he said, Sandra Street could never dream to have. In his street, for instance, there was the savannah where they played football and cricket, but the boys of Sandra Street had to play their cricket in the road. And to the amusement of Mr. Blades, who also came from the other side of the town, he described Sandra Street as a silly little girl who ran away to the bushes to hide herself. Everyone laughed except the few of us from Sandra Street, and I knew what was going to happen when school was dismissed, although Mr. Blades said it was all a joke and in fact Sandra Street was very fine. I did not know whether he meant this or not, for he seemed very much amused and I felt this was because he came from the other side of the town. He read out a few more of the compositions.

Some of them said very nice things about Sandra Street but those were the ones written by ourselves. Mr. Blades seemed delighted about these, too, and I felt he was trying to appease us when he said that they showed up a new character of the beauty of Sandra Street. There were only a few of us who were appeased, though, and he noticed this and said all right, next Tuesday we will write about the other side of the town. This brought fiendish laughter from some of us from Sandra Street, and judging from the looks on the faces of those from the other side of the town, I knew what would happen next Tuesday, too, when school was dismissed. And I felt that whatever happened it was not going to make any difference to our side or to the other side of the town.

Yet the boy's composition was very truthful. Sandra Street was so different from the other street beyond. Indeed, it came from the very quiet fringes and ran straight up to the forests. As it left the town there were a few houses and shops along it, and then the school, and after that there were not many more houses, and the big trees started from there till the road trailed off to the river that bordered the forests. During the day all was very quiet except perhaps for the voice of one neighbor calling to another, and if some evenings brought excitement to the schoolyard, these did very little to disturb the calmness of Sandra Street. Nor did the steel-band gently humming from the other side of the town. I had to remember the steel-band because although I liked to hear it, I had to put into my composition that it was very bad. We had no steel-bands in Sandra Street, and I thought I could say this was because we were decent, cultured folk and did not like the horrible noises of steel-bands.

I sat in class recalling the boy's composition again. Outside the window I could see the women coming out of the shops. They hardly passed each other without stopping to talk and this made me laugh. For that was exactly what the boy had written—that they could not pass without stopping to talk, as if they had something to talk about. I wondered what they talked about. I did not know. What I did know was that they never seemed to leave Sandra Street to go into town. Maybe they were independent of the town. I chuckled, a triumphant little chuckle because this, too, would be good to put into my composition next Tuesday.

Dreamingly I gazed out of the window. I noticed how Sandra Street stood away from the profusion of houses. Indeed, it did not seem to belong to the town at all. It stood off, not proudly, but sadly, like one desiring peace and rest. I felt all filled-up inside. Not because of the town in the distance, but of this strange little road. It was funny, the things the boy had written. He had written in anger what I thought of now in joy. He had spoken of the pleasures and palaces on the other side of the town. He had said why they were his home sweet home. As I looked at Sandra Street, I, too, knew why it was my home sweet home. It was dull and uninteresting to him but it meant so much to me. It was-

"Oh" I started, as the hand rested on my shoulder.

"It's recess," said Mr. Blades.

"O-yes, Sir" The class was surging out to the playground. I did not seem to have heard a sound before.

Mr. Blades looked at me and smiled. "What are you thinking of?" he said. He seemed to be looking inside me. Inside my very mind. I stammered out a few words which even if they were clear would not have meant anything. I stopped. He was still smiling quietly at me. "You are the boy from Sandra Street?" he said.

"Yes, Sir."

"I thought so," he said.

What happened the following Tuesday after school was a lot worse than what had ever happened before, and it was a mystery how the neighbors did not complain or Mr. Blades did not get to hear of it. We turned out to school the next morning as if all had been peaceful, and truly there was no sign of the battle save the little bruises which were easy to explain away.

We kept getting compositions to write. Mr. Blades was always anxious to judge what we wrote but none gave him as much delight as those we had written on Sandra Street. He had said that he knew the other side of the town very well and no one could fool him about that, but if any boy wrote anything about Sandra Street he would have to see. And when he had said that he had looked at me and I was very embarrassed. I had turned my eyes away, and he had said that when the mango season came, he would see the boy who did not speak the truth about Sandra Street.

By Michael Anthony, Extracted from When the Sun Goes Down and Other Stories from Africa and Beyond.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. What does the boy from the other side of town mainly write about Sandra Street?
A. Its beautiful gardens B. Its poor conditions and problems C. Its famous people
D. Its sports activities

2. In which point of view is the story told?

- A. First-person narration B. Third-person narration C. Second-person narration D. Dialogue narration

ii. Answer True or False

1. The students on Sandra Street feel proud and happy about what the boy writes about them. _
2. The narrator of the story is one of the characters telling events using words like "I" or "we."

iii. Open-ended questions

1. Pick one sentence where the narrator shares a personal thought. What does it reveal about his feelings?
2. The narrator notices that women of Sandra Street never go into town. What does this tell us about life on Sandra Street compared to the other side?
3. The narrator admits the other boy's composition was "truthful," but he still feels hurt. Why do people feel hurt when someone criticizes a place they love?

B. Language enhancement

Write down the difficult vocabularies found in the extract and use dictionary to find their meanings?

C. Oral presentation

Why does the narrator love Sandra Street while the other boy finds it dull? What does this teach you about how people see the same place differently?

Review the key aspects of prose

A. Characters and Characterization and its effect

Characters are the central agents of a narrative; their presentation and development shape the plot, influence thematic meaning, and determine the overall impact of the story on the reader Aspect	Effect on Story Development
Characters	Create conflict, generate reader empathy, embody themes, and drive the plot forward through their choices and actions.
Characterization	Reveals character personality, motivations, and growth, which shapes how readers understand and respond to events.

In "*Sandra Street*":

The narrator's deep attachment to his home creates the central conflict—not a physical fight, but an internal struggle between pride and honesty.

B. Point of View and its effect

Point of view determines what readers see, know, and feel. It controls the flow of information and shapes the reader's relationship with characters and events.

Type of Point of View	Effect on Story Development
First Person	Creates intimacy and immediacy; readers experience events through the narrator's senses and emotions. Limits knowledge to what the narrator knows, which can create suspense or mystery.
Third Person Limited	Balances intimacy with some distance; readers know one character deeply but must infer others' thoughts and feelings.
Third Person Omniscient	Provides a broad view of all characters and events; can shift between perspectives to create complex understanding.

In *Sandra Street*:

The first-person narrator allows readers to feel his embarrassment, his defensive pride, and his growing awareness of why he loves his street.

Application activity 2.1.1.2



Read the Extract below and answer questions that follow

Since that day I was very shy of Mr. Blades and whenever I saw him walking towards me, I turned in another direction. At such times there would always be a faint smile at the corners of his mouth. I stood looking out of the school window one day thinking about this and about the compositions when again I felt a light touch and jumped.

"Looking out?" Mr. Blades said.

"Yes, Sir."

He stood there beside me and we both looked out of the window. It was just about noon and the sun was blazing down on Sandra Street. The houses stood tall and almost somber, and there seemed to be no movement about save for the fowls lying in the shadows of the houses. As I watched this, a certain sadness came over me and I looked over the houses across to the hills. Suddenly my heart leaped, and I turned to Mr. Blades, but I changed my mind and did not speak. He had hardly noticed that I looked up at him. I saw his face looking sad as his eyes wandered about the houses.

I looked at Mr. Blades. He was smiling faintly.

"Fowls," he said.

"There are no gates," I apologized.

"No, there are no gates." And he laughed softly.

"Because..." I had to stop. I didn't know why there were no gates.

"Because you did not notice that before."

"I noticed that before," I said.

Looking sharply at me he raised his brows and said slowly, "You noticed all this and you wrote about Sandra Street without mentioning it, eh? How many marks did you make?"

"Forty-five." He looked surprised.

"Mango blossoms," I said, feeling like crying out. "I wanted to show it to you."

"Did you write about it?"

"No." I just wanted to break out and run away.

"There is something like observation, Steve," he said. "Observation. You live in Sandra Street. Yet Kenneth writes a composition on your own place better than you."

I was often jealous. Mr. Blades had a passion for compositions, and I was anxious to show him how much I observed. And whenever I said something wonderful, I knew it because of the way Mr. Blades would look at me.

The rains had almost ceased, but there were still great patches of dark cloud in the sky. The sun was shining brightly now, and I could smell the steam rising from the hot pitch and the galvanized roofs.

"Rain falling, sun shining," Mr. Blades said. And I smiled.

Then thoughtfully he said, "You think they're all right?"

"What, Sir?"

"In the immortelle root."

I was astonished. I put my hands to my mouth. How did he know? He smiled down at me. "You won't be able to jump over now!" And the whole thing was revealed. I could not help laughing. I had put into my composition how I went into the hills last Sunday evening and how the mango trees were laden with small mangoes, some full, and how there were banana trees among the immortelles and poui.

"They're all right" I said, and pretended to be watching the steam rising from the hot pitch. I liked bananas too. It always made me lick my lips.

"Sir..." I said to him, and I hesitated. Then I took the wild chance. And when he answered, a feeling of extreme happiness swept over me.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple Choice questions

1. Why is the narrator shy of Mr. Blades at the beginning of the extract?
 - A. Mr. Blades punished him for talking in class.
 - B. He feels embarrassed about their previous conversation.
 - C. Mr. Blades comes from the other side of town.
 - D. He failed his composition and got low marks.
2. According to Mr. Blades, what is more important than just living in a place?
 - A. Writing long compositions with big words.
 - B. Getting good marks to pass examinations.
 - C. Observation and noticing details around you.
 - D. Being friends with everyone in the neighborhood.

ii. Open-ended questions

1. What is the extract about?

iii. Match each term in Column A with its correct description in Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Dialogue	A. The main character around whom the story revolves
2. Indirect characterization	B. The story is told by a character using "I" or "we"
3. First-person point of view	C. When we learn about a character through their actions and thoughts
4. Protagonist	D. Words spoken by characters that reveal their thoughts or feelings

iv. Answer True or False

1. The narrator feels proud when Mr. Blades points at the mango blossoms.

 - b. Mr. Blades teaches the narrator to notice and describe what he observes around him. ____
 - +c. The narrator is initially shy of Mr. Blades. _____
 - d. By the end of the conversation, the narrator understands the lesson about observation. _
2. E. Mr. Blades asks the narrator: "Did you notice the cedar grove at the pot? Did you speak of the river? Did you notice the hills?" What point is Mr. Blades trying to make about the narrator's composition?
 3. F. Explain how the narrator's feelings toward Mr. Blades change during their conversation at the window. What causes this change?

B. Oral presentation

Suppose you are asked to describe your home village, what would you include in your writing. Share your ideas orally?

2.1.2. Themes, messages, settings and conflicts

Learning activity 2.1.2.1



Read the Extract below "When the Sun Goes Down" by Goro wa Kamau and answer questions that follow

She heaved and gasped painfully, trying to get hold of her emotions. Finally, she wiped her tears and looked at her son, playing innocently on his father's lap. She had two daughters from her first marriage but this boy, the fruit of the only true love she had ever known in her thirty and five years under the sun, was the crown of her life. Still, a fear tugged at her heart leaving her belly feeling an airy hollowness. Would she live to see him grow up into a man? And if she died, would Steve care for him or would he let the boy to wander unloved, unwanted on the harsh streets of life? Maureen had no doubt that Steve would live: he had the will. She wished she too could summon up that kind of spirit. She looked at Steve and their son again, the way a seer peers at the contents of his diviner-gourd to read the secrets of life and she smiled wearily These were her men. She could die but these two, father and son, would always be together. Nothing could separate them. She could see that in the way the boy sat and played so snugly with his father, in the way Steve held him as if he would never let go. It was such a perfect picture. Just as if the whole world was just the two of them. Still, she wanted reassurance but when she tried to speak, the-words would not form. Steve held her eyes in his in that judicious manner of his and she knew he knew what she wanted to ask. And the answer was in his eyes — a more profound answer than any words could speak. In that moment, Maureen felt strangely relaxed and her heart sang: *Ngũmbûkanyumethĩĩ, Mageganiameekwothĩĩ, matarĩmekwo!* Yes, she would fly out of this world and wonders hitherto unseen would be performed on earth ...

Maureen felt ready to fly. Long after Steve and the boy had left, Maureen stood in the middle of the room gazing at that picture in her mind. The beauty of it tugged painfully at her heart and in spite of herself something gave way. Warm tears flowed freely down her face. If only people were more compassionate.

The sun was already dipping behind the Kianderi hills. "How time flies!" Steve exclaimed when they came to the road. "Let's see you again when the sun rises. "Yes, let's," Kanja said.

When he returned, Steve found Maureen coiled up in bed; a picture of dejection. Her Bible, everpresent these days, open at Psalms Twenty-Three. "What is it, Ma?" the little boy asked. He tried to turn her over but Maureen buried her face in the pillows and wept.

The boy started to cry. Maureen sat up and took him in her arms. "You know why your friend did not drink the juice?" she asked between her heart wrenching cries.

"Yes, of course I know," Steve replied.

"Why are people so cruel?"

"No, Maureen. Normally, people do not mean to be cruel. Most are just selfish and ignorant. It is normal, I think, to fear the unknown.

"It hurts . . . when your age-mate comes to my house and refuses to take what I serve him, it hurts," Maureen moaned.

"You must learn to ignore people like that. What they say, what they do. What does it matter? Are they not the same people who a while ago used to speak of how beautiful you are?"

"They didn't mean it!" Maureen scowled like an angry cat.

"Of course, they didn't. *Gûthekiotikwendwo*, to be smiled at is not to be loved. That's how the elders caution us. But do we listen? No! The result? I will tell you. Dysfunctional, loveless families that weigh like a millstone around our necks or we are condemned to living shadowy, demeaning lives that turn the best among us into mean and cruel monsters. I don't consider that living. And verily, verily I say unto you: do not be deceived. Despite all the pretences, not many people can say they have lived as happily as we have lived these past three or so years. That is something. That is everything. And we can still live if you always remember to forget the things that make you sad, and remember to remember the things that make you glad. Like our son,

here. Let's always count our blessings, dear.'

"You should have been a preacher," Maureen smiled.

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions.

- a) Which idea best reveals the main theme in Maureen's thought, "These were her men"?
- A. Love and family bonds give people hope during difficult times.
 - B. Wealth is necessary for happiness.
 - C. Children create problems in families.
 - D. Illness always destroys relationships.
- b) Kanja's refusal to drink the juice mainly reveals which conflict/message in the extract?
- A. The conflict between wealth and poverty.
 - B. The fear and stigma surrounding HIV/AIDS.
 - C. A disagreement about food preferences.
 - D. Competition between friends.

ii. Answer True or False

- a) Maureen's thoughts about Steve and her son help reveal the theme of love and family support. __
- b) Kanja drinking the juice helps show that fear and stigma can be overcome. __
- c) The mention of the Kianderi hills and the setting sun creates a mood connected to Maureen's emotional state. __
- d) Steve's words suggest the message that people can sometimes judge others unfairly. __

iii. Open-ended questions

- a) Maureen looks at Steve and their son and thinks, "These were her men."

What theme and message does this thought reveal? Explain how it shapes the emotions in the scene.

- b) The sun is described as "dipping behind the Kianderi hills."

How does this description help reveal the setting and mood of the extract? Explain the connection between the setting and the events happening in the story.

- c) Two important conflicts appear in the extract:

Maureen's fear of death

Kanja's refusal to drink juice

Explain how each conflict is revealed in the extract and give examples to show what message the writer wants readers to learn.

B. Language enhancement

1. Listen and fill in the gaps as the paragraph is being read to you.

Maureen's greatest __ was that she would not live to see her __ __ up. As she looked at Steve and her child, she thought, "These were her __." The sun was __ behind the Kianderi __, creating a quiet atmosphere. Maureen worried about her __ and how it might affect her __. Meanwhile, Kanja refused to drink the __ because of people's __ attitudes and fears.

2. Matching question

Column A: Words/ Expressions from the Extract	Column B: Meanings
1. Reassured	A. To become older and more mature
2. Cruel	B. Feeling comforted and less worried
3. Dipping	C. A disease or unhealthy condition
4. Illness	D. Showing little kindness or causing suffering to others
5. Fear	E. Going down slowly below the horizon
6. Refusal	F. A feeling of worry or anxiety about danger
7. Kianderi hills	G. Saying no or rejecting something
8. Grow up	H. A physical feature of the setting mentioned in the story

A. Themes ,Messages and effects

Themes give a story depth and meaning beyond the surface events. They connect characters' personal experiences to universal human concerns that readers can relate to. Messages guide readers toward reflection on life, morality, and society, often revealed through character actions and story outcomes.

When a theme is developed well, it makes readers think about their own lives and the world around them. The story becomes more than just entertainment—it becomes a mirror for human experience.

Example: In this extract, the theme of love and fear of death shapes everything Maureen feels and does. Her concern for her son's future after she dies drives her emotions and gives the scene its emotional weight.

B. Setting and its effect

Setting creates atmosphere and mood that influence how readers feel about events. The physical surroundings can reflect characters' emotional states—a dark room might mirror sadness, while an open landscape might suggest hope or freedom.

Time and social environment shape characters' perspectives and the conflicts they face. A story set in a village will have different tensions than one set in a city. The social setting reveals cultural values and expectations that characters must navigate.

Example: The story takes place in a home with Maureen in bed, her Bible open at Psalms Twenty-Three. This domestic setting makes her suffering feel personal, and the Bible reference adds a spiritual dimension to her fear of death.

C. Conflict and its effect

Conflict drives the plot forward and reveals who characters really are. When characters face struggles, their true nature emerges. Internal conflict happens within a character's mind—fear, doubt, guilt, or competing desires. This type of conflict creates reader empathy because everyone has experienced inner struggles.

External conflict happens between a character and outside forces—another person, society, or nature. This creates action and tension that keeps readers engaged.

Both types of conflict work together to create emotional engagement and make readers care about what happens.

Example: Maureen experiences internal conflict between her fear of death and her love for her family. Kanja's refusal to drink juice creates external conflict between him and the family, revealing society's stigma against HIV.

Application activity 2.1.2.2



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

Steve felt a strong craving for a cigarette. His lips and fingers quivered. He looked longingly at the three cigarettes he had strung together and hung at the head of his bed the day the doctor asked him to stop smoking. For a while, he struggled with the temptation to reach out for one. "Actually, when I was young I toyed with the idea of becoming a Catholic priest. My mother discouraged me. I was her eldest child, you see, and when my father passed on, I knew I had a duty to my ancestors to keep the family name alive. That's why for me it is such a good thing that Kimotho is free of the virus. When we are gone, he shall bring us back you and me to earth through his own children. Do you realise that in the next generation, we two shall be brother and sister?" Maureen now laughed. This man, the things he spoke. "But you don't know whether he shall have only sons or only daughters, or even no children at all," she said.

"I am positive..."

"Of course, you are. The doctor said so," she interjected.

Steve laughed. He felt good. If she could joke about their status, that was a good sign. There was hope. "It is not of that I speak. That I accept. What I meant to say is that I am sure our son shall have a son of his own, who as is customary, he shall name after his father; and a daughter whom he shall name after his mother. In our next life we shall be brother and sister! Don't you see Maureen, today we may have no names in the street. For those who know no better, the virus might be our first names but our names, our remembrance shall never be erased from the face of the earth!"

It was true, Maureen thought. The cycle of life of which Steve spoke was so true. So comforting. Wasn't she herself the reincarnation of her grandmother? Were these not the wonders to be performed when she was gone? How had she forgotten such a natural principle of life? The revelation was so uplifting. She hugged Steve.

"I will always love you — in this and the next life," she smiled and for a moment it was just like in the days when they met. "Let me tell you something.

One day, I will meet your mother just to tell her what a wonderful man she managed to bring into this world. You know, women don't bring forth boys like you anymore."

In the corner, Steve put a record on the gramophone. In a while, Kamarû's silky-smooth voice filled the house with wistful love lyrics "Till Death Do Us Part." It was one of Steve's favourite records. As he sang along, he marvelled at the power of love to overcome:

My love

I love you like a ring on the finger

Or like my bedtime clothes I love you like a mirror directed towards the sun Or like an orange in the month of dryness...

The song held Steve in its spell. And it dawned on him how true the words of the song were. The greatest is love. It was the only sanctuary for those who suffered. Yet, what a short supply it was in! He wished people would not hoard love, the way businessmen hid flour so that the price could go up. Always thinking about their profits while across the country, hunger trailed the poor to their beds. What selfishness! what cruelty! God, forgive them for they know not what they do!

It was now dark. Steve stood at the window. A smattering of stars was barely visible in the sky. He switched on the lights and blinked against the sudden brightness that flooded the room. Maureen was like the sun; the way the pendulum of her moods swung these days, shining bright one moment and hiding behind dark clouds in the next. Now she lay on the bed, the little boy asleep in her arms, looking forlorn, woebegone.

Steve went to the kitchen and started preparing supper. As he fell to work, he smiled to himself with a new remembrance. According to the people, Steve's woman had bewitched him. See how he goes shopping in the market, and I hear he even cooks for her . . . Now 6' what's that if not medicine? A man cooking for a woman? That woman, she's ruined a fine man just so that she can reach his money! Such talk used to enrage Steve. Now he just savoured it indulgently, remembering many years ago when his mother traded clay pots at the Murang'a market. He would help her sometimes. But on many a day, he would be left at home to take care of his sisters — washing for them, cooking for them. So what was the big deal? Let those who must speak because they have mouths to speak. Yes, let them talk.

The food was ready. Mweapishori served with *kunde*, lentils, spinach and fried liver. The little boy gobbled up the food happily but Maureen would not eat no matter how hard Steve tried to coax her. It was a waste of good food, seeing that she was dying anyway, she argued. "You can't hold your health if you don't eat," he pleaded.

"You just must eat and take your drugs every day.

"Oh Steve, you don't know how weary I am. I just wish to rest." Steve tried to jostle with Maureen and managed to force some food into her mouth.

She gave in but after she had eaten just a few spoonfuls, she started to gasp as if she would throw up. Nausea. "I just wish to rest," she repeated. Steve knew very well what she meant by rest. "I have told you many times that you should banish thoughts of death from your mind," he admonished.

"Knowing that every sun that sets brings me closer to the grave?"

"But it does that for everybody."

"Well, yes. Life is a fatal disease. But with AIDS coursing through my veins, I am the living dead already," Maureen declared.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. What does Steve mean when he says, "I am positive..."?

- A. Steve is confident about the future B. Steve has tested positive for HIV
C. Steve is optimistic about their son D. Steve agrees with Maureen's question

2. What song does Steve play on the gramophone?

- A. "Love Forever" B. "Till Death Do Us Part" C. "Always Together" D. "My Love"

3. Why does Maureen refuse to eat?

- A. She does not like the food B. She is angry with Steve
C. She feels she is dying anyway D. She is not hungry

ii. Matching Activity

(Match each idea in Column A with its correct meaning in Column B.)

Column A	Column B
a. Theme	A. The time and place where a story happens
b. Setting	B. A struggle within a character's mind
c. Internal conflict	C. The central idea or message of a story
d. External conflict	D. A struggle between a character and outside forces

iii. Answer True or False

- a) Steve's mother encouraged him to become a Catholic priest. _____
- b) Maureen finds comfort in the idea of reincarnation and the cycle of life. _____
- c) Steve becomes angry when he remembers people gossiping about him cooking for Maureen. _____
- d) Steve believes that love is abundant and freely given by everyone. _____

iv. Open-ended questions

- a. Steve tells Maureen, "Our names, our remembrance shall never be erased from the face of the earth!"**

What theme does this statement reveal? How does this idea help Maureen cope with her situation?

- b. The extract shifts from day to night, with Steve standing at the window looking at the stars.**

How does this change in setting reflect what is happening in the story? What mood does it create?

- c. Maureen experiences both internal and external conflict in this extract.**

Identify one example of each and explain what it reveals about her character.

- Internal conflict example: _____
- What it reveals: _____
- External conflict example: _____
- What it reveals: _____

- d. Steve thinks about people who gossip about him for cooking and caring for Maureen.**

How does his reaction to this gossip show his character? What lesson can readers learn from his behavior?

B. Oral presentation

Suppose you were Steve in this story.

What advice would you give Maureen to help her remain hopeful?

Speak for one minute.

2.1.3. Symbolism, Flashbacks, Foreshadowing and Dialogue

Learning activity 2.1.3.1



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

"That's the wrong way to look at it and you know it," Steve retorted with a tinge of impatience. "Why is it when we agree that we must fight this thing together, you keep on retracting? Why?" "But I am just a woman you know. The mind agrees with you but the spirit is weak," Maureen said. "You insult yourself. You insult all womanhood. What on earth do you mean, the mind is willing but the spirit is weak?" Steve demanded. But maybe she was right, he mused, Maureen had simply allowed the virus to kill her spirit to live.

On second thought, he concluded that this was not even true. This had nothing to do with the fact that she was a woman. It had nothing to do with the virus either. It had to do with her deep-seated sense of guilt. The feeling that she was somehow responsible for his illness. It was an idea that loose speaking mouths had so rooted in her unconscious mind that it was always lying somewhere just below the surface, ready to bubble up any moment at the least excuse. Like a refrain in a dirge or a stuck gramophone record, those idle words repeated themselves so regularly in her heart that she too had come to believe them. That woman, she's ruined a fine man just so that she can reach his money! No matter how much you loved them, how did one uproot a thorny thicket that grew inside another person's heart? Without Maureen, Steve knew that there should be no sunshine in his world but for the first time ever, he allowed himself to contemplate the terrible possibility of her death.

"I was a faithful woman ...faithful to my husband . . . faithful to this other man, the only man who ever truly loved me and treated me like a woman should be treated. With love. Respect. I was a faith-'

"Maureen, are you alright?" Steve asked, roused from his sleep by her rumbling. He switched on the lights. Maureen coiled away to the far end of the bed, her back against the wall and a dazed expression on her face. She was trembling like somebody who had just woken up from a nightmare. A burst of panic sent spasms of fear cascading down Steve's spine. Gently; he touched her brow. It was scalding hot. Was this the moment he had dreaded?

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Match each description with the correct example from the extract.

Column A (Description)	Column B (Example from the extract)
1. Words spoken between characters	A. Steve remembers the words people said about Maureen
2. Remembering something that happened before	B. Steve and Maureen argue about her spirit being weak
3. A sign that something bad may happen later	C. Maureen's fever might represent approaching death
4. An object or condition that stands for another idea	D. The question "Was this the moment he had dreaded?" hints at what may come

2. What are the real literary terms of the description in column A?

- Words spoken between characters.
- Remembering something that happened before.
- A sign that something bad may happen later.
- An object or condition that stands for another idea.

ii. Open ended questions

1. What is the extract about?
2. What does Steve believe is the real cause of Maureen's weakened spirit?
3. What words keep repeating in Maureen's heart «like a refrain in a dirge»?
4. What wakes Steve up in the middle of the night?
5. Maureen show some physical symptoms and Steve started guessing what would show up in the coming days. How do we call this author's technique?
6. How do the hurtful words that repeat in Maureen's heart explain her feelings of guilt?
7. Why does Steve's question at the end of the extract create suspense for the reader?

B. Oral presentation

Imagine you have a friend and that friend is facing a difficult situation similar to Maureen's. What words would you say to comfort or advise your friend? Give examples of what you would tell them.

A. Symbolism and its effect

Symbolism adds layers of meaning to a story. When an object or action represents something beyond itself, readers understand themes and emotions without the writer stating them directly.

Effect: Creates connections between physical details and deeper ideas. A simple moment can carry great weight when it symbolizes something larger.

Example: A fever can symbolize the arrival of a long-feared moment.

B. Flashbacks and its effect

Flashbacks interrupt the present action to show something that happened earlier. They provide background that helps readers understand why characters behave as they do.

Effect: Reveals past events that shape present conflicts. Creates depth by showing how the past lives on in the present.

Example: When a character remembers hurtful words spoken by others, it explains their current feelings of guilt.

C. Foreshadowing and its effect

Foreshadowing drops hints about what will happen later in the story. These clues prepare readers without giving everything away.

Effect: Creates suspense and anticipation. Makes future events feel believable and connected to what came before.

Example: A sudden fever and trembling can hint that a long-dreaded moment is approaching.

D. Dialogue and its effect

Dialogue is conversation between characters. It brings the story to life by letting readers hear characters directly.

Effect: Reveals personalities, emotions, and beliefs. Advances the plot by sharing information. Shows relationships and conflicts in action rather than description.

Example: When characters argue about guilt, their words reveal their inner struggles and their feelings toward each other.

Application activity 2.1.3.2



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

Though I walk through the valley of death . . . thy rod and thy staff ... comfort me!"
Though she sounded coherent, Maureen's eyes Steve had a glassy and empty look.

Steve jumped out of bed and started to dress. His mind was in a turmoil. "Thou prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies . . .," Maureen mumbled on.

Steve shook her, trying to snap her out of her reverie. ... my cup overflows "Maureen! „ "1- I shall dwe-ll in the hous-e of the Lo-r-d forever!" She was losing coherence.

"No Maureen, please! Please don't leave me *mama* Kimotho," Steve cried. He held her in his arms and felt her go limp as she lost consciousness. They say a man's tears flow into his stomach — not to be seen. Steve felt his drip like rain drops. He stormed out of the house to where he parked his pickup truck in the corner. It had been a long while since he used it but when he turned the ignition, it started readily. He drove it up to his door. He saw a neighbour peeping through the window and gestured to him to come out. He was a young teacher at the local primary school. "Tom, Maureen is very ill.

I want to rush her to the hospital. Please help me carry her into the truck."

"The truck cannot be comfortable if she is so ill," Tom pointed out. "That's true but . . ."

"Mr Kabia's house is just behind the shops. I will see if he can lend me his car," Tom explained and dashed off before Steve could say anything. He came back almost immediately without the car. Steve did not ask what had transpired. They carried Maureen out and sat her in the front seat. She was limp and heavy but her pulse was okay. The hospital was only twenty minutes away and they arrived within no time. Steve explained what had happened. "She is HIV-positive and of late she has refused to take her drugs.'

"That's dangerous," the doctor said. He examined her for a while and had her admitted right away. As the nurses wheeled her to the ward, with Steve and Tom trotting beside them, Maureen regained her consciousness.

"Steve dear . . . What's happening? Where are they taking me?" Then realizing that she was in hospital, she screamed. "Hospital!" She spat out the word like a bitter pill. "I don't want to die in a hospital, Steve."

"You're not dying, Sister," one of the nurses said soothingly.

"I am dying . . . Why don't you just tell me I am dying!"

Even as she protested and pleaded with Steve not to leave her in the hospital, the two nurses eased Maureen into a bed. When it was obvious nobody was paying any heed to her protestations, Maureen coiled up in bed in her familiar manner. "Steve, bring your mother to see me. I've an important message for her. Please do not fail." After that, she did not speak any other word — not even to Steve.

The following morning, Steve was up early. After making breakfast and feeding the boy he left him in Tom's house and went to the hospital. He went to the ward. One of the nurses who had attended to them the previous night was at the report desk. Was she avoiding his eyes? With a sense of trepidation, Steve glanced towards the bed in which Maureen had lain. It was empty.

"I'm so sorry, Steve," the nurse said. "Please come with me." He followed her into a small office.

"She passed on at around four this morning," she informed him. Steve was in a daze. Did pass on mean die? "How? Why?" "Pneumonia," he heard the nurse speak from far, far away.

Opportunistic diseases, Steve thought. The doctor had warned that those were the main threats to a person living with HIV and AIDS. He felt as if his legs would give in under him. He sat down. A bout of dizziness overwhelmed him. Around him everything went dark.

They buried her within the week. A great many people turned up that Saturday for the brief ceremony. Many stood in small groups conversing in whispers. What will he do with the child now? Maybe Maureen's daughters will take care of him. You know, a child once born is never thrown away. Throughout the ceremony, Steve stood by the grave. He could feel the hundreds of eyes drilling into him, but he did not mind. They could stare till their eyes popped out. Soon the grave was a mound with freshly planted flowers. The people retreated to the perimeters of the farm, talking, whispering and staring.

Steve started looking around. Where was Kimotho? He saw the boy leaning against a banana tree. He walked towards him. "Boy!" he called when he was within ear shot. "Time to go home, Daddy." The boy came running.

Steve hoisted the boy up, like a flag, and sat him spread-eagled across his shoulders. He could feel the tears dripping into his stomach but he was determined that they should never flow down his face. And in his sadness, the words he had always spoken to Maureen in her moments of depression, now spoke to him with a meaning so profound.

When the sun goes down, do not cry because the tears will not let you see the stars. Maureen might be dead but she had left him with this boy, their son, to always remind him of she who once lit up his life so brightly. As Steve walked away, people cleared the way before him, and the boy waved at them. Bye!

From “When the Sun Goes Down” by Goro Wa Kamau from the anthology “When the Sun Goes Down and Other Stories from Africa and Beyond”. Edited by Emelia Ilieva and Waveney Olembo. Nairobi

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. What is the extract mainly about?

- A. A doctor’s struggle to save a patient with pneumonia
- B. A man’s experience of losing his sick partner and facing life as a single father
- C. A community’s effort to raise money for HIV treatment
- D. A nurse’s account of caring for HIV patients in a rural hospital

2. What does Maureen’s repetition of Psalm 23 suggest about her state of mind?

- A. She is happy and at peace
- B. She is angry at God
- C. She is seeking comfort and facing death
- D. She is reciting a poem she learned in school

3. What was the official cause of Maureen’s death?

- A. HIV
- B. Pneumonia
- C. Heart failure
- D. Malaria

ii. Matching Activity

1. Match each device with its example from the extract.

Device	Example
1.Symbolism	A. Steve remembers the words people said about Maureen
2.Flashback	B. Steve and Maureen argue about her spirit being weak
3.Foreshadowing	C. Maureen’s fever might represent approaching death
4.Dialogue	D. The question “Was this the moment he had dreaded?” hints at what may come

iii. Answer True or False

1. Steve’s truck starts immediately when he turns the ignition. _____
2. Mr Kabia lent his car to Tom to help take Maureen to the hospital. _____
3. Maureen dies at four o’clock in the morning. _____

4. Steve cries openly at the funeral for everyone to see. _____
5. The boy waves at people as Steve carries him away from the grave. _____

iv. Open-ended questions

1. Maureen recites Psalm 23 as she loses consciousness: «Though I walk through the valley of death . . . thy rod and thy staff . . . comfort me!» How does this biblical reference function as symbolism? What does it reveal about what Maureen is experiencing?
2. Throughout the story, Steve has dreaded Maureen's death. When the nurse tells him she has passed away, the writer describes: "Steve was in a daze. Did pass on mean die?" How does this moment connect to earlier hints in the story? What effect does this foreshadowing have on the reader?
3. The story ends with Steve carrying his son on his shoulders while the boy waves at people. What might this image symbolize about the future for Steve and his son?

B. Oral presentation

At the end of the story, Steve remembers the words he used to tell Maureen: "When the sun goes down, do not cry because the tears will not let you see the stars." Explain the lesson you learn from this line orally?

2.1.4. Language, style and diction

Learning activity 2.1.4.1



Read the extract from "Tuesday Siesta" by Gabriel Garcia Marquez (Colombia), and answer the questions that follow.

The train emerged from the quivering tunnel of sandy rocks, began to cross the symmetrical, interminable banana plantations, and the air became humid and they couldn't feel the sea breeze any more. A stifling blast of smoke came in the car window. On the narrow road parallel to the railway there were oxcarts loaded with green bunches of bananas. Beyond the road, in uncultivated spaces set at odd intervals there were offices with electric fans, red-brick buildings, and residences with chairs and little white tables on the terraces among dusty palm trees and rosebushes. It was eleven in the morning, and the heat had not yet begun. "You'd better close the window," the woman said. "Your hair will get full of soot." The girl tried to, but the shade wouldn't move because of the rust.

They were the only passengers in the lone third-class car. Since the smoke of the locomotive kept coming through the window, the girl left her seat and put down the only things they had with them: a plastic sack with some things to eat and a bouquet of flowers wrapped in newspaper. She sat on the opposite seat, away from the window, facing her mother. They were both in severe and poor mourning clothes. The girl was twelve years old, and it was the first time she'd ever been on a train.

The woman seemed too old to be her mother, because of the blue veins on her eyelids and her small, soft, and shapeless body, in a dress cut like a cassock. She was riding with her spinal column braced firmly against the back of the seat, and held a peeling patent-leather handbag in her lap with both hands. She bore the conscientious serenity of someone accustomed to poverty.

By twelve the heat had begun. The train stopped for ten minutes to take on water at a station where there was no town. Outside, in the mysterious silence of the plantations, the shadows seemed clean. But the still air inside the car smelled like untanned leather. The train did not pick up speed. It stopped at two identical towns with wooden houses painted bright colors. The woman's head nodded and she sank into sleep. The girl took off her shoes. Then she went to the washroom to put the bouquet of flowers in some water. When she came back to her seat, her mother was waiting to eat. She gave her a piece of cheese, half a cornmeal pancake, and a cookie, and took an equal portion out of the plastic sack for herself. While they ate, the train crossed an iron bridge very slowly and passed a town just like the ones before, except that in this one there was a crowd in the plaza. A band was playing a lively tune under the oppressive sun. At the other side of town, the plantations ended in a plain which was cracked from the drought.

The woman stopped eating.

"Put on your shoes," she said.

The girl looked outside. She saw nothing but the deserted plain, where the train began to pick up speed again, but she put the last piece of cookie into the sack and quickly put on her shoes. The woman gave her a comb.

"Comb your hair," she said.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Which phrase best describes the heat in the environment?

- A. cool sea breeze B. stifling blast of smoke C. gentle morning wind D. cold tunnel air

2. What do the descriptions of banana plantations and dusty palm trees mainly help readers understand?

- A. The characters' emotions
B. The time of the journey
C. The setting of the story
D. The ending of the story

ii. Matching Activity

Matching: Match the examples from the extract to their functions

Column A (Extract Examples)	Column B (Functions)
1. "a stifling blast of smoke came in the car window"	A. Creates atmosphere of quietness and mystery
2. "the train emerged from the quivering tunnel of sandy rocks"	B. Shows movement and arrival of the train
3. "severe and poor mourning clothes"	C. Creates image of heat and discomfort
4. "banana plantations and dusty palm trees"	D. Builds a picture of the natural environment
5. "the mysterious silence of the plantations"	E. Shows poverty and suffering of the characters

iii. Answer True or False

- a) The girl had travelled by train many times before. _____
- b) The woman appeared calm and used to living in poverty. _____

iv. Open-ended questions

- a) Find one example of descriptive language used to describe the train journey. Explain how this description helps readers imagine the situation clearly.
- b) The girl carries a bouquet of flowers wrapped in newspaper. What might this object suggest about the purpose of their journey?
- c) Based on the language and word choices used in the extract, describe the general mood or atmosphere created by the writer. Support your answer with one detail from the extract.
- d) Look at the sentence: *"She bore the conscientious serenity of someone accustomed to poverty."*
- e) What does this sentence tell you about the woman's character and background?
- f) What is the main theme suggested in this extract?

B. Oral Presentation

The extract shows characters travelling under harsh conditions such as heat, poverty, and long journeys. Imagine a young person is persuaded to leave the country illegally with promises of jobs but may end up in forced labour or recruited as a child soldier in armed groups. What advice would you give to help them stay safe?

A. Language and Style and its effect

Language refers to the words and expressions a writer chooses. Style is the unique way a writer uses language to create meaning and effect.

Effect on Story Development:

Aspect	Effect
Language	Determines how clearly readers understand characters and events. Creates the overall tone and mood of the story.
Style	Gives the story its unique voice. Reflects the writer's personality and purpose. Shapes how readers experience the narrative.

Elements of Style:

- Sentence length and structure
- Choice of words (formal, informal, simple, complex)
- Use of figurative language
- Rhythm and flow of sentences
- Repetition or variation

Example: Short, simple sentences can create tension or urgency. Longer, flowing sentences can create a reflective or dreamy mood.

B. Diction – Effect on Story Development

Definition: Diction is the writer's choice of words. It includes the type of vocabulary used and how words are arranged to create specific effects.

Effect on Story Development:

Aspect	Effect
Diction	Creates tone and atmosphere. Reveals character education, background, and emotions. Guides reader response to events and people.

Example: A character who uses formal language may seem educated or distant. A character who uses local expressions feels connected to a specific place and culture.

Learning activity 2.1.5.1



Read the extract from "Tuesday Siesta" by Gabriel Garcia Marquez (Colombia), and answer the questions

The train emerged from the quivering tunnel of sandy rocks, began to cross the symmetrical, interminable banana plantations, and the air became humid and they couldn't feel the sea breeze any more. A stifling blast of smoke came in the car window. On the narrow road parallel to the railway there were oxcarts loaded with green bunches of bananas. Beyond the road, in uncultivated spaces set at odd intervals there were offices with electric fans, red-brick buildings, and residences with chairs and little white tables on the terraces among dusty palm trees and rosebushes. It was eleven in the morning, and the heat had not yet begun. "You'd better close the window," the woman said. "Your hair will get full of soot." The girl tried to, but the shade wouldn't move because of the rust.

They were the only passengers in the lone third-class car. Since the smoke of the locomotive kept coming through the window, the girl left her seat and put down the only things they had with them: a plastic sack with some things to eat and a bouquet of flowers wrapped in newspaper. She sat on the opposite seat, away from the window, facing her mother. They were both in severe and poor mourning clothes. The girl was twelve years old, and it was the first time she'd ever been on a train. The woman seemed too old to be her mother, because of the blue veins on her eyelids and her small, soft, and shapeless body, in a dress cut like a cassock. She was riding with her spinal column braced firmly against the back of the seat, and held a peeling patent-leather handbag in her lap with both hands. She bore the conscientious serenity of someone accustomed to poverty.

By twelve the heat had begun. The train stopped for ten minutes to take on water at a station where there was no town. Outside, in the mysterious silence of the plantations, the shadows seemed clean. But the still air inside the car smelled like untanned leather. The train did not pick up speed. It stopped at two identical towns with wooden houses painted bright colors. The woman's head nodded and she sank into sleep. The girl took off her shoes. Then she went to the washroom to put the bouquet of flowers in some water. When she came back to her seat, her mother was waiting to eat. She gave her a piece of cheese, half a cornmeal pancake, and a cookie, and took an equal portion out of the plastic sack for herself. While they ate, the train crossed an iron bridge very slowly and passed a town just like the ones before, except that in this one there was a crowd in the plaza. A band was playing a lively tune under the oppressive sun. At the other side of town, the plantations ended in a plain which was cracked from the drought.

The woman stopped eating. "Put on your shoes," she said.

The girl looked outside. She saw nothing but the deserted plain, where the train began to pick up speed again, but she put the last piece of cookie into the sack and quickly put on her shoes. The woman gave her a comb.

"Comb your hair," she said.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Which of the following best describes the general mood of the town during the siesta?
 - A. Busy and noisy
 - B. Celebratory and joyful
 - C. Crowded and chaotic
 - D Quiet and sleepy
2. The description "*The town was floating in the heat*" is mainly used to:
 - A. Show that the town is near the sea
 - B. Emphasize the extreme heat and stillness
 - C. Describe a festival in the town
 - D. Explain the movement of the train

ii. Answer True or False

The language used to describe the town and environment helps create a calm but oppressive atmosphere in the story.

iii. Matching Activity

Match the **element of language or style** with its **effect in the story**.

Colmn A	Column B
A. Descriptions of heat and silence	1. Reveals character attitudes and emotions
B. Simple and clear sentences	2. Helps readers clearly follow events
C. Specific details about the town	3. Builds the atmosphere of the setting
D. Dialogue between characters	4. Makes the place feel realistic

iv. Open-ended questions

1. Identify two examples of diction (word choice) used to describe the environment. Explain how these words influence the tone of the story.
2. Explain how the dialogue between the woman and the priest helps reveal the woman's character.
3. How does the writer's descriptive style help readers to visualize the town during the siesta?In the extract, the girl carries a bouquet of flowers. What might the flowers symbolize in the story?
4. Explain how the language and diction used by the writer reflect the social situation of the characters.

2.1.5. Plot

Learning activity 2.1.5.1



Read the extract from “Tuesday Siesta” by Gabriel Garcia Marquez (Colombia), and answer the questions

The train whistle began to blow while the girl was combing her hair. The woman dried the sweat from her neck and wiped the oil from her face with her fingers. When the girl stopped combing, the train was passing the outlying houses of a town larger but sadder than the earlier ones.

“If you feel like doing anything, do it now,” said the woman. “Later, don’t take a drink anywhere even if you’re dying of thirst. Above all, no crying.”

The girl nodded her head. A dry, burning wind came in the window, together with the locomotive’s whistle and the clatter of the old cars. The woman folded the plastic bag with the rest of the food and put it in the handbag. For a moment a complete picture of the town, on that bright August Tuesday, shone in the window. The girl wrapped the flowers in the soaking-wet newspapers, moved a little farther away from the window, and stared at her mother. She received a pleasant expression in return. The train began to whistle and slowed down. A moment later it stopped.

There was no one at the station. On the other side of the street, on the sidewalk shaded by the almond trees, only the pool hall was open. The town was floating in the heat. The woman and the girl got off the train and crossed the abandoned station—the tiles split apart by the grass growing up between—and over to the shady side of the street.

It was almost two. At that hour, weighted down by drowsiness, the town was taking a siesta. The stores, the town offices, the public school were closed at eleven, and didn’t reopen until a little before four, when the train went back. Only the hotel across from the station, with its bar and pool hall, and the telegraph office at one side of the plaza stayed open. The houses, most of them built on the banana company’s model, had their doors locked from inside and their blinds drawn. In some of them it was so hot that the residents ate lunch in the patio. Others leaned a chair against the wall, in the shade of the almond trees, and took their siesta right out in the street.

Keeping to the protective shade of the almond trees, the woman and the girl entered the town without disturbing the siesta. They went directly to the parish house. The woman scratched the metal grating on the door with her fingernail, waited a moment, and scratched again. An electric fan was humming inside. They did not hear the steps. They hardly heard the slight creaking of a door, and immediately a cautious voice, right next to the metal grating: “Who is it?” The woman tried to see through the grating. “I need the priest,” she said.

“He’s sleeping now.”

“It’s an emergency,” the woman insisted. Her voice showed a calm determination.

The door was opened a little way, noiselessly, and a plump, older woman appeared, with very pale skin and hair the color of iron. Her eyes seemed too small behind her thick eyeglasses.

"Come in," she said, and opened the door all the way.

They entered a room permeated with an old smell of flowers. The woman of the house led them to a wooden bench and signaled them to sit down. The girl did so, but her mother remained standing, absentmindedly, with both hands clutching the handbag. No noise could be heard above the electric fan. The woman of the house reappeared at the door at the far end of the room. "He says you should come back after three," she said in a very low voice. "He just lay down five minutes ago." "The train leaves at three thirty," said the woman.

It was a brief and self-assured reply, but her voice remained pleasant, full of undertones. The woman of the house smiled for the first time.

"All right," she said.

When the far door closed again, the woman sat down next to her daughter. The narrow waiting room was poor, neat, and clean. On the other side of the wooden railing which divided the room, there was a worktable, a plain one with an oilcloth cover, and on top of the table a primitive typewriter next to a vase of flowers. The parish records were beyond. You could see that it was an office kept in order by a spinster.

The far door opened and this time the priest appeared, cleaning his glasses with a handkerchief. Only when he put them on was it evident that he was the brother of the woman who had opened the door.

"How can I help you?" he asked.

"The keys to the cemetery," said the woman.

The girl was seated with the flowers in her lap and her feet crossed under the bench. The priest looked at her, then looked at the woman, and then through the wire mesh of the window at the bright, cloudless sky.

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. From the extract, identify the main character and the place where the story begins.
2. What information does the writer give about why the narrator is leaving his home?
3. Identify two details from the extract that help the reader understand the background or past life of the narrator.
4. Explain how the writer introduces the situation or problem that motivates the narrator to begin his journey.
5. Which parts of the extract help the reader understand the context of migration to Europe?
6. Explain how this beginning of the story prepares the reader for the events that will follow in the plot.

Notes: Plot and Its Effect on Story Development

Plot refers to the sequence of events that make up a story. Here is a clear analysis on how these elements influence the development of the story and the reader's understanding of events.

1. Exposition and Its Effect

The exposition introduces the characters, setting, and background information needed to understand the story.

Effect on development:

- Helps readers understand **who the characters are and where the story takes place**.
- Explains the **initial situation or conflict**.
- Creates interest and prepares readers for the events that follow.

2. Rising Action and Its Effect

The rising action is the part of the plot where **events become more complicated and tension increases**.

Effect on development:

- Builds **suspense and curiosity**.
- Introduces **new challenges or obstacles**.
- Shows how characters respond to problems.

3. Climax and Its Effect

The climax is the turning point or the most intense moment in the story.

Effect on development:

- Determines the **direction of the story's outcome**.
- Reveals the **true nature or decisions of characters**.
- Creates the highest emotional tension for readers.

4. Falling Action and Its Effect

The falling action includes the events that happen after the climax.

Effect on development:

- Shows the **consequences of the climax**.
- Begins to resolve the conflicts introduced earlier.

5. Resolution and Its Effect

The resolution is the final outcome of the story.

Effect on development:

- Explains **how the conflict is resolved**.
- Allows readers to understand the **final situation of the characters**.
- Leaves the reader with the **message or reflection of the story**.

Application activity 2.1.5.2



Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow.

Morning. I began to untie our tent. Obazee is busy organizing the move to another part of the forest. Almost everyone has agreed to go, which means that everyone must. This is the way it is around here, all together, through the forest, up the mountain, up, two, three. One day, I fear they might move so far, they will reach the cliff and fall off. Obazee makes his rounds and guides them like Moses. "You," he says, snapping his fingers when he passes by me. "When is your mummy coming back?"

"She is not my mother."

"Well, remember that by evening, we're leaving this place." I fold the tent as he walks on. The ground is bare except for our footprints, Patience and I. Noon. Most people have moved to the new site. Those who remain, gather clothes, pick up pots, and search for what is lost. I sit on the tent as if it is a mat and lean against a tree trunk. Obazee comes by again.

"She's not back yet?"

"It takes long."

"Not this long," he says checking his watch. This time, he does not even stop to look at my face. I spread my toes. There is space in my sneakers now: too much space since Patience took my money. Dusk. I can count the people left in the camp, besides me. One of them is the woman who left with Patience. They have cleared up everything except for a sandal, a bucket handle and a red rag. Obazee startles me.

"You're still waiting?"

"Yes."

"You don't think you should come at this rate?"

"No." I can spare him only one word at a time. He contemplates the little I have said and then bends to wipe his forehead with his shirt.

"Don't worry," he says. "Maybe she got stuck. Whenever she appears, follow the way to the cliff. You'll find us there."

After they leave, I turn on Patience's flashlight and flick through her Bible: Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus. I cannot find the story. I reach Revelation and still cannot find the stupid story she told me, but you will not catch me running off like some girl. I will wait until morning if necessary. If I shiver it is because of the winds. They come from the desert and the sea. They carry sand and salt. They clash right here in the forest and can pierce to the bones no matter how well you are prepared for them; it is funny.

I hope she drowns.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. **The narrator remaining alone in the camp mainly represents which stage of the plot?**
A. Exposition B. Rising action
C. Falling action D. Resolution
2. **Obazee's repeated questioning about the narrator's "mother" mainly helps to:**
A. Create humor in the story B. Build tension and highlight concern
C. End the conflict quickly D. Introduce a new setting
3. **The movement of people to another place in the forest contributes to:**
A. The development of tension in the rising action B. peaceful resolution
C. The conclusion of the story D. The narrator's success

ii. Answer True or False

1. The extract mainly represents a moment where the consequences of earlier actions are becoming clear.
2. The narrator feels completely calm and satisfied while waiting in the camp.
3. The description of the empty camp helps to create a sense of tension and loneliness.

iii. Open-ended question

1. Explain how the events in this extract show the falling action of the story.
2. Analyze how the writer builds suspense through the narrator's waiting.
3. Discuss how Obazee's character influences the development of the plot in this extract.
4. Explain how the narrator's attitude toward Patience reveals internal conflict.
5. Explain how the use of time markers (Morning, Noon, Dusk) affects the pacing and development of the story.
6. Analyze the emotional impact of the ending line: "I hope she drowns." What does it reveal about the narrator and the situation?

B. Oral presentation

Suppose you were the author of this story. Write a paragraph of about 100 words to provide a suitable ending to the story. After completing your writing, present your paragraph orally to the class, focusing on clarity, expression, and the main message of your ending.

2.1.6 Tone, mood and atmosphere

Learning activity 2.1.6.1



Read the extract from "Twilight Trek" by Sefi Atta and answer the questions that follow

When it is dark enough, I come out of the hut. My stomach is so fed up with grumbling for attention it is in a silent sulk. I buy myself bread and sardines to eat, enough to last the journey. I buy drinking water, bottles of it. I meet a pretty girl called Patience at the depot where the agent instructed me to wait with other travelers for our transportation out of Gao. Patience is skinny with a bit of a backside. Her trousers are too tight. Her hair is curly and greased back. She wears a silver hoop in her nostril. She claims to be from Mali, but she has been living in the capital city, Bamako. She says this as if it is some sort of achievement, as if it separates her from villagers who are happy to stay in Africa herding their cattle, hoeing their land or whatever.

"You have a man in Bamako?" I ask her.

"Do you know how old I am?"

"Sweet sixteen at most?"

"You small boy! Don't cheek me! How old are you yourself?"

She laughs and swings slaps at me. I am a year older than I was on the day I left home, is all she needs to know. African women are proud of their ages. I bet Patience is taken by my looks. I bet she has taken rubbish from men not nearly as good-looking as me. I bet she is used to it. In my old neighborhood, a pretty girl like her would have been beaten up several times by her man.

Our trucks arrive while she is still busy trying to snub me. They are small trucks with tarpaulin covers. We do not scramble for them. We all believe we will get in one way or the other. Our guides are Tuaregs with indigo cloths wrapped around their heads. They know the desert routes. They will drive us through Mali, Algeria, and beyond. There is talk that travelers are sometimes attacked by bearded Moslems and bandits; that trucks often break down and there is no guarantee the gendarmes on patrol will arrive on time to rescue us. This makes a few women turn around at the last moment, especially those with children. I hop into the same truck as Patience and sit by her.

"You again?" she says.

I wink. "I'm just here to protect you."

A. Comprehension questions

Open-ended questions

1. Identify two words or phrases from the extract that describe the situation or environment of the characters.
2. How does the conversation between the narrator and Patience help create the mood of the scene?

3. What feeling might the reader experience when learning about the dangerous journey across the desert?
4. Explain how the writer's description of the travelers and the trucks contribute to the atmosphere of the journey.
5. Identify one example of the narrator's attitude toward Patience. What does this reveal about the tone?
6. . What is the extract about?

B. Oral presentation

Explain what you have learnt from uncertain and risky situation of the travelers and share it to your colleagues?

Tone and its effect

Tone refers to the **writer's or narrator's attitude toward the subject, characters, or events.**

Effect on the story:

- Reveals how the narrator feels about events or characters.
- Helps readers understand whether the situation is serious, humorous, critical, or sympathetic.
- Influences how readers interpret the actions of characters.

A. Mood and its effect : Mood refers to the **emotional feeling created in the reader while reading the story.**

Effect on the story:

- Helps readers connect emotionally with the events.
- Creates feelings such as tension, fear, hope, sadness, or excitement.
- Makes the story more engaging and memorable.

B. Atmosphere and its effect: Atmosphere refers to the **overall feeling or emotional environment created by the setting, descriptions, and events.**

Effect on the story:

- Helps readers imagine the conditions surrounding the characters.
- Strengthens the mood and supports the themes of the story.
- Makes the setting feel realistic and vivid.

Relationship Between Tone, Mood, and Atmosphere

- **Tone** reflects the narrator's attitude.
- **Mood** describes the feelings experienced by the reader.
- **Atmosphere** is the emotional environment created by the setting and events.

Together, these elements help the reader **experience the story more deeply and understand the characters' struggles.**

Application activity 2.1.6.2



Read the extract from “Twilight Trek” and answer the questions.

There are seven of us under the tarpaulin. I check out the others while cracking my knuckles: passenger one, tattered shoes; two, greasy skullcap; three, lopsided headscarf; four, chapped lips; five, gold chain and red eyes. Nothing new.

How long can I bear this god-forsaken place? We can only travel at night when cold winds blow. During the day, the sand—you cannot understand—is like needles in my eyes, ants in my nostrils, cobwebs in my chest. It is everywhere. I eat bread and crunch on grains. I gulp down water, and grit gets stuck in my throat. I cough so hard my head could detonate.

I am telling you, in the most crowded cities, I have ridden in taxis with wobbly wheels and no doors, hitched rides on highways in lorries that bounce from one pothole to the other. I have slept in villages where dogs will not stop to take a piss, had bouts of diarrhea, fever, to get to Gao. I cannot understand these Tuaregs. Only camels are meant to survive in the Sahara.

At first, Patience would say, “Mr. Protector, how now?” and I would mumble, “Cool.” Then I could not be bothered to answer because my tongue started to swell. Then she stopped teasing me, perhaps because she realized that joking around might eventually exhaust her. Now, she is choking away like everyone else in our truck. We spit where we crouch. We reek badly. Our legs are cramped. The man with the skullcap says he is suffering from piles because of the constant jolts. His wheezy wife complains that she cannot breathe.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

- Which feeling best describes the **mood created in this extract**?
A. Joyful and relaxed B. Peaceful and calm
C. Harsh and uncomfortable D. Excited and hopeful
- The description of the desert sand as “*needles in my eyes, ants in my nostrils*” mainly helps to:
A. Create a humorous situation B. Emphasize the painful and difficult conditions
C. Show that the desert is beautiful D. Introduce a new character

ii. Answer True or False

The descriptions of heat, sand, and exhaustion create an atmosphere that helps readers understand the difficulty of the migrants’ journey.

iii. Matching Activity

Match the **element** with its **effect in the story**.

Elements	Effects in the story
A. Mood	i. Shows the narrator's attitude toward the situation
B. Tone	ii. Creates emotional feelings in the reader
C. Descriptive language	iii. Builds the environment surrounding the characters
D. Atmosphere	iv. Helps readers visualize events and conditions

iv. Open-ended questions

1. Identify two details from the extract that create the harsh atmosphere of the desert journey.
2. Explain how the narrator's complaints about the journey reveal the tone of the narration.
3. How does the writer use descriptive language to make the reader feel the suffering of the travelers?
4. Explain how the mood of this scene helps readers understand the struggles faced by migrants crossing the desert.
5. In your opinion, how do tone, mood, and atmosphere together help the reader experience the reality of the journey in the story?

B. Language enhancement / Presentation

Summarize in a paragraph between 4 to 7 sentences what this extract is about?

2.2. Language Focus: Use of Would, Should and Could

Learning activity 2.2.1



Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

The travelers were preparing for a long journey across the desert. The guide warned them that the trip **could** be very dangerous if they were not careful. He explained that everyone **should** carry enough water and food before starting the journey.

He also told them that strong winds **could** appear suddenly in the desert and make the road difficult to see. Because of this, travelers **should** always listen carefully to the guide's instructions.

"If the truck stopped in the middle of the desert," the guide said, "we **would** need to stay calm and wait for help." He added that the travelers **should** support each other during difficult moments.

One of the travelers asked whether the journey **would** become easier after a few days. The guide replied that it **could** become easier if everyone remained patient and cooperative.

Before leaving, he reminded them once more: "You **should** never travel alone in such a harsh place."

By REB's Literature in English Content Developer Team (2026).

Comprehension questions

1. Identify the words used as helping verbs in the passage above.
2. What type of verbs are **would**, **should**, and **could** according to their function in the passage?
3. In the sentence "*The guide warned them that the trip could be very dangerous,*" what idea does **could** express?
4. In the sentence "*Everyone should carry enough water and food,*" what does **should** tell the travelers to do?
5. Why is **would** used in the sentence "*If the truck stopped in the middle of the desert, we would need to stay calm and wait for help*"?
6. In the sentence "*The journey would become easier after a few days,*" what does **would** show about the situation?
7. Find another sentence in the passage where **could** expresses possibility. What possibility does it show?
8. Find two examples where **should** expresses advice or responsibility. Explain their meanings.
9. What is the difference between the meanings expressed by **would** and **could** in the passage?
10. Explain how **would**, **should**, and **could** help speakers express advice, possibility, and imagined situations more clearly.

Use of Would, Should and Could

Would, Should and Could are modal verbs. Modal verbs are helping verbs used with a main verb **to express ideas such as possibility, advice, ability, or future situations.**

1. Would: "Would" is used to express:

- Future in the past

Example: He said the journey would be difficult.

- Imagined or conditional situations

Example: If the truck broke down, we would wait for help.

- Polite requests or offers

Example: Would you help me carry this bag?

2. Should: "Should" is used to express:

- Advice or recommendation

Example: Travelers should carry enough water.

- Moral duty or responsibility

Example: People should respect others during the journey.

- Expectation

Example: The truck should arrive before night.

3. Could: "Could" is used to express:

- Possibility

Example: The truck could break down on the road.

- Past ability

Example: When he was younger, he could walk long distances.

- Polite requests

Example: Could you help me?

These modal verbs help speakers to express **opinions, suggestions, possibilities, and imagined situations** more clearly.

Application Activity 2.2.2

Read the extract and answer the questions.

If we could leave earlier, the journey would be easier. The desert heat is terrible during the day, and travelers should rest whenever they get the chance. Some people say that the trucks could break down in the middle of the desert, and if that happened, the travelers would have to wait for help.

Patience says that people should prepare well before starting such a journey. They should carry enough food and water because the road is long and dangerous. She also says that anyone who would like to travel across the desert should be brave and patient.

By REB's Literature in English Content Developer Team (2026).

A. Comprehension questions

1. Circle the correct modal verb.

- a) Travelers _____ carry enough water in the desert. (should / could)
- b) The truck _____ break down on the road. (would / could)
- c) If the travelers rested well, they _____ feel stronger. (would / should)
- d) If I had enough money, I _____ travel across Africa. (would / should)
- e) People _____ respect others during a journey. (could / should)
- f) The guide _____ know the safest route through the desert. (could / would)

2. Complete the sentences using *would*, *should*, or *could*.

- a) If the weather became worse, the travelers _____ stop the journey.
- b) You _____ listen carefully to the guide's instructions.
- c) The driver _____ lose the road in the desert at night.
- d) If they had more water, they _____ continue the trip safely.

3. Rewrite the sentences using the modal verb in brackets.

- a) It is a good idea for travelers to prepare well. (*should*)
→ Travelers _____.
- b) It is possible that the truck breaks down. (*could*)
→ The truck _____.
- c) If the travelers were tired, they rested. (*would*)
→ If the travelers were tired, they _____.

4. Write a short paragraph of about 50 words on the topic: "How Hard Work Can Influence a Person's Life." Use the modal verbs *should*, *could*, and *would* correctly to express advice, possibilities, and expected outcomes. After writing, prepare and deliver an oral presentation of your paragraph to the class.

B. Oral Presentation

Explain briefly why modal verbs such as **would**, **should**, and **could** are useful when

giving instructions or describing possible situations.

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



I. Re-read the extracts from "Twilight Trek" by Sefi Atta (Lesson:4, activity: 4.2.1.) and answer the questions of **Comprehension**

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple Choice Questions

1. The description of the desert environment mainly helps the reader to understand:
A. The beauty of the desert landscape B. The comfort of the travelers
C. The difficulty and danger of the journey D. The wealth of the travelers
2. Which detail best shows the harsh conditions faced by the travelers?
A. The travelers talked quietly B. The sand felt like needles in the eyes
C. The travelers laughed together D. The journey started early

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Describe one problem faced by the travelers during the journey.
2. Explain how the setting of the desert influences the events in the extract.
3. Identify one descriptive word or phrase from the extract and explain its effect on the reader.

B. Fill in the gaps

Instructions: Use the words in the box to complete the sentences. Each word can only be used once.

Words to choose from: *desert, exhaustion, sand, harsh, travelers, wind*

1. The travelers moved across the _____ during the long journey.
2. The strong wind carried _____ into their eyes.
3. The journey was difficult because the environment was _____.
4. The travelers continued moving despite feeling _____.

C. Answer True or False

1. Characters are the people or animals who take part in a story.
2. Point of view refers to the time when the story takes place.
3. Flashbacks help readers understand future events in a story.
4. The climax is the highest point of tension in a story.

D. Language Focus

Use **would, should, or could** correctly.

a. Choose the correct modal verb

1. Travelers _____ carry enough water before crossing the desert.
2. If the truck stopped suddenly, the travelers _____ wait for help.
3. The driver _____ lose direction during a sandstorm.
4. If the weather improved, the journey _____ become easier.

b. Rewrite the sentences using the modal verb given

1. It is good advice for travelers to stay together. **(should)**
→ Travelers _____.
2. It is possible that the travelers lose their way. **(could)**
→ The travelers _____.

E. Project: Creative Writing and Oral Presentation

Creative Writing

- a. Write a short story (1 page) about **a time you or someone you know faced a difficult journey or challenge in real life** (e.g., traveling long distances, preparing for exams, or helping family during a problem).

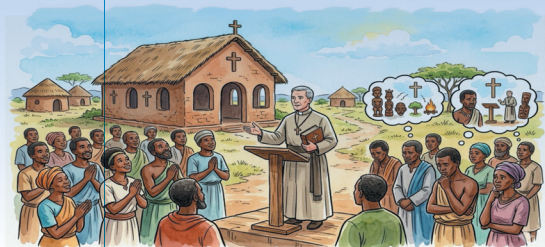
Include:

- Characters (real or fictional)
- Setting Problem or challenge
- Steps taken to overcome it
- Resolution

- b. After submitting your written work, prepare a **2–3-minute presentation in front of the class.**

UNIT 3

THEMES AND MESSAGE IN AFRICAN NOVELS



Key Unit Competence:

To be able to analyze Themes and messages in African novels and evaluate how they reflect historical, economic, social, and cultural contexts.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- ☒ Identify major and minor themes and messages in African novels and recognize the techniques authors use to convey them.
- 1** ☒ Explain how historical, social, economic, and cultural factors influence African fiction and shape characters and events.
- ☒ Describe how African writers address issues such as colonialism, independence, corruption, gender, resilience, and how literature reflects moral, political, and cultural realities in African societies.

Skills

- ☒ Analyze and interpret passages to identify themes and evaluate how literary elements reflect historical, social, economic, and cultural contexts.
- 2** ☒ Compare and justify interpretations of themes by discussing ideas and supporting responses with textual evidence.
- ☒ Write analytical essays on themes and authorial techniques using clear language, including correct use of active and passive voice.

Attitudes and values

- ☒ Appreciate African literature as a reflection of social, historical, and cultural identity and experiences.
- 3** ☒ Respect diverse perspectives and show empathy toward characters and communities facing social and cultural challenges.
- ☒ Promote values such as justice, gender equality, resilience, and cultural pride through literary discussions and reflections.

3.0. Introduction to the unit

Have you ever wondered what stories can teach us about society? African novels do more than entertain; they reflect the history, culture, and everyday experiences of African people.

In these stories, writers communicate important **themes and messages** about life and society.

A **theme** is the main idea explored in a story, while a **message** is the lesson the author wants readers to learn.

One common theme in African novels is the **historical theme**, which explores events such as colonialism, independence, and social change.

These stories help readers understand how the past has shaped present African societies.

Another important theme is the **cultural theme**, which highlights traditions, beliefs, customs, and values.

Writers also explore **economic themes**, such as poverty, work, wealth, and development.

Many novels also address **social themes** like family relationships, education, gender roles, and unity.

Through these themes, authors present challenges faced by individuals and communities. Studying these themes helps learners understand how literature reflects and influences society.

Introductory activity



Chapter One

Okonkwo was well known throughout the nine villages and even beyond. His fame rested on solid personal achievements. As a young man of eighteen he had brought honour to his village by throwing Amalinze the Cat. Amalinze was the great wrestler who for seven years was unbeaten, from Umuofia to Mbaino. He was called the Cat because his back would never touch the earth. It was this man that Okonkwo threw in a fight which the old men agreed was one of the fiercest since the founder of their town engaged a spirit of the wild for seven days and seven nights.

The drums beat and the flutes sang and the spectators held their breath. Amalinze was a wily craftsman, but Okonkwo was as slippery as a fish in water. Every nerve and every muscle stood out on their arms, on their backs and their thighs, and one almost heard them stretching to breaking point. In the end Okonkwo threw the Cat.

That was many years ago, twenty years or more, and during this time Okonkwo's fame had grown like a bush-fire in the harmattan. He was tall and huge, and his bushy eyebrows and wide nose gave him a very severe look. He breathed heavily, and it was said that, when he slept, his wives and children in their out-houses could hear him breathe. When he walked, his heels hardly touched the ground and he seemed to walk on springs, as if he was going to pounce on somebody.

And he did pounce on people quite often. He had a slight stammer and whenever he was angry and could not get his words out quickly enough, he would use his fists. He had no patience with unsuccessful men. He had had no patience with his father.

Unoka, for that was his father's name, had died ten years ago. In his day he was lazy and improvident and was quite incapable of thinking about tomorrow. If any money came his way, and it seldom did, he immediately bought gourds of palm-wine, called round his neighbours and made merry. He always said that whenever he saw a dead man's mouth he saw the folly of not eating what one had in one's lifetime. Unoka was, of course, a debtor, and he owed every neighbour some money, from a few cowries to quite substantial amounts.

He was tall but very thin and had a slight stoop. He wore a haggard and mournful look except when he was drinking or playing on his flute. He was very good on his flute, and his happiest moments were the two or three moons after the harvest when the village musicians brought down their instruments, hung above the fireplace. Unoka would play with them, his face beaming with blessedness and peace. Sometimes another village would ask Unoka's band and their dancing egungun to come and stay with them and teach them their tunes.

They would go to such hosts for as long as three or four markets, making music and feasting. Unoka loved the good fare and the good fellowship, and he loved this season of the year, when the rains had stopped and the sun rose every morning with dazzling beauty. And it was not too hot either, because the cold and dry harmattan wind was blowing down from the north. Some years the harmattan was very severe and a dense haze hung on the atmosphere. Old men and children would then sit round log fires, warming their bodies. Unoka loved it all, and he loved the first kites that returned with the dry season, and the children who sang songs of welcome to them. He would remember his own childhood, how he had often wandered around looking for a kite sailing leisurely against the blue sky. As soon as he found one he would sing with his whole being, welcoming it back from its long, long journey, and asking it if it had brought home any lengths of cloth.

That was years ago, when he was young. Unoka, the grown-up, was a failure. He was poor and his wife and children had barely enough to eat. People laughed at him because he was a loafer, and they swore never to lend him any more money because he never paid back. But Unoka was such a man that he always succeeded in borrowing more, and piling up his debts.

One day a neighbour called Okoye came in to see him. He was reclining on a mud bed in his hut playing on the flutes. He immediately rose and shook hands with Okoye, who then unrolled the goatskin

Comprehension questions

1. How does the wrestling match between Okonkwo and Amalinze show the cultural traditions of the Umuofia community?
2. What traditional feats of strength or skill in ancient Rwanda could bring honour and recognition to a man? Compare them with the wrestling match between Okonkwo and Amalinze.
3. What does Okonkwo's victory over Amalinze tell us about the social values of the community?
4. What economic message can you learn from the description of Unoka's debts and spending habits?
5. What cultural practices are shown in the passage when Unoka plays the flute and joins village musicians?
6. In what ways are Okonkwo and Unoka different in terms of economic attitudes toward life?

3.1. Historical themes

Learning activity 3.1.1



Read the Extract below and answer the questions that follow.

Who else among his children could have read his thoughts so well? With two beautiful grown-up daughters, his return to Umuofia would attract considerable attention. His future sons-in-law would be men of authority in the clan. The poor and unknown would not dare to come forth.

Umuofia had indeed changed during the seven years Okonkwo had been in exile. The church had come and led many astray. Not only the low-born and the outcast but sometimes a worthy man had joined it. Such a man was Ogbuefi Ugonna, who had taken two titles, and who like a madman had cut the anklet of his titles and cast it away to join the Christians. The white missionary was very proud of him and he was one of the first men in Umuofia to receive the sacrament of Holy Communion, or Holy Feast as it was called in Ibo. Ogbuefi Ugonna had thought of the Feast in terms of eating and drinking, only more holy than the village variety. He had therefore put his drinking-horn into his goatskin bag for the occasion.

But apart from the church, the white men had also brought a government. They had built a court where the District Commissioner judged cases in ignorance. He had court messengers who brought men to him for trial. Many of these messengers came from Umuru on the bank of the Great River, where the white men first came many years before and where they had built the centre of their religion and trade and government. These court messengers were greatly hated in Umuofia because they were foreigners and also arrogant and high-handed.

They were called kotma, and because of their ash-coloured shorts they earned the additional name of Ashy-Buttocks. They guarded the prison, which was full of men who had offended against the white man's law.

Some of these prisoners had thrown away their twins and some had molested the Christians. They were beaten in the prison by the kotma and made to work every morning clearing the government compound and fetching wood for the white Commissioner and the court messengers.

Some of these prisoners were men of title who should be above such mean occupation. They were grieved by the indignity and mourned for their neglected farms. As they cut grass in the morning the younger men sang in time with the strokes of their matches:

"Kotma of the ash buttocks, He is fit to be a slave."

The court messengers did not like to be called Ashy-Buttocks, and they beat the men. But the song spread in Umuofia.

Okonkwo's head was bowed in sadness as Obierika told him these things.

"Perhaps I have been away too long," Okonkwo said, almost to himself. "But I cannot understand these things you tell me. What is it that has happened to our people? Why have they lost the power to fight?"

"Have you not heard how the white man wiped out Abame?" asked Obierika.

"I have heard," said Okonkwo. "But I have also heard that Abame people were weak and foolish. Why did they not fight back? Had they no guns and matches? We would be cowards to compare ourselves with the men of Abame. Their fathers had never dared to stand before our ancestors. We must fight these men and drive them from the land."

"It is already too late," said Obierika sadly. "Our own men and our sons have joined the ranks of the stranger. They have joined his religion and they help to uphold his government. If we should try to drive out the white men in Umuofia we should find it easy. There are only two of them. But what of our own people who are following their way and have been given power? They would go to Umuru and bring the soldiers, and we would be like Abame." He paused for a long time and then said: "I told you on my last visit to Mbanta how they hanged Aneto."

"What has happened to that piece of land in dispute?" asked Okonkwo. "The white man's court has decided that it should belong to Nnama's family, who had given much money to the white man's messengers and interpreter." "Does the white man understand our custom about land?" "How can he when he does not even speak our tongue? But he says that our customs are bad; and our own brothers who have taken up his religion also say that our customs are bad. How do you think we can fight when our own brothers have turned against us? The white man is very clever. He came quietly and peaceably with his religion."

We were amused at his foolishness and allowed him to stay. Now he has won our brothers, and our clan can no longer act like one. He has put a knife on the things that held us together and we have fallen apart." "How did they get hold of Aneto to hang him?" asked Okonkwo. "When he killed Oduche in the fight over the land, he fled to Aninta to escape the wrath of the earth."

This was about eight days after the fight, because Oduche had not died immediately from his wounds. It was on the seventh day that he died. But everybody knew that he was going to die and Aneto got his belongings together in readiness to flee. But the Christians had told the white man about the accident, and he sent his kotma to catch Aneto.

He was imprisoned with all the leaders of his family. In the end Oduche died and Aneto was taken to Umuru and hanged. The other people were released, but even now they have not found the mouth with which to tell of their suffering."The two men sat in silence for a long while afterwards.

Extract from *Things Fall Apart* by Chinua Achebe

Comprehension questions

1. Who arrives in Umuofia that changes the life of the villagers?
2. How does the coming of the missionaries reflect the historical reality of colonialism in Nigeria?
3. How do some villagers respond to the new religion introduced by the missionaries?
4. Describe the meeting between the villagers and the District Commissioner. What is its outcome?
5. How does Okonkwo react to the arrival of the missionaries?
6. Why do some villagers convert to the new religion while others resist? What does this suggest about the social impact of colonialism?
7. Discuss what Obierika meant by "he has put a knife on things that held us together and we have fallen apart"

Meaning

Historical Theme

A **historical theme** in literature refers to ideas or messages in a story that are connected to **past events, historical experiences, or important changes in society**. It helps readers understand how history influences people's lives, cultures, and communities.

Historical themes often explore issues such as **colonialism, resistance, wars, independence struggles, cultural change, leadership, and national identity**. Through these themes, authors show how historical events shape the behaviour, beliefs, and decisions of characters.

In literature, historical themes also help readers **learn about the past, understand social and political changes, and reflect on how history affects the present and future**.

Importance

The **importance of a historical theme** in literature is that it helps readers understand how past events shape the lives, culture, and identity of a community. It shows how societies respond to major changes such as colonialism, new political systems, or cultural influences.

Historical themes also help readers learn about the struggles people faced in protecting their traditions, freedom, and unity. In addition, they encourage reflection on how history influences the present and why it is important to preserve cultural identity while learning from past experiences.

Historical Theme in this extract

1. Colonialism

Colonialism is shown when **white men introduce a new government, religion, and court system** in Umuofia. The **District Commissioner and court messengers (kotma)** enforce foreign laws that **replace traditional Igbo customs and leadership**, disrupting the community's way of life.

2. Resistance

Resistance is shown through **Okonkwo's desire to fight the white men** and defend the clan's traditions. Villagers also show resistance by **mocking the court messengers in songs**, but resistance weakens because **some villagers accept the new religion and government**.

3. Struggle for Independence

The struggle for independence is shown when **colonial authorities punish villagers**, such as the **execution of Aneto and imprisonment of others**. These actions show that the **community is losing control over its land, justice system, and decisions**.

4. National Identity and Unity

National identity weakens when some villagers convert to Christianity and support colonial rule. As Obierika explains, the white man has broken the unity of the clan, making it difficult for the people to defend their traditions and remain united.

Application activity 3.1.2



Read the extract and answer the questions that follow

There were many men and women in Umuofia who did not feel as strongly as Okonkwo about the new dispensation. The white man had indeed brought a lunatic religion, but he had also built a trading store and for the first time palm-oil and kernel became things of great price, and much money flowed into Umuofia.

And even in the matter of religion there was a growing feeling that there might be something in it after all, something vaguely akin to method in the overwhelming madness.

This growing feeling was due to Mr Brown, the white missionary, who was very firm in restraining his flock from provoking the wrath of the clan. One member in particular was very difficult to restrain. His name was Enoch and his father was the priest of the snake cult. The story went around that Enoch had killed and eaten the sacred python, and that his father had cursed him.

Mr Brown preached against such excess of zeal. Everything was possible, he told his energetic flock, but everything was not expedient. And so Mr Brown came to be respected even by the clan, because he trod softly on its faith

He made friends with some of the great men of the clan and on one of his frequent visits to the neighbouring villages he had been presented with a carved elephant tusk, which was a sign of dignity and rank. One of the great men in that village was called Akunna and he had given one of his sons to be taught the white man's knowledge in Mr Brown's school.

Whenever Mr Brown went to that village he spent long hours with Akunna in his obi talking through an interpreter about religion. Neither of them succeeded in converting the other but they learnt more about their different beliefs.

"You say that there is one supreme God who made heaven and earth," said Akunna on one of Mr Brown's visits. "We also believe in Him and call Him Chukwu. He made all the world and the other gods.

"There are no other gods," said Mr Brown. "Chukwu is the only God and all others are false. You carve a piece of wood—like that one" (he pointed at the rafters from which Akunna's carved Ikenga hung), "and you call it a god. But it is still a piece of wood."

"Yes," said Akunna. "It is indeed a piece of wood. The tree from which it came was made by Chukwu, as indeed all minor gods were. But He made them for His messengers so that we could approach Him through them. It is like yourself. You are the head of your church."

"No," protested Mr Brown. "The head of my church is God Himself."

Extract from Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe

A. Comprehension Questions

1. Who was Mr Brown, and how did he approach the people of Umuofia?
2. Who was Enoch, and what did he do that caused tension in the community?
3. How did villagers initially respond to education in Mr Brown's school?
4. How do villagers show both acceptance and resistance to the new religion?
5. Compare and contrast the Igbo belief in Chukwu and the lesser gods with Mr Brown's teaching about the Christian God. In what ways are these beliefs similar or different? Explain your answer clearly. How does the discussion between Akunna and Mr Brown illustrate respectful dialogue between cultures?
6. Explain why reaching a peaceful agreement, as shown in the conversation between Mr Brown and Akunna, is an effective way of resolving disagreements. In your opinion, did the villagers make wise choices in embracing some aspects of the mission and rejecting others? Explain.

7. Would you describe Mr Brown as respectful or manipulative in his approach? Support your answer with examples from the text.

B. Language enhancement

Choose the meaning of the underlined word based on how it is used in the text.

The white man had indeed brought a lunatic religion, but he had also built a trading store.

- a) Crazy b) Wise c) Ordinary d) Peaceful

Everything was possible, he told his energetic flock, but everything was not expedient.

- a) Useful and suitable b) Dangerous c) Difficult d) Forbidden

He was presented with a carved elephant tusk, which was a sign of dignity and rank.

- a) Wealth b) Respect and honor c) Power d) Size

The story went around that Enoch had killed and eaten the sacred python, and that his father had cursed him.

- a) Blessed b) Condemned c) Protected d) Ignored

C. Oral Presentation question

Summarize in 80 words, the key ideas from the extract.

3.2. Economic Themes

Learning activity 3.2.1



Read the extract and answer the questions that follow

Okonkwo did not have the start in life which many young men usually had. He did not inherit a barn from his father. There was no barn to inherit. The story was told in Umuofia of how his father, Unoka, had gone to consult the Oracle of the Hills and the Caves to find out why he always had a miserable harvest.

The Oracle was called Agbala, and people came from far and near to consult it. They came when misfortune dogged their steps or when they had a dispute with their neighbours. They came to discover what the future held for them or to consult the spirits of their departed fathers.

The way into the shrine was a round hole at the side of a hill, just a little bigger than the round opening into a hen-house. Worshippers and those who came to seek knowledge from the god crawled on their belly through the hole and found themselves in a dark, endless space in the presence of Agbala. No one had ever beheld Agbala, except his priestess. But no one who had ever crawled into his awful shrine had come out without the fear of his power. His priestess stood by the sacred fire which she built in the heart of the cave and proclaimed the will of the god. The fire did not burn with a flame. The glowing logs only served to light up vaguely the dark figure of the priestess.

Sometimes a man came to consult the spirit of his dead father or relative. It was said that when such a spirit appeared, the man saw it vaguely in the darkness, but never heard its voice. Some people even said that they had heard the spirits flying and flapping their wings against the roof of the cave.

Many years ago when Okonkwo was still a boy his father, Unoka, had gone to consult Agbala. The priestess in those days was a woman called Chika. She was full of the power of her god, and she was greatly feared. Unoka stood before her and began his story.

'Every year,' he said sadly, 'before I put any crop in the earth, I 'sacrifice a cock to Ani, the owner of all land. It is the law of our fathers. I also kill a cock at the shrine of Ifejioku, the god of yams. I clear the bush and set fire to it when it is dry. I sow the yams when the first rain has fallen, and stake them when the young tendrils appear. I weed —'

'Hold your peace!' screamed the priestess, her voice terrible as it echoed through the dark void. 'You have offended neither the gods nor your fathers. And when a man is at peace with his gods and his ancestors, his harvest will be good or bad according to the strength of his arm. You, Unoka, are known in all the clan for the weakness of your matchet and your hoe. When your neighbours go out with their axe to cut down virgin forests, you sow your yams on exhausted farms that take no labour to clear. They cross seven rivers to make their farms; you stay at home and offer sacrifices to a reluctant soil. Go home and work like a man.'

Unoka was an ill-fated man. He had a bad chi or personal god, and evil fortune followed him to the grave, or rather to his death, for he had no grave. He died of the swelling which was an abomination to the earth goddess. When a man was afflicted with swelling in the stomach and the limbs he was not allowed to die in the house. He was carried to the Evil Forest and left there to die. There was a story of a very stubborn man who staggered back to his house and had to be carried again to the forest and tied to a tree. The sickness was an abomination to the earth, and so the victim could not be buried in her bowels. He died and rotted away above the earth, and was not given the first or the second burial. Such was Unoka's fate. When they carried him away, he took with him his flute.

With a father like Unoka, Okonkwo did not have the start in life which many young men had. He neither inherited a barn nor a title, nor even a young wife. But in spite of these disadvantages, he had begun even in his father's lifetime to lay the foundations of a prosperous future. It was slow and painful. But he threw himself into it like one possessed. And indeed he was possessed by the fear of his father's contemptible life and shameful death. There was a wealthy man in Okonkwo's village who had three huge barns, nine wives and thirty children. His name was Nwakibie and he had taken the highest but one title which a man could take in the clan. It was for this man that Okonkwo worked to earn his first seed yams.

He took a pot of palm-wine and a cock to Nwakibie. Two elderly neighbours were sent for, and Nwakibie's two grown-up sons were also present in his obi. He presented a kola nut and an alligator pepper, which was passed round for all to see and then returned to him. He broke it, saying: 'We shall all live. We pray for life, children, a good harvest and happiness. You will have what is good for you and I will have what is good for me. Let the kite perch and let the eagle perch too. If one says no to the other, let his wing break.'

After the kola nut had been eaten Okonkwo brought his palm-wine from the corner of the hut where it had been placed and stood it in the centre of the group. He addressed Nwakibie, calling him 'Our father'.

'Nna ayi,' he said. 'I have brought you this little kola. As our people say, a man who pays respect to the great paves the way for his own greatness. I have come to pay you my respects and also to ask a favour. But let us drink the wine first.'

Everybody thanked Okonkwo and the neighbours brought out their drinking horns from the goatskin bags they carried. Nwakibie brought down his own horn, which was fastened to the rafters. The younger of his sons, who was also the youngest man in the group, moved to the centre, raised the pot on his left knee and began to pour out the wine. The first cup went to Okonkwo, who must taste his wine before anyone else. Then the group drank, beginning with the eldest man. When everyone had drunk two or three horns, Nwakibie sent for his wives. Some of them were not at home and only four came in.

'Is Anasi not in?' he asked them. They said she was coming. Anasi was the first wife and the others could not drink before her, and so they stood waiting.

Anasi was a middle-aged woman, tall and strongly built. There was authority in her bearing and she looked every inch the ruler of the womenfolk in a large and prosperous family. She wore the anklet of her husband's titles, which the first wife alone could wear.

She walked up to her husband and accepted the horn from him.

Extract from Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe

Comprehension questions

1. Why did Okonkwo not inherit a barn or wealth from his father? How does this reflect the economic disadvantage he faced?
2. How did Unoka's farming practices contribute to his poverty?
3. What does the priestess mean when she says, "you, Unoka are known in all the clan for the weakness of your matchet and your hoe". ?
4. Compare Unoka's farming practices with those of his neighbours. What economic lessons can be derived from this contrast?
5. How does the extract demonstrate that economic hardship results not only from a lack of resources but also from individual choices and levels of effort? What message is Achebe giving about personal responsibility and its impact on economic wellbeing?

Meaning

An **economic theme** in literature refers to ideas in a story that relate to **money, wealth, poverty, work, trade, and how people earn or use resources to survive**. It explores how economic conditions affect individuals, families, and communities.

Economic themes often show **how people struggle to meet their needs, how wealth or poverty influences social status, and how work and resources shape people's lives**. Writers use these themes to explain how economic situations can create opportunities, hardships, or inequalities in society.

For example, in "*Things Fall Apart*" by Chinua Achebe, economic themes appear through **poverty, farming, hard work, debt, and the struggle to achieve wealth and respect in the community**.

Importance

The **economic theme** in literature is important because it helps readers understand how people survive and earn a living through work, farming, trade, or other activities. It shows how **wealth and poverty influence a person's status, respect, and opportunities** in society. Economic themes also explain why characters make certain decisions, such as working hard, seeking better opportunities, or trying to escape poverty. In addition, they reflect **real-life economic challenges** like inequality, unemployment, and exploitation. Through these themes, literature teaches the value of **hard work, responsibility, and wise use of resources**, while encouraging readers to think critically about how economic conditions affect individuals and communities.

1. Poverty

The extract shows the problem of **poverty through the character of Unoka**, Okonkwo's father. Unoka is poor because he does not work hard on his farms and prefers easy land instead of clearing new forests like other farmers. As a result, his harvests are always poor and he cannot accumulate wealth. This poverty affects his social status in the community and leaves nothing for his son to inherit.

2. Lack of Economic Responsibility

The priestess explains that Unoka's poverty is not caused by the gods but by his **lack of effort and responsibility**. In Umuofia society, success in farming depends on **hard work, determination, and personal effort**. The message is that economic success comes from labour rather than relying only on rituals or luck.

3. Economic Hardship

Because Unoka fails to work hard, his family experiences **economic hardship**. They struggle to produce enough crops and cannot build wealth like other families. This hardship also means that Okonkwo begins life without resources such as barns, farmland, or seed yams.

4. Social Consequences of Poverty

In Umuofia, wealth and farming success bring **respect and honour**, while poverty brings **shame and low social status**. Unoka's poverty affects how others see him and influences Okonkwo's strong desire to become successful and respected.

5. Value of Hard Work

The extract highlights the cultural belief that **economic success is linked to hard work**. The priestess advises Unoka to “go home and work like a man,” showing that the community values effort, perseverance, and responsibility as the path to prosperity.

Application activity 3.2.2



Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow

If you give me some yam seeds, I shall not fail you.'

Nwakibie cleared his throat. 'It pleases me to see a young man like you these days when our youth have gone so soft. Many young men have come to me to ask for yams but I have refused because I knew they would just dump them in the earth and leave them to be choked by weeds. When I say no to them they think I am hard-hearted. But it is not so. Eneke the bird says that **since men have learnt to shoot without missing, he has learnt to fly without perching**. I have learnt to be stingy with my yams. But I can trust you. I know it as I look at you. As our fathers said, you can tell a ripe corn by its look. I shall give you twice four hundred yams. Go ahead and prepare your farm.'

Okonkwo thanked him again and again and went home feeling happy. He knew that Nwakibie would not refuse him, but he had not expected he would be so generous. He had not hoped to get more than four hundred seeds. He would now have to make a bigger farm. He hoped to get another four hundred yams from one of his father's friends at Isiuzo.

Share-cropping was a very slow way of building up a barn of one's own. After all the toil one only got a third of the harvest. But for a young man whose father had no yams, there was no other way.

And what made it worse in Okonkwo's case was that he had to support his mother and two sisters from his meagre harvest. And supporting his mother also meant supporting his father. She could not be expected to cook and eat while her husband starved. And so, at a very early age when he was striving desperately to build a barn through share-cropping Okonkwo was also fending for his father's house. It was like pouring grains of corn into a bag full of holes. His mother and sisters worked hard enough, but they grew women's crops, like coco-yams, beans and cassava. Yam, the king of crops, was a man's crop.

The year that Okonkwo took eight hundred seed-yams from Nwakibie was the worst year in living memory. Nothing happened at its proper time; it was either too early or too late. It seemed as if the world had gone mad. The first rains were late, and, when they came, lasted only a brief moment. The blazing sun returned, more fierce than it had ever been known, and scorched all the green that had appeared with the rains. The earth burned like hot coals and roasted all the yams that had been sown. Like all good farmers, Okonkwo had begun to sow with the first rains. He had sown four hundred seeds when the rains dried up and the heat returned. He watched the sky all day for signs of rain-clouds and lay awake all night. In the morning he went back to his farm and saw the withering tendrils. He had tried to protect them from the smouldering earth by making rings of thick sisal leaves around them. But by the end of the day the sisal rings were burnt dry and grey. He changed them every day, and prayed that the rain might fall in the night. But the drought continued for eight market weeks and the yams were killed.

Some farmers had not planted their yams yet. They were the lazy easy-going ones who always put off clearing their farms as long as they could. This year they were the wise ones. They sympathised with their neighbours with much shaking of the head, but inwardly they were happy for what they took to be their own foresight.

Okonkwo planted what was left of his seed-yams when the rains finally returned. He had one consolation. The yams he had sown before the drought were his own, the harvest of the previous year. He still had the eight hundred from Nwakibie and the four hundred from his father's friend. So, he would make a fresh start.

But the year had gone mad. Rain fell as it had never fallen before. For days and nights together, it poured down in violent torrents, and washed away the yam heaps. Trees were uprooted and deep gorges appeared everywhere. Then the rain became less violent. But it went on from day to day without a pause. The spell of sunshine which always came in the middle of the wet season did not appear. The yams put on luxuriant green leaves, but every farmer knew that without sunshine the tubers would not grow.

That year the harvest was sad, like a funeral, and many farmers wept as they dug up the miserable and rotting yams. One man tied his cloth to a tree branch and hanged himself.

Okonkwo remembered that tragic year with a cold shiver through-

Extract from *Things Fall Apart* by Chinua Achebe

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple Choice question

Nwakibie gave Okonkwo 800 yams because:

- a) He wanted to test Okonkwo's strength
- b) He trusted that Okonkwo would work hard and not waste the yams
- c) He had too many yams and wanted to get rid of them
- d) Okonkwo was related to him by family

ii. Answer True or False:

Okonkwo's father had no yams, which forced Okonkwo to start building his own wealth through share-cropping.

iii. Closed questions

1. Who are the characters in this story
2. Why did Nwakibie refuse to give his yams to the young men?

iv. Open ended questions

1. Compare Okonkwo's farming challenges during the drought with the farmers who delayed planting. What economic lesson does this convey?
2. What does the text suggest about the relationship between hard work, risk, and economic success in Umuofia?
3. Explain how yams being "the king of crops" influenced men's social and economic status in the clan.
4. Do you agree or disagree that a farmer's wealth depends more on the natural environment than on personal effort? Use Okonkwo's experience to support your answer.

B. Language enhancement

Eneke the bird says that **since men have learnt to shoot without missing, he has learnt to fly without perching**. What do you learn from figurative language?

C. Oral presentation

Okonkwo works hard to build his wealth, but he still faces challenges caused by factors beyond his control. In your own life or community, discuss a situation where someone works hard but is affected by external circumstances such as environment, society, or unexpected events?

3.3. Cultural Themes

Learning activity 3.3.1



Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow

..., Those who believed such stories were unworthy of the Lord's Table. There was a saying in Umuofia that as a man danced so the drums were beaten for him. Mr Smith danced a furious step and so the drums went mad. The over zealous converts who had started under Mr Brown's restraining hand now flourished in full favour. One of them was Enoch, the son of the snake-priest who was believed to have killed and eaten the sacred python. Enoch's devotion to the new faith had seemed so much greater than Mr Brown's that the villagers called him The Outsider who wept louder than the bereaved.

Enoch was short and slight of build, and always seemed in great haste. His feet were short and broad, and when he stood or walked his heels came together and his feet opened outwards as if they had quarrelled and meant to go in different directions. Such was the excessive energy bottled up in Enoch's small body that it was always erupting in quarrels and fights. On Sundays he always imagined that the sermon was preached for the benefit of his enemies. And if he happened to sit near one of them, he would occasionally turn to give him a meaningful look, as if to say, 'I told you so.' It was Enoch who touched off the great conflict between church and clan in Umuofia which had been gathering since Mr Brown left.

It happened during the annual ceremony which was held in honour of the earth deity. At such times the ancestors of the clan who had been committed to Mother Earth at their death emerged again as *egwugwu* through tiny ant-holes.

One of the greatest crimes a man could commit was to unmask an *egwugwu* in public, or to say or do anything which might reduce its immortal prestige in the eyes of the uninitiated. And this was what Enoch did.

The annual worship of the earth goddess fell on a Sunday, and the masked spirits were abroad. The Christian women who had been to church could not therefore go home. Some of their men had gone out to beg the *egwugwu* to retire for a short while for the women to pass. They agreed and were already retiring, when Enoch boasted aloud that they would not dare to touch a Christian. Whereupon they all came back and one of them gave Enoch a good stroke of the cane, which was always carried. Enoch fell on him and tore off his mask.

The other *egwugwu* immediately surrounded their desecrated companion, to shield him from the profane gaze of women and children, and led him away. Enoch had killed an ancestral spirit, and Umuofia was thrown into confusion.

That night the Mother of the Spirits walked the length and breadth of the clan, weeping for her murdered son. It was a terrible night. Not even the oldest man in Umuofia had ever heard such a strange and fearful sound, and it was never to be heard again. It seemed as if the very soul of the tribe wept for a great evil that was coming – its own death.

On the next day all the masked egwugwu of Umuofia assembled in the market-place. They came from all the quarters of the clan and even from the neighbouring villages. The dreadful Otakagu came from Imo, and Ekwensu, dangling a white cock, arrived from Uli. It was a terrible gathering. The eerie voices of countless spirits, the bells that clattered behind some of them, and the clash of matches as they ran forwards and backwards and saluted one another, sent tremors of fear into every heart. For the first time in living memory the sacred bull-roarer was heard in broad daylight.

From the market-place the furious band made for Enoch's compound. Some of the elders of the clan went with them, wearing heavy protections of charms and amulets. These were men whose arms were strong in ogun, or medicine. As for the ordinary men and women, they listened from the safety of their huts.

The leader of the Christians had met together at Mr Smith's parsonage on the previous night. As they deliberated, they could hear the Mother of Spirits wailing for her son. The chilling sound affected Mr Smith, and for the first time he seemed to be afraid.

'What are they planning to do?' he asked. No one knew, because such a thing had never happened before. Mr Smith would have sent for the District Commissioner and his court messengers, but they had gone on tour on the previous day.

'One thing is clear,' said Mr Smith. 'We cannot offer physical resistance to them. Our strength lies in the Lord.' They knelt down together and prayed to God for delivery.

'O Lord save Thy people,' cried Mr Smith.

'And bless Thine inheritance,' replied the men.

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A. Comprehension questions

1. What crime did Enoch commit during the ceremony of the earth deity?
2. Why was unmasking an **egwugwu** considered a serious offense in Umuofia?
3. What strange event happened during the night after the egwugwu was unmasked?
4. How does the role of the **egwugwu** show the importance of customs and heritage in the community?
5. How does Enoch's behaviour show the conflict between the Christian religion and traditional Igbo beliefs?

Meaning

Cultural Themes

A cultural theme is the main idea in a literary work that shows the beliefs, values, traditions, and way of life of a particular society or community.

It explains **how people live, what they believe in, and the customs they follow** in their culture.

In the novel, the **Igbo culture** is presented through:

- Religious beliefs such as the worship of gods and ancestors.
- Ceremonies and festivals like the worship of the **earth goddess**.
- Traditional leadership through elders and spiritual figures like the **egwugwu**.
- Respect for community laws and traditions.

These cultural practices guide how people behave and how the society is organized

Importance of Cultural Themes

Cultural themes are important in literature because they help readers understand the **values, traditions, and beliefs of a particular society**. In works such as *Things Fall Apart*, cultural themes play several important roles.

1. They help readers understand a society

Cultural themes show how people live, what they believe in, and the customs they follow. This helps readers learn about different cultures.

2. They preserve traditions and heritage

Literature records cultural practices such as ceremonies, beliefs, and social rules, helping to keep them alive for future generations.

3. They promote respect for different cultures

By learning about other cultures through Literature, readers develop tolerance and appreciation for cultural diversity.

4. They explain characters' actions

Many characters act according to the traditions and beliefs of their culture. Cultural themes help readers understand why characters behave the way they do.

5. They show social change and conflict

Cultural themes can reveal how societies change over time, especially when new ideas challenge traditional beliefs.

6. Role of Customs and Heritage

Customs are the traditional practices followed by a community, while **heritage** refers to the cultural traditions passed from one generation to another.

In the story: The **egwugwu** represent the spirits of the ancestors and play an important role in justice and tradition.

- Religious ceremonies honour gods and ancestors.

- The community respects sacred traditions, and breaking them is considered a serious offense.

These customs help preserve the **identity and unity** of the Igbo people.

3. Clash Between Tradition and Modernity

This theme shows the **conflict between traditional Igbo culture and new Western ideas brought by missionaries and colonial rule.**

Examples in the novel include:

- The introduction of **Christianity**, which challenges traditional beliefs.
- Converts like **Enoch** disrespecting sacred traditions such as the **egwugwu**.
- Conflicts between the church and the clan.

This clash creates tension and division in the community, eventually leading to the weakening of traditional society.

Application activity 3.3.2



Read the extract and answer the questions that follow

They decided that Enoch should be hidden in the parsonage for a day or two. Enoch himself was greatly disappointed when he heard that he had hoped that a holy war was imminent, and there were a few other Christians who thought like him. But wisdom prevailed in the camp of the faithful and many lives were thus saved.

The band of egwugwu moved like a furious whirlwind to Enoch's compound and with matchet and fire reduced it to a desolate heap. And from there they made for the church, intoxicated with drunkenness.

Mr Smith was in his church when he heard the masked spirits coming. He walked quietly to the door which commanded the approach to the church compound, and stood there. But when the first three or four egwugwu appeared on the church compound he nearly bolted. He overcame this impulse and instead of running away he went down the two steps that led up to the church and walked towards the approaching spirits.

They surged forward, and a long stretch of the bamboo fence with which the church compound was surrounded gave way before them. Discordant bells clanged, matchets clashed and the air was full of dust and weird sounds. Mr Smith heard a sound of footsteps behind him. He turned round and saw Okeke, his interpreter. Okeke had not been on the best of terms with his master since he had strongly condemned Enoch's behaviour at the meeting of the leaders of the church during the night. Okeke had gone as far as to say that Enoch should not be hidden in the parsonage, because he would only draw the wrath of the clan on the pastor. Mr Smith had rebuked him in very strong language, and had not sought his advice that morning. But now, as he came up and stood by him confronting the angry spirits, Mr Smith looked at him and smiled. It was a wan smile, but there was deep gratitude there.

For a brief moment the onrush of the egwugwu was checked by the unexpected composure of the two men. But it was only a momentary check, like the tense silence between blasts of thunder. The second onrush was greater than the first. It swallowed up the two men. Then an unmistakable voice rose above the tumult and there was immediate silence. Space was made around the two men, and Ajofia began to speak.

Things fall apart chapter, 22, page 133

A. Comprehension questions

1. **Why did the Christians decide to hide Enoch in the parsonage?**
 - A. They wanted him to escape from the village
 - B. They wanted him to travel to another village
 - C. They wanted him to continue preaching
 - D. They feared the anger of the clan
2. **What does Enoch's disappointment about not having a "holy war" suggest?**
 - A. He wished to leave the church
 - B. He wanted peace between the church and the clan
 - C. He was afraid of the egwugwu
 - D. He wanted a conflict to defend the new religion
3. **How did the egwugwu first react to Enoch's actions?**
 - A. They went to the church immediately
 - B. They destroyed Enoch's compound
 - C. They arrested Enoch
 - D. They reported the case to the District Commissioner
4. **The destruction of Enoch's compound mainly shows that the clan:**
 - A. Was defending its customs and traditions
 - B. Wanted to join Christianity
 - C. Was celebrating a festival
 - D. Wanted to destroy all houses in the village
5. **What traditional group led the attack on Enoch's compound and the church?**
 - A. The missionaries
 - B. The Christian converts
 - C. The egwugwu
 - D. The elders of the church
6. **The egwugwu represent which important cultural belief in Umuofia?**
 - A. The leaders of the church
 - B. The power of warriors
 - C. The colonial government
 - D. The ancestors and traditional justice
7. **What does the attack on the church symbolize in the extract?**
 - A. Cooperation between the church and the clan
 - B. The struggle between traditional beliefs and Christianity

- C. The end of the egwugwu tradition
- D. The victory of the missionaries

8. How did Mr Smith react when he saw the egwugwu approaching the church?

- A. He stood at the door and faced them
- B. He ran away immediately
- C. He hid inside the church
- D. He called the District Commissioner

B. Language enhancement

Vocabulary

What does the word **"imminent"** mean in the sentence:

"...he had hoped that a holy war was imminent."

Give the meaning of **"desolate"** as used in the text.

Find a word in the passage that means **"very angry and violent."**

What does **"composure"** mean in the sentence:

"...the unexpected composure of the two men."

Identify a synonym of **"confusion or noise"** from the passage.

Oral presentation "In your community or school, have you ever seen a situation where people with different beliefs, traditions, or opinions came into conflict? Compare that situation with what happens in this extract, where the egwugwu and the church clash. What lesson can we learn about respecting culture, handling disagreements peacefully, and living together in harmony?"

3.4. Social themes

Learning activity 3.4.1



Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow

Then he began to speak, quietly and deliberately, picking his words with great care. 'It is Okonkwo that I primarily wish to speak to,' he began. 'But I want all of you to note what I am going to say. I am an old man and you are all children. I know more about the world than any of you. If there is any one among you who thinks he knows more than I do, let him speak up.' He paused, but no one spoke.

'Why is Okonkwo with us today? This is not his clan. We are only his mother's kinsmen. He does not belong here. He is an exile, condemned for seven years to live in a strange land. And so, he is bowed with grief. But there is just one question I would like to ask him. Can you tell me, Okonkwo, why it is that one of the commonest names we give our children is Nneka, or "Mother is Supreme"? We all know that a man is the head of the family and his wives do his bidding. A child belongs to its father and his family and not to its mother and her family. A man belongs to his fatherland and not to his motherland. And yet we say Nneka – "Mother is Supreme". Why is that?'

There was silence. 'I want Okonkwo to answer me,' said Uchendu. 'I do not know the answer,' Okonkwo replied.

'You do not know the answer? So you see that you are a child. You have many wives and many children – more children than I have. You are a great man in your clan. But you are still a child, my child. Listen to me and I shall tell you. But there is one more question I shall ask. Why is it that when a woman dies, she is taken home to be buried with her own kinsmen? She is not buried with her husband's kinsmen. Why is that? Your mother was brought home to me and buried with my people. Why was that?'

Okonkwo shook his head.

'He does not know that either,' said Uchendu, 'and yet he is full of sorrow because he has come to live in his motherland for a few years.' He laughed a mirthless laughter, and turned to his sons and daughters. 'What about you? Can you answer my question?'

They all shook their heads.

'Then listen to me,' he said and cleared his throat. 'It's true that a child belongs to its father. But when a father beats his child, it seeks sympathy in its mother's hut. A man belongs to his fatherland when things are good and life is sweet. But when there is sorrow and bitterness, he finds refuge in his motherland. Your mother is there to protect you. She is buried there. And that is why we say that mother is supreme. Is it right that you, Okonkwo, should bring your mother a heavy face and refuse to be comforted? Be careful or you may displease the dead. Your duty is to comfort your wives and children and take them back to your fatherland after seven years. But if you allow sorrow to weigh you down and kill you, they will all die in exile.' He paused for a long while. 'These are now your kinsmen.' He waved at his sons and daughters. 'You think you are the greatest sufferer in the world. Do you know that men are sometimes banished for life? Do you know that men sometimes lose all their yams and even their children? I had six wives once. I have none now except that young girl who knows not her right from her left. Do you know how many children I have buried – children I begot in my youth and strength? Twenty-two. I did not hang myself, and I am still alive. If you think you are the greatest sufferer in the world, ask my daughter Akeuni, how many twins she has borne and thrown away. Have you not heard the song they sing when a woman dies?

"For whom is it well, for whom is it well?

There is no one for whom it is well."

'I have no more to say to you.'

Things fall Apart, chapter 14 page 96

Comprehension questions

1. What question does Uchendu ask about the name **"Nneka"**?
2. Why does Uchendu say a child runs to the mother when the father beats him?

3. How do you feel after reading the passage?
4. According to Uchendu, where does a man go when life becomes difficult?
5. How does this extract show the importance of **support during difficult times** in society?
6. How does the passage show the theme of **suffering as a common human experience**?
7. Why are women buried with their **own kinsmen** instead of their husband's family?
8. What does this extract teach about the **role of extended family** in Igbo society?

Meaning

Social theme

A **social theme** is a **central idea in a story that focuses on how people live together in society**, including their relationships, roles, values, traditions, and problems.

It shows **how individuals interact with their community, family, culture, and social institutions**.

Examples of Social Themes

Common social themes include:

- Family relationships
- Kinship and clan structure
- Gender roles
- Respect for elders
- Community support
- Social inequality
- Traditions and cultural values

Example from the Extract

In the passage where **Uchendu** speaks to **Okonkwo**, the social theme is **family support and the importance of kinship**.

Uchendu explains that when life becomes difficult, a person finds **comfort and protection in the mother's family**.

Importance

Importance of Social Theme in Literature

Social themes are important because they help readers understand **how people live and interact in a society**. They show the values, traditions, and challenges that influence people's lives.

1. Helps Readers Understand Society

Social themes explain how communities function, including family roles, leadership, and cultural traditions.

For example, in **Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe**, readers learn about the structure and customs of Igbo society.

2. Shows Relationships Between People

They highlight relationships such as family bonds, kinship, and community support. Through characters like **Uchendu** and **Okonkwo**, the novel shows how relatives support each other in difficult times.

3. Teaches Moral and Social Lessons

Social themes help readers learn lessons about respect, cooperation, responsibility, and compassion.

Application activity 3.4.2



Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow

It was in the second year of Okonkwo's exile that his friend, Obierika, came to visit him. He brought with him two young men, each of them carrying a heavy bag on his head. Okonkwo helped them put down their loads. It was clear that the bags were full of cowries.

Okonkwo was very happy to receive his friends. His wives and children were very happy too, and so were his cousins and their wives. When he went to them and told them who his guest was, one of his cousins said to Okonkwo, "You must take him to salute our father."

"Yes," replied Obierika. "We are going straight to him." But before they went he whispered something to Okonkwo's first wife. She nodded, and soon the children were chasing one of their cocks.

Uchendu had been told by one of his grandchildren that three strangers had come to Okonkwo's house. He was therefore waiting to receive them. He held out his hands to them when they came into his obi, and after they had shaken hands, he asked Okonkwo who they were.

"This is Obierika, my great friend. I have already spoken to you about him."

"Yes," said the old man, turning to Obierika. "My son has told me about you, and I am happy you have come to see us. I knew your father, Ibe. He was a great man. He had many friends here and came to see them quite often. Those were good days when a man had friends in distant clans. Your generation does not know that. You stay at home, afraid of your next-door neighbour. Even a man's mother-land is strange to him nowadays." He looked at Okonkwo. "I am an old man and I like to talk. That is all I am good for now." He got up painfully, went into an inner room and came back with a kola nut. "Who are the young men with you?" he asked as he sat down again on his stool. Okonkwo told him.

Things Fall Apart Chapter 15. Page 96

A. Comprehension questions

1. What happened to the main character before this passage?
2. When did Obierika come to visit Okonkwo during his exile?
3. What does the welcome given to Obierika show about hospitality in the community?
4. How does the passage show the importance of respect for elders?
5. Why is Okonkwo asked to take Obierika to salute Uchendu?
6. How might living in exile affect Okonkwo's family and social status?

B. Language enhancement

Explain the meaning of the following expressions as used in the passage:

- a) "Mother is Supreme."
- b) "A man belongs to his fatherland when things are good."
- c) "He is bowed with grief."
- d) "Bring your mother a heavy face."
- e) "There is no one for whom it is well."

C. Oral presentation

Explain what happens when the egwugwu arrive at the church and describe how Mr Smith reacts to the situation. Do you think he was brave? Give reasons for your answer. (orally)

3.5. Political Themes

Learning activity 3.5.1



Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

When Odili Samalu, a young school-teacher, is invited to the capital by his former teacher, now Chief the Honourable M. A. Nanga, Minister of Culture, he is struck by the sheer scale of the minister's new wealth. Nanga's official residence in Bori is filled with imported furniture, a fleet of cars and a household of servants, all acquired within a few short years of entering government. When Odili quietly wonders aloud how such riches were gathered, Nanga simply laughs and changes the subject to his popularity among "his people" back home.

Odili watches party loyalists flatter the minister in exchange for small favours, while ordinary citizens wait for hours outside the gate hoping for a job, a scholarship or a handout. When a visiting journalist raises questions about funds missing from the Overseas Training Scholarship Scheme, Nanga waves the matter away and calls for more drinks. Slowly, Odili begins to understand that independence has merely replaced one set of masters with another — leaders who speak of service to the nation while quietly building personal fortunes, protected by patronage, propaganda, and the fear they inspire in anyone who might expose them.

Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe.

Comprehension questions

1. What does Chief Nanga's mansion and lifestyle reveal about how he uses his political position?
2. What is the significance of the missing funds from the Overseas Training Scholarship Scheme?
3. What political message is Achebe conveying through Odili's growing disillusionment?
4. In your own words, explain how patronage is used to protect corrupt leaders in this extract.
5. Compare the promise of independence with the reality shown in this extract.

Meaning

Political Theme

A political theme in literature refers to ideas connected to power, leadership, government, corruption, justice, and the relationship between rulers and the ruled. It reflects how political systems, decisions and struggles for power affect individuals and communities.

Political themes often explore issues such as corruption, dictatorship, propaganda, elections, nationalism, revolution, and the abuse of power by those in authority. Through these themes, authors expose the gap between what leaders promise and what they deliver, encouraging readers to examine leadership, justice and civic responsibility critically.

Importance

The political theme in literature is important because it helps readers understand how power is gained, used, and abused within society. It shows how political decisions affect ordinary people's lives, from access to resources and opportunities to freedom and justice. Political themes also expose corruption, dictatorship, and the manipulation of citizens by those in power, encouraging readers to think critically about leadership and governance. In addition, they help readers appreciate the value of accountability, good governance and civic participation, while reflecting on the responsibilities of both leaders and citizens in building a just society.

Political Theme in this extract

1. Political corruption

Nanga's rapid accumulation of wealth and the missing scholarship funds show how public office is exploited for private gain rather than for service to the nation.

2. Abuse of power

As Minister of Culture, Nanga uses his authority to reward loyalty and deflect criticism, showing how political power can be turned into a tool of personal control.

3. Patronage and clientelism

The crowd waiting at Nanga's gate illustrates how citizens become dependent on a "big man" for favours, deepening inequality and weakening genuine democratic participation.

4. Disillusionment with independence

Odili's growing unease reflects a wider disappointment felt across many newly independent African nations, where colonial rulers were replaced by local elites who repeated familiar patterns of exploitation.

5. Betrayal of the common people

Nanga continues to call his constituents "his people" while diverting resources meant for their development, revealing the gap between political rhetoric and genuine commitment to citizens' welfare.

Application activity 3.5.2



Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow.

In Peter Abrahams' *Mine Boy*, Xuma, a young man who has come from the countryside to work in the Johannesburg gold mines, discovers a world governed by strict racial rules: black miners must carry passes, live in crowded compounds, and take orders without question from white overseers who are paid many times more for the same dangerous work underground. When a rock fall traps several black miners deep in the mine, the white officials hesitate, more concerned about lost production than about the trapped men's lives. Xuma, defying the unwritten code that a black man should never challenge a white man's decision, confront the mine officials and insists that rescue efforts begin at once. His stand encourages the other black miners, who have long endured unsafe conditions in silence, to demand better treatment and to reject the assumption that their lives are worth less than the gold they dig. For his defiance, Xuma is arrested, but his action exposes to Paddy O'Shea, a sympathetic white miner, and to the reader, how the entire system of the mines depends on black workers quietly accepting danger, low pay and voicelessness as the natural order of things.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple-choice questions

- Which political theme is most clearly shown by the different treatment of black and white miners?
A. Democracy
B. Racial discrimination and inequality
C. National unity
D. Political participation
- What does the reaction of the white officials to the trapped miners mainly reveal?

- A. Respect for workers' rights B. Abuse of power and exploitation of workers
- C. Equality among miners D. Concern for human rights

3. Why is Xuma's confrontation with the mine officials politically significant?

- A. He accepts the existing system without question.
- B. He uses his position to gain wealth.
- C. He challenges an oppressive system and demands justice.
- D. He supports the mine officials' decisions.

ii. Answer by True or False

1. The treatment of black miners illustrates racial inequality and exploitation.
2. Xuma's arrest shows that those in power may suppress people who challenge an unjust system.
3. The extract presents the mine system as fair because all workers have equal rights and opportunities.

iii. Open-ended questions

1. How does the extract portray abuse of power by the mine officials?
2. How does racial discrimination contribute to the suffering of the black miners?
3. What does Xuma's resistance teach us about challenging injustice and oppression?
4. How does the extract show the relationship between **power, exploitation and inequality**?

B. Language enhancement

Explain the meaning of the following expressions as used in the extract:

- a) "a world governed by strict racial rules"
- b) "take orders without question"
- c) "defying the unwritten code"
- d) "quietly accepting danger, low pay and voicelessness"
- e) "the natural order of things"

C. Oral presentation – Role play

Role play: Challenging Unfair Leadership

Work in groups and perform a role play based on the political themes in the extract.

Scenario: A group of employees works under a powerful leader who gives them **low pay, unsafe working conditions and no opportunity to express their concerns**. When the employees complain, the leader threatens them with dismissal. One employee decides to challenge the unfair system, just as **Xuma challenges the mine officials**.

Task: Act out the situation and demonstrate how ordinary people can respond to **abuse of power, exploitation, inequality and suppression of dissent**. After the role play, explain how your situation relates to **Xuma's resistance in *Mine Boy*** and give **one real-life example** of people challenging unfair treatment.

3.6. Language focus: Active and Passive voice

Learning activity 3.6.1



Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow

Yesterday, the teacher **explained** the new lesson on traditional Igbo customs to the students. Many students **asked** questions about the proverbs and their meanings. Their answers **were checked** carefully by the teacher to make sure everyone understood. Later, the principal **was invited** to address the class about the importance of respecting elders. A short speech **was delivered** by the principal, and the students **listened** attentively. After the speech, the class monitor **collected** all the homework assignments and **was praised** by the teacher for doing it efficiently. Finally, the students **were reminded** to revise their lessons at home before the next class, and they **left** the classroom happily.

By REB's Literature in English Content Developer Team (2026).

Comprehension questions

1. In the sentence "Yesterday, the teacher explained the lesson...", who is performing the action?
2. In the sentence "A short speech was delivered by the principal," who is receiving the action?
3. In "The homework was collected by the class monitor," what happened first, the homework being collected or the class monitor doing it?
4. Find a sentence where the focus is on **what happened** rather than who did it.
5. Find a sentence where the focus is on **who did the action**.

Active Voice

Definition: Active voice is when the subject of the sentence does the action. It clearly shows who is doing what.

Structure: Subject + Verb + Object

Examples:

- The teacher **explained** the lesson.
- The students **answered** the questions.
- Okonkwo **built** his compound.

Why it is used:

- Makes writing and speaking **clear and direct**.
- Helps the listener or reader **understand easily** who is responsible for the action.
- Common in **stories, conversations, and speeches**.

Tip: If you can answer **"Who is doing the action?"** in a sentence, it is usually written in active voice.

Passive Voice

Definition: Passive voice is when the **subject of the sentence receives the action** instead of doing it. The focus is on **what happens** rather than **who does it**.

Changing from Active to Passive: Simple Guide

1. Identify the subject, verb, and object in the active sentence.

Example: *The teacher **explained** the lesson yesterday.*

- Subject: The teacher
- Verb: explained (past tense)

Object: **the lesson**

2. Move the object to the front of the sentence.

- The lesson ...

3. Change the verb form depending on the tense:

- **Present Simple:** am/is/are + past participle → *The lesson **is explained** by the teacher.*
- **Past Simple:** was/were + past participle → *The lesson **was explained** by the teacher.*
- **Future Simple:** will be + past participle → *The lesson **will be explained** by the teacher.*
- **Present Continuous:** am/is/are being + past participle → *The lesson **is being explained** by the teacher.*
- **Present Perfect:** has/have been + past participle → *The lesson **has been explained** by the teacher.*

1. **Add the original subject at the end** with "by" (optional if the doer is not important).

- ... by the teacher

2. **Keep other words** (like time expressions) in their place.

- Yesterday, the lesson was explained by the teacher.

Summary Table: Example "The teacher explained the lesson yesterday"

Active Sentence	Passive Sentence
Present Simple	The teacher explains the lesson. → The lesson is explained by the teacher.
Past Simple	The teacher explained the lesson. → The lesson was explained by the teacher.
Future Simple	The teacher will explain the lesson. → The lesson will be explained by the teacher.
Present Continuous	The teacher is explaining the lesson. → The lesson is being explained by the teacher.
Present Perfect	The teacher has explained the lesson. → The lesson has been explained by the teacher.

Application activity 3.5.2



Read each sentence and choose the option that correctly shows who is doing the action or what happened.

1. The teacher **explained** the lesson yesterday.
A. The lesson will be explained by the teacher yesterday
B. The lesson was explained by the teacher yesterday.
C. The lesson explains the teacher yesterday.
D. None of the above
2. The students **are answering** the questions now.
A. The questions will answer the students now.
B. The questions answered by the students now.
C. The questions are being answered by the students now.
D. None of the above.
3. The principal **gave** a speech last week.
A. A speech was given by the principal last week.
B. A speech gave by the principal last week.
C. A speech is given by the principal last week.
D. None of the above.
4. The homework **will be collected** by the class monitor tomorrow.
A. The homework collected the class monitor tomorrow.
B. The class monitor will collect the homework tomorrow.
C. The class monitor collects the homework tomorrow.
D. None of the above
5. The students **have finished** the exercise.
A. The exercise finished by the students.
B. The exercise is finished by the students.
C. The exercise has been finished by the students.
D. None of the above

**Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow**

Many years ago, when Okonkwo was still a boy, his father, Unoka, had gone to consult Agbala. The priestess in those days was a woman called Chika. She was full of the power of her god, and she was greatly feared. Unoka stood before her and began his story. "Every year," he said sadly, "before I put any crop in the earth, I sacrifice a cock to Ani, the owner of all land. It is the law of our fathers. I also kill a cock at the shrine of Ifejioku, the god of yams. I clear the bush and set fire to it when it is dry. I sow the yams when the first rain has fallen, and stake them when the young tendrils appear. I weed" – "Hold your peace!" screamed the priestess, her voice terrible as it echoed through the dark void. "You have offended neither the gods nor your fathers. And when a man is at peace with his gods and his ancestors, his harvest will be good or bad according to the strength of his arm.

You, Unoka, are known in all the clan for the weakness of your machete and your hoe. When your neighbours go out with their axe to cut down virgin forests, you sow your yams on exhausted farms that take no labour to clear. They cross seven rivers to make their farms, – you stay at home and offer sacrifices to a reluctant soil. Go home and work like a man." Unoka was an ill-fated man. He had a bad chi or personal god, and evil fortune followed him to the grave, or rather to his death, for he had no grave. He died of the swelling which was an abomination to the earth goddess. When a man was afflicted with swelling in the stomach and the limbs he was not allowed to die in the house. He was carried to the Evil Forest and left there to die. There was the story of a very stubborn man who staggered back to his house and had to be carried again to the forest and tied to a tree.

The sickness was an abomination to the earth, and so the victim could not be buried in her bowels. He died and rotted away above the earth, and was not given the first or the second burial. Such was Unoka's fate. When they carried him away, he took with him his flute.

With a father like Unoka, Okonkwo did not have the start in life which many young men had. He neither inherited a barn nor a title, nor even a young wife. But in spite of these disadvantages, he had begun even in his father's lifetime to lay the foundations of a prosperous future. It was slow and painful. But he threw himself into it like one possessed. And indeed he was possessed by the fear of his father's contemptible life and shameful death. There was a wealthy man in Okonkwo's village who had three huge barns, nine wives and thirty children. His name was Nwakibie and he had taken the highest but one title which a man could take in the clan. It was for this man that Okonkwo worked to earn his first seed yams. He took a pot of palm-wine and a cock to Nwakibie. Two elderly neighbours were sent for, and Nwakibie's two grown-up sons were also present in his obi. He presented a kola nut and an alligator pepper, which were passed round for all to see and then returned to him. He broke the nut saying: "We shall all live. We pray for life, children, a good harvest and happiness. You will have what is good for you and I will have what is good for me. Let the kite perch and let the eagle perch too. If one says no to the other, let his wing break."

A. Comprehension Questions

Multiple choice questions.

1. Why did Unoka go to consult Agbala?
a) To ask for land to farm b) To find out why his harvests were poor
c) To request a title from the clan d) To thank the gods for success
2. According to the priestess, what was the main reason for Unoka's poor harvests?
a) He had offended the gods b) His neighbours bewitched him
c) He was lazy and used exhausted farms d) The rains were too heavy
3. Why was Unoka not buried in the usual way?
a) He died far from home b) His sickness was considered an abomination
c) He had no children d) He refused traditional burial rites
4. What did Okonkwo do to obtain seed yams from Nwakibie?
a) He borrowed money from neighbours b) He worked secretly on Nwakibie's farm
c) He brought gifts and requested help respectfully
d) He inherited yams from his father

B. Fill in the Gaps

Complete the sentences using appropriate words related to the themes: social, cultural, historical, economic.

1. The consultation of Agbala shows a _____ theme because it reflects traditional religious beliefs.
2. The use of sacrifices to Aní and Ifejioku represents a _____ theme.
3. The reference to traditional farming practices shows a _____ way of life.
4. Okonkwo's effort to obtain seed yams shows an _____ theme because it relates to production and wealth.
5. The gathering of elders in Nwakibie's obi shows a _____ relationship within the community.
6. The belief in personal gods (chi) is part of the _____ identity of the people.
7. The practice of sharing kola nut reflects _____ traditions.
8. The importance of barns and yams represents _____ development in the clan.

C. Answer True or False

1. Unoka was known for being hardworking and successful in farming. _____
2. The priestess told Unoka that he had offended the gods. _____
3. Unoka died of a sickness that was considered an abomination. _____

4. Okonkwo inherited wealth from his father. ____
5. Nwakibie was a wealthy man with many barns and wives. ____
6. Okonkwo brought gifts when he visited Nwakibie. ____

D. Language Focus

Rewrite the sentences in passive voice if they are in active voice, or in active voice if they are in passive voice.

1. The villagers built a new trading store.
2. The novel *The River Between* was written by Ngugi wa Thiong'o.
3. Mr Brown encouraged the children to attend school.
4. The palm-oil and kernels were sold at high prices.
5. Enoch destroyed the sacred python.

D. Project: creative writing and oral presentation

Write a short story of 6 to 9 sentences about **any Rwandan traditional culture**. And after submitting to your teacher get ready to present it in front of the class.

Include:

- Characters
- Setting
- Cultural practice
- Problem
- Resolution

UNIT 4

EUROPEAN DRAMA



Key Unit Competence:

To analyze connections between European dramas across historical periods regarding their themes, showing different times and cultures.

Learning objectives: At the end of this unit you should be able to

Knowledge and understanding

1

- ✓ Identify the origin, historical development, major periods, forms, genres, characteristics, and conventions of European drama.
- ✓ Describe how dramatic elements such as characters, conflict, dialogue, stage directions, symbolism, language, and dramatic structure contribute to meaning in a play.
- ✓ Outline how European drama reflects the beliefs, values, cultures, and social issues of different historical periods.

Skills

2

- ✓ Analyse dramatic extracts by examining characters, conflicts, themes, emotions, language, and dramatic techniques, using relevant textual evidence to support interpretations.
- ✓ Compare European drama across historical periods in terms of themes, characteristics, forms, conventions, and representations of society.
- ✓ Present clear and confident oral and written responses to dramatic texts and use adjectives in the correct order when constructing meaningful sentences and noun phrases.

Attitudes and values

3

- ✓ Appreciate European drama as a reflection of diverse historical, cultural, and social experiences.
- ✓ Respect diverse perspectives and interpretations when discussing characters, themes, conflicts, moral issues, and social concerns in dramatic texts.
- ✓ Demonstrate honesty, justice, responsibility, cooperation, confidence, and integrity in discussions, presentations, performance activities, and reflections on the relevance of drama to contemporary life.

4.0. INTRODUCTION TO THE UNIT

European drama has developed over many centuries and reflects the **history, culture, and ideas of European societies**. It began in ancient times and later evolved through important periods such as the **Medieval, Renaissance, and Modern eras**. In each period, drama explored different **themes, conflicts, and human emotions**. Playwrights used dialogue, characters, and dramatic techniques to express ideas about **morality, love, power, identity, and social change**. In this unit, you will learn about the **history and main characteristics of European drama**, compare themes across historical periods, and analyze how drama reflects society and human experience.

Introductory activity



Look carefully at the picture and answer the following questions:

1. What different dramatic scenes can you identify in the picture? How do costumes and stage settings help to distinguish between different historical periods in European drama? What emotions are expressed by the actors in the different scenes? What does the **large book in the background** symbolize in relation to drama?
2. How do the audience's reactions (e.g., surprise, happiness) show the importance of drama in society?
3. Compare the three stages shown in the picture. What differences can be observed in terms of themes or ideas?

4.1. Introduction to the History of European Drama

Learning activity 4.1.1



Read the following extract from the play *The Crucible* By Arthur Miller and answer questions that follow

The witch-hunt was not, however, a mere repression. It was also, and as importantly, a long overdue opportunity for every-one so inclined to express publicly his guilt and sins, under the cover of accusations against the victims. It suddenly became possible - and patriotic and holy - for a man to say that **Martha Corey** had come into his bedroom at night, and that, while his wife was sleeping at his side, Martha laid herself down on his chest and "nearly suffocated him." Of course it was her spirit only, but his satisfaction at confessing himself was no lighter than if it had been Martha herself. One could not ordinarily speak such things in public.

Long-held hatreds of neighbors could now be openly expressed, and vengeance taken, despite the Bible's charitable injunctions. Land-lust which had been expressed before by constant bickering over boundaries and deeds, could now be elevated to the arena of morality; one could cry witch against one's neighbor and feel perfectly justified in the bargain. Old scores could be settled on a plane of heavenly combat between Lucifer and the Lord; suspicions and the envy of the miserable toward the happy could and did burst out in the general revenge.

Reverend Parris is praying now, and, though we cannot hear his words, a sense of his confusion hangs about him. He mumbles, then seems about to weep; then he weeps, then, prays again; but his daughter does not stir on the bed.

*The door opens, and his Negro slave enters. **Tituba** is in her forties. Parris brought her with him from Barbados, where he spent some years as a merchant before entering the ministry. She enters as one does who can no longer bear to be barred from the sight of her beloved, but she is also very frightened because her slave sense has warned her that, as always, trouble in this house eventually lands on her back.*

Tituba, already taking a step backward: My **Betty** be hearty soon? Parris: Out of here!

Tituba, backing to the door: My Betty not goin' die...

Parris, scrambling to his feet in a fury: Out of my sight! She is gone. Out of my - He is overcome with sobs. He clamps his teeth against them and closes the door and leans against it, exhausted. Oh, my God! God help me! Quaking with fear, mumbling to himself through his sobs, he goes to the bed and gently takes Betty's hand. Betty. Child. Dear child, Will you wake, will you open up your eyes! Betty, little one...

*He is bending to kneel again when his niece, **Abigail Williams**, seventeen, enters - a strikingly beautiful girl, an orphan, with an endless capacity for dissembling. Now she is all worry and apprehension and propriety.*

From *The Crucible* By Arthur Miller

Comprehension questions

1. What is happening in the extract?
2. Who are the main characters mentioned in the extract?
3. What problem or situation is affecting Reverend Parris and his daughter Betty?
4. What does the extract suggest about the **beliefs of the society** presented in the play?

A History of European Drama

- **European drama** refers to plays written and performed in Europe that present human actions, emotions, and conflicts through dialogue and performance. Drama is used to entertain audiences, teach moral lessons, and reflect the culture and beliefs of society.
- Origin of European Drama

European drama began from **religious ceremonies** in churches. Short dramatic scenes were used to explain Bible stories to people who could not read. With time, these performances moved from churches to **marketplaces and public spaces**, allowing more people to watch. Gradually, drama became organized and developed into theatre performances.

- Major Periods of European Drama

European drama developed through **three main historical periods**. Each period introduced new ideas, styles, and performance methods.

The three main periods are:

- Medieval Drama
- Renaissance Drama
- Modern Drama
- Medieval Drama (5th–15th Century)

Medieval drama developed during the Middle Ages and was strongly influenced by religion. Most plays were performed in churches or marketplaces and focused on teaching religious beliefs and moral values. These plays were simple and easy for people to understand.

Main features of Medieval Drama:

- Religious in nature
- Performed in churches or marketplaces
- Used simple language
- Taught moral lessons

Types of Medieval Drama:

- **Mystery Plays** — Based on Bible stories
- **Morality Plays** — Taught lessons about right and wrong

1. Renaissance Drama (15th–17th Century)

Renaissance drama marked a period of great development in theatre. Drama during this period was influenced by Greek and Roman ideas and focused more on human life and emotions. Permanent theatres were built, and professional actors began performing plays before large audiences.

One famous playwright of this period was **William Shakespeare**, who wrote tragedies, comedies, and historical plays that are still studied today.

Main features of Renaissance Drama:

- Focus on human life and emotions
- Development of permanent theatres
- Growth of professional actors
- More complex plots and characters

1. Modern Drama (19th Century–Present)

Modern drama developed as societies changed due to industrialization and modernization. Unlike earlier periods, modern drama focuses on realistic situations and social problems. It presents characters who face real-life challenges and emotional struggles.

Common themes in Modern Drama:

- Social inequality
- Justice and power
- Family conflicts
- Identity and human rights

Example: The extract from *The Crucible*, clearly shows this through themes of **fear, justice, and realistic characters**.

Main features of Modern Drama:

- Realistic characters,
- Focus on social issues
- Psychological conflicts
- Everyday language

Example: Characters behave like real people with strengths and weaknesses.
_Reverend Parris : *fearful and confused*

_Tituba : *frightened* and powerless

_Abigail Williams →: dishonest and manipulative

✓ Continuity in European Drama

European drama developed gradually, with each period building on earlier ideas. Medieval drama focused on religion, Renaissance drama emphasized human life, and Modern drama explored real-life social issues. This continuous development shows how drama changes as society changes.

Application activity 4.1.2



Read the extract below *From The Crucible* By Arthur Miller and answer the questions that follow

Abigail: Uncle? *He looks to her.* Susanna Walcott's here from Doctor Griggs. Parris: Oh?. Let her come, let her come.

Abigail, *leaning out the door to call to Susanna, who is down the hall a few steps:* Come in, Susanna. *Susanna Walcott, a little younger than Abigail, a nervous, hurried girl, enters.*

Parris, *eagerly:* What does the doctor say, child?

Susanna, *craning around Parris to get a look at Betty:* He bid me come and tell you, reverend sir, that he cannot discover no medicine for it in his books.

Parris: Then he must search on.

Susanna: Aye, sir, he have been searchin' his books since he left you, sir. But he bid me tell you, that you might look to un-natural things for the cause of it.

Parris, *his eyes going wide:* No - no. There be no unnatural cause here. Tell him I have sent for Reverend Hale of Beverly, and Mr. Hale will surely confirm that. Let him look to medicine and put out all thought of unnatural causes here. There be none.

Susanna: Aye, sir. He bid me tell you. *She turns to go.*

Abigail: Speak nothin' of it in the village, Susanna.

Parris: Go directly home and speak nothing of unnatural causes.
Susanna: Aye, sir. I pray for her. *She goes out.*

Abigail: Uncle, the rumor of witchcraft is all about; I think you'd best go down and deny it yourself. The parlor's packed with people, sir. I'll sit with her.

Parris, *pressed, turns on her:* And what shall I say to them? That my daughter and my niece I discovered dancing like heathen in the forest?

Abigail: Uncle, we did dance; let you tell them I confessed it - and I'll be whipped if I must be. But they're speakin' of witch-craft. Betty's not witched.

Parris: Abigail, I cannot go before the congregation when I know you have not opened with me. What did you do with her in the forest?

Abigail: We did dance, uncle, and when you leaped out of the bush so suddenly, Betty was frightened and then she fainted. And there's the whole of it.

Parris: Child. Sit you down.

Abigail, *quavering, as she sits:* I would never hurt Betty. I love her dearly.

Parris; Now look you, child, your punishment will come in its time. But if you trafficked with spirits in the forest I must know it now, for surely my enemies will, and they will ruin me with it.

Abigail: But we never conjured spirits.

Parris: Then why can she not move herself since midnight? This child is desperate! *Abigail lowers her eyes.* It must come out - my enemies will bring it out. Let me know what you done there. Abigail, do you understand that I have many enemies?

Abigail: I have heard of it, uncle.

Parris: There is a faction that is sworn to drive me from my pulpit. Do you understand that?

Abigail: I think so, sir.

Parris: Now then, in the midst of such disruption, my own household is discovered to be the very center of some obscene practice. Abominations are done in the forest -

Abigail: It were sport, uncle!

Parris, pointing at Betty: You call this sport? *She lowers her eyes. He pleads:* Abigail, if you know something that may help the doctor, for God's sake tell it to me. *She is silent.* I saw Tituba waving her arms over the fire when I came on you. Why was she doing that? And I heard a screeching and gibberish coming from her mouth. She were swaying like a dumb beast over that fire!

Abigail: She always sings her Barbados songs, and we dance.

From The Crucible By Arthur Miller

A. Comprehension Questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Who brings the message from Doctor Griggs?
a) Abigail b) Susanna Walcott c) Tituba d) Betty
2. According to the doctor, Betty's illness may be caused by:
a) hunger b) natural sickness c) unnatural things d) cold weather
3. What does Abigail say they were doing in the forest?
a) dancing b) praying c) working d) studying

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Briefly explain the situation in the scene?
2. Why is Reverend Parris worried about what people in the village might say?
3. Identify two features of modern drama shown in this extract. Give examples?
4. Show how the extract reflects a real-life social issue.
5. Identify one example of psychological conflict in the extract?
6. Explain how the language used in the extract shows everyday speech.
7. Give one theme shown in the extract and support it with an example.

B. Oral presentation

How can fear and rumors affect relationships in a community?
Relate your answer to real life by providing examples.

4.2. Main Characteristics of European Drama

Learning activity 4.2.1



Read the following extract From *The Crucible* By Arthur Miller and answer questions

Parris: I cannot blink what I saw, Abigail, for my enemies will not blink it. I saw a dress lying on the grass.

Abigail, *innocently*: A dress?

Parris - *it is very hard to say*: Aye, a dress. And I thought I saw - someone naked running through the trees!

Abigail, *in terror*: No one was naked! You mistake yourself, uncle!

PARRIS, *with anger*: I saw it! *He moves from her. Then, re-solved*: Now tell me true, Abigail. And I pray you feel the weight of truth upon you, for now my ministry's at stake, my ministry and perhaps your cousin's life. Whatever abomination you have done, give me all of it now, for I dare not be taken unaware when I go before them down there.

Abigail: There is nothin' more. I swear it, uncle.

Parris, *studies her, then nods, half convinced*: Abigail, I have sought here three long years to bend these stiff-necked people to me, and now, just now when some good respect is rising for me in the parish, you compromise my very character. I have given you a home, child, I have put clothes upon your back - now give me upright answer. Your name in the town - it is entirely white, is it not?

Abigail, *with an edge of resentment*: Why, I am sure it is, sir. There be no blush about my name.

Parris, *to the point*: Abigail, is there any other cause than you have told me, for your being discharged from Goody Proctor's service? I have heard it said, and I tell you as I heard it, that she comes so rarely to the church this year for she will not sit so close to something soiled. What signified that remark?

Abigail: She hates me, uncle, she must, for I would not be her slave. It's a bitter woman, a lying, cold, sniveling woman, and I will not work for such a woman!

Parris: She may be. And yet it has troubled me that you are now seven months out of their house, and in all this time no other family has ever called for your service.

Abigail: They want slaves, not such as I. Let them send to Barbados for that. I will not black my face for any of them! *With ill-concealed resentment at him*: Do you begrudge my bed, uncle?

Parris: No - no.

Abigail, *in a temper*: My name is good in the village! I will not have it said my name is soiled! Goody Proctor is a gossiping liar!

Enter Mrs. Ann Putnam. She is a twisted soul of forty-five, a death-ridden woman, haunted by dreams.

Parris, *as soon as the door begins to open*: No - no, I cannot have anyone'. *He sees her, and a certain deference springs into him, although his worry remains.* Why, Goody Putnam, come in.

Mrs. Putnam, *full of breath, shiny-eyed*: It is a marvel. It is surely a stroke of hell upon you.

Parris: No, Goody Putnam, it is -

Mrs. Putnam, *glancing at Betty*: How high did she fly, how high?

Parris: No, no, she never flew

Mrs. Putnam, *very pleased with it*: Why, it's sure she did. Mr. Collins saw her goin' over Ingersoll's barn, and come down light as bird, he says!

From The Crucible By Arthur Miller

Comprehension questions

1. What is happening in the extract?
2. Who are the main characters speaking in the extract?
3. What problem or conflict is presented in the extract?
4. Comment on the emotions that are shown by the characters in this scene and why?
5. Discuss the type of society reflected in the extract and give evidence?
6. Pick one character from the extract and say which lesson you learn from him or her.

Main characteristics of European drama

European drama developed through different historical periods such as **Medieval, Renaissance, and Modern drama**. Although each period has its own style and themes, many plays share important characteristics.

Example used from *The Crucible* by Arthur Miller

1. Human Conflict and Emotion

European drama focuses on **conflict between characters** and **strong emotions**.

Conflict creates tension and moves the story forward

Emotions include fear, anger, jealousy, and anxiety

Example from extract:

Conflict between Parris and Abigail:

"Now tell me true, Abigail..." → Parris suspects Abigail is hiding the truth

Emotion example:

Anger: "I saw it!" (Parris)

Fear/anxiety: Parris worries about his reputation and ministry

2. Symbolism and Allegory

Drama uses symbols and deeper meanings to represent ideas.

Symbolism → objects/actions represent ideas

Allegory → characters represent moral qualities

Example from extract:

The "dress" and "naked running" suggest **hidden sin or wrongdoing**

Witchcraft (mentioned indirectly) symbolizes **fear of evil and the unknown**

3. Reflection of Social Change

European drama reflects **beliefs and issues in society**.

Medieval → religion

Renaissance → human nature

Modern → social issues (fear, reputation, injustice)

Example from extract:

Society believes in witchcraft: "How high did she fly...?" (Mrs. Putnam)

→ Shows strong belief in supernatural powers

Another example:

Reputation is very important: "My ministry's at stake..." (Parris)

Application activity 4.2.2



Read the following extract and answer questions

Parris: Now, look you, Goody Putnam, she never - *Enter Thomas Putnam, a well-to-do, hard-handed landowner, near fifty.* Oh, good morning, Mr. Putnam.

Putnam: It is a providence the thing is out now! It is a providence. *He goes directly to the bed.*

Parris: What's out, sir, what's - ?

Mrs. Putnam goes to the bed.

Putnam, *looking down at Betty:* Why, *her* eyes is closed! Look you, Ann. Mrs.

Putnam: Why, that's strange. *To Parris:* Ours is open. Parris, *shocked:* Your Ruth is sick?

Mrs. PUTNAM, *with vicious certainty*: I'd not call it sick; the Devil's touch is heavier than sick. It's death, y'know, it's death drivin' into them, forked and hoofed.

Parris: Oh, pray not! Why, how does Ruth ail?

Mrs. Putnam: She ails as she must - she never waked this morning, but her eyes open and she walks, and hears naught, sees naught, and cannot eat. Her soul is taken, surely.

Parris is struck.

PUTNAM, *as though for further details*: They say you've sent for Reverend Hale of Beverly?

Parris, *with dwindling conviction now*: A precaution only. He has much experience in all demonic-arts, and I -

Mrs. Putnam: He has indeed; and found a witch in Beverly last year, and let you remember that.

Parris: Now, Goody Ann, they only thought that were a witch, and I am certain there be no element of witchcraft here.

Putnam: No witchcraft! Now look you, Mr. Parris -

PARRIS: Thomas, Thomas, I pray you, leap not to witchcraft. I know that you - you least of all, Thomas, would ever wish so disastrous a charge laid upon me. We cannot leap to witchcraft. They will howl me out of Salem for such corruption in my house.

A word about Thomas Putnam. He was a man with many grievances, at least one of which appears justified. Sometime before, his wife's brother-in-law, James Bayley, had been turned down as minister of Salem. Bayley had all the qualifications, and a two-thirds vote into the bargain, but a faction stopped his acceptance, for reasons that are not clear.

Thomas Putnam was the eldest son of the richest man in the village. He had fought the Indians at Narragansett, and was deeply interested in parish affairs. He undoubtedly felt it poor payment that the village should so blatantly disregard his candidate for one of its more important offices, especially since he regarded himself as the intellectual superior of most of the people around him.

His vindictive nature was demonstrated long before the witch-craft began. Another former Salem minister, George Burroughs, had had to borrow money to pay for his wife's funeral, and, since the parish was remiss in his salary, he was soon bankrupt. Thomas and his brother John had Burroughs jailed for debts the man did not owe. The incident is important only in that Burroughs succeeded in becoming minister where Bayley,

Thomas Putnam's brother-in-law, had been rejected; the motif of resentment is clear here. Thomas Putnam felt that his own name and the honor of his family had been smirched by the village, and he meant to right matters however he could.

Another reason to believe him a deeply embittered man was his attempt to break his father's will, which left a disproportionate amount to a stepbrother. As with every other public cause in which he tried to force his way, he failed in this.

So, it is not surprising to find that so many accusations against people are in the handwriting of Thomas Putnam, or that his name is so often found as a witness corroborating the super-natural testimony, or that his daughter led the crying-out at the most opportune junctures of the trials, especially when - But we'll speak of that when we come to it.

Putnam - *at the moment he is intent upon getting Parris, for whom he has only contempt, to move toward the abyss:* Mr. Parris, I have taken your part in all contention here, and I would continue; but I cannot if you hold back in this. There are hurtful, vengeful spirits layin' hands on these children.

Parris: But, Thomas, you cannot -

Putnam: Ann! Tell Mr. Parris what you have done.

From The Crucible By Arthur Miller

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. The conflict shown in the extract mainly involves:
 - a) friendship between characters
 - b) disagreement and suspicion among characters
 - c) celebration in the village
 - d) cooperation between families
2. The belief in witchcraft in the extract reflects:
 - a) social & cultural thinking
 - b) scientific thinking
 - c) economic development
 - d) political competition
3. Which period of European drama often focused on religious beliefs and moral lessons?
 - a) Modern drama
 - b) Renaissance drama
 - c) Medieval drama
 - d) Contemporary drama

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Identify one example of **human conflict** in the extract.
2. What emotion is strongly expressed by the characters in the scene?
3. With evidence, explain how the extract reflects the **beliefs or social attitudes of the society** in which the play is set?

B. Oral presentation

Discuss how religious beliefs influence people's actions. Should a person always protect their reputation in religion, even when it leads to conflict or dishonesty? Give real-life examples.

4.3 Analysis of European Drama.

Learning activity 4.3.1



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

MRs. Putnam: Reverend Parris, I have laid seven babies un-baptized in the earth. Believe me, sir, you never saw more hearty babies born, and yet, each would wither in my arms the very night of their birth. I have spoke nothin', but my heart has clamored intimations. And now, this year, my Ruth, my only - I see her turning strange. A secret child she has become this year, and shrivels like a sucking mouth were pullin' on her life too. And so I thought to send her to your Tituba -

Parris: To Tituba! What may Tituba -?

Mrs. Putnam: Tituba knows how to speak to the dead, Mr. Parris.

Parris: Goody Ann, it is a formidable sin to conjure up the dead!

Mrs. Putnam: I take it on my soul, but who else may surely tell us what person murdered my babies?

Parris, horrified: Woman!

MRs. Putnam: They were murdered, Mr. Parris! And mark this proof! Mark it! Last night my Ruth were ever so close to their little spirits; I know it, sir. For how else is she struck dumb now except some power of darkness would stop her mouth? It is a marvelous sign, Mr. Parris!

Putnam: Don't you understand it, sir? There is a murdering witch among us, bound to keep herself in the dark. *Parris turns to Betty, a frantic terror rising in him.* Let your enemies make of it what they will, you cannot blink it more.

Parris, to Abigail: Then you were conjuring spirits last night.

Abigail, whispering: Not I, sir - Tituba and Ruth.

Parris turns now, with new fear, and goes to Betty, looks down at her, and then, gazing off: Oh, Abigail, what proper payment for my charity! Now I am undone.

Putnam: You are not undone! Let you take hold here. Wait for no one to charge you - declare it yourself. You have dis-covered witchcraft -

Parris: In my house? In my house, Thomas? They will topple me with this! They will make of it a -

Enter Mercy Lewis, the Putnams' servant, a fat, sly, merciless girl of eighteen.

Mercy: Your pardons. I only thought to see how Betty i

Putnam: Why aren't you home? Who's with Ruth?

Mercy: Her grandma come. She's improved a little, I think - she give a powerful sneeze before.

Mrs. Putnam: Ah, there's a sign of life!

Mercy: I'd fear no more, Goody Putnam. It were a grand sneeze; another like it will shake her wits together, I'm sure. *She goes to the bed to look.*

Parris: Will you leave me now, Thomas? I would pray a while alone.

Abigail: Uncle, you've prayed since midnight. Why do you not go down and -

PARRis: No - no. *To Putnam:* I have no answer for that crowd. I'll wait till Mr. Hale arrives. *To get Mrs. Putnam to leave:* If you will, Goody Ann...

PutnAM: Now look you, sir. Let you strike out against the Devil, and the village will bless you for it! Come down, speak to them - pray with them. They're thirsting for your word, Mister! Surely you'll pray with them.

Parris, swayed: I'll lead them in a psalm, but let you say nothing of witchcraft yet. I will not discuss it. The cause is yet unknown. I have had enough contention since I came; I want no more.

Mrs. Putnam: Mercy, you go home to Ruth, d'y'hear?

From "The Crucible" By Arthur Miller

A. Comprehension questions

1. Who are the main characters involved in the conversation in this extract?
2. What problem does Mrs. Putnam describe about her children and her daughter Ruth?
3. How do Reverend Parris and the Putnams react to the idea of witchcraft in the village?
4. What does the dialogue in this extract reveal about the beliefs and fears of the society shown in the play?

B. Language enhancement

1. Give the meanings of the following words as used in the extract:
 - a. conjure
 - b. formidable
 - c. horrified
 - d. contention
 - e. psalm
2. Comment on the way this extract is formed, and language used? Provide examples for each?

Analysis of European Drama:

When analyzing European drama, readers focus on **how the play is written and how characters, language, and structure present ideas and conflicts.**

1. Stylistic and Structural Innovations

Style refers to the way the playwright expresses ideas and emotions in the play.

Structure refers to how the play is organized.

Key points

Plays are usually organized into **acts and scenes**.

Playwrights use **dramatic techniques** to make the story interesting and meaningful.

- **Symbolism:** objects, actions, or events represent deeper ideas.
- **Allegory:** characters or events represent moral or abstract ideas.
- **Stage directions:** guide actors' actions, movements, and emotions.

Modern drama sometimes **changes or breaks traditional structures** to present new perspectives.

Example from the extract

The stage direction "**Parris, horrified**" shows the character's emotional reaction and helps actors understand how to perform the scene.

2. Language and Dialogue

Language in drama expresses ideas, emotions, and themes.

Dialogue is the conversation between characters.

Functions of dialogue

Reveals character personalities.

Develops the plot.

Shows conflict between characters.

Communicates **themes and ideas**.

Types of dramatic speech

Dialogue: conversation between two or more characters.

Monologue: a long speech by one character.

Soliloquy: when a character speaks thoughts aloud while alone on stage.

Example from the extract

Mrs. Putnam's speech about losing her babies shows **her grief and suspicion**, revealing emotional tension in the story.

3. Form and Genre

Form: Form refers to **how a play is structured and presented**.

It includes:

Acts and scenes
Dialogue
Stage directions
Character interactions

Genre: Genre refers to the **type of drama**.

Common genres include:

Tragedy: serious drama where characters face suffering or downfall.

Comedy: humorous drama that usually ends happily.

Tragicomedy: mixture of serious and comic elements.

Morality plays: dramas that teach moral lessons.

Different historical periods in Europe preferred different dramatic forms and genres.

4. Characterization and Psychology

Characterization is how playwrights create and develop characters in a play.

It shows **characters' personalities, emotions, motivations, and relationships**.

Types of characters:

Protagonist: the main character.

Antagonist: the character opposing the protagonist.

Minor characters: supporting characters.

Psychological aspects in drama show:

Inner conflicts
Emotions and fears
Motivations and desires

Common psychological themes include:

- Love, • Jealousy, • Power, • Fear, • Guilt, • Identity

Example from the extract:

Abigail's threats to the other girls reveal **fear, guilt, and a desire to control the situation**, showing psychological tension among the characters.

Application activity 4.3.2



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

Mercy: Aye, mum.

Mrs. Putnam goes out.

Parris, to Abigail: If she starts for the window, cry for me at once. Abigail: I will, uncle.

Orris, to Putnam: There is a terrible power in her arms to-day. *He goes out with Putnam.*

Abigail, with hushed trepidation: How is Ruth sick?

Mercy! It's weirdish, I know not - she seems to walk like a dead one since last night.

Abigail, turns at once and goes to Betty, and now, with fear in her voice: Betty?

Betty doesn't move. She shakes her. Now stop this! Betty! Sit up now!

Betty doesn't stir. Mercy comes over.

Mercy: Have you tried beatin' her? I gave Ruth a good one and it waked her for a minute. Here, let me have her.

Abigail, holding Mercy back: No, he'll be comin' up. Listen, now; if they be questioning us, tell them we danced - I told him as much already,

Mercy: Aye. And what more?

Abigail: He knows Tituba conjured Ruth's sisters to come out of the grave. Mercy: And what more?

Abigail: He saw you naked.

Mercy: *clapping her hands together with a frightened laugh:* Oh, Jesus!

Enter Mary Warren, breathless. She is seventeen, a subservient, naive, lonely girl.

Mary Warren: What'll we do? The village is out! I just come from the farm; the whole country's talkin' witchcraft! They'll be callin' us witches, Abby!

Mercy, pointing and looking at Mary Warren: She means to tell, I know it.

Mary Warren: Abby, we've got to tell. Witchery's a hangin' error, a hangin' like they done in Boston two year ago! We must tell the truth, Abby! You'll only be whipped for dancin', and the other things!

Abigail: *Oh, -we'll be whipped!*

Mary Warren: I never done none of it, Abby. I only looked!

Mercy, moving menacingly toward Mary: Oh, you're a great one for lookin', aren't you, Mary Warren? What a grand peeping courage you have!

Betty, on the bed, whimpers. Abigail turns to her at once.

Abigail: Betty? *She goes to Betty.* Now, Betty, dear, wake up now. It's Abigail. *She sits Betty up and furiously shakes her.* I'll beat you, Betty! *Betty whimpers.* My, you seem improving. I talked to your papa and I told him everything. So there's nothing to -

Betty, *darts up the bed, frightened of Abigail, and flattens her-self against the wall:* I want my mama!

Abigail, *with alarm, as she cautiously approaches Betty:* What ails you, Betty? Your mama's dead and buried.

Betty: I'll fly to Mama. Let me fly! *She raises her arms as though to fly, and streaks for the window, gets one leg out.*

Abigail, *pulling her away from the window:* I told him every-thing,' he knows now, he knows everything we

Betty: You drank blood, Abby! You didn't tell him that! **Abigail:** Betty, you never say that again! You will never--

Betty: You did, you did! You drank a charm to kill John Proctor's wife! You drank a charm to kill Goody Proctor!

Abigail, *smashes her across the face:* Shut it! Now shut it!

Barry, *collapsing on the bed:* Mama, Mama! *She dissolves into sobs*

Abigail: Now look you. All of you. We danced. And Tituba conjured Ruth Putnam's dead sisters. And that is all. And mark this. Let either of you breathe a word, or the edge of a word, about the other things, and I will come to you in the black of some terrible night and I will bring a pointy reckoning that will shudder you. And you know I can do it; I saw Indians smash my dear parents' heads on the pillow next to mine, and I have seen some reddish work done at night, and I can make you wish you had never seen the sun go down! *She goes to Betty and roughly sits her up.* Now, you - sit up and stop this'

But Betty collapses in her hands and lies inert on the bed.

Marry Warren, *with hysterical fright:* What's got her? *Abigail stares in fright at Betty.*

Abby, she's going to die! It's a sin to conjure, and we -

Abigail, *starting for Mary:* I say shut it, Mary Warren!

Enter John Proctor. On seeing him, Mary Warren leaps in fright,

Proctor was a farmer in his middle thirties, He need not have been a partisan of any faction in the town, but there is evidence to suggest that he had a sharp and biting way with hypocrites. He was the kind of man - powerful of body, even-tempered, and not easily led - who cannot refuse support to partisans with-out drawing their deepest resentment. In Proctor's presence a fool felt his foolishness instantly - and a Proctor is always marked for calumny therefore.

But as we shall see, the steady manner he displays does not spring from an untroubled soul. He is a sinner, a sinner not only against the moral fashion of the time, but against his own vision of decent conduct. These people had no ritual for the washing away of sins. It is another trait we inherited from them. and it has helped to discipline us as well as to breed hypocrisy among us. Proctor, respected and even feared in Salem, has

come to regard himself as a kind of fraud. But no hint of this has yet appeared on the surface, and as he enters from the crowded parlor below it is a man in his prime we see, with a quiet confidence and an unexpressed, hidden force. Mary Warren, his servant, can barely speak for embarrassment and fear.

Mary Warren: Oh! I'm just going home, Mr. Proctor.

From "The Crucible" By Arthur Miller

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Why is Mary Warren frightened when she enters the room?
a) She is afraid of the dark b) She fears Abigail and the other girls
c) She has done something wrong in the church
d) She is nervous about school
2. What does Abigail threaten the other girls with if they tell the truth?
a) She will hit them b) She will leave them alone
c) She will accuse them of witchcraft d) She will take their belongings

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Compare the language used in the extract with your everyday language use.
2. Which themes are portrayed in the above extract?
3. Give an example of fear or tension shown in the girls' behavior.

B. Language enhancement

1. Look at the dialogue in the extract. Identify informal words used by the characters. Use a dictionary to write the formal word and its meaning.
2. With examples, analyse this extract?

C. Oral Presentation

Have you ever felt afraid to tell the truth because of social pressure or fear of ruining your reputation? Describe the situation and explain how you handled it.

4.4. Language Focus: Order of adjectives

Learning activity 4.4.1



Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

Passage

Last weekend, we watched a wonderful modern European drama performance in a large old theatre. The actors performed on a beautiful wooden stage with bright colorful lights.

One actor wore a long black Italian coat, while another appeared in a simple white cotton costume. The audience enjoyed the play because it told a powerful emotional story about human conflict and society.

At the end, everyone clapped for the talented young actors who gave an excellent memorable performance.

Comprehension questions

1. Identify the **noun phrases** in the passage that contain more than one adjective.
2. Which type of adjective comes first in this phrase:
(Color, Origin, Opinion, Size, Age)
3. What do you notice about how adjectives are arranged before nouns in the passage?

1. What is the Order of Adjectives?

When we use **more than one adjective** to describe a noun, they must follow a **specific order** in English. This makes sentences sound **natural and correct**.

Example:

- a beautiful small old wooden house ✓
- a wooden old small beautiful house ✗

2. Standard Order of Adjectives

Adjectives usually follow this order:

1. **Opinion** (what you think)
2. **Size** (big, small)
3. **Age** (old, new)
4. **Shape** (round, square)
5. **Color** (red, blue)
6. **Origin** (European, African)

7. Material (wooden, metal)

8. Purpose (used for something)

Formula: Opinion → Size → Age → Shape → Color → Origin → Material
→ Purpose + Noun

3. Examples

1. a beautiful large old round red Italian wooden table
2. a small new black African drama book
3. a wonderful modern European theatre performance
4. a long ancient religious play

4. Easy Way to Remember

👉 Use this pattern: **OSASCOMP**

- ✓ **O** – Opinion
- ✓ **S** – Size
- ✓ **A** – Age
- ✓ **S** – Shape
- ✓ **C** – Color
- ✓ **O** – Origin
- ✓ **M** – Material

P – Purpose

5. Important Notes

- ✓ Not all adjectives are always used.
- ✓ Usually, we use **2–3 adjectives** to avoid long sentences.
- ✓ The order must remain correct even with fewer adjectives.
- Example:
 - ✓ a small old theatre ✓
 - ✓ an old small theatre ✗

6. Common Mistakes

- wrong: a red big ball
- correct: a big red ball
- wrong: a wooden Italian beautiful chair
- correct: a beautiful Italian wooden chair

Application activity 4.4.2



A. Put the adjectives in the correct order to form meaningful noun phrases. Do not use commas.

1. We wanted _____ table. (*a / grey / metal*)
2. They bought _____ car. (*a / new / red*)
3. She went home and sat on _____ bed. (*her / comfortable / old / wooden*)
4. He bought _____ suit. (*a / fabulous / British / woollen*)
5. They have _____ bicycles. (*black / Dutch*)
6. He wants _____ cheese. (*some / really / delicious / French*)
7. _____ girl walked into the room. (*a / pretty / young*)
8. He has _____ books. (*a lot of / interesting / old*)
9. She bought _____ lunchbox. (*a / new / red / plastic*)
10. He is looking for _____ bag. (*a / stylish / black / leather*)
11. She dropped _____ plate and it smashed. (*the / beautiful / old*)
12. I want _____ dress. (*an / amazing / green / silk*)
13. She drank _____ coffee. (*hot / black / Italian*)
14. He saw _____ desk. (*an / old / French / writing*)
15. They stayed in _____ cottage. (*a / cute / little*)
16. I visited _____ castle. (*a / spooky / ancient / German*)
17. He has _____ ring. (*a / beautiful / old / silver*)
18. We ate _____ apples. (*some / round / green / English*)
19. I need _____ desk. (*a / comfortable / computer*)
20. They went on holiday to _____ cabin. (*a / beautiful / small / wooden*)

Oral Question

Instruction:

Work in pairs to **prepare and present a short dialogue** in front of the class. Your dialogue should include **at least three noun phrases** that use **adjectives in the correct order**.

Guidelines:

- The dialogue should not be less than **6–9 lines long**, about any topic of your choice
- Use **different types of adjectives** (e.g., opinion, size, color, origin, material).
- Speak clearly and confidently during your presentation.
- Ensure that the **order of adjectives is correct** in each noun phrase.

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



Read the following extract and answer to questions that follow

Proctor: Be you foolish, Mary Warren? Be you deaf? I for-bid you leave the house, did I not? Why shall I pay you? I am looking for you more often than my cows!

Mary Warren: I only come to see the great doings in the world.

Proctor: I'll show you a great doin' on your arse one of these days. Now get you home; my wife is waitin' with your work! *Trying to retain a shred of dignity, she goes slowly out.*

Mercy Lewis, both afraid of him and strangely titillated: I'd best be off. I have my Ruth to watch. Good morning, Mr. Proctor.

Mercy sidles out. Since Proctor's entrance, Abigail has stood as though on tiptoe, absorbing his presence, wide-eyed. He glances at her, then goes to Betty on the bed.

Abigail: Gah! I'd almost forgot how strong you are, John Proctor!

Proctor, looking at Abigail now, the faintest suggestion of a knowing smile on his face: What's this mischief here?

Abigail, with a nervous laugh: Oh, she's only gone silly some-how.

Proctor: The road past my house is a pilgrimage to Salem all morning. The town's mumbling witchcraft.

Abigail: Oh, posh! *Winningly she comes a little closer, with a confidential, wicked air.* We were dancin' in the woods last night, and my uncle leaped in on us. She took fright, is all.

Proctor, his smile widening: Ah, you're wicked yet, aren't y'! *A trill of expectant laughter escapes her, and she dares come closer, feverishly looking into his eyes.* You'll be clapped in the stocks before you're twenty.

He takes a step to go, and she springs into his path.

Abigail: Give me a word, John. A soft word. *Her concentrated desire destroys his smile.*

Proctor: No, no, Abby. That's done with.

Abigail, tauntingly: You come five mile to see a silly girl fly? I know you better.

Proctor, setting her firmly out of his path: I come to see what mischief your uncle's brewin' now. *With final emphasis:* Put it out of mind, Abby.

Abigail, grasping his hand before he can release her: John - I am waitin' for you every night.

Proctor: Abby, I never give you hope to wait for me.

Abigail, now beginning to anger - she can't believe it: I have something better than hope, I think!

Proctor: Abby, you'll put it out of mind. I'll not be comin' for you more. Abigail: You're surely sportin' with me.

Proctor: You know me better.

Abigail: I know how you clutched my back behind your house and sweated like a stallion whenever I come near! Or did I dream that? It's she put me out, you cannot pretend it were you. I saw your face when she put me out, and you loved me then and you do now!

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple Choice Questions

1. What does Proctor's treatment of Mary Warren mainly show?
a) Kindness b) Authority and control c) Fear of Mary
d) Friendship and neighborhood
2. The statement "The town's mumbling witchcraft" suggests that:
a) People are busy celebrating
b) People are traveling especially young daughters
c) People are busy doing their normal activities
d) People believe in supernatural forces
3. Abigail's behaviour toward Proctor mainly shows:
a) Respect and honesty b) Fear and ignorance
c) Desire and manipulation d) Indifference and self-centeredness

ii. Open-ended questions

1. Identify two characters in the extract and state their relationship.
2. Give examples that explain the main conflict from the extract.
3. What emotion is strongly shown in Abigail's behavior? Give evidence.

4. What does this extract reveal about the society in Salem?
5. Explain how dialogue is used to develop the conflict between characters.
6. Identify **one theme** and explain how it is presented in the extract.
7. Which period of European drama fits this extract? Give facts.

B: Fill in the Gaps

Complete the sentences below using appropriate terms from your study of European drama.

1. _____ drama focused mainly on religion, moral lessons, and biblical stories during the early period of European theatre.
2. _____ drama explored human nature, leadership, love, and ambition, especially during the period of renewed interest in classical learning.
3. _____ drama deals with social issues such as justice, identity, inequality, and real-life experiences in society.
4. A _____ is a long speech in which a character speaks at length to other characters on stage.
5. A _____ is a speech in which a character expresses thoughts aloud while alone on stage, revealing inner feelings.
6. The _____ is the central or most important character in a play, around whom the main action revolves.

C: TRUE OR FALSE

Read each statement carefully and write True or False.

1. Drama is mainly written to be performed on stage.
2. Dialogue in a play does not help to the development of the plot.
3. John Proctor clearly rejects Abigail in the extract above.
4. The extract shows harmony and agreement among all the characters.
5. European drama can reflect social issues such as reputation and morality.

D: LANGUAGE FOCUS – ORDER OF ADJECTIVES

A. Arrange the adjectives in the correct order to form clear and meaningful sentences. Do not use commas.

1. We watched a _____ theatre performance during the school drama festival last week.
(a / wonderful / modern / European)
2. They entered a _____ building that stood at the center of the town.
(a / old / large)

7. What does this extract reveal about the society in Salem?
8. Explain how dialogue is used to develop the conflict between characters.
9. Identify **one theme** and explain how it is presented in the extract.
10. Which period of European drama fits this extract? Give facts.

B: Fill in the Gaps

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UNIT 5

LANGUAGE IN EUROPEAN DRAMA



Key Unit Competence:

To evaluate language in European drama to understand character development, dramatic tension, and theme, while appreciating cultural, social, and moral values expressed through dialogue.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

1 Knowledge and understanding

- ✓ Explain the role of language in European drama.
- ✓ Describe dialogue, monologue, soliloquy, and stage directions.
- ✓ To analyze how literary language employs stylistic devices—such as symbolism, metaphor, and irony—and to evaluate how these devices reflect and convey cultural and historical contexts, particularly within dramatic texts.

2 Skills

- ✓ Evaluate characters and dramatic tension through language in European drama.
- ✓ Interpret themes and messages using European drama extracts.
- ✓ Perform short European drama scenes demonstrating understanding of language and character.

3 Attitudes and values

- ✓ Appreciate cultural and social nuances expressed through dialogue in European Drama
- ✓ Value moral, ethical, and historical insights communication in European drama.
- ✓ Demonstrate respect for playwrights' choices and critical thinking in analyzing European drama language

5.0. INTRODUCTION TO THE UNIT

European drama is a form of literature designed to be performed and experienced, not just read. Unlike prose, which is meant to be read silently, or poetry, which relies on rhythm and condensed language, drama depends on dialogue, stage directions, and the interaction between characters to tell a story. Language in European drama communicates conflict, emotion, and tension, and often reveals cultural, social, and historical context. In this unit, you will explore how playwrights use dialogue, monologue, soliloquy, figurative and symbolic language to develop characters, advance the plot, and express themes. You will read and analyze extracts from famous European plays, such as *An enemy of the People and others*, to understand how language shapes meaning, character, and dramatic tension. By the end of this unit, you will not only understand the role of language in drama but also appreciate how performance, dialogue, and stagecraft reveal human experiences and societal values.

Introductory activity



Study the picture carefully and answer the questions that follow



1. Where do you think this scene is taking place? Describe in detail everything you observe in the picture.
2. The audience reacts differently depending on what they are watching. What could explain these different reactions?
3. Identify at least one symbolic object or gesture on the stage. What do you think it represents in drama?
4. The open book in the background is significant. How does it help you understand European drama in contrast to African drama?

5.1. Language and Dialogue in European Drama

Learning activity 5.11



Read the extract from *An Enemy of The People* by Henrik Ibsen and answer questions that follow

DR. STOCKMANN: Anyway, I assure you I don't waste money unprofitably/ but I can't find it in my heart to deny myself the pressure of entertaining my friends. I need something like that you know. I have lived for so long shut out of it all that for me it is a necessity of life to mix with young, eager, ambitious men, men of liberal and active minds; and that describes every one of those fellows who are enjoying their supper in there. I wish you knew more of Hovstad.

PETER STOCKMANN: By the way, Hovstad was telling me he was going to print another article of yours.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: An article of mine?

PETER STOCKMANN: Yes, about the Baths. An article you wrote in the winter.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Oh, that one! No, I don't intend that to appear just for the present.

PETER STOCKMANN: Why not? It seems to me that this would be the most opportune moment.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, very likely--under normal conditions. [Crosses the room.]

PETER STOCKMANN (*following him with his eyes*) Is there anything abnormal about the present conditions?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: [standing still] To tell you the truth, Peter, I can't say just at this moment--at all events not tonight. There may be much that is very abnormal about the present conditions-- and it is possible there may be nothing abnormal about them at all. It is quite possible it may be merely my imagination.

PETER STOCKMANN: I must say it all sounds most mysterious. Is there something going on that I am to be kept in ignorance of? I should have imagined that I, as Chairman of the governing body of the Baths--

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: And I should have imagined that I--. Oh, come, don't let us fly out at one another, Peter.

PETER STOCKMANN: Heaven forbid! I am not in the habit of flying out at people, as you call it. But I am entitled to request most emphatically that all arrangements shall be made in a businesslike manner, through the proper channels, and shall be dealt with by the legally constituted authorities. I can allow no going behind our backs by any roundabout means.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Have I ever at any time tried to go behind your backs?

PETER STOCKMANN: You have an ingrained tendency to take your own way, at all events; and, that is almost equally inadmissible in a well ordered community, The individual ought undoubtedly to acquiesce in subordinating himself to the community--or, to speak more accurately, to the authorities who have the care of the community's welfare.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Very likely. But what the deuce has all this got to do with me?

PETER STOCKMANN: That is exactly what you never appear to be willing to learn, my dear Thomas. But, mark my words, some day you will have to suffer for it--sooner or later. Now I have told you. Good-bye.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Have you taken leave of your senses? You are on the wrong scent altogether.

PETER STOCKMANN: I am not usually that. You must excuse me now if I-- [calls into the dining-room]. Good night, Katherine. Good night, gentlemen. [Goes out.]

MRS. STOCKMANN.(*coming from the dining-room*): Has he gone?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, and in such a bad temper.

MRS. STOCKMANN: But, dear Thomas, what have you been doing to him again?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN.

Nothing at all. And, anyhow, he can't oblige me to make my report before the proper time.

MRS. STOCKMANN: What have you got to make a report to him about?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Hm! Leave that to me, Katherine. It is an extraordinary thing that the postman doesn't come.

(*HOVSTAD, BILLING and HORSTER have got up from the table and come into the sitting-room. ELLIF and MORTEN come in after them.*)

BILLING(*stretching himself*): Ah!--one feels a new man after a meal like that.

HOVSTAD: The mayor wasn't in a very sweet temper tonight, then.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN.: It is his stomach; he has wretched digestion.

HOVSTAD: I rather think it was us two of the "People's Messenger" that he couldn't digest.

MRS. STOCKMANN: I thought you came out of it pretty well with him.

HOVSTAD: Oh yes; but it isn't anything more than a sort of truce.

BILLING: That is just what it is! That word sums up the situation. Pretty succinctly.

From "An Enemy of The People" by Henrik Ibsen

Comprehension questions:

Read the extract from *An Enemy of the People* by Henrik Ibsen and answer the questions that follow:

1. What is the conversation in this extract mainly about?
2. Identify two words or phrases used by Dr. Stockmann that show he is serious and concerned about public health.
3. How does the dialogue reveal Dr. Stockmann's relationship with Mrs. Stockmann and Hovstad? Support your answer with examples from the extract.
4. Identify one example of figurative language (metaphor or symbolic expression) in the extract. Explain its meaning in context.
5. What does Dr. Stockmann's use of technical or scientific language suggest about his character?
6. What tone is expressed by Dr. Stockmann in this dialogue? How does it differ from the tone used by Hovstad and Billing?

7. How does this conversation help to develop or move forward the events of the play?
8. Comment on the language used by the characters in the extract and explain how it helps to communicate the central ideas of the play.

I. Language and Dialogue in European Drama

a) Dialogue: Conversation between two or more characters.

- ✓ Moves the plot forward.
- ✓ Reveals relationships, conflict, and character traits.

b) Monologue: Extended speech by one character addressing others or the audience.

Reveals inner thoughts, motivations, or feelings.

c) Soliloquy: A character speaks alone on stage, revealing private thoughts directly to the audience.

- ✓ Creates dramatic irony when the audience knows something other characters do not.

d) Stage Directions: Written instructions in the script.

- ✓ Guide actors' movements, gestures, tone, and setting.
- ✓ Often not spoken, but essential to understanding **context and emotion**.

II. Figurative and Symbolic Language

a) Metaphor: Comparing two unrelated things for dramatic effect.

Example: Calling a corrupted institution a "pest-house" to emphasize danger.

b) Irony: Contrast between appearance and reality.

Example: A town praising the Baths while they are actually contaminated.

c) Symbolism: Objects, places, or actions represent larger ideas.

Example: Baths symbolize the town's prosperity and moral health.

III. Characterization through Language

a) Tone: Attitude expressed in speech – angry, sarcastic, joyful, urgent.

b) Vocabulary: Choice of words shows social status, profession, education, or personality.

Example: Stockmann uses scientific and technical vocabulary to establish authority.

c) Speech Patterns: Rhythm, repetition, exclamations, and rhetorical questions reveal emotion and intent.

Indirect Characterization: Revealed through dialogue, actions, and reactions of other characters.

d) Direct Characterization: Author explicitly describes a character's traits (less common in European drama).

Application activity 5.1.2



Work in pairs. Read the extract below from Act 1, of "An enemy of the People" and answer questions that follow

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: And the Baths--we have called them the "main artery of the town's life- blood," the "nerve-centre of our town," and the devil knows what else--

BILLING: "The town's pulsating heart" was the expression I once used on an important occasion.

Quite so. Well, do you know what they really are, these great, splendid, much praised Baths, that have cost so much money--do you know what they are?

HOVSTAD: No, what are they?

MRS. STOCKMANN: Yes, what are they?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: The whole place is a pest-house!

PETRA: The Baths, father?

MRS. STOCKMANN (at the same time): Our Baths?

HOVSTAD: But, Doctor--

BILLING: Absolutely incredible!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: The whole Bath establishment is a whited, poisoned sepulchre, I tell you--the gravest possible danger to the public health! All the nastiness up at Molledal, all that stinking filth, is infecting the water in the conduit-pipes leading to the reservoir; and the same cursed, filthy poison oozes out on the shore too--

HORSTER: Where the bathing-place is?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Just there.

HOVSTAD: How do you come to be so certain of all this, Doctor?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I have investigated the matter most conscientiously. For a long time past I have suspected something of the kind. Last year we had some very strange cases of illness among the visitors--typhoid cases, and cases of gastric fever--

MRS. STOCKMANN: Yes, that is quite true.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: At the time, we supposed the visitors had been infected before they came; but later on, in the winter, I began to have a different opinion; and so I set myself to examine the water, as well as I could.

MRS. STOCKMANN: Then that is what you have been so busy with?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Indeed I have been busy, Katherine. But here I had none of the necessary scientific apparatus; so I sent samples, both of the drinking-water and of the sea-water, up to the University, to have an accurate analysis made by a chemist.

HOVSTAD: And have you got that?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN(*showing him the letter*) : Here it is! It proves the presence of decomposing organic matter in the water--it is full of infusoria. The water is absolutely dangerous to use, either internally or externally.

MRS. STOCKMANN: What a mercy you discovered it in time.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: You may well say so.

HOVSTAD: And what do you propose to do now, Doctor?

A. Comprehension questions

How do Stockmann's stage directions (e.g., [*walks about, rubbing his hands*], [*stamps his foot*]) contribute to the audience's understanding of his emotional state and sense of urgency? Identify two examples of figurative language in this extract and explain their meaning.

1. What does this extract reveal about Stockmann's relationship with authority (the Mayor, townspeople)?
2. Explain how Stockmann's tone and speech patterns help communicate his character to the audience.
3. Why is this scene important in the development of the plot? Refer to events or characters in your answer. Compare the speech of Stockmann with Mrs. Stockmann's. How does their dialogue reflect differences in personality. Provide examples from the extract?

II. Language enhancement

Copy the difficult words from the extract and use dictionary to check their meanings?

III. Oral presentation question

Choose two characters from the extract. What do you like and dislike about each of them? Give reasons for your answers.?

5.2. Interpretation and Context in European Drama

Learning activity 5.2.1



Read the following extract and answer questions that follow

(SCENE – The same. The door into the dining room is shut. It is morning. MRS. STOCKMANN, holding a sealed letter, comes in from the dining room, goes to the DOCTOR'S study door, and peeps in.)

MRS. STOCKMANN: Are you in, Thomas?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (*from within his room*) Yes, I've just come in. (*Comes into the room.*) What is it?

Read the following extract and answer questions that follow

(SCENE – The same. The door into the dining room is shut. It is morning. MRS. STOCKMANN, holding a sealed letter, comes in from the dining room, goes to the DOCTOR'S study door, and peeps in.)

MRS. STOCKMANN: Are you in, Thomas?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (from within his room) Yes, I've just come in. (Comes into the room.) What is it?

MRS. STOCKMANN: A letter from your brother.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Aha, let's see! (Opens the letter and reads quietly) : "I return herewith the manuscript you sent me." H'm!—

MRS. STOCKMANN: What does he say?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (putting the papers in his pocket) Oh, he only writes that he will come here himself around midday.

MRS. STOCKMANN: Well, try to be at home this time.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: That's fine; I've finished all my morning visits.

MRS. STOCKMANN: I'm very curious to see how he will take it.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: You'll see he won't be pleased that it was I, not he, who made the discovery.

MRS. STOCKMANN: Aren't you a little nervous about that?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Oh, he'll be pleased enough, I'm sure. But Peter is so terribly afraid that anyone else should do a service to the town except himself.

MRS. STOCKMANN: Thomas, you should be good-natured and share the credit with him. Couldn't you suggest it was he who led you to the discovery?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I'm quite willing—if only I can get the matter set right. I—

(MORTEN KIIL puts his head in through the door from the hall, looking around with a curious chuckle.)

MORTEN KIIL: (slyly) Is it—is it true?

MRS. STOCKMANN: (going to the door) Father! Is that you?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Ah, Mr. Kiil—good morning, good morning!

MRS. STOCKMANN: Come in.

MORTEN KIIL: If it's true, I will; if not, I'm off.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: If what is true?

MORTEN KIIL: This story about the water supply—is it true?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Certainly it is true. But how did you hear about it?

MORTEN KIIL: (*coming in*) Petra ran in on her way to school—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Did she?

MORTEN KIIL: Yes, and she insists—at first, I thought she was teasing—but it isn't like Petra to do that.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Of course not. How could you think otherwise?

MORTEN KIIL: Well, it's better never to trust anyone—you may find yourself made a fool before you know it. But it really is true, isn't it?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: You can depend on it. Sit down. [Settles him on the couch.] Isn't this a real bit of luck for the town—

MORTEN KIIL: (*suppressing his laughter*) A bit of luck for the town?

Comprehension questions

1. What is the extract mainly about? Briefly explain your answer. Who brings the letter to Dr. Thomas Stockmann, and what is the content of the letter?
2. How does Dr. Stockmann feel about his brother's upcoming visit? Use evidence from the dialogue.
3. Describe the relationship between Dr. Stockmann and Peter based on their conversation.
4. How does Morten Kiil react when he hears about the water supply? What does his reaction suggest about him?
5. Find and explain one moment in the extract that shows Dr. Stockmann's confidence in the truth of his discovery.
6. Discuss the context of the extract?

1. Cultural, Historical, and Social Context

European drama often reflects the **values, beliefs, and issues** of the society in which it was written.

Language and dialogue are shaped by **historical periods**:

- Example: 19th-century dramas use formal speech and structured dialogue.
- Modern European plays may include everyday language, slang, or fragmented sentences to reflect contemporary life.

Social roles and hierarchies influence how characters **speak and interact**:

- Nobility may use formal, elaborate language.
- Common people may speak in everyday conversational language.

2. Conveying Conflict

Drama is often built around **conflict** between characters, ideas, or social groups.

Conflict can be expressed through:

- **Speech:** Arguments, persuasive or accusatory dialogue.
- **Silence:** Pauses or hesitations indicating tension or unspoken feelings.
- **Tone and volume:** Raising one's voice or whispering to show dominance, fear, or secrecy.

Example: In *An Enemy of the People*, Dr. Stockmann's urgency and repeated warnings create conflict with town officials.

3. Expressing Emotion

European drama communicates emotion through **words and actions**.

Techniques include:

- **Exclamations and interjections:** "Oh, Thomas! Thomas!" shows shock or fear.
- **Repetition:** Emphasizes strong feelings, e.g., Stockmann repeating "just see!"
- **Stage directions:** [Walks about, rubbing his hands], [stamps his foot] show anxiety, excitement, or anger.

Characters' emotions are often **intensified for the audience** to perceive clearly.

4. Tension and Suspense

Drama relies on building **tension** to engage the audience.

Methods include:

- **Interruptions or overlaps** in dialogue (characters speaking at the same time).
- **Delayed information:** Secrets revealed gradually to heighten suspense.
- **Contrasts in tone:** Calm speech followed by sudden outbursts.

Example: Stockmann's revelation about the Baths' contamination builds tension as he anticipates the townspeople's reactions.

Application activity 5.2.2



Read the following extract and answer questions that follow

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, it was I who made the discovery in good time.

MORTEN KIIL: (*as before*) Yes, yes, yes! But I would never have thought you the kind of man to tease your own brother like this!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Tease him?

MRS. STOCKMANN: Really, father dear

MORTEN KIIL (*resting his hands and chin on the handle of his stick, winking slyly at the DOCTOR*) Let me see... what was the story? Some sort of creature got into the water pipes, wasn't it?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Infusoria—yes.

MORTEN KIIL: And according to Petra, a whole lot of these creatures got in—an enormous number.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Certainly; hundreds of thousands, probably.

MORTEN KIIL: But nobody can see them, right?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes; you can't see them. [with a quiet chuckle] Damn—it's the finest story I've ever heard!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: What do you mean?

MORTEN KIIL: But you'll never get the Mayor to believe such a thing.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: We shall see.

MORTEN KIIL: Do you think he'll be foolish enough to—?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I hope the whole town will be fools enough.

MORTEN KIIL: The whole town! Well, that wouldn't be a bad thing—it would serve them right and teach them a lesson. They think themselves so cleverer than us old fellows. They hounded me out of the council—they really did. Now they'll pay. You pull their legs too, Thomas!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Really, I—

MORTEN KIIL: You pull their legs! (*Gets up.*) If you can make the Mayor and his friends swallow the same bait, I'll give ten pounds to charity—like that!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: That's very kind of you.

MORTEN KIIL: I haven't much money to throw away, I can tell you. But if you pull this off, I'll give five pounds to charity at Christmas.

(*HOVSTAD enters through the hall door.*)

HOVSTAD:

Good morning! (*Pauses.*) Oh, I beg your pardon.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Not at all; come in.

MORTEN KIIL: (*with another chuckle*) Oho! He's in on this too?

HOVSTAD: What do you mean?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Certainly, he is.

MORTEN KIIL: I might have guessed! This must get into the papers. You know how to do it, Thomas—set your wits to work. I must be off now.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Won't you stay a little while?

MORTEN KIIL: No, I must go. Keep up this game for all it's worth—you won't regret it, I'm damned if you will!

He exits; MRS. STOCKMANN follows him into the hall.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (*laughing*) Just imagine—the old chap doesn't believe a word of this about the water supply.

HOVSTAD: Oh, that was it, then?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, that's what we were discussing. Perhaps it's the same thing that brings you here?

HOVSTAD: Yes. Can you spare me a few minutes, Doctor?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: As long as you like, my dear fellow.

HOVSTAD: Have you heard from the Mayor yet?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Not yet. He'll be coming here later.

HOVSTAD: I've thought a lot about this matter since last night.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Well?

HOVSTAD: From your point of view, as a doctor and man of science, this water supply issue is an isolated matter. But you don't realise it involves much more.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: How do you mean? Let's sit down, my dear fellow. No, you sit on the couch. (*HOVSTAD sits; DR. STOCKMANN sits on a chair across the table.*) Now then, you mean that—?

HOVSTAD: Yesterday, you said the water pollution was due to impurities in the soil.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, unquestionably—it comes from that poisonous morass up at Molledal.

HOVSTAD: Begging your pardon, Doctor, I think it's due to quite another morass entirely.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: What morass?

HOVSTAD: The morass on which the whole life of our town is built—and is rotting.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: What on earth are you driving at, Hovstad?

HOVSTAD: The town's interests have gradually fallen into the hands of a pack of officials.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. What does the stage direction “(MORTEN KIIL puts his head in through the door... and chuckles)” suggest about Morten Kiil’s mood?
A. Angry and disappointed B. Curious and amused
C. Worried and feared D. Confused and felt rejected
2. When Dr. Stockmann says “Certainly it is true, but how did you come to hear it?”, what does it reveal about his character?
A. He is indifferent B. He is secretive C. He is confident D. He is afraid

ii. Answer True / False

Dr. Stockmann’s statement “I hope the whole town will be fools enough” shows his frustration with the town’s ignorance.

iii. Open-ended questions

1. Explain the meaning of the idiom “You pull their legs too, Thomas!” and how does it contribute to the dramatic effect.
2. How does the dialogue between Dr. Stockmann and Morten Kiil create tension in the scene? Give examples.
3. Explain how the interactions between characters in this scene reflect the social and cultural life of the town. Support your answer with evidence from the dialogue or stage directions

iv. Match the characters with their tone or behavior in this scene:

Character	Tone/Behavior Description
Dr. Stockmann	a. Concerned and caring
Morten Kiil	b. Hopeful and confident
Mrs. Stockmann	c. Sly, curious, playful

B. Language enhancement

List down the punctuations used in the extract and give one example each?

C. Oral presentation

What is the extract about? Summarize your answer in 6 to 9 sentences and present your work in front of the class.

5.3. Analyzing Theme Development in European Drama

Learning activity 5.3.1



Read the following extract and answer questions that follow

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Oh, come now—they are not all officials.

HOVSTAD: No, but those who aren't officials are at least their friends and supporters. The wealthy families and old notable citizens have completely influenced us.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, but after all, they are capable and knowledgeable men.

HOVSTAD: Did they show much ability when they decided where to lay the water pipes?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: No, that was clearly a mistake. But we are going to correct it now.

HOVSTAD: Do you think it will be that easy?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Easy or not, it must be done.

HOVSTAD: Yes, provided the press covers it.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I don't think that will be necessary. I am confident my brother—

HOVSTAD: Excuse me, Doctor. I feel I should handle this in the newspaper.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: In the paper?

HOVSTAD: Yes. When I took over the *People's Messenger*, my aim was to challenge this group of self-important officials who control everything.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: But you told me yourself what happened—you nearly ruined the paper.

HOVSTAD: Yes, at that time we had to back down a bit, because the whole Baths project depended on their support. But now the plan has succeeded, and we no longer need to rely on these men.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: We can dispense with them, yes—but we still owe them gratitude.

HOVSTAD: That will be acknowledged, of course. But as a journalist committed to democratic ideals, I cannot miss this chance. The myth of official infallibility must be exposed and destroyed.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I agree completely, Mr. Hovstad. If it's a superstition, it should go!

HOVSTAD: I would rather not involve the Mayor, since he is your brother. But truth must come first.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Of course. [with emphasis] Yes, but—but—

HOVSTAD: Do not misunderstand me. I am no more ambitious or self-interested than any other man.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: My dear fellow—who suggests otherwise?

HOVSTAD: As you know, I come from humble beginnings, which has taught me what ordinary people truly need: a say in public affairs. That develops their minds, self-respect, and intelligence.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I understand and appreciate that.

HOVSTAD: A journalist has a duty not to miss a chance to empower the masses—the humble and oppressed. People in high society may call me an agitator, but they can say what they like. As long as my conscience is clear, that is enough.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Absolutely right, Mr. Hovstad. Still—devil take it! [A knock is heard.] Come in!

(ASLAKSEN enters. He is modestly dressed in black, with a slightly wrinkled white neckcloth, gloves in hand, and a felt hat.)

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. According to Hovstad, why are the wealthy families and officials criticized?
 - a) They lack knowledge and influence.
 - b) They have completely controlled public affairs.
 - c) They support Dr. Stockmann's plans.
 - d) They are humble and powerless.
2. Dr. Stockmann believes that the problem with the water supply:
 - a) Must be corrected, whether it is easy or not.
 - b) Should be ignored for the moment and reconsidered later.
 - c) Should be left entirely to the press for publicity.
 - d) Will solve itself over time.

ii. Open-ended questions

1. What is the extract mainly about?
2. Identify two words or expressions from the dialogue between Dr. Stockmann and Hovstad that reveal their different views on truth and authority.
3. How is the theme of power and social control presented in this extract? Support your answer with reference to the dialogue.

Analyzing Theme Development in European Drama

1. Main Themes in European Drama

European drama often explores universal themes that reflect human experience and society. Some key themes include:

1. **Power:** Struggles for control, authority, and influence (e.g., political power, social hierarchy).
2. **Identity:** Characters' search for self, personal values, or social roles.
3. **Love:** Romantic, familial, or platonic love and its conflicts.
4. **Justice:** Morality, law, fairness, and social responsibility.
5. **Freedom:** Personal liberty, social emancipation, and resistance to oppression.

2. How Themes Develop

Themes in European drama are developed through **characters, conflict, language, and setting**:

a) Characters

Characters embody themes through their beliefs, choices, and actions.

Example: A character who challenges authority may develop the theme of **freedom**.

Heroic or morally conscious characters often highlight **justice** and **truth**.

b) Conflict

Conflict drives the exploration of themes.

Types of conflict:

1. **Person vs. Person** : Reveals power struggles or love tensions.
2. **Person vs. Society** : Highlights social injustice or oppression.
3. **Person vs. Self**:- Explores identity, moral dilemmas, or personal freedom.

c) Language

Dialogue, monologues, and rhetoric communicate themes.

Choice of words, tone, and figurative language reveal social attitudes and moral messages.

Example: Sarcasm or irony may expose corruption; passionate speech may highlight love or justice.

d) Setting

- The physical and social setting reinforces the theme.
- Example: A decaying town may symbolize corruption or social stagnation.

- Settings can reflect power hierarchies (palaces, courts) or oppression (prisons, poor --- neighborhoods).

3. Tips for Analyzing Theme Development

- Identify the central issue** the drama is exploring.
- Track how characters' actions influence or challenge the theme.
- Notice turning points or conflicts** that deepen the theme.
- Examine language** for symbols, metaphors, or recurring motifs related to the theme.
- Connect the setting** to the social, political, or moral environment affecting the theme.

Application activity 5.3.2



Read the following extract and answer questions that follow

ASLAKSEN (*bowing*): Excuse my taking the liberty, Doctor.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN (*getting up*): Ah, it is you, Aslaksen!

ASLAKSEN: Yes, Doctor.

HOVSTAD: (*standing up*) Do you want me, Aslaksen?

ASLAKSEN: No, I didn't expect to find you here. It was the Doctor I came to see.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I am at your service. What is it?

ASLAKSEN: Is what I heard from Mr. Billing true, sir—that you intend to improve our water supply?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, for the Baths.

ASLAKSEN: I understand. I have come to say that I will support this by every means I can.

HOVSTAD: (*to the Doctor*) You see!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I shall be very grateful, but—

ASLAKSEN: It may help to have us small tradesmen behind you. We can form a strong majority in the town if we choose. Having the majority on your side is always an advantage, Doctor.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: That is true, but I don't see why such extra precautions are necessary here. This seems so plain and straightforward.

ASLAKSEN: Even so, it might be wise. I know our local authorities; officials rarely act quickly on proposals from others. That is why a small demonstration may not be a bad idea.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: A demonstration? What exactly do you mean?

ASLAKSEN: We will act with moderation, Doctor. Moderation is always my goal; I believe it is the greatest virtue of a citizen.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, that is well known about you, Mr. Aslaksen.

ASLAKSEN: I take pride in it. The water supply is very important to us small tradesmen. The Baths will be profitable for the town, and especially for householders like us. That is why we will fully support the project. As I am currently Chairman of the Householders' Association—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes?

ASLAKSEN: And also local secretary of the Temperance Society—you know, Doctor, that I am active in promoting temperance?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Of course, of course.

ASLAKSEN: This puts me in contact with many people. As someone respected for being temperate and law-abiding, like yourself, I have some influence in the town. So, if necessary, I could easily organize public support or testimonials.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I know that well, Mr. Aslaksen.

ASLAKSEN: So you see, Doctor, it would be simple to set up some backing if needed.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Who comes to support Dr. Stockmann's water supply project?
a) Hovstad b) Aslaksen c) The Mayor d) Petra
2. What position does Aslaksen currently hold?
a) Chairman of the Householders' Association and local secretary of the Temperance Society b) Mayor of the town
c) Editor of the People's Messenger d) Chief official of the Baths
3. What is Aslaksen's approach to promoting the project?
a) Aggressive public protests b) Acting with moderation
c) Threatening officials d) Ignoring the issue

ii. Open-ended questions

1. What is the extract about?
2. How does Aslaksen's influence in the town help develop the theme of power and citizen participation?
3. Explain with examples how the dialogue between Dr. Stockmann and Aslaksen illustrates the theme of freedom or social responsibility.

B. Answer True or False:

- i. Aslaksen believes having the majority on their side is an advantage.
- ii. Dr. Stockmann immediately agrees that a demonstration is necessary.

C. Language enhancement

Write down the difficult words used in the extract and with the dictionary write their meanings in your notebook?

D. Oral presentation

What do you think about freedom of speech and expression. Present your work by giving the examples negative and positive effects of that freedom in your community?

5.4. Cultural Identity in European Drama

Learning activity 5.4.1



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: A testimonial?

ASLAKSEN: Yes, some kind of an address of thanks from the townsmen for your share in a matter of such importance to the community. I need scarcely say that it would have to be drawn up with the greatest regard to moderation, so as not to offend the authorities—who, after all, have the reins in their hands. If we pay strict attention to that, no one can take it amiss, I should think!

HOVSTAD: Well, and even supposing they didn't like it—

ASLAKSEN: No, no, no; there must be no discourtesy to the authorities, Mr. Hovstad. It is no use falling foul of those upon whom our welfare so closely depends. I have done that in my time, and no good ever comes of it. But no one can take exception to a reasonable and frank expression of a citizen's views.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (*shaking him by the hand*) I can't tell you, dear Mr. Aslaksen, how extremely pleased I am to find such hearty support among my fellow-citizens. I am delighted—delighted! Now, you will take a small glass of sherry, eh?

ASLAKSEN: No, thank you; I never drink alcohol of that kind.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Well, what do you say to a glass of beer, then?

ASLAKSEN: Nor that either, thank you, Doctor. I never drink anything as early as this. I am going into town now to talk this over with one or two householders, and prepare the ground.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: It is tremendously kind of you, Mr. Aslaksen; but I really cannot understand the necessity for all these precautions. It seems to me that the thing should go of itself.

ASLAKSEN: The authorities are somewhat slow to move, Doctor. Far be it from me to seem to blame them—

HOVSTAD: We are going to stir them up in the paper tomorrow, Aslaksen.

ASLAKSEN: But not violently, I trust, Mr. Hovstad. Proceed with moderation, or you will do nothing with them. You may take my advice; I have gathered my experience in the school of life. Well, I must say goodbye, Doctor. You know now that we small tradesmen are at your back at all events, like a solid wall. You have the compact majority on your side Doctor.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I am very much obliged, dear Mr. Aslaksen. [Shakes hands with him.] Goodbye, goodbye.

ASLAKSEN: Are you going my way, towards the printing-office. Mr. Hovstad?

HOVSTAD: I will come later; I have something to settle up first.

ASLAKSEN: Very well. (*Bows and goes out; STOCKMANN follows him into the hall.*)

HOVSTAD: (*as STOCKMANN comes in again*) Well, what do you think of that, Doctor? Don't you think it is high time we stirred a little life into all this slackness and vacillation and cowardice?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Are you referring to Aslaksen?

HOVSTAD: Yes, I am. He is one of those who are floundering in a bog—decent enough fellow though he may be, otherwise. And most of the people here are in just the same case—see-sawing and edging first to one side and then to the other, so overcome with caution and scruple that they never dare to take any decided step.

Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

Which idea is emphasized by Aslaksen when he advises that the message should not offend the authorities?

- a) Respect for authority b) Love for the town
- c) Personal ambition d) Entertainment

ii. Open-ended questions.

1. Why does Aslaksen insist on moderation when dealing with the authorities?
2. Identify one example from the extract where language reflects respect toward authority.
3. How do the different opinions of Aslaksen and Hovstad reveal different social perspectives in society?
4. What moral lesson about citizens' behavior in society can be learned from this discussion?
5. What is the extract about?

1. Language and Cultural Identity

In European drama, **language reflects the cultural identity and social values of a society**. Characters express their beliefs, attitudes, and social positions through their speech.

- People in authority often use formal or controlled language to maintain power.
- Ordinary citizens may speak more directly or emotionally when discussing social issues.
- Dialogue reveals **social class, education level, and cultural attitudes**.

For example, a cautious character may use polite and moderate language to show respect for authority, while a rebellious character may use strong words to challenge power.

2. Social Perspectives in Dialogue

Dialogue in European drama often reveals **different social perspectives**.

Characters may represent different groups in society such as:

- political leaders
- journalists
- workers
- ordinary citizens

Through conversation, these perspectives **show conflicts between authority and the people**.

3. Moral and Ethical Lessons in European Drama

European drama frequently uses dialogue to communicate **moral and ethical lessons**.

These lessons may include:

- the importance of **truth and honesty**
- the value of **standing up against injustice**
- the responsibility of citizens in society
- the dangers of **blind obedience to authority**

Application activity 5.4.2



Read the extract below and answer questions that follow

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, but Aslaksen seemed to me so thoroughly well-intentioned.

HOVSTAD: There is one thing I esteem higher than that; and that is for a man to be self-reliant and sure of himself.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I think you are perfectly right there.

HOVSTAD: That is why I want to seize this opportunity, and try if I cannot manage to put a little virility into these well-intentioned people for once. The idol of Authority must be shattered in this town. This gross and inexcusable blunder about the water supply must be brought home to the mind of every municipal voter.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Very well; if you are of opinion that it is for the good of the community, so be it. But not until I have had a talk with my brother.

HOVSTAD: Anyway, I will get a leading article ready; and if the Mayor refuses to take the matter up—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: How can you suppose such a thing possible!

HOVSTAD: It is conceivable. And in that case—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: In that case I promise you—Look here, in that case you may print my report—every word of it.

HOVSTAD: May I? Have I your word for it?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (*giving him the MS.*) Here it is; take it with you. It can do no harm for you to read it through, and you can give it me back later on.

HOVSTAD: Good, good! That is what I will do. And now goodbye, Doctor.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Goodbye, goodbye. You will see everything will run quite smoothly, Mr. Hovstad—quite smoothly.

HOVSTAD: Hm! —we shall see. (*Bows and goes out.*)

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (*opens the dining-room door and looks in*) Katherine! Oh, you are back, Petra?

PETRA: (*coming in*) Yes, I have just come from the school.

MRS. STOCKMANN: (*coming in*) Has he not been here yet?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Peter? No, but I have had a long talk with Hovstad. He is quite excited about my discovery; I find it has a much wider bearing than I at first imagined. And he has put his paper at my disposal if necessity should arise.

MRS. STOCKMANN: Do you think it will?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Not for a moment. But at all events it makes me feel proud to know that I have the liberal-minded independent press on my side. Yes, and just imagine—I have had a visit from the Chairman of the Householders' Association!

MRS. STOCKMANN: Oh! What did he want?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: To offer me his support too. They will support me in a body if it should be necessary. Katherine—do you know what I have got behind me?

MRS. STOCKMANN: Behind you? No, what have you got behind you?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: The compact majority.

MRS. STOCKMANN: Really? Is that a good thing for you, Thomas?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I should think it was a good thing. (*Walks up and down rubbing his hands.*) By Jove, it's a fine thing to feel this bond of brotherhood between oneself and one's fellow citizens!

PETRA: And to be able to do so much that is good and useful, father!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

What quality does Hovstad value more than good intentions?

- a) Wealth
- b) Self-reliance and confidence
- c) Friendship
- d) Popularity

ii. Open-ended questions

1. According to Hovstad, what serious problem should be made known to the municipal voters?
2. Why does Hovstad want the newspaper to publish the report?
3. How does the language used by Hovstad reflect his strong views about authority and social change?
4. What does Dr. Stockmann's willingness to publish his report suggest about his moral values?
5. What ethical message about truth and responsibility in society can be learned from this extract?

B. Oral and presentation

Comment on the contribution of press in the play "An Enemy of The People" in influencing the political decisions. Present your opinion in front of the class?

5.5. Language Focus: Using idiomatic Expression and its effect

Learning activity 5.5.1



Read the dialogue below and in pairs discuss the questions that follow

Title: Thinking Outside the Box

(Scene: Frederick's office. Frederick is sitting at his desk, thinking looking as if he has a problem unsolved)

Frederick (*muttering to himself*): I need a new way to solve this problem... I must think *outside the box*.

(The Boss enters, holding a file, looking serious.)

Boss (*firmly*): Frederick, are you following the company rules?

Frederick (*nervously*): Yes, sir... but I think we could try a more creative approach.

Boss (*shaking head*): No, Frederick. *Play it safe*—follow the rules.

(Frederick sighs and looks down at his work.)

Frederick (*quietly, to himself*): I guess I have to *bite the bullet* and do things the boring way.

(Scene shifts: Weeks later. Frederick is at his desk, looking more confident.)

Frederick (*smiling, to himself*): Thinking *outside the box* really works!

(The Boss enters again.)

Boss: Frederick, how is your work going?

Frederick (*calmly*): It's going well, sir.

Frederick (*aside, quietly*): I should take his opinions *with a grain of salt*.

(Final Scene: Frederick's performance is recognized.)

Boss (*pleased*): Frederick, your work has improved greatly. I am promoting you.

Frederick (*happily*): Thank you, sir! Now I can use my creative ideas fully.

(Frederick stands confidently at his desk.)

Frederick (*to audience*): I finally get to put my creative problem-solving skills to good use! **(Lights fade.)**

Questions

1. What is the meaning of the title of the dialogue?
2. Identify expressions from the dialogue that are used figuratively (not in their literal sense). Explain their meanings.
3. From the context, what does Frederick's boss mean when he tells him to "play it safe"?
4. Identify other expressions used in the dialogue and explain their meanings in context.

1. Idiomatic Expressions

An **idiomatic expression (idiom)** is a group of words whose meaning is **different from the literal meaning of the individual words**.

Idioms are commonly used in everyday language to express ideas **more vividly, naturally, and culturally**.

For example, if someone says **“break the ice,”** it does not mean to break actual ice. It means **to start a conversation in a friendly way**.

Idiomatic expressions are important because they:

- make language **more natural and expressive**
- reflect **culture and social attitudes**
- help speakers communicate ideas **more effectively**

2. Characteristics of Idiomatic Expressions

Idiomatic expressions usually have the following characteristics:

1. **Figurative meaning** – The meaning is not the same as the literal words.
2. **Fixed structure** – The words in an idiom usually cannot be changed.
3. **Cultural connection** – Idioms often reflect the culture and experiences of the people who use them.

Example: **“Hit the nail on the head”** means **to say something exactly right**, not to hit a real nail.

3. Examples of Common Idiomatic Expressions

Idiom	Meaning	Example Sentence
Break the ice	Start a conversation or make people feel comfortable	The teacher told a joke to break the ice in the class.
Spill the beans	Reveal a secret	He spilled the beans about the surprise party.
Hit the nail on the head	Say exactly the right thing	Your answer hit the nail on the head.
Piece of cake	Something very easy	The test was a piece of cake for the students.
Once in a blue moon	Something that happens rarely	We see him only once in a blue moon.

4. Idiomatic Expressions in Literature and Drama

In drama and literary texts, idiomatic expressions are used to:

- make **dialogue sound natural and realistic**
- show **characters’ emotions and attitudes**

- reflect **social background and cultural identity**

Writers often use idioms to make characters sound like **real people in everyday conversation**.

Application activity 5.5.2



Read carefully and answer the following questions

1. Match the idioms in the left-hand column with their meanings in the right-hand column.

Idiomatic expressions	Meanings
butterflies in one's stomach	A. to keep quiet
foot the bill	B. very easy to do
by heart	C. to pay the cost
pull the wool over one's eyes	D. to help someone
lend a hand	E. to deceive someone
put one's foot down	F. to feel very nervous
A piece of cake	G. to memorize something
Hold someone's tongue	H. to be very old and about to stop working
The car is on its last leg	I. to take a firm decision
foot the bill	J. to pay expenses

2. Why do you think writers use idiomatic expressions in drama instead of simple, direct words and what is their effect?

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



Read the extract below carefully and answer the questions that follow.

PETER STOCKMANN: Yes, **dating** from today. (*Lays the letter on the table.*) It gives us pain to do it; but, to speak **frankly**, we dared not do otherwise on account of public opinion.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: (*smiling*) Dared not? I seem to have heard that word before, today.

PETER STOCKMANN: I must beg you to understand your position clearly. For the future you must not count on any practice whatever in the town.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Devil take the practice! But why are you so sure of that?

PETER STOCKMANN: The Householders' Association is **circulating** a list from house to house. All right-minded citizens are being called upon to give up employing you; and I can assure you that not a single head of a family will risk **refusing** his **signature**. They simply dare not.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: No, no; I don't doubt it. But what then?

PETER STOCKMANN: If I might advise you, it would be best to leave the place for a little while—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, the **propriety** of leaving the place has occurred to me.

PETER STOCKMANN: Good. And then, when you have had six months to think things over, if, after **mature** consideration, you can persuade yourself to write a few words of regret, **acknowledging** your error—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I might have my appointment **restored** to me, do you mean?

PETER STOCKMANN: Perhaps. It is not at all impossible.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: But what about public opinion, then? Surely you would not dare to do it on account of public feeling...

PETER STOCKMANN: Public opinion is an extremely **mutable** thing. And, to be quite **candid** with you, it is a matter of great importance to us to have some admission of that sort from you in writing.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Oh, that's what you are after, is it! I will just trouble you to remember what I said to you lately about **foxy** tricks of that sort!

PETER STOCKMANN: Your position was quite different then. At that time you had reason to suppose you had the whole town at your back--

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Yes, and now I feel I have the whole town ON my back--[flaring up]. I would not do it if I had the devil and his dam on my back--! Never--never, I tell you!

PETER STOCKMANN: A man with a family has no right to **behave** as you do. You have no right to do it, Thomas.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: I have no right! There is only one single thing in the world a free man has no right to do. Do you know what that is?

PETER STOCKMANN: No.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN: Of course you don't, but I will tell you. A free man has no right to **soil** himself with filth; he has no right to behave in a way that would **justify** his **spitting** in his own face.

A. Comprehension

A. Multiple Choice Questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. Why does Peter Stockmann advise Dr. Stockmann to leave the town?
a) Public opinion is against him b) To go abroad and start a new job
c) To travel and rest d) To visit his family
2. What does Peter Stockmann expect Dr. Stockmann to do after six months?
a) Publish another report b) Write a new article
c) Start a new business d) Apologize and admit his mistake
3. What does the expression "*public opinion is an extremely mutable thing*" suggest?
a) Public opinion never changes b) Public opinion changes easily
c) Public opinion is always correct d) Public opinion is not important
4. Which moral value is Dr. Stockmann defending?
a) Wealth b) Popularity
c) Truth and integrity d) Authority
5. What is the main conflict presented in this extract?
a) Family conflict b) Conflict between science and religion
c) Conflict between workers and leaders d) Conflict between truth and public opinion

ii. Open-ended questions

1. What does Dr. Stockmann mean when he says:
"A free man has no right to soil himself with filth"?
2. Comment on the language used in the extract. How does it reveal the characters' attitudes and conflict?
3. What is the main message conveyed in this extract?

C. Answer True or False

1. Dialogue in European drama is mainly used for decoration and does not influence the development of the plot.
2. Stage directions are usually not spoken aloud but help actors understand how to perform a scene.
3. A soliloquy allows other characters on stage to hear the private thoughts of the speaker.
4. The language used in drama can reflect the historical period in which the play was written.
5. In European drama, conflict can only occur between characters and not within a character's mind.

D. Fill in the gaps

1. During a town meeting, a doctor discovers that the water is contaminated, but the leaders refuse to accept the truth. This situation shows a conflict between _____ and _____.
2. A character stands alone on stage and reveals his inner thoughts directly to the audience. This is called a _____.
3. When two characters argue using strong and emotional language to express opposing ideas, this creates _____ in the drama.
4. A journalist in a play uses the newspaper to influence people's thinking and challenge those in power. This reflects the theme of _____.
5. A character describes a corrupt system as a "poisoned well" to show danger. This is an example of _____.
6. When a character uses formal and controlled language to show respect for leaders and avoid conflict, it reflects _____ values in society.
7. A character who refuses to lie even when pressured by society demonstrates the moral value of _____.
8. When stage directions show actions like [stamps foot] or [walks nervously], they help the audience understand the character's _____.
A group of citizens supports a leader's idea to improve their community, showing the importance of _____ in society.
9. When a character says something that means the opposite of what is actually true, it is called _____.

E. Language skills

1. Summarize the Extract from Henrik Ibsen's *An Enemy of the People*, given above in 70-80 words
2. Identify the Idiomatic expressions that appear in that extract and find out their literal meanings.

V. Project Work

Group Activity (4-5 learners)

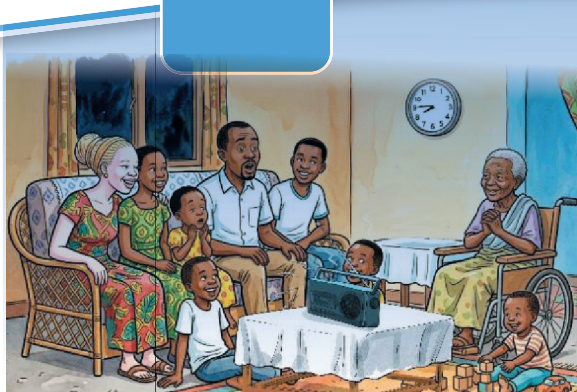
Task: Exploring *An Enemy of the People*

- a) Read the play *An Enemy of the People* scene by scene.
- b) Identify the main characters in the play.
- c) Discuss the main conflict between Dr. Stockmann and society.
- d) Identify at least **three themes** in the play.

- e) Select one important scene and perform it in class.
- f) Explain the moral lesson of the play.
- g) Present your work in oral presentation or short drama performance.

UNIT 6

RADIO AND TELEVISION DRAMA



Key Unit Competence:

To analyze radio and television dramas, demonstrating understanding of their features, themes, messages, and social functions through performance.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

1

Knowledge and understanding

- ✓ Explain what radio and TV drama are and explain their purposes such as **entertainment, education, information, and social awareness**.
- ✓ Describe the **characteristics** of radio drama (sound, dialogue, narration) and TV drama (visuals, acting, setting), and identify different **types** such as series, soap operas, and teleplays.
- ✓ Identify stylistic devices used in radio and TV drama (dialogue, sound effects, music, camera work) and compare their similarities and differences, especially the use of sound in radio and visual elements in television.

2

Skills

- ✓ Analyze radio and television drama scripts and performances to understand their structure, characters, and dramatic elements.
- ✓ Compare themes, messages, and styles used in radio and TV drama and interpret how language and setting influence meaning in media drama.
- ✓ Perform short scenes from radio or television drama, demonstrating understanding of dialogue, voice, expression, and actions.

3

Attitudes and values

- ✓ Appreciate radio and television drama as important **cultural and artistic forms of expression**.
- ✓ Demonstrate creativity and cooperation when performing or participating in drama activities.
- ✓ Respect different viewpoints presented in media drama and value the role of media in educating and informing society.

6.0. INTRODUCTION TO THE UNIT

Close your eyes for a moment. Imagine hearing a voice coming from a small radio. The voice is rich and full of emotion. You hear different sounds, music, and moments of silence. There are no pictures, but your mind creates the characters, the place, and the story. This is **radio drama**. Radio drama tells a story using **voices, sound effects, music, and silence**.

Now imagine a television screen lighting up. Characters appear on the screen. They move, speak, laugh or cry. You can see their actions, expressions, clothes, and surroundings. Many people can watch the same story at the same time. This is **television drama**. Television drama tells a story using **pictures, actions, voices, music, and sound effects**.

In this unit, you will study **radio drama and television drama**. You will listen, watch, analyze, and perform short drama scenes. You will learn how stories in media communicate ideas, feelings, and messages to the audience.

Introductory activity



A. Listen to the audio clip from 'The Crucible' by Arthur Miller, **Act 1A. p5-p7**, and answer the questions that follow. [<https://youtu.be/xjOi1C9HNpA>]

Questions

1. Using your own words, discuss what the audio clip is about?
2. Identify the extra sounds other than the characters' voice used in the audio clip.
3. What lesson do you learn from the audio clip?
4. Who are the characters you have heard from the audio clip?
5. Describe the mood of those characters.

B. Watch the video clip from 'An Enemy of the people' by Henrik Ibsen, **Act 1** [<https://youtu.be/-LLmP-y6O6s>] and answer the questions that follow.

Questions

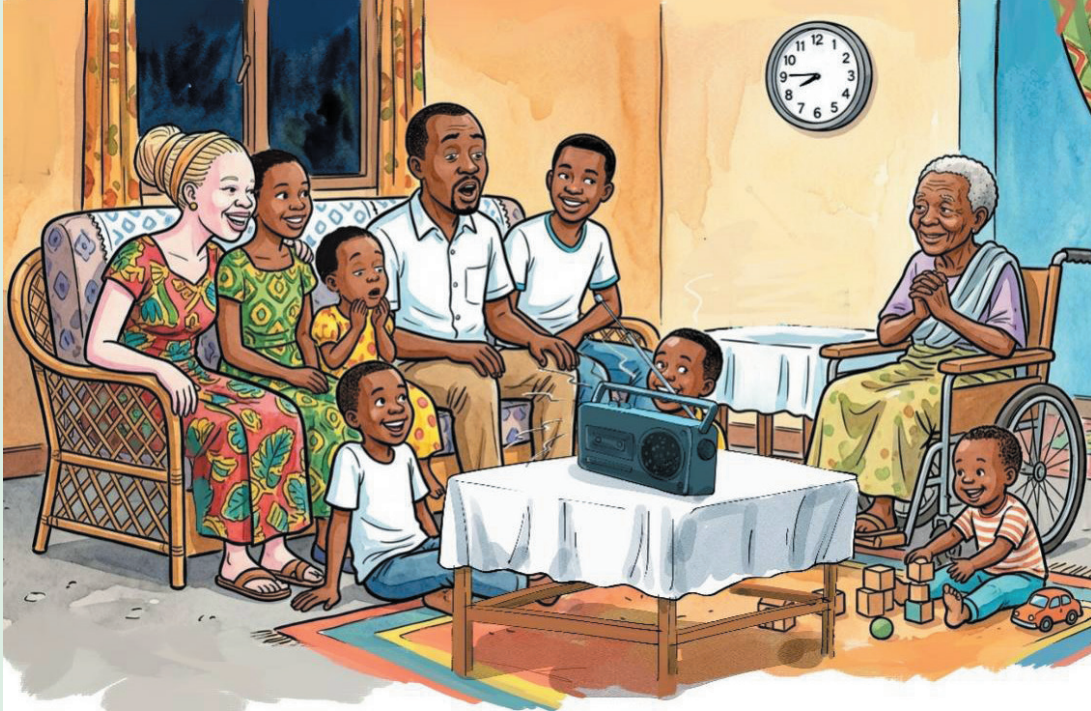
1. What is the video clip about?
2. After watching the video clip, identify the special images used in it.
3. Discuss the causes of those effects.
4. What is the main message (s) do you draw from this passage?

6.1. Introduction to Radio Drama

Learning activity 6.1.1



Study the picture carefully and answer the questions that follow:



Questions

1. What are the people in the picture doing? Describe their actions clearly.
2. Why do you think some people in the picture appear happy while others seem sad? Explain your answer based on what you observe.

Radio Drama

1. Meaning

Radio drama is a type of drama performed and broadcast on radio. It tells a story using **voices, dialogue, music, sound effects, and silence** without pictures, so listeners use **imagination** to understand characters, setting, and actions.

2. Functions of Radio Drama in Society

- **Entertainment:** Provides enjoyable stories
- **Education:** Teaches social issues, culture, health, and values
- **Information:** Spreads important messages
- **Cultural preservation:** Keeps traditions and language alive
- **Social change:** Encourages positive behavior and awareness

3. Features of Radio Drama

- **Voice:** Expresses emotions and actions
- **Dialogue:** Main way of telling the story
- **Sound effects:** Create setting and action
- **Narration:** Explains or describes events
- **Imagination:** No visuals, listeners imagine
- **Short scenes:** Clear and engaging

4. Types of Radio Drama

- **Serial drama:** Story continues in episodes
- **Single play:** One complete story
- **Soap opera:** Long-running, focuses on relationships
- **Documentary drama:** Based on real events
- **Comedy drama:** Focuses on humor

5. Analysing Radio Drama

Plot: Sequence of events

Characters: People in the story

Theme: Main idea/message

Setting: Time and place

Language & dialogue: Communication of ideas and emotions

Sound & music: Create mood and meaning

Application activity 6.1.2



1. Listen to the audio clip from *The Crucible* by Arthur Miller, Act 2 and answer the questions that follow.

Audio https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SQOUpdI3W_I

Questions

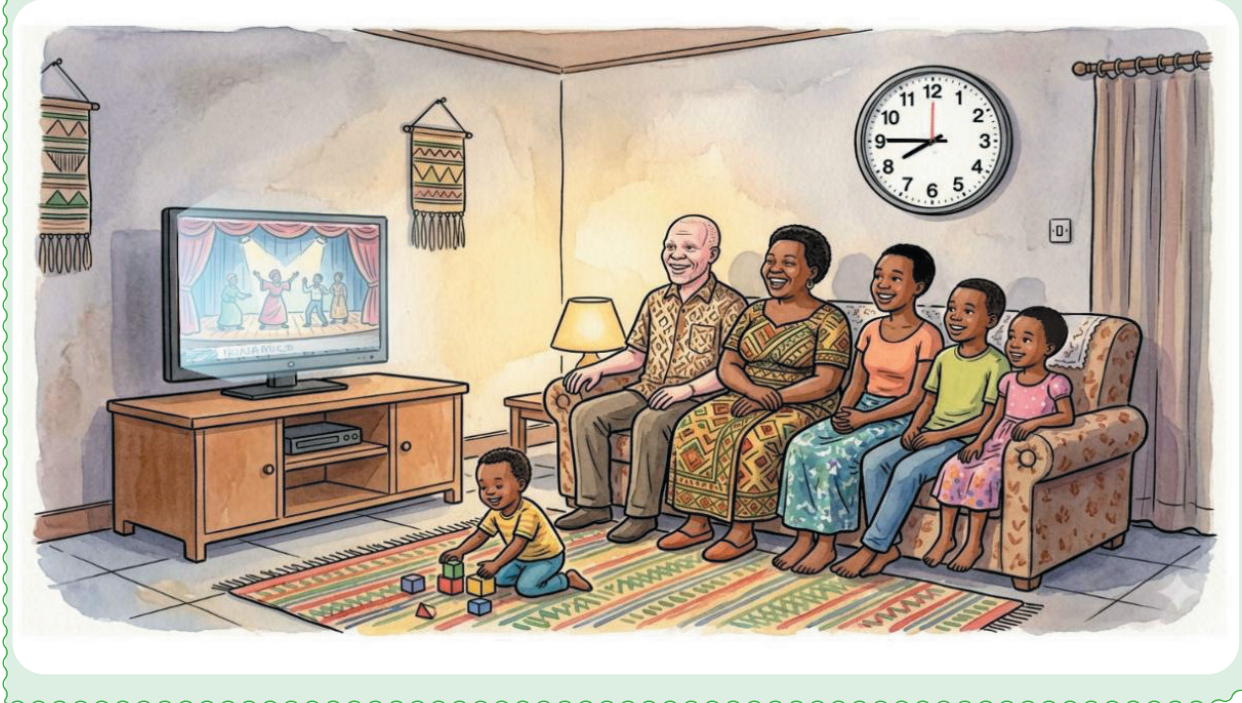
1. Using your own words, discuss what the audio clip is about?
2. Identify the sound effects used in the audio clip.
3. What lesson do you learn from the audio clip?
4. Who are the characters you have heard from the audio clip?
5. Describe the mood of those characters.

6.2 Introduction to Television Drama

Learning activity 6.2.1



Study the video carefully and answer the questions that follow:



Questions

1. What are these people doing? Describe their actions clearly.
2. Describe the emotions shown by the people in the video. Support your answer with evidence from what you observe.

Television (TV) Drama

1. Meaning

TV drama is a type of drama shown on television. It tells a story using **actors, dialogue, actions, visuals, music, and sound effects**, allowing viewers to **see and hear** characters, setting, and events.

2. Functions of TV Drama

- **Entertainment:** Provides enjoyment and relaxation
- **Education:** Teaches social issues, culture, and life experiences
- **Information:** Helps understand societal problems
- **Cultural representation:** Shows traditions and lifestyles
- **Social awareness:** Encourages thinking about issues like justice and relationships

3. Features of TV Drama

- **Visual performance:** Shows actions and facial expressions
- **Dialogue:** Communication between characters
- **Setting & costumes:** Show time and place
- **Sound & music:** Create mood and emotion
- **Camera techniques:** Angles and movements highlight scenes
- **Episodes/scenes:** Organized in parts or series

4. Types of TV Drama

- **Series drama:** Continuous story with same characters
- **Soap opera:** Long-running, focuses on relationships
- **Comedy drama (sitcom):** Humor and funny situations
- **Historical drama:** Based on past events
- **Crime/detective drama:** Focuses on solving crimes

5. Analysing TV Drama

- **Plot:** Sequence of events
- **Characters:** People in the story
- **Theme:** Main idea/message
- **Setting:** Time and place
- **Dialogue & language:** Words used
- **Visual elements:** Actions, expressions, costumes, scenery
- **Sound & music:** Create mood and meaning

Analyzing these helps understand the **story, message, and techniques** used.

Application activity 6.2.2



A. Watch the video clip from *An Enemy of the People* (Act 2) by Henrik Ibsen and answer the questions that follow

1. What is the video clip mainly about?
2. Identify the visual effects used in the clip.
3. What are the possible causes or purposes of these effects?
4. Analyse the characters, setting, and dialogue presented in the clip.
5. What main message(s) do you draw from the clip?
6. How do you feel after watching the clip? Explain your response.

A. Assimilation Activity Title: Taking a Stand for Truth

Instruction:

Imagine you are Dr. Stockmann after discovering the truth about the Baths.

Write a short reflective response (100–150 words) in which you:

- Explain what you would do in his situation
- Describe the challenges you expect from society
- State whether you would defend the truth or follow public opinion, and why

C. Role Play Activity

Title: The Town Meeting Debate

Instruction: In groups of 4–5 students, act out a short scene inspired by *An Enemy of the People*.

Assign roles such as:

- Dr. Stockmann
- Peter Stockmann (the Mayor)
- Hovstad (journalist)
- A townspeople

Task: Create and perform a short dialogue where:

- Dr. Stockmann tries to convince the town about the danger of the Baths
- The Mayor opposes him to protect the town's reputation
- The journalist and townspeople react differently

Guidelines:

- Use expressive language and clear emotions
- Include at least one moment of conflict
- Show how public opinion influences decisions

6.3. Compare and Contrast Radio and TV Drama

Learning activity 6.3.1



Read the dialogue below and answer the questions that follow

Mwiza: Yesterday, I listened to a radio drama about a storm at sea. It was so interesting! I imagined the huge waves, the dark sky, and the fear of the sailors.

Aganze: Really? I don't enjoy radio drama that much. I prefer watching TV drama because I can actually see what is happening.

Matsiko: I think Mwiza has a point. Radio drama makes you use your imagination more. You create the pictures in your mind.

Mukantwari: That's true, but TV drama shows everything clearly. You can see the actors' facial expressions, costumes, and actions, which helps you understand emotions better.

Mwiza: Yes, but sometimes imagining the scenes yourself makes the story more exciting and personal.

Aganze: Maybe, but TV drama is easier to follow because everything is shown to you directly.

Matsiko: So, it seems both radio drama and TV drama have their own advantages.

Comprehension questions

1. Which type of drama does Mwiza prefer, and why?
2. Why does Aganze prefer TV drama? Give one reason from the dialogue.
3. According to Matsiko, what is the main advantage of radio drama?
4. What does Mukantwari say is the benefit of TV drama?
5. Which type of drama requires more imagination? Explain your answer using the dialogue.
6. Identify one difference between radio drama and TV drama from the discussion.
7. Give one similarity between radio drama and TV drama.
8. From your own opinion, do you agree or disagree with the statement: *"Radio Drama is better than TV Drama"*? Give a reason.

Difference between Radio Drama and TV Drama

Radio drama and TV drama are both forms of media drama that tell stories through performance. They share key elements but differ in **techniques and presentation**.

Similarities

- **Plot:** Sequence of events
- **Characters:** Actors play roles
- **Dialogue:** Spoken communication
- **Theme:** Central message
- **Conflict:** Problems or challenges
- **Setting:** Time and place
- **Sound & music:** Create mood and atmosphere

Both use these elements to communicate **stories and emotions**.

Differences

Radio Drama

- Uses **audio only** (voice, dialogue, narration, sound, music)
- Relies on **imagination**
- Uses **narration and descriptive dialogue**
- Focuses on **voice acting and sound design**

TV Drama

- Uses **audio + visuals**
- Shows **facial expressions, gestures, movement**
- Uses **camera, lighting, costumes, scenery**
- Audience **sees actions and setting directly**

Key Difference:

- Radio = **hear and imagine**
- TV = **watch and hear**

Radio vs Television Drama

Aspect	 Radio Drama	 TV Drama
Medium	Audio only	Audio + visuals
Audience	Listens and imagines	Sees and hears
Acting style	Voice-focused	Voice + body language
Dialogue	Descriptive	More natural, less detailed
Visual elements	None	Present (costume, setting)
Sound effects	Very important	Supportive
Narration	Often used	Rarely used

Application activity 6.3.2



Class Debate

Motion: "Radio Drama is better than TV Drama."

Form two groups:

Group A (Proposition): Supports the motion (Radio Drama is better than TV Drama)

Group B (Opposition): Opposes the motion (TV Drama is better than Radio Drama)

Debate Instructions

Each group selects a speaker to present the opening argument.

Other members support by adding points during the discussion.

Each group must give at least 3 strong reasons.

Respect opposing views and take turns speaking.

Each group must end with a short conclusion.

6.4. Themes and Message in TV and Radio Drama

Learning activity 6.4.1



Listen to the audio clip of the extract below from *The Crucible* and answer the questions that follow. (Audio clip: *The Crucible* Act 1. p7-p10...)

Parris: Child. Sit you down.

Abigail: (quavering, as she sits): I would never hurt Betty. I love her dearly.

Parris: Now look you, child, your punishment will come in its time. But if you trafficked with spirits in the forest I must know it now, for surely my enemies will, and they will ruin me with it.

Abigail: But we never conjured spirits.

Parris: Then why can she not move herself since midnight? This child is desperate! (Abigail lowers her eyes.) It must come out - my enemies will bring it out. Let me know what you done there. Abigail, do you understand that I have many enemies?

Abigail: I have heard of it, uncle.

Parris: There is a faction that is sworn to drive me from my pulpit. Do you understand that?

Abigail: I think so, sir

Parris: Now then, in the midst of such disruption, my own household is discovered to be the very center of some obscene practice. Abominations are done in the forest -

Abigail: It were sport, uncle!

Parris: (pointing at Betty): You call this sport? (She lowers her eyes. He pleads): Abigail, if you know something that may help the doctor, for God's sake tell it to me. (She is silent). I saw Tituba waving her arms over the fire when I came on you. Why was she doing that? And I heard a screeching and gibberish coming from her mouth. She were swaying like a dumb beast over that fire!

Abigail: She always sings her Barbados songs, and we dance.

Parris: I cannot blink what I saw, Abigail, for my enemies will not blink it. I saw a dress lying on the grass.

Abigail: (innocently): A dress?

Parris: (it is very hard to say): Aye, a dress. And I thought I saw - someone naked running through the trees!

Abigail: (in terror): No one was naked! You mistake yourself, uncle!

PARRIS: (with anger): I saw it ! (He moves from her. Then, re-solved): Now tell me true, Abigail. And I pray you feel the weight of truth upon you, for now my ministry's at stake, my ministry and perhaps your cousin's life.

Whatever abomination you have done, give me all of it now, for I dare not be taken unaware when I go before them down there.

Abigail: There is nothin' more. I swear it, uncle.

Parris: (studies her, then nods, half convinced): Abigail, I have sought here three long years to bend these stiff-necked people to me, and now, just now when some good respect is rising for me in the parish, you compromise my very character. I have given you a home, child, I have put clothes upon your back - now give me upright answer. Your name in the town - it is entirely white, is it not?

Abigail: (with an edge of resentment): Why, I am sure it is, sir. There be no blush about my name.

Parris: (to the point): Abigail, is there any other cause than you have told me, for your being discharged from Goody Proctor's service? I have heard it said, and I tell you as I heard it, that she comes so rarely to the church this year for she will not sit so close to something soiled. What signified that remark?

Abigail: She hates me, uncle, she must, for I would not be her slave. It's a bitter woman, a lying, cold, sniveling woman, and I will not work for such a woman!

Parris: She may be. And yet it has troubled me that you are now seven months out of their house, and in all this time no other family has ever called for your service.

Abigail: They want slaves, not such as I. Let them send to Barbados for that. I will not black my face for any of them! (With ill-concealed resentment at him): Do you begrudge my bed, uncle?

Parris: No - no.

Abigail: (in a temper): My name is good in the village! I will not have it said my name is soiled! Goody Proctor is a gossiping liar!

Enter Mrs. Ann Putnam. She is a twisted soul of forty-five, a death-ridden woman, haunted by dreams.

Parris: as soon as the door begins to open: No - no, I cannot have anyone'. He sees her, and a certain deference springs into him, although his worry remains. Why, Goody Putnam, come in.

Mrs. PUT'M: (full of breath, shiny-eyed): It is a marvel. It is surely a stroke of hell upon you.

Parris: No, Goody Putnam, it is -

Mrs. PUT'M: (glancing at Betty): How high did she fly, how high?

Parris: No, no, she never flew -

Mrs. PUT'M: (very pleased with it): Why, it's sure she did. Mr. Collins saw her goin' over Ingersoll's barn, and come down light as bird, he says!

Parris: Now, look you, Goody Putnam, she never - (Enter Thomas Putnam, a well-to-do, hard-handed landowner, near fifty). Oh, good morning, Mr. Putnam.

Putnam: It is a providence the thing is out now! It is providence. (He goes directly to the bed.)

Parris: What's out, sir, what's -?

Mrs. Putnam goes to the bed.

Putnam: (looking down at Betty): Why, her eyes is closed! Look you, Ann.

Mrs . PUT'M: Why, that's strange. To Parris: Ours is open.

Parris: (shocked): Your Ruth is sick?

Mrs . PuTNAM: (with vicious certainty): I'd not call it sick; the Devil's touch is heavier than sick. It's death, y'know, it's death drivin' into them, forked and hoofed.

Parris: Oh, pray not! Why, how does Ruth ail?

Mrs . PUT'M: She ails as she must - she never waked this morning, but her eyes open and she walks, and hears naught, sees naught, and cannot eat. Her soul is taken, surely. Parris is struck.

PUTNAM: (as though for further details): They say you've sent for Reverend Hale of Beverly?

Parris: with dwindling conviction now: A precaution only. He has much experience in all demonic-arts, and I

Comprehension questions

10. In your own words, analyse the central theme of the audio clip, providing specific evidence to support your response.
11. Identify and explain the sound effects used in the audio clip, and discuss how they contribute to meaning and atmosphere.
12. What message or moral lesson does the audio clip convey? Support your answer with relevant details from the clip.
13. Identify the characters presented in the audio clip and describe their roles in the development of the narrative.
14. Analyse the mood and emotional states of the characters, explaining how these are conveyed through voice, tone, and sound.

Themes and Messages in TV and Radio Drama

A **theme** is the central or underlying idea explored in a drama, such as *love, conflict, justice, or corruption*. It reflects broader human experiences and social concerns.

A **message** (or moral) is the lesson or insight that the audience derives from the drama, for example, *honesty leads to trust* or *abuse of power results in consequences*.

How Themes and Messages Are Conveyed

In Radio Drama

Themes and messages are communicated primarily through aural techniques, including:

1. Dialogue – reveals ideas, relationships, and conflicts.
2. Voice tone and intonation – convey emotions, attitudes, and implicit meanings.
3. Sound effects – create setting, atmosphere, and symbolic meaning.

In Television Drama

Themes and messages are conveyed through a combination of **visual and auditory techniques**, such as:

1. Visual elements (actions, setting, costumes, lighting) – provide contextual and symbolic meaning.
2. Facial expressions and body language – reveal characters' emotions and psychological states.
3. Dialogue – communicates ideas and advances the plot.

Similarity Between TV and Radio Drama

Both forms:

- Communicate ideas and themes
- Convey moral or social messages
- Reflect and critique aspects of society

Differences Between TV and Radio Drama

1. Radio drama relies on sound and the listener's imagination to construct meaning.
2. Television drama combines sound and visuals, making meaning more immediate and explicit.
3. Interpretation in radio drama tends to be more subjective, while television often provides clearer visual guidance.

Importance of Themes and Messages

Themes and messages:

Help audiences understand human **behavior and societal issues**

- Encourage **critical thinking and moral reflection**
- Connect literary works to **real-life experiences**

Application activity 6.4.2



1. Watch the video clip from 'An Enemy of the people' by Henrik Ibsen, **Act 3** and answer the questions that follow.



Comprehension questions

1. What is the main theme?
2. What message is communicated?
3. How is the message delivered?
4. How do you feel after watching the video clip?

6.5. Stylistic Devices in TV and Radio Drama

Learning activity 6.5.1



Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow

Proctor, *his smile widening*: Ah, you're wicked yet, aren't y'! A *trill of expectant laughter escapes her, and she dares come closer, feverishly looking into his eyes*. You'll be clapped in the stocks before you're twenty.

He takes a step to go, and she springs into his path.

Abigail: Give me a word, John. A soft word. *Her concentrated desire destroys his smile*.

Proctor: No, no, Abby. That's done with.

Abigail, *tauntingly*: You come five mile to see a silly girl fly? I know you better.

Proctor, *setting her firmly out of his path*: I come to see what mischief your uncle's brewin' now. *With final emphasis*: Put it out of mind, Abby.

Abigail, *grasping his hand before he can release her*: John - I am waitin' for you every night.

Proctor: Abby, I never give you hope to wait for me.

Abigail, *now beginning to anger - she can't believe it*: I have something better than hope, I think!

Proctor: Abby, you'll put it out of mind. I'll not be comin' for you more.

Abigail: You're surely sportin' with me.

Proctor: You know me better.

Abigail: I know how you clutched my back behind your house and sweated like a stallion whenever I come near! Or did I dream that? It's she put me out, you cannot pretend it were you. I saw your face when she put me out, and you loved me then and you do now!

Proctor: Abby, that's a wild thing to say -

Abigail: A wild thing may say wild things. But not so wild, I think. I have seen you since she put me out; I have seen you nights.

Proctor: I have hardly stepped off my farm this seven month.

Abigail: I have a sense for heat, John, and yours has drawn me to my window, and I have seen you looking up, burning in your loneliness. Do you tell me you've never looked up at my window? Proctor: I may have looked up.

Abigail, *now softening*: And you must. You are no wintry man. I know you, John. I know you. *She is weeping*. I cannot sleep for dreamin'; I cannot dream but I wake and walk about the house as though I'd find you comin' through some door. *She clutches him desperately*.

Proctor, *gently pressing her from him, with great sympathy but firmly*: Child -

Abigail, *with a pash of anger*: How do you call me child!

Proctor: Abby, I may think of you softly from time to time. But I will cut off my hand before I'll ever reach for you again. Wipe it out of mind. We never touched, Abby.

Abigail: Aye, but we did.

Proctor: Aye, but we did not.

Abigail, *with a bitter anger*: Oh, I marvel how such a strong man may let such a sickly wife be -

Comprehension questions

1. Identify instances of repetition in the dialogue and explain their effect on meaning and character interaction.
2. Identify and analyse an example of imagery in Abigail's language. Explain their effect on meaning.
3. Analyse how repetition in the dialogue reinforces the conflict between Proctor and Abigail. Support your answer with evidence from the extract.
4. Examine how the language used in the dialogue creates tension between the characters. Refer to specific words or expressions in your response.
5. Interpret the phrase "I will cut off my hand before I'll ever reach for you again" and explain what it reveals about Proctor's character.

6. Analyse the persuasive techniques Abigail uses in her language to influence Proctor. Provide relevant examples.
7. Identify the stylistic device used in the expression *"I will cut off my hand"* and analyse what it reveals about the speaker's state of mind and moral stance.

Stylistic Devices in TV and Radio Drama

Meaning: Stylistic devices are techniques used to make drama **interesting, emotional, and meaningful**, helping to develop **themes, characters, and audience engagement**.

1. Radio Drama Devices (Audio-based)

- **Dialogue:** Main storytelling tool; clear and descriptive
- **Sound Effects (SFX):** Create setting and action
- **Music:** Sets mood and signals changes
- **Voice Techniques:** Tone, pitch, pace, volume show emotion
- **Narration:** Explains scenes or background

2. TV Drama Devices (Audio + Visual)

- **Dialogue:** Supported by visuals, often shorter
- **Visual Imagery:** Setting, costume, lighting create meaning
- **Camera Techniques:** Close-up (emotion), long shot (setting), angles
- **Body Language & Facial Expression:** Show feelings without words
- **Editing:** Cuts, flashbacks, slow motion
- **Sound & Music:** Support visuals and mood

3. Common Language Devices (Both)

- **Metaphor:** Direct comparison → deeper meaning
- **Simile:** Comparison using "like/as"
- **Repetition:** Emphasis and urgency
- **Hyperbole:** Exaggeration for strong feelings
- **Rhetorical Questions:** Engage audience
- **Irony:** Opposite meaning for humor/contrast
- **Symbolism:** Represents deeper ideas
- **Imagery:** Creates mental pictures
- **Alliteration:** Repeated sounds → catchy
- **Tone & Mood:** Attitude and feeling
- **Colloquial Language:** Natural, informal speech
- **Dialogue Structure:** Short = tension; long = explanation

- **Flashback:** Past events
- **Suspense:** Builds curiosity

Foreshadowing: Hints about future **Key Idea:**

- Radio uses **sound techniques**
- TV uses **sound + visual techniques**
- Both use **language devices** to enhance meaning and emotion

Application activity 6.4.2



Oral presentation

1. Using ICT LAB, with the help of your teacher, listen to some episodes of Soap Opera "*Urunana*" and then, discuss its language devices used.

6.6. Performing Radio and Television Drama

Learning activity 6.6.1



Perform a short scene on the following simple situation and Use actions, facial expressions, and gestures

1. A student arrives late to school and meets the teacher
2. A family disagreement while looking for a certain problem solution

Performing Radio and Television Drama

1. Meaning

Performing drama is **acting out a story for an audience**.

- **Radio Drama:** Uses **voice, dialogue, narration, and sound effects** → audience **imagines** the story
- **TV Drama:** Uses **voice, body language, facial expressions, movement, props, and visuals** → audience **sees and hears**

Key Difference:

- Radio = **sound + imagination**
- TV = **sound + visuals**

How to Perform Radio Drama

- Understand script & character
- **Use voice** (tone, pitch, pace, volume)

- **Speak clearly** (descriptive dialogue)
- **Add sound effects (SFX)** for action
- **Use narration** (if needed)
- **Use pauses** for suspense
- **Rehearse** timing and coordination

How to Perform TV Drama

- Understand script & character
- Use natural voice & dialogue
- **Show emotions** (body language, facial expressions)
- Use props, costume, setting
- **Interact with others** naturally
- **Adjust to camera** (close-up = subtle, long shot = bigger actions)
- **Rehearse** lines, movement, timing

Key Idea:

- Radio focuses on voice **and sound**
- TV combines **voice, visuals, and movement**

Application activity 6.6.2



Read Act V of An Enemy of the People by Henrik Ibsen and perform it as a short class drama.

Instructions:

Form groups of **4–6** learners.

Read **Act V** carefully and understand the main events and characters.

Share roles among group members.

Practice your dialogue using clear voice and simple actions.

Perform the selected scene(s) before the class.

6.7. Language Focus: Language in different setting

Learning activity 6.7.1



Read the texts below and answer the questions the questions that follow.

Text 1

Judge (at the bench): "Order! The courtroom is in session. All rise for the jury."

Prosecutor: "Your Honor, the evidence, witness statements, and case files show the truth."

Defense Lawyer: "Objection! The bench must consider all facts carefully."

Witness (at the stand): "I saw him near the defendant's table."

Bailiff: "Please step forward to the witness stand."

The courtroom gallery murmurs as pens scratch notepads.

Judges and lawyers consult law books, while the clerk records everything.

Text 2

Sunlight shines through stained glass windows, lighting up the altar and sanctuary.

Priest (at the pulpit): "Blessed are the meek, for their hearts shall find peace."

The choir loft sings from the hymnals, voices echo in the nave.

Congregation (kneeling in the pews): "Amen... Amen..."

Candles flicker on the altar rail, and incense rises toward the ceiling.

Elder (at the lectern): "Let us pray for the sick and the lonely in this chapel."

The soft sound of the organ fills the church pews, bringing calm.

Text 3

Teacher (at the blackboard): "Open your textbooks to page ten in the classroom."

Student 1: "I don't understand this diagram on the board. Can you explain?"

Teacher: "Look carefully at the model and write in your notebooks."

The school bell rings, echoing through the corridors.

Students rush to the playground, laughing and chatting.

Student 2: "Ah! Now I get it!"

Backpacks slam, and sunlight fills the classroom walls.

Text 4

Seller 1: "Fresh fruits! Sweet mangoes at the fruit stall in the market!"

Buyer 1: "How much for a dozen?"

Seller 2: "Catch of the day! Fresh fish at the seafood stall!"

Buyer 2: "I'll take two kilos of rice from the grain stall."

The market lanes buzz with voices, carts rolling, and spices in the air.

Sunlight shines on produce baskets and metal scales, while the crowd haggles energetically.

Text 5

Nurse: "Doctor! Patient in room 3 of the emergency ward is critical!"

Doctor: "Prepare the ICU bed. Start the ventilator immediately."

Assistant: "Vitals are falling. The heart monitor is beeping."

Nurse: "IV drip ready. Administer medication now."

Footsteps echo in the hospital corridor, alarms beep, and the nurses' station is busy.

Doctors consult charts, check oxygen tanks, and move quickly through the wards.

Text 6

Anchor (in the news studio): "Good evening. Breaking story: the storm floods the city streets."

Reporter (on-site): "Trees fall across avenues, homes in neighborhoods are evacuated, emergency crews are active."

Anchor: "Citizens, follow public safety instructions and stay indoors."

Camera Crew: "Adjust the tripod, check the microphone, and focus the lens."

The control room buzzes with monitors and teleprompters, guiding the live broadcast.

Reporter: "Shelters are open for residents. Stay safe and alert, everyone in the city."

A. Comprehension questions

i. Matching questions

Dialogues	Settings
1. "Order! The courtroom is in session. All rise for the jury."	A. School
2. "Blessed are the meek, for their hearts shall find peace."	B. Hospital
3. "Open your textbooks to page ten in the classroom."	C. Market
4. "Fresh fruits! Sweet mangoes at the fruit stall in the market!"	D. Church
5. "Prepare the ICU bed. Start the ventilator immediately."	E. Courtroom

ii. Choose the option that is NOT matching (Word Recognition)

1. Courtroom setting A. Judge C. Jury 2. Church setting A. Blackboard C. Choir 3. School setting A. Ventilator C. Textbook	B. Altar D. Witness B. Pulpit D. Pew B. Classroom D. Notebook	4. Market setting A. Stall C. Mangoes 5. Hospital setting A. ICU C. Hymnal 6. News studio setting A. Anchor C. Tripod	B. Oxygen tank D. Fish B. Nurse D. IV drip B. Microphone D. Grain stall
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Language in Different Settings – General Notes

Have you ever noticed that people speak differently depending on where they are? The words we use in a **home, market, church, or hospital** are different because each place has its own purpose and rules. Learning to recognize these words helps us understand the **setting**, the **speaker**, and the **situation**, and also how to use **language in our daily life**.

1. Home / Family Language

- **Setting:** Home / Family
- **Key words:** Mom, dad, siblings, chores, homework, kitchen, living room, dinner, bedtime, greetings.
Example: "Mom, can you help me with my homework?"
"Don't forget to wash the dishes!"
- **Features:** Informal, friendly, casual, sometimes emotional.
- **Purpose:** To communicate, express feelings, build relationships, and manage family tasks.
- **Apply in daily life:** Speak **friendly, polite, and caring language** at home to maintain good relationships and help family members.

2. Courtroom Language

- **Setting:** Courtroom
- **Key words:** Judge, jury, evidence, witness stand, bench, prosecutor, defense lawyer, gallery, clerk.
- **Example:** "Order! The courtroom is in session. All rise for the jury."
- **Features:** Formal, precise, polite, serious.
- **Purpose:** To discuss legal matters, present evidence, and maintain order.
- **Apply in daily life:** Use **polite and respectful language** when discussing rules, explaining facts, or resolving conflicts.

3. Church Language

- **Setting:** Church / Chapel
- **Key words:** Altar, pulpit, pews, choir loft, hymnals, incense, candles, organ, lectern, sanctuary.

- **Example:** *"Blessed are the meek, for their hearts shall find peace."*
- **Features:** Calm, respectful, spiritual, formal.
- **Purpose:** Worship, prayer, guidance, and teaching religious values.
- **Apply in daily life:** Speak **respectfully and kindly**, especially in spiritual or serious settings.

4. School Language

- **Setting:** Classroom / School
- **Key words:** Teacher, blackboard, textbooks, notebooks, school bell, playground, corridors, student, diagram.
- **Example:** *"Open your textbooks to page ten in the classroom."*
- **Features:** Polite, instructive, interactive, educational.
- **Purpose:** To teach, explain, ask questions, and interact with classmates.
- **Apply in daily life:** Use **clear, polite, and instructional language** when helping others learn or giving instructions.

5. Market Language

- **Setting:** Market / Public Place
- **Key words:** Stall, seller, buyer, produce, carts, haggling, spices, lanes, catch of the day.
- **Example:** *"Fresh fruits! Sweet mangoes at the fruit stall in the market!"*
- **Features:** Informal, lively, persuasive, conversational.
- **Purpose:** To buy, sell, bargain, and socialize.
- **Apply in daily life:** Use **friendly, persuasive, and conversational language** when shopping, selling, or negotiating.

6. Hospital Language

- **Setting:** Hospital / Clinic
- **Key words:** Nurse, doctor, ICU bed, ventilator, heart monitor, emergency ward, IV drip, charts, wards.
- **Example:** *"Prepare the ICU bed. Start the ventilator immediately."*
- **Features:** Clear, formal, precise, urgent when necessary.
- **Purpose:** To give instructions, provide care, and report patient status.
- **Apply in daily life:** Use **clear, precise, and calm language** in emergencies or when giving instructions.

7. Media / Broadcast Language

- **Setting:** TV / Radio / News Studio
- **Key words:** Anchor, reporter, microphone, tripod, control room, monitors, live broadcast, teleprompters, emergency updates.

- **Example:** "Good evening. Breaking story: the storm floods the city streets."
- **Features:** Formal, semi-formal, conversational, informative.
- **Purpose:** To inform, educate, guide, and entertain the public.
- **Apply in daily life:** Speak **clearly, confidently, and informatively** when sharing important news or updates.

Bottom of Form

Application activity 6.7.2



Oral presentation

A. In your groups, choose from the places below and create a short literary dialogue (3–5 lines)

- a) Classroom / School
- b) Hospital / Clinic
- c) Market / Shop
- d) Home / Family gathering

Workplace / Office

B. In groups, perform the dialogue before the class, demonstrating a clear understanding of the characters, their emotions, and the conflict between them. Use appropriate voice modulation, gestures, and facial expressions to convey meaning effectively

C. After the performance, explain the choices you made in interpreting your characters and how these choices helped to convey the central conflict of the dialogue.

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



Read the extract below from *The Crucible* by Arthur Miller, Act 1, then answer all questions.

Extract — *The Crucible*, Act 1 (pp. 7–10) by Arthur Miller

Parris: Now look you, child, your punishment will come in its time. But if you trafficked with spirits in the forest I must know it now, for surely my enemies will, and they will ruin me with it.

Abigail: But we never conjured spirits.

Parris: Then why can she not move herself since midnight? This child is desperate! It must come out — my enemies will bring it out. Let me know what you done there.

Abigail, do you understand that I have many enemies?

Abigail: I have heard of it, uncle.

Parris: There is a faction that is sworn to drive me from my pulpit. Do you understand that? Now then, in the midst of such disruption, my own household is discovered to be the very center of some obscene practice. Abominations are done in the forest —

Abigail: It were sport, uncle!

Parris: (pointing at Betty): You call this sport? Abigail, if you know something that may help the doctor, for God's sake tell it to me. I saw Tituba waving her arms over the fire when I came on you. Why was she doing that? And I heard a screeching and gibberish coming from her mouth. She were swaying like a dumb beast over that fire!

Abigail: She always sings her Barbados songs, and we dance.

Parris: I cannot blink what I saw, Abigail, for my enemies will not blink it. I saw a dress lying on the grass. And I thought I saw — someone naked running through the trees!

Abigail: (in terror): No one was naked! You mistake yourself, uncle!

Parris: (with anger): I saw it! Now tell me true, Abigail. And I pray you feel the weight of truth upon you, for now my ministry's at stake, my ministry and perhaps your cousin's life. Whatever abomination you have done, give me all of it now.

Abigail: There is nothin' more. I swear it, uncle.

Mrs. Putnam: (entering, shiny-eyed): It is a marvel. It is surely a stroke of hell upon you. How high did she fly, how high?

Parris: No, no, she never flew —

Putnam: (looking down at Betty): Why, her eyes is closed! Look you, Ann.

Mrs. Putnam: (with vicious certainty): I'd not call it sick; the Devil's touch is heavier than sick. It's death drivin' into them, forked and hoofed. Her soul is taken, surely.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple choice questions

1. What is the main issue discussed in the extract?
A. A celebration in the village B. Suspicion of witchcraft and strange behavior
C. A family reunion D. A farming problem
2. Which character is most worried about his reputation in the community?
A. Abigail
B. Betty
C. Parris
D. Mrs. Putnam

3. What does the phrase “swaying like a dumb beast” mainly show?

- A. Happiness
B. Strength
C. Fear and strange behavior
D. Intelligence

ii. Open-ended questions

1. In your own words, summarise the extract and explain the central conflict or main idea it presents. Support your response with relevant details from the text. Name all the characters in this extract and describe the personality of any TWO of them, using evidence from the text.
2. Describe the mood of the characters in this extract. Support your answer with examples from the dialogue.

If this extract were performed as a radio drama, suggest THREE sound effects you would use and explain why each would be effective.

B. Fill in the Gaps

1. Two major themes found in *The Crucible* are _____ and _____. These themes are shown through events and characters in the play.
2. Themes in media drama are relevant to Rwandan society today because they address issues such as _____ and _____, helping people learn and reflect on real-life situations.
3. A _____ is a type of media drama that presents continuous stories focusing on everyday life and relationships. Its purpose is to _____ and _____ the audience.

Musekeweya communicates important social messages such as _____, _____, and _____, which remain important in promoting positive values in society today.

C. Answer TRUE or FALSE

No.	Statement	True / False
1	Radio drama relies on visual elements like costume and lighting to tell its story.	
2	A soap opera is a long-running drama focused on relationships between characters.	
3	In TV drama, the audience only hears and uses imagination to picture characters.	
4	Sound effects in radio drama help create the setting and sense of action.	
5	Narration is more commonly used in TV drama than in radio drama.	
6	Camera techniques such as close-ups are a feature of TV drama.	

D. Language skills

i. Make sentence of each term as used in radio and TV drama.

- i. Sound Effect (SFX)
- ii. Documentary drama
- iii. Camera technique

ii. Presentation task on exploring Language in Different Settings

1. Visit Different Settings: Choose at least **three** of the following places to visit:

- a) Market
- b) School
- c) Hospital or Clinic
- d) Church or Religious Gathering
- e) Bus Station / Taxi Park
- f) Courtroom
- g) Media (Radio or TV)

2. Listen and Record: At each place, **listen carefully to the way people speak**. Write down **at least 10 words or short phrases** used in Kinyarwanda and translate them into English. **Organize Your Findings:** Create a table like this for each setting:

Setting	10 Words	Meaning (Optional)
Market		
School		
Hospital		
Church		
Bus Station		
Courtroom		
Media		

2. Share with Classmates:

- a) Present your table in class.
- b) Explain how the language differs from one setting to another.
- c) Discuss interesting or new words you learned from your classmates' reports.

3. Reflection Questions (Optional):

Which setting had the most formal language?

Which words or phrases were surprising to you?

How does knowing the language used in different settings help you communicate better?

E. Project: Creative Writing & Oral Presentation

Instruction: Choose **ONE option only**. Your response should be **at least half a page of dialogue or script**.

OPTION A — Radio Drama Script

Write a **radio drama script** based on ONE of the following situations:

A community discovers that their water source is contaminated.

A teenager is pressured by friends to cheat in an examination.

Your script must include:

Character names

Dialogue

At least TWO sound effects (SFX)

At least ONE narration line

After submitting your script, prepare for an **oral presentation (performance practice)** in class.

OPTION B — TV Drama Scene

Write a **TV drama scene** based on ONE of the following situations:

A family is divided over an important decision affecting all members.

A community leader is confronted about a decision that harms the people.

Your scene must include:

Character names

Dialogue

Stage directions in brackets

A clear setting description

At least **ONE camera direction or lighting direction**

After submitting your script, prepare for an **oral presentation (performance practice)** in class.

UNIT 7

FORMS OF POETRY



Key Unit Competence:

To be able to analyze different forms of poetry by examining meaning, structure, rhyme, rhythm, syllable patterns, and themes while appreciating creativity and developing positive attitudes toward literary expression.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

- ✓ Identify the meaning and structure of short, structured poems (limerick, haiku, tanka), including rhyme schemes and syllable patterns.
- ✓ Explain the features of epigram, concrete poetry, and free verse, including the flexible structure of free verse.
- ✓ Analyze stylistic and grammatical variations in poetry and interpret their effects on meaning. (196)

Skills

2

- ✓ **Analyze** rhyme, rhythm, and syllable patterns and **compose** poems in structured forms.
- ✓ **Interpret** meaning and visual elements in poetry and **create** epigrams and concrete poems.
- ✓ Express ideas creatively in free verse and write and perform poems that highlight stylistic choices.

Attitudes and values

3

- ✓ **Appreciate** creativity, humor, simplicity, and artistic expression in different poetic forms.
- ✓ **Value** brevity, wit, freedom of expression, and diverse poetic styles, including storytelling and classical forms.
- ✓ Demonstrate confidence and respect for others' ideas while engaging with poetic structures, themes, rhyme, rhythm, and syllable patterns.

7.0 Introduction to the unit

Have you ever noticed how a few simple words can make you laugh, think deeply, or even create vivid images in your mind? Poetry is a powerful way of expressing ideas, emotions, and stories through creative language, rhythm, and structure. Some poems are short and playful, while others are longer and more emotional; some follow strict patterns, while others allow complete freedom of expression. In this unit, you will explore a variety of poetic forms, from structured poems like limericks, haiku, and tanka to more flexible forms such as free verse. You will discover how poets use rhyme, rhythm, syllables, and structure to create meaning, humor, and beauty, and how poetry can also be visual or storytelling in forms like concrete poems, epigrams, ballads, odes, and sonnets.

As you read and analyze different poems, you will develop an appreciation for creativity, humor, simplicity, and artistic expression. You will also build your own confidence by composing and performing poems, experimenting with language, and making intentional stylistic choices to shape meaning. By the end of this unit, you will not only understand different forms of poetry but also express your ideas clearly, value diverse styles and perspectives, and enjoy poetry as a meaningful part of everyday life.

Introductory activity



1) Observe the picture below and answer the following questions



Comprehension questions

1. What do you see in this picture? Write 5 short lines poem describing it.
2. Imagine , you are seated there. Which sounds might you hear?
3. How does it make you feel? Use senses (see, hear, feel, smell, touch). To describe those feelings?

7.1. Limerick

Learning activity 7.1.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions.



There was an Old Man with a beard,
Who said, It is just as I feared!
Two Owls and a Hen,
Four Larks and a Wren,
Have all built their nests in my beard!
Edward Lear (The "Father of Limericks")

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem about?
2. Describe the unique features that you notice in lines of this poem.
3. Identify and explain the poetic devices used in the poem.
4. What kind of poem do you think this poem is? Why?

A limerick: is a form of poetry consisting of five lines with a fixed rhyme scheme (AABBA) and a rhythmic pattern, usually used to express humorous, playful, or imaginative ideas.

Example:

There was a young man from Peru,
Who dreamed he was eating his shoe.
He woke with a fright
In the middle of the night
To find that his dream had come true!

2. Structure of a Limerick

- A limerick has a stanza with **five lines, no more, no less**.
- Made up of thirty-nine syllables in total. Its structure is 9-9-6-6-9.
- Lines **1, 2, and 5** are longer and usually rhyme with each other.
- Lines **3 and 4** are shorter and rhyme with each other.
- The general syllable pattern is often:
 - ✓ Lines 1, 2, 5 → 8–9 syllables
 - ✓ Lines 3, 4 → 5–6 syllables

Are often humorous/funny and sometimes obscene.

Visual pattern: A A B B A (rhyme scheme)

3. Rhymes in Limericks

- Rhymes make limericks catchy and fun to read aloud.
- The first, second, and fifth lines share one rhyme.
- The third and fourth lines share a different rhyme.

Example:

There was an Old Man with a beard (A)
Who said, It is just as I feared! (A)
Two Owls and a Hen, (B)
Four Larks and a Wren, (B)
Have all built their nests in my beard! (A)

4. Rhythm in Limericks

- Limericks often have a **bouncy, sing-song rhythm**.
- This rhythm is created by alternating stressed and unstressed syllables, giving a playful flow.

Example (stressed syllables in capitals): There WAS an OLD man WITH a BEARD
who SAID, it IS just AS I FEARED

5. Common Themes and Messages

- **Humor and silliness** – funny or absurd situations.
- **Exaggeration** – often impossible things happen (like birds nesting in a beard).
- **Characters** – usually one main character, often an old man, a young person, or an animal.
- **Lessons or warnings** – sometimes limericks include a small lesson, but mostly they entertain.

5. Common Themes and Messages

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- **Exaggeration** – often impossible things happen (like birds nesting in a beard).
- **Characters** – usually one main character, often an old man, a young person, or an animal.
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Example Themes:

- An unusual habit (e.g., eating shoes, building nests in a beard)
- Strange adventures (e.g., a man traveling somewhere weird)
- Playful observations of life or nature

Application activity 7.1.2



1. Read the poem below and answer the questions

There was a young lady from Niger,
Who smiled as she rode on a tiger.
They came back from the ride
With the lady inside,
And the smile on the face of the tiger.

Comprehension questions

1. Identify the main character in the poem and explain her role in the narrative.
2. Describe the setting of the poem using evidence from the text.
3. Identify the animal mentioned and explain its symbolic or narrative significance in the poem.
4. Explain what happens to the lady during the ride and how the situation changes.
5. Analyse the emotional tone suggested in the first line (the situation changes.e in the p
6. How many lines does the poem have, and what type of poem is it? Justify your answer.
7. Identify the rhyme scheme of the poem and give supporting evidence from the text.
8. Comment on the rhythm and line length in the poem. How do they contribute to its effect?
9. Explain why the ending is unexpected and identify the literary device used.
10. Analyse whether the poem is humorous. Support your answer with evidence from the poem.
11. What moral or implied message can be drawn from the poem? Explain your interpretation.

2. Language enrichment

Question: Match each word to its correct meaning.

Word	Meaning
1. Lady	A. A journey on the back of an animal
2. Niger	B. A large wild cat known for its stripes
3. Ride	C. A well-mannered or high-ranking woman
4. Tiger	D. A country located in West Africa
5. Smile	E. A happy facial expression showing pleasure

3.Oral presentation

Recite the poem in front of the class, showing clear understanding of its meaning, tone, and humour. Use appropriate voice modulation, rhythm, and expression to bring out the effect of the poem.

7.2 Haiku

Learning activity 7.2.1



Read the following poem and answer the following questions.

Old Pond (Haiku by Matsuo Bashō)

An old silent pond...

A frog jumps into the pond,
splash! Silence again.

Comprehension questions

1. Analyse the central idea of the poem and explain what moment it captures.
2. Identify the physical features of a haiku present in the poem and explain how they contribute to its meaning.
3. Break down the syllable pattern of each line and show how it follows the structure of a haiku.
4. Analyse the effect of sound and silence in the poem, particularly the word "splash!"
5. Recite the poem in class, using appropriate pauses and tone to reflect its mood and imagery.

1. Meaning of a Haiku

A **haiku** is a traditional Japanese form of poetry that expresses a **brief moment of experience**, often drawn from nature or human emotion. It is characterized by extreme brevity and simplicity, yet it conveys **deep meaning through suggestion rather than explanation**. Haikus aim to capture a fleeting impression, encouraging the reader to visualize, reflect, and interpret beyond the words on the page. **Example:**

An old silent pond
A frog jumps into the pond—
Splash! Silence again.

2. Structure of a Haiku

- A haiku has **3 lines** only.
- It follows a **syllable pattern**:

- Line 1 → **5 syllables/moras**
- Line 2 → **7 syllables**
- Line 3 → **5 syllable**

It contains 17 syllables in total.

- A Haiku poem does not rhyme.
- The poem has two juxtaposed subjects that are divided into two contrasting parts.
- Haikus are written on topics and things that the readers can identify with easily. For example, seasons and animals are readily recognizable topics to readers. Generally, haiku is written for realistic and objective reasons; however, haikus are also written for children

Sometimes it presents two juxtaposed ideas to express meanings through internal comparison

Pattern: 5 – 7 – 5 (Rhyme scheme)

3. Rhymes in Haiku

- **Haikus do not usually rhyme.**
- Instead of rhyme, they focus on **imagery and meaning**.

4. Rhythm in Haiku

- The rhythm is created by the **syllable count (5–7–5)**.

It has a **calm, natural flow**, not a bouncy rhythm like a limerick.

5. Common Themes and Messages

Haikus typically explore **brief yet meaningful human and natural experiences**, often capturing a moment of insight or reflection. Their themes are simple in subject matter but **rich in implication and emotional depth**.

Common thematic areas include:

- **Nature and the environment:** rain, trees, animals, landscapes, and natural phenomena, often used to reflect harmony or change in the world.
- **Seasons and cyclical time:** spring, summer, autumn, and winter, symbolizing change, growth, decay, and renewal.
- **Human emotions and fleeting moments:** feelings such as peace, sadness, joy, or silence, usually presented indirectly through imagery.
- **Everyday life observations:** ordinary scenes or actions that are transformed into moments of reflection or awareness.

Example Themes:

- A rainy day
- A bird flying
- The beauty of the sunset
- Quiet moments in nature

Application activity 7.2.2



Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow

Soft rain on the roof
Children whisper in their beds
Night sings quietly

A. Comprehension questions

1. Comprehension
2. What is falling on the roof?
3. Who is whispering?
4. Where are the children?
5. How many lines are in the poem?
6. Does the poem rhyme?
7. How many syllables are in the first line?
8. What feeling does the poem create?
9. Why do you think the children are whispering?

B. Language Enhancement

1. What does "night sings quietly" mean to you?
2. What time of day is suggested in the poem?

C. Oral Presentation

Compose your own haiku on a person, object, or moment of your choice. Present it orally in class, ensuring that your poem follows the correct 5–7–5 syllable structure and reflects a clear theme or emotion. During presentation, use appropriate pauses and tone to enhance meaning and imagery

7.3. Tanka

Learning activity 7.3.1



Read the following poem and answer the following questions.

I love my kitten
She is also little and cute
She has a pink tongue,
And lots of long whiskers too.
She purrs when I stroke her back

1. Analyse the central idea of the poem and explain what it reveals about the speaker's relationship with the kitten.
2. Identify the stylistic features used in the poem (such as imagery or descriptive language) and explain how they contribute to meaning.
3. Analyse the poet's stylistic features used in the poem (such as imagery or descriptive language) a
4. Examine the rhythm of the poem by counting the syllables in each line. What pattern do you notice, and what effect does it create?
5. Recite the poem in class, using appropriate tone and expression to reflect the speaker's emotions and affection.

1. Meaning of a Tanka

A **tanka** is a traditional Japanese poetic form that expresses **human emotions, reflections, or moments of lived experience**. It is an extension of the haiku, but slightly longer, allowing for a more developed expression of thought and feeling. Tanka poetry often explores **deep emotional states such as love, sadness, longing, or appreciation of nature**, moving from observation to personal reflection.

Example:

I love my kitten
 She is also little and cute
 She has a pink tongue,
 And lots of long whiskers too.
 She purrs when I stroke her back

2. Structure of a Tanka

- A tanka has **5 lines**.
- It follows a **syllable pattern**:
 - ✓ Line 1 → **5 syllables**
 - ✓ Line 2 → **7 syllables**
 - ✓ Line 3 → **5 syllables**
 - ✓ Line 4 → **7 syllables**
 - ✓ Line 5 → **7 syllables**
- The tanka is longer than the haiku. It has two additional lines that have seven syllables each. In total, it has 31 syllables. Its structure is 5-7-5-7-7.
- A tanka does not have end punctuation.
- The third line of the tanka acts like a pivot that divides the poem into two parts.

- The tanka uses imagery to convey its meaning. Remember, an imagery is a word that creates mental pictures. Examples include similes, metaphors and personification, though it could be any word that makes a reader smell, touch, hear, taste or see what the poet intends.

Pattern:(Rhyme scheme) 5 – 7 – 5 – 7 – 7

3. Rhymes in Tanka

- Tankas **do not usually rhyme**.
- They focus more on **meaning, imagery, and emotion** rather than rhyme.

4. Rhythm in Tanka

- The rhythm comes from the syllable pattern (5–7–5–7–7).
- It has a gentle, flowing rhythm, similar to natural speech.

5. Themes / Messages

Tanka poems often focus on:

- Nature (seasons, weather, landscapes)
- Love and relationships
- Feelings and emotions (joy, sadness, loneliness)
- Personal reflection
- Moments in everyday life

Key idea:

- The first three lines often describe a scene (like a haiku)
- The last two lines express a feeling or reflection about that scene

Application activity 7.3.2



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow:

The quiet evening
Leaves fall softly to the ground
Autumn whispers low
I remember days of joy
Now carried by the wind

A. Comprehension questions

1. What is happening in the first line of the poem?
2. What season is being described?
3. What images do you see in your mind when you read the poem?
4. Who do you think is speaking in the poem?

5. What does "leaves fall softly to the ground" suggest?
6. Why do you think the poet says "autumn whispers low"?
7. What feeling is created by the word "quiet"?
8. Which words in the poem appeal to your senses?
9. Do you think the poem is more happy or sad? Why?

Language enrichment

Match each word to its correct meaning.

Word	Meaning
1. Quiet	A. The season when leaves fall from trees
2. Softly	B. Gently and without much force or sound
3. Autumn	C. Peaceful and free from noise
4. Whispers	D. Speaks in a very low and soft voice

B. Oral Presentation

If you could change the ending of the poem, rewrite an alternative ending and present it to the class. Explain the reasons for your changes, showing how your ending affects the theme, mood, or message of the poem

7.4. Epigram

Learning activity 7.4.1



Read the statements below and answer the questions that follow

- a) There is only one thing in the world worse than being talked about, and that is not being talked about. (**Oscar Wilde**)
- b) Whatsoever ye do unto the least of these, my brethren, you do unto me.
(*Jesus Christ*)
- c) No one can make you feel inferior without your consent. (**Eleanor Roosevelt**)
- d) There are no small nations ...only small minds. (**King Leopold of Belgium**)

Comprehension questions

1. Describe your feelings after reading the statements.
2. What is the meaning of the statements above?
3. What name do we give to this kind of writing?
4. Read each line again carefully. What makes it interesting?

Meaning

An **epigram** is a brief, witty, and often satirical poetic statement that expresses a single idea in a **concise and striking manner**. It typically ends with a **surprising or thought-provoking twist**, designed to reveal a deeper truth, provoke reflection, or create humour through irony or contrast.

Structure

- Usually very short (1–4 lines)
- Simple and direct language
- Often ends with a punchline or unexpected idea
- Can be written as a complete sentence or a brief poem

Rhymes

- May rhyme, but not always
- If rhymes are used, they are usually simple and regular (e.g., AABB or ABAB)
- Some epigrams are written in prose without rhyme

Rhythms

- No strict rhythm rule
- Often uses a regular rhythm to sound smooth and memorable
- Sometimes uses balanced or parallel phrases for emphasis

Themes and Messages in Epigrams

Epigrams typically convey **concise insights about human experience**, often expressed with wit, irony, or paradox. Their themes are not merely stated; they are **sharply revealed through a brief, striking formulation**.

Common thematic concerns include:

- **Universal truths and wisdom:** reflections on life, morality, or human limitations, often expressed in a paradoxical or memorable way.
- **Human behaviour and character:** exposure of vanity, hypocrisy, ambition, or folly through ironic observation.
- **Love and relationships:** commentary on attraction, desire, or emotional contradictions, frequently with a witty or cynical tone.
- **Social criticism and satire:** critique of societal norms, institutions, or pretensions, often through indirect or humorous attack.
- **Humour and irony:** the use of contrast, understatement, or surprise to produce both amusement and reflection.

Example

"I can resist everything except temptation." Oscar Wilde

This epigram is witty and ironic because it contradicts itself in a clever way.

Application activity 7.4.2



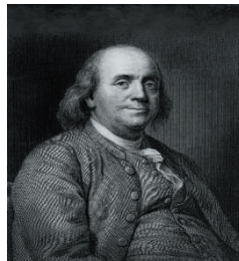
Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow:

The quiet evening
Leaves fall softly to the ground
Autumn whispers low
I remember days of joy
Now carried by the wind

In pairs, read the following epigrams and answer the questions that follow

a) Little strokes

Fell great oaks.



Ben Franklin

b) Whatever the mind can conceive and believe, the mind can achieve.



Napoleon Hill

c) This is the moment when we must come together to save this planet.

Let us resolve that we will not leave our children a world where the oceans rise and famine spreads and terrible storms devastate our lands.



Barack Obama

A. Comprehension questions

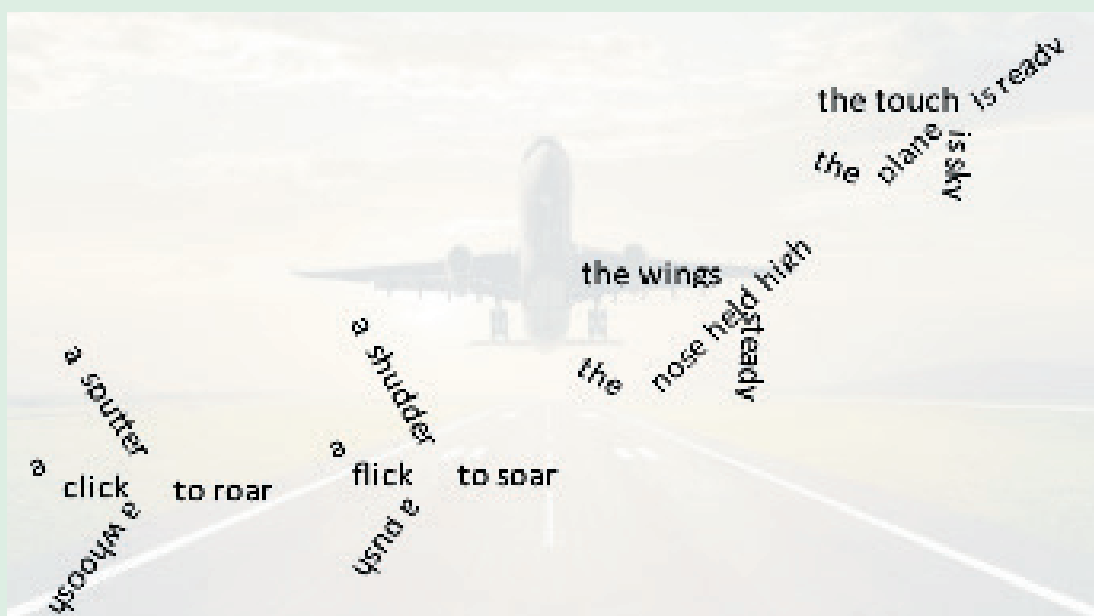
1. What do "little strokes" represent?
2. What are "great oaks" in real life?
3. What message is the writer giving about effort?
4. Can small actions really lead to big results? How?
5. What does "conceive" mean in this context?
6. Why is belief important in success?
7. Do you agree that thinking can lead to achievement?
8. Can you give an example from your life?
9. What issue is being talked about in this statement?
10. Why does the speaker say "we must come together"?
11. What dangers are mentioned in the epigram?
12. What message is given about responsibility for the future?

B. Oral Presentation

Compose your own epigram on a theme of your choice (e.g., life, love, or society). Your epigram should be brief, witty, and end with a striking or thought-provoking twist. Recite it in class, using appropriate tone and emphasis to highlight its meaning and effect.

7.5. Concrete poem

Learning activity 7.5.1



Comprehension questions

1. What do you see first: the words or the shape?
2. What is the poem about?
3. How does the shape connect to the meaning?
4. Explain why it is a unique poem

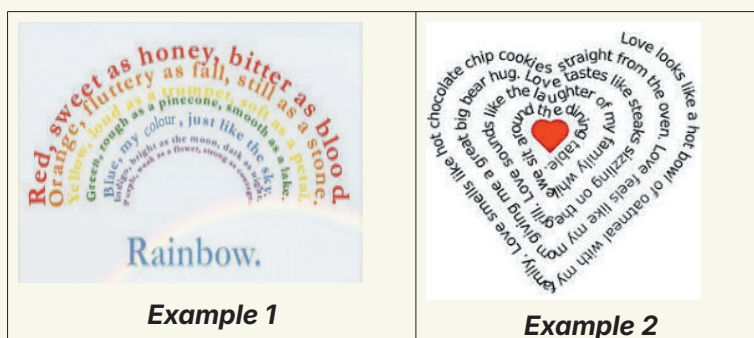
Meaning

A **concrete poem** (or **shape poem**) is a form of poetry in which the **visual arrangement of words on the page** creates a shape that reflects or reinforces the poem's subject. In this form, **layout and language function together**: meaning emerges not only from the words themselves, but also from their **spatial design**, which guides the reader's perception and interpretation.

Structure

- Words are arranged in a **visual shape** (e.g., tree, heart, star, rain).
- Lines may be **uneven** to fit the shape.
- It does not follow strict rules like other poems.
- The **layout is very important**.

Examples of concrete poems



Rhymes

- May **rhyme or not rhyme**.
- Rhyme is **not the main focus**.
- The focus is more on **visual appearance**.
- Rhythms
- Rhythm is usually **irregular**.
- It depends on how the words fit the shape.
- Some concrete poems may sound like normal poems, others may not.

Themes / Messages : Concrete poems often talk about:

- Nature (trees, rain, sun)
- Objects (house, car)

- Feelings (love, happiness)
- Everyday life

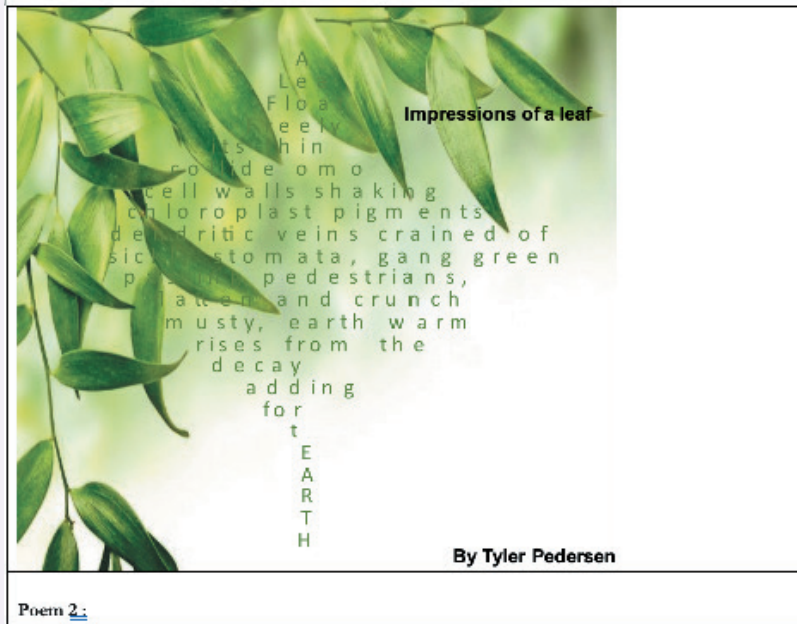
The shape helps to explain the message.

Application activity 7.5.2



Read the following poems and answer the questions

Poem1



A. Comprehension questions

1. What is the shape of the poem 1 and 2
2. How do the shapes of poem 1 and poem 2 relate to their meaning?
3. What is the message of the poem1 and 2
4. Describe the poet's mood.

B. Language enhancement

What do you think the poet wanted to mean by "This bottle will overthrow me one day"

C. Oral presentation

Recite the poem "*Impressions of a Leaf*", ensuring clear voice projection, correct pronunciation, proper rhythm, and appropriate expression.

7.6 Acrostic poem

Learning activity 7.6.1



Read the poems below and answer questions that follow.

Poem 1

Participate actively
Ask questions
Respect each other's ideas
Take turns
Never give up
Explain your answers
Respect others' answers
Stay with your partner(s)

Poem 2

Maybe this day is not
One of your favorites but
Never forget that every
Day you wake up is an
Amazing gift and it's up to
You to make it count

Comprehension questions

1. What do you notice when you observe the structure of the poems?
2. What is the meaning of Take turns in the first poem?
3. According to the first poem, discuss the qualities of a good learner.
4. What is the message of the above poems?
5. It's up to you to make your day count". Discuss what it means in the second poem.

ACROSTIC POEM

Meaning

An **acrostic poem** is a form of poetry in which the **initial letters of each line**, when read vertically, spell out a word, name, or message. This key word often reflects the **central theme or subject** of the poem.

Structure

- A **word or phrase is arranged vertically**, forming the backbone of the poem.
- Each letter of this word begins a **new line**.
- Each line **develops, describes, or reflects** an aspect of the central word.
- The structure is **highly organized**, but allows for **creative expression within constraints**.

Example 1. (LOVE):

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Example 2. (SCHOOL):

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Rhymes

- May rhyme or not rhyme.
- Rhyming is optional.
- Focus is on the **letters and meaning**, not rhyme.

Rhythms

- Usually **simple and natural**.
- No fixed rhythm pattern.
- Sounds like normal sentences or short poetic lines.

Themes / Messages

Acrostic poems often express:

- Personal ideas (name, feelings)
- People (friend, teacher)
- Places (school, country)
- Values (love, respect, peace)

Each line **adds meaning to the main word**.

SIMPLE DIFFERENCE of Concrete and Acrostic poem

Aspect	Concrete Poem (Shape Poem)	Acrostic Poem
Definition	A poem where the layout forms a visual shape related to the subject	A poem where the first letters of each line spell a word/ message vertically
Focus of Structure	Visual shape or image (e.g., tree, heart, star)	Hidden word or message through initial letters
Role of Form	Form visually represents meaning	Form organizes content around a key word
Reading Experience	Reader both sees and reads the poem	Reader mainly reads line by line, then notices the vertical word
Creativity Type	Combines visual design + language	Combines word choice + structured pattern
Flexibility	Flexible in wording, but constrained by shape design	Flexible in ideas, but constrained by starting letters
Example Idea	A poem about rain written in the shape of a raindrop	A poem about "HOPE" where each line begins with H-O-P-E
Feature	Concrete Poem	Acrostic Poem
Focus	Shape (picture)	Letters (vertical word)
Structure	Words form a shape	First letters form a word
Rhyme	Optional	Optional
Rhythm	Irregular	Simple
Main Idea	Visual meaning	Word meaning

Application activity 7.6.2



1. Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow:

Best Teacher

Bringing knowledge to every eager mind,
 Encouraging students never left behind,
 Sharing wisdom with patience every day,
 Teaching young hearts to find their own way,
 Trusting each learner to grow and to shine,
 Every lesson crafted with a design,
 Always ready with a kind word or smile,
 Challenging students to go the extra mile,
 Helping dreamers reach for the highest star,
 Empowering youth to become who they are,
 Remembering always how great teachers are.

A. Comprehension Questions

1. What qualities of a good teacher are mentioned in the poem?
2. What does the line *"Teaching young hearts to find their own way"* suggest about a good teacher's role?
3. How does the poet show that a good teacher cares about every student? Use evidence from the poem to support your answer.

B. Language enhancement

Match each word to its correct meaning.

Column A (Word)	Column B (Meaning)
1. Encouraging	A. Carefully made or created with skill
2. Wisdom	B. Making someone try harder or test their ability
3. Empowering	C. Giving someone strength and confidence to do something
4. Challenging	D. Knowledge and good judgment gained from experience
5. Crafted	E. Helping someone feel able and confident to take control of their actions

C. Creative & Oral presentation

1. Use the following words to compose your own acrostic poem

Peace b. leader c. Africa d. Parent e. best teacher f. your name g. your favorite day

Instructions:

- Write one acrostic poem for each word (or as instructed by your teacher).
- Each line of the poem should begin with the letters of the chosen word.
- Your poems should show meaningful ideas and creativity.
- **After writing, recite your poems** in class using a clear and loud voice.

7.7. Ballad

Learning activity 7.6.1



Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow.



The Cool Fountain

Cool fountain of love,
Where all the sweet birds come
For comforting – but one, A widow
turtledove, sadly sorrowing.
At once the nightingale,

That wicked bird, came by,
And spoke this honied words:
"My lady if you will,
I shall be your slave."
"You are my enemy:
Be gone, you are not true!
Green boughs no longer rest me.
Nor any budding grove.
Clear springs, where they are such,
Turn muddy at my touch.
I want no spouse to love
Nor any children either.
I forego that pressure
And their comfort too.
No, leave me; you are false
And wicked – vile, untrue!
I'll never be your mistress!
I'll never marry you!"

Comprehension questions

1. What is the main idea of the poem?
2. Find out the sweet words sung by the nightingale
3. What was the reply from the turtledove?
4. Describe the mood in the poem.
5. How is the title appropriate to the content of the poem?

Ballad

1. Meaning

A **ballad** is a form of **narrative poetry** that tells a story, often focusing on themes such as love, adventure, tragedy, or historical events. Traditionally, ballads were **oral compositions**, designed to be sung or recited, which explains their **simple, rhythmic, and memorable style**.

2. Structure and Features

- Ballads are typically written in **stanzas**, which organize the narrative into manageable units.
- They often include **dialogue**, allowing characters to speak directly and making the story more dramatic.
- A ballad presents a **clear narrative progression**—beginning, development (middle), and resolution (end).
- Many ballads use a **refrain** (a repeated line or phrase), which reinforces key ideas and enhances musicality.
- The most common form is the **quatrain** (four-line stanza), often with a regular rhythm and rhyme scheme.
- However, the structure is **flexible**, and some ballads may use:
 - ✓ couplets (two lines)
 - ✓ six-line stanzas
 - ✓ or irregular stanza patterns, depending on the narrative and stylistic intention

3. Rhymes

- Common rhyme schemes:
 - ✓ **ABCB** (most common)
 - ✓ ABAB
- Rhymes help create a musical effect

4. Rhythms

- Has a **regular, song-like rhythm**
- Often uses alternating:
 - ✓ 4 beats (stressed syllables)
 - ✓ 3 beats
- This makes it easy to **sing or recite**

5. Themes and Messages in Ballads

Ballads typically explore **human experiences through narrative**, presenting events and conflicts that reveal deeper meanings about life, society, and morality.

Common thematic concerns include:

- **Love and romance:** often portrayed in intense or tragic forms, highlighting loyalty, betrayal, or sacrifice.
- **Adventure and bravery:** stories of heroic actions, journeys, or challenges that test courage and determination.

- **Tragedy and death:** dramatic events involving loss, fate, or suffering, often used to evoke strong emotional responses.
- **Legends and historical events:** retelling of cultural stories, myths, or real events, preserving collective memory and identity.
- **Moral lessons:** implicit or explicit messages about right and wrong, often conveyed through the consequences of characters' actions.

Application activity 7.7.2



Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow

The Ballad of a Bachelor by Ellis Parker
Butler

Listen, ladies, while I sing

The ballad of John Henry King.

John Henry was a bachelor,
His age was thirty-three or four.

Two maids for his affection vied,
And each desired to be his bride,

And bravely did they strive to bring
Unto their feet John Henry King.

John Henry liked them both so well,
To save his life he could not tell.

Which he most wished to be his bride,
Nor was he able to decide.

Fair Kate was jolly, bright, and gay,
And sunny as a summer day;

Marie was kind, sedate, and sweet,
With gentle ways and manners neat.

Each was so dear that John confessed
He could not tell which he liked best.

He studied them for quite a year,
And still found no solution near,

And might have studied two years more
Had he not, walking on the shore,

Conceived a very simple way
Of ending his prolonged delay —

A way in which he might decide
Which of the maids should be his bride.

He said, "I'll toss into the air
A dollar, and I'll toss it fair;

If heads come up, I'll wed Marie;
 If tails, fair Kate my bride shall be."
 Then from his leather pocket-book
 A dollar bright and new he took;

He kissed one side for fair Marie,
 The other side for Kate kissed he.

Then in a manner free and fair
 He tossed the dollar in the air.

"Ye fates," he cried, "pray let this be
 A lucky throw indeed for me!"

The dollar rose; the dollar fell;
 He watched its whirling transit well,

And of some twenty yards or more
 The dollar fell upon the shore.

John Henry ran to where it struck
 To see which maiden was in luck.

But, oh, the irony of fate!
 Upon its edge the coin stood straight!

And there, embedded in the sand,
 John Henry let the dollar stand!

And he will tempt his fate no more,
 But live and die a bachelor.

Thus, ladies, you have heard me sing
 The ballad of John Henry King.

1. Comprehension Questions: "The Ballad of a Bachelor" by Ellis Parker Butler

1. Who is the main character in the poem, and what situation does he face?
2. Who are the two women involved in John Henry Kingtuation da?
3. How are the two women characterized in the poem? Support your answer with evidence.
4. What does the poem suggest about John Henryoem? Support your answer wit
5. How does John Henry attempt to make his decision, and what unexpected outcome occurs?
6. What does the coin landing on its edge symbolize in the poem?
7. What is the tone of the poem? Support your answer with textual evidence.
8. Identify and explain the central theme(s) of the poem.
9. Do you agree with John Henrytral theme(s) of the ptify your answer logically.
10. What moral lesson does the poem communicate to readers?
11. What type of poem is this? Describe its structure and rhyme scheme

2. Language enhancement

Find two examples of descriptive language used to contrast Kate and Marie.

3. Oral presentation

In a short oral presentation, explain why people sometimes find it difficult to choose between two good options. Refer to John Henry King in the poem you studied to support your explanation. Illustrate your ideas with examples from everyday life or personal experience.

7.8 Ode

Learning activity 7.8.1



Read carefully the poem below and answer the questions that follow.

Ode to a Rainy Day

Pitter patter- what's the matter?
Can't go out and play?
Pitter patter – get your madder –
Hate this rainy day;
Thunder, lightning – it's so frightening!
Let's go run and hide,
Find a place that's warm and cozy
– Leave the storm outsider;
Splish splash – lightning flash!
Between the drops of rain,
Tumbling like a waterfall
Down the window pane;
Something sort of comforting
Listening to the rain-
Pitter patter, skitter skatter -
Like my thoughts today
Washing out the cobwebs
Is refreshing- let's go play

By Linda Ori

Questions

1. Identify the main idea in the poem.
2. Describe the mood/atmosphere in the poem.
3. With examples, analyze the poetic devices in this poem and the effect they create.
4. Recite the poem above with a clear voice?

Ode

1. Meaning

An ode is a type of lyric poem that expresses deep admiration, praise, or reflection on a person, object, idea, or event. It celebrates something the poet values highly and often explores its emotional or philosophical significance.

2. Structure

Odes are characterized by the following features:

- They are usually written in stanzas (groups of lines)
- They focus on a single subject or idea
- They use formal, elevated, and expressive language
- They often include direct address to the subject (for example, "O...")
- They are descriptive, reflective, and emotionally rich
- Some odes include repetition or a refrain for emphasis
- There is no fixed stanza length or rigid structure

Unlike ballads, which tell a story in a simple narrative form, odes are mainly **lyrical and reflective**, focusing on emotional expression rather than storytelling.

3. Rhymes

- Odes **may rhyme** or **may not rhyme**
- When rhymes are used, they are often **regular and musical**
- Common rhyme schemes: **ABAB, AAB**, or free rhyme

4. Rhythms

- Odes often have a **flowing, musical rhythm**
- Can be **sing-song or lyrical**
- The rhythm adds to the **emotional impact** of the poem

5. Themes / Messages

Odes usually explore:

- **Admiration or praise** (for people, objects, ideas)
- Love and affection
- Nature and beauty
- Achievements or greatness
- Emotions or moral ideas

Example

- O sun, you rise with golden light,
You chase away the endless night.
Your warmth awakens every flower,
And fills the world with gentle power.

Application activity 7.8.2



1. Read carefully the following poem before answering the questions that follow

Ode to Ethiopia by Paul Laurence Dunbar (1872-1906)

O Mother Race! to thee I bring
This pledge of faith unwavering,
This tribute to thy glory.
I know the pangs which thou didst feel,
When Slavery crushed thee with its heel,
With thy dear blood all gory.

Sad days were those -- ah, sad indeed!
But through the land the fruitful seed
of better times was growing.
The plant of freedom upward sprung,
And spread its leaves so fresh and young --
Its blossoms now are blowing.

On every hand in this fair land, proud Ethiopia's swarthy children stand
Beside their fairer neighbor;

The forests flee before their stroke, their hammers ring, their forges smoke, they
stir in honest labour.

They tread the fields where honour calls;

Their voices sound through senate halls

In majesty and power.

To right they cling; the hymns they sing

Up to the skies in beauty ring,

And bolder grow each hour.

Be proud, my Race, in mind and soul;
Thy name is writ on Glory's scroll
In characters of fire.
High 'mid the clouds of Fame's bright sky

Thy banner's blazoned folds now fly,
And truth shall lift them higher.
Thou hast the right to noble pride,
Whose spotless robes were purified
By blood's severe baptism.
Upon thy brow the cross was laid,
And labour's painful sweat-beads made
A consecrating chrism.

No other race, or white or black,
When bound as thou wert, to the rack,
So seldom stooped to grieving;
No other race, when free again,
Forgot the past and proved them men
So noble in forgiving.

Go on and up! Our souls and eyes
Shall follow thy continuous rise;
Our ears shall list thy story
From bards who from thy root shall spring,
And proudly tune their lyres to sing
Of Ethiopia's glory.

A. Comprehension questions

1. What is the subject matter of the poem?
2. With examples, describe the mood and feeling in the poem.
3. According to the poem, what do you think the poet refers to as "Mother race..." Why?
4. Describe the attitude of the poet about Ethiopia.

B. Language enhancement:

Match each word to its correct meaning.

Word	Meaning
1. Unwavering	A. Solemn dedication or commitment to a cause
2. Tribute	B. Declared or displayed in a showy and bold way
3. Pledge	C. Steady and firm without any doubt or hesitation
4. Pangs	D. An expression of respect and admiration offered to someone
5. Gory	E. Sudden sharp feelings of pain or distress
6. Swarthy	F. Covered in blood in a disturbing way
7. Forges	G. Having a dark or olive-toned complexion
8. Blazoned	H. Places where metal is heated and shaped by a blacksmith
9. Consecrating	I. Making something sacred or holy through a ritual
10. Chrism	J. Holy oil used in religious ceremonies and blessings

C.Oral presentation

Compose your own Ode of between 10 to 15 lines and recite it in front of the class.

7.9 Sonnet

Learning activity 7.9.1



Read the poems below and answer the questions that follow

The Negro's Tragedy

It is the Negro's tragedy I feel
Which binds me like a heavy iron chain
It is the Negro's wounds I want to heal
Because I know the keenness of his pain
Only a thorn-crowned Negro and no white
Can penetrate into the Negro's ken
Or feel the thickness of the shroud of night
Which hides and buries him from other men
So what I write is urged out of my blood
There is no white who could write my book
Though many think their story should be told

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem about?
2. How many lines does it have?
3. How is the rhyme scheme?
4. Study the form/structure of 2 poems above and list down the characteristics they both share in common?

Meaning

A sonnet is a highly structured poem consisting of 14 lines, typically written in regular rhythm and rhyme. It is often used to express deep emotions, reflections, or philosophical ideas, especially themes such as love, beauty, time, and mortality.

2. Types of Sonnets

(a) Shakespearean (English) Sonnet

The Shakespearean sonnet is composed of:

- Three quatrains (four-line stanzas each)
- One final rhyming couplet (two lines)

Its rhyme scheme is: **abab cdcd efef gg**

(b) Petrarchan (Italian) Sonnet

The Petrarchan sonnet is divided into:

- An octave (8 lines)
- A sestet (6 lines)

Its rhyme scheme is usually:

- Octave: **abba abba**
- Sestet: **cdecde** or **cdcdcd**

3. Examples

- The poem *The Negro's Tragedy* follows the Shakespearean rhyme scheme: **abab cdcd efef gg**, making it a Shakespearean sonnet.
- The poem *In Some Ways* follows the Petrarchan structure: **abba abba cdecde**, making it a Petrarchan sonnet.

4. Structural Features of a Sonnet

- It always contains 14 lines
- It follows a fixed rhyme scheme depending on its type
- It is divided into meaningful structural units (quatrains, octave, sestet, or couplet)
- It often develops a problem–solution or argument–resolution pattern

b) Petrarchan (Italian) Sonnet

- It consists of 14 lines divided into:
 - ✓ An octave (8 lines)
 - ✓ A sestet (6 lines)
- The octave typically presents a problem, situation, or emotional conflict, while the sestet provides a resolution, response, or reflective commentary.
- This shift is known as the *volta* (turn).
- It is usually written in **iambic pentameter**, meaning each line contains approximately 10 syllables arranged in a pattern of unstressed and stressed syllables:
da-DUM da-DUM da-DUM da-DUM da-DUM

3. Rhymes

- Shakespearean Sonnet: **ABAB CDCD EFEF GG**
- Petrarchan Sonnet: **ABBAABBA** (octave) + **CDECDE** or **CDCDCD** (sestet)

4. Rhythms

- Uses **iambic pentameter**: 10 syllables per line, alternating unstressed and stressed syllables
- This creates a **musical, flowing rhythm**

Example of iambic pentameter:

"Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?"

5. Themes / Messages

Sonnets often explore:

- Love and romance
- Beauty and admiration
- Time and mortality
- Nature
- Philosophical or moral reflections

Application activity 7.9.2



Read the poems below and answer the questions that follow.

Sonnet 130 by William Shakespeare

My mistress' eyes are nothing like the sun;

Coral is far more red than her lips' red;

If snow be white, why her breasts are **dun**;

If hairs be wires, black wires grow on her head.

I have seen roses **damasked**, red and white,

But no such roses see I in her cheeks, And in some perfumes is there more delight
That from my mistress **reeks**.

I love to hear her speak, yet well I know

That music hath a far more pleasing sound.

I grant I never saw a goddess go;

My mistress when she walks treads on the ground. And yet, by heaven, I think my
love as rare As any as she **belied** with false compare.

(Adapted from Wikipedia)

A. Comprehension Questions

- Write down the rhyme scheme of the poem.
- With reasons, say whether this is a Shakespearean sonnet or a Petrarchan.
- Give the words that have been used to describe the persona's mistress.
- Do you agree with the persona's description of his mistress? Give reasons for your answer.
- What is strange in the persona's feeling towards his mistress?
- What is the message in the poem?

B. Language enrichment

Match each word to its correct meaning.

Word	Meaning
1. Mistress	A. A dull greyish or brownish color.
2. Coral	B. Patterned with intertwined colors like a woven fabric.
3. Dun	C. A woman who is the object of someone's love.
4. Damasked	D. A hard reddish pink material found in the sea.
5. Reeks	E. Gives off a strong or unpleasant smell.
6. Grant	F. Unusual and exceptionally valuable or special.
7. Goddess	G. To admit or acknowledge that something is true.

8. Treads	H. A divine female being of great beauty and power.
9. Rare	I. Walks heavily or firmly on a surface.
10. Belied	J. Gave a false or misleading impression of something.

C. Oral Presentation

Prepare and deliver a short oral presentation of the poem studied in class. Your recitation should demonstrate clear pronunciation, appropriate intonation, and understanding of the poem's meaning.

D. Creative Writing

Compose your own sonnet on the theme of love. Your poem should:

- consist of 14 lines
- follow an appropriate rhyme scheme (Shakespearean or Petrarchan)
- reflect a clear theme or message

7.10 Free Verse

Learning activity 7.10.1



Read the following poems and answer the questions that follow

I WISH I WERE A POET

If I were a poet I would set a target,
For all poets to be like the prophets of old,
Fighting for the much-desired freedom.

Since I have friends with a poetic spirit
For sure we shall succeed and remove limits
That hinder our communal development.

Poetry is a genuine and pure cure
That provides a place where we can hide and feel secure
And also find space to work and become mature.

Brothers and our seniors should let no one
Call us foolish juniors
Let us express our minds;
We do not need any supervisor!

If I were a poet I would write for my countrymen
Encouraging them to rebuild their broken hearts
And to unburden and relax their minds.

By AMIZERO Theogene

From "A Country of A Thousand Hills "

Comprehension Questions

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Who is the speaker in the poem?

- A. A king speaking to his people B. A teacher giving instructions
C. A poet expressing personal ideas D. A soldier telling a story

2. What does the speaker wish to become?

- A. A famous politician B. A successful poet C. A wealthy businessman
D. A school head teacher

3. According to the poem, what is the purpose of poetry?

- A. To entertain only B. To pass time during leisure C. To decorate books
D. To heal, inspire, and express truth

4. Who are the people the poet wants to inspire or write for?

B. Open ended questions

1. How does the poet connect poetry to the development of the community?
2. If you were a poet, what message would you want to share?
3. Do you think poetry can help people express their feelings or solve problems? Why?
4. Which stanza do you like the most and why?
5. How does this poem make you feel about the power of words?
6. Can you relate to the poet's desire to express yourself freely?

Free Verse

1. Meaning

Free verse is a form of poetry that does not follow a fixed rhyme scheme, regular meter, or traditional stanza pattern. Instead of relying on strict structural rules, it allows the poet to organize language freely in order to reflect natural speech, emotion, and meaning.

2. Structure

- Free verse has no fixed number of lines or stanzas
- Line length varies according to emphasis, rhythm, or meaning
- Line breaks, spacing, and punctuation are used deliberately to shape tone and pause
- It often relies on imagery, repetition, symbolism, and figurative language
- The rhythm is flexible and usually follows the natural flow of speech rather than a fixed metrical pattern

Although free verse does not follow traditional rules, it is not unstructured. Its form is carefully shaped by the poet to enhance meaning, emotion, and reader interpretation.

3. Rhymes

- **Usually does not rhyme**, but the poet may choose to include rhymes occasionally
- The focus is on **natural rhythm and meaning**, not rhyme

4. Rhythms

- No regular meter; rhythm comes from:
 - ✓ Word choice
 - ✓ Punctuation and line breaks
 - ✓ **Sound patterns** (alliteration, assonance, consonance)

This creates a **natural, speech-like flow**

5. Themes / Messages

Free verse can explore **any theme**, such as:

- Nature and the environment
- Personal feelings and emotions
- Life experiences and events
- Social or political issues
- Philosophical or reflective thoughts

Application activity 7.10.2



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

My island is in need of a poem

My island is in need of a poem
Yes! Another poem for a poet to recite
But now in everyone's sight ...
While we're peacefully seated at home
My island is in need of a poem
Not to make children scatter again ...
But to let them feel at home
And recognize our island's vision
To get ready for their own mission

My island is in need of a poem
A long narrative but different poem
Telling a story on our peace tunnel
Evoking the hard-works of their hands-
A good way to get it strongly secured
My island is in need of a poem
A poem to relocate our broken hope
Out of a gloomy valley, where rested
That wounding streaming tears
This takes roots from our downfalls.

by **Jean de Dieu BAVUGEMPORE**

From A Country of A Thousand Hills

A. Comprehension questions

1. Does the poem follow a fixed stanza pattern or line structure? Explain your answer.
2. What do you notice about the length and arrangement of the lines in the poem?
3. How does the poet use structural freedom (line breaks, spacing, repetition) to express meaning?
4. Identify and explain the effect of repetition in the poem (especially the line "*My island is in need of a poem*").
5. What images or mental pictures are created in the poem? Explain their significance.
6. What is the central message or theme of the poem?
7. According to the poem, what do "the island" and "a poem" symbolize?
8. Do you think the poet's use of free verse is effective in communicating the message? Justify your answer.

B. Language enhancement

In a few sentences, summarize the poem, highlighting its main ideas rather than retelling it line by line.

C. Oral presentation

In an oral presentation, identify the line or lines of the poem that appeal to you most, and explain why they are significant to you.

7.11. Language Focus: Grammatical, spelling, and intentional stylistic mistakes in poetry and their effects

Learning activity 7.11.1



Read the following statements and answer the following questions

Poem 1

If I Were a Mother

If I were a mother,
I would never allow,
Never allow daughters to:
Wear mini-skirts as if they were babies
Wear tight dresses through
which their contours can be counted!
I would neither allow them:
'Cook' their hair,
Cooked hair resembles that of a drowned rat!
Nor allow them tan their lips
Tanned lips poison food!

I would beseech them to avoid being murderesses,
I would tell them every innocent unborn child must live.
I would teach them about the pride of being a mother,
The African mother who proudly straps her baby on her back.

Fidel C. Nkurunziza

Poem 2

Wisdom
Unlike fools,
the wise never bother about
when the days barricade their ways
and plot with nyamunsi – death
to steal their breath.
What worries the wise

Is the image they will leave behind
When Nyamunsi lulls them into a
Once and for all sleep!

Sylvestre Ntabajyana

(Adopted from Mugumya Amooti, R. ed. [2016] Maiden Poems from East Africa.
Kigali-Rwanda: Excel Education Partners.)

Comprehension questions

1. Who is the speaker in **Poem 1**, and what role does she imagine herself to have?
2. Mention **two things** the speaker in **Poem 1** would not allow her daughters to do.
3. What message does the speaker give about unborn children in **Poem 1**?
4. What image of motherhood is presented in the last lines of **Poem 1**?
5. Who are contrasted with the wise in **Poem 2**?
6. What does the phrase "**days barricade their ways**" suggest in **Poem 2**?
7. What does "**Nyamunsi**" represent in **Poem 2**?
8. Compare Poem 1 and Poem 2 in terms of their main message.
9. Identify words/ phrases or lines used in the poems above that do not follow normal grammar rules but still make sense?
10. Why do you think poets sometimes break grammar or spelling rules when writing poems. Give evidence from the poems given above?

1. Meaning

In poetry, writers sometimes **break normal grammar, spelling, or punctuation rules on purpose**.

These are not always errors—they are **intentional stylistic choices** used to create meaning, emotion, emphasis, or rhythm.

Examples from the poems show that poets **do not always follow standard English**, but this helps express ideas strongly.

2. Grammatical "Mistakes" in Poetry

These include:

- Sentence fragments
- Missing words
- Unusual word order
- Incorrect verb forms

Examples from Poem 1: *If I Were a Mother* (by Fidel C. Nkurunziza)

Example 1: "Never allow daughters to:"

Explanation:

The sentence ends with **"to"** without a verb immediately following.
This is grammatically incomplete.

- Effect:**
- Creates **emphasis**
 - Builds **suspense** before listing actions
 - Draws attention to what follows

Example 2: "Nor allow them tan their lips"

Explanation: The word **"to"** is missing.

Correct English: "Nor allow them to tan their lips."

- Effect:**
- Maintains rhythm ,
 - Makes the line shorter and stronger

Example 3: "The African mother who proudly straps her baby on her back."

Explanation: This is a sentence fragment (no main verb).

- Effect:**
- Emphasizes the image of the African mother
 - Makes the line more descriptive and memorable

3. Spelling "Mistakes" in Poetry

Poets may change spelling intentionally to reflect speech or create style.

Examples from Poem 1

Example: 'Cook' their hair

Explanation: The word **"cook"** is used instead of **"perm"** or **"process."**
This reflects **informal or local speech**.

- Effect:**
- Shows **cultural influence**
 - Makes language sound **natural and familiar**

4. Intentional Stylistic Deviations

These include:

- Lack of punctuation
- Repetition
- Unusual capitalization

- Use of local or symbolic words

Examples from Poem 2: *Wisdom* (by Sylvestre Ntabajyana)

Example 1: "when the days barricade their ways"

Explanation: The word "barricade" is usually used for physical objects, but here it describes days blocking people's progress.

Effect:

- Creates **strong imagery**
- Shows life difficulties as obstacles

Example 2: "Nyamunsi – death"

Explanation: **Nyamunsi** is a local word meaning **death**.

Effect:

- Shows **cultural identity**

Makes the poem feel **African and traditional**

Example 3: "Once and for all sleep!"

Explanation: Sleep is used to mean death.

Effect:

- Creates metaphor
- Makes death sound softer and symbolic

5. Why Poets Use These "Mistakes"

Poets break language rules to:

- Express strong emotions
- Create rhythm and musicality
- Sound natural or conversational
- Emphasize important ideas
- Show cultural identity

Application activity 7.11.2



Read the following Poems and answer questions that follow

Poem 1

I, Too

I, too, sing America.

I am the darker brother.

They send me to eat in the kitchen

When company comes,

But I laugh,

And eat well,

And grow strong.

Poem 2

The Tyger

Tyger Tyger, burning bright,

In the forests of the night;

What immortal hand or eye,

Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

In what distant deeps or skies.

Burnt the fire of thine eyes?

On what wings dare he aspire?

What the hand, dare seize the fire?

And what shoulder, & what art,

Could twist the sinews of thy heart?

And when thy heart began to beat.

What dread hand? & what dread feet?

Tomorrow,

I'll be at the table

When company comes.

Nobody'll dare

Say to me,

"Eat in the kitchen,"

Then.

Besides,

They'll see how beautiful I am

And be ashamed—

I, too, am America.

By Langston Hughes

What the hammer? what the chain,

In what furnace was thy brain?

What the anvil? what dread grasp.

Dare its deadly terrors clasp?

When the stars threw down their spears

And water'd heaven with their tears:

Did he smile his work to see?

Did he who made the Lamb make thee?

Tyger Tyger burning bright,

In the forests of the night:

What immortal hand or eye,

Dare frame thy fearful symmetry?

By William Blake

A. Comprehension of Poems

i. Multiple Choice Questions

1. **What does the speaker mean by "I, too, sing America"?**
A. He wants to become a musician B. He feels he belongs to America
C. He dislikes his country D. He plans to leave America
2. **In the poem *The Tyger*, the tiger mainly symbolizes:**
A. A gentle animal to take care of B. A natural disaster, very deadly
C. Power and mystery of creation D. A pet animal
3. **What happens to the speaker in *I, Too* when visitors come?**
A. He is sent outside B. He hides himself in the kitchen
C. He is sent to eat in the kitchen D. He welcomes the guests to the kitchen

B. Answer True or False

1. The speaker in *I, Too* believes that one day he will be accepted equally.
2. The tiger in *The Tyger* is described as weak and harmless.
3. In *The Tyger*, the poet asks questions about who created the tiger
4. The poem *I, Too* shows feelings of fear and defeat.

C. Open-ended questions

1. Identify grammatical or stylistic deviations from either poem and explain its effect.
2. Explain how repetition is used in "Tyger Tyger, burning bright" and its effect on the reader.
3. Explain how the speaker in *I, Too* shows hope for the future.
4. Describe one metaphor or symbolic expression used in *The Tyger* and explain its meaning.

D. Oral Presentation

i. Recitation

Recite one of the following poems: *I, Too* or *The Tyger*. During your recitation, demonstrate and explain the following literary elements:

- The tone of the poem
- The mood created in the poem
- The rhythm and sound patterns as reflected in your reading

ii. Composition and Presentation

If you wish to express an interesting idea or topic through poetry, explain how the use of *poetic licence* can help you communicate your message effectively.

In your composition, discuss how poetic licence allows a poet to:

- express ideas creatively
- bend or break language rules for effect
- enhance meaning, emotion, and imagery

Submit it to your teacher, then present your ideas orally to the class.

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



Read **Poem 1**, **Poem 2**, and **Poem 3** carefully before answering the questions. Answer all questions clearly and support your responses with evidence where required.

Poem 1

There was a young man from the town,
Who always wore a big frown.
He tripped on a cat,
Then sat on his hat,
And his trousers fell down
with a crown!

Poem 2

Morning light breaks through,
A bird sings on the wet branch,
The world wakes in peace.

Poem 3

Sonnet 18 by William Shakespeare

Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?
Thou art more lovely and more temperate.
Rough winds do shake the darling buds of May,
And summer's lease hath all too short a date.

Sometime too hot the eye of heaven shines,
And often is his gold complexion dimmed;
And every fair from fair sometime declines,
By chance, or nature's changing course, untrimmed;

But thy eternal summer shall not fade,
Nor lose possession of that fair thou ow'st,
Nor shall death brag thou wand'rest in his shade,
When in eternal lines to Time thou grow'st.
So long as men can breathe, or eyes can see,
So long lives this, and this gives life to thee.

A. Comprehension questions

i. Multiple Choice Questions

Choose the most appropriate answer.

1. The humorous effect in Poem 1 reflects a characteristic feature of which poetic form?
A. Ode
B. Limerick
C. Ballad
D. Free verse
2. The short structure of Poem 2 mainly demonstrates the influence of which poetic tradition?
A. Haiku poetry
B. Narrative poetry
C. Dramatic poetry
D. Epic poetry
3. The structural design of Poem 3 best represents which poetic form?
A. Ballad
B. Epigram
C. Sonnet
D. Tanka
4. Which poetic form studied in this unit is most closely associated with storytelling through song-like narration?
A. Free verse
B. Ode
C. Ballad
D. Acrostic
5. A poem that expresses strong admiration toward a person, object, or idea belongs to which poetic type?
A. Ode
B. Limerick
C. Epigram
D. Concrete poem

ii. Open-ended Questions

1. Compare Poem 1 and Poem 3 in terms of purpose and tone. Give clear differences, using examples from the poems.
2. Analyze how imagery is used in Poem 2 to create mood. Support your answer with words or phrases from the poem.
3. Explain how the poet in Poem 3 uses figurative language to express the idea of lasting beauty or love.
4. Identify ONE structural difference between a tanka and a haiku, and explain how this difference affects meaning or expression.

B. Answer True or False

1. A tanka poem contains five lines arranged in a 5–7–5–7–7 syllable pattern.
2. An epigram is usually a long narrative poem.
3. A concrete poem forms a visual shape that relates to its subject.
4. A free verse poem does not follow a fixed rhyme scheme.
5. A ballad commonly includes repetition and dialogue.
6. An acrostic poem hides meaning through rhyme instead of letters.

7. A sonnet traditionally consists of fourteen lines.
8. An ode expresses strong feelings of admiration or praise.

C. Fill In the gaps

1. A poem that forms a picture or shape related to its meaning is called a _____ poem.
2. A short witty poem that expresses a clever idea is called an _____.
3. A poem that tells a story, often involving dramatic events, is called a _____.
4. The arrangement of sounds at the end of lines in poetry is called _____.
5. A poem written without fixed rhyme or rhythm is called _____ verse.
6. A poem in which the first letters of lines spell a word is called an _____ poem.
7. The syllable pattern **5-7-5** is most commonly associated with a _____.

D. Language Focus: Poetic Language And Style

Read the lines below carefully.

Line A: "luv is real, it hurts but heals"

Line B: "And bravely did they strive to bring
Unto their feet John Henry King."

Line C: "run run run no stopping now the night is long".

1. Identify the spelling variation used in **Line A** and explain why a poet might deliberately use such spelling.
2. In **Line B**, explain how the poet has altered the normal word order.
3. Discuss the effect of this altered word order on rhythm or emphasis.
4. Identify **TWO stylistic techniques** used in **Line C**.
5. Explain how repetition in **Line C** contributes to the meaning or emotional impact of the line.
6. Give **TWO reasons** why poets sometimes break grammar or punctuation rules.

V. PROJECT: CREATIVE WRITING AND ORAL PRESENTATION

Choose **ONE** task.

Task 1: Acrostic Poem

Write an **acrostic poem** using the word:

POETRY

Requirements:

- Each line must begin with the correct letter
- The poem must express meaningful ideas about poetry
- Use imagery or figurative language
- Maintain clear thematic development

Task 2: Tanka Poem

Write a **tanka poem** on one of the following themes:

- Nature
- A strong emotion
- A person you admire

Requirements:

- Follow the 5-7-5-7-7 syllable structure
- Use descriptive imagery
- Express a clear mood or message

Task 3: Sonnet Writing

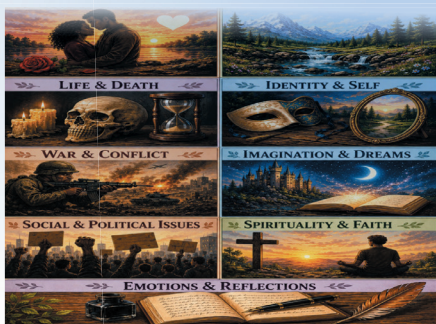
Write a **sonnet** on the theme of **love, admiration, or memory**.

Requirements:

- Fourteen lines
- Logical development of ideas
- Attempt a consistent rhyme scheme
- Use figurative language
- End with a meaningful concluding idea

UNIT 8

THEMES AND MESSAGES IN POETRY



Key Unit Competence:

To interpret themes and messages in poetry and apply them to real-life situations in order to develop personal understanding and values.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

- ☒ Identify common themes in poetry such as love, nature, identity, time, and death.
- ☒ Explain how poets convey meaning using imagery, tone, structure, and language.
- ☒ Recognize basic poetic elements such as rhythmic patterns (e.g., iambic pentameter) and the historical or cultural context of a poem.

Skills

2

- ☒ Interpret and analyze poetic messages using literary devices like metaphor, simile, symbolism, tone, and imagery.
- ☒ Compare how different poets express similar themes across various styles, periods, and contexts.
- ☒ Express personal and critical responses to poetry through discussion and writing, linking poems to personal or cultural experiences.

Attitudes and values

3

- ☒ Appreciate the **emotional and intellectual depth** of poetry and its power to communicate human experiences.
- ☒ Show respect for **diverse cultural perspectives** and ideas expressed in poems.
- ☒ Develop empathy and openness by engaging with different voices and experiences in poetry.

8.0 Introduction to the unit

Poetry is a powerful form of expression that allows poets to communicate ideas, emotions, and experiences through carefully chosen words, rhythm, and imagery. In many poems, writers explore important themes such as love, nature, identity, time, and mortality to reflect human life and society. By studying themes and messages in poetry, readers learn how poets use language, tone, structure, and poetic devices to convey deeper meanings. Understanding the historical and cultural context of poems also helps readers appreciate different perspectives and experiences. This unit therefore focuses on helping learners identify themes, interpret messages, analyze poetic devices, and express personal responses to poetry while appreciating the beauty and impact of poetic language.

Introductory activity



Read the poem extract from the "Song of Lawino" by Okot p' Bitek and answer the questions that follow

THE GRACEFUL GIRRAFE CANNOT BECOME A MONKEY

My husband tells me

I have no ideas

Of modern beauty.

He says

I have stuck

To old-fashioned hair styles.

He says

I am stupid and very backward,

That my hair style

Makes him sick Because I am dirty.

It is true

I cannot do my hair

As white women do.

Listen,

My father comes from Payira,

My mother is a woman of Koc!

I am a true Acoli

I am not a half-caste

I am not a slave girl;

My father was not brought home

By the spear
 My mother was not exchanged
 For a basket of millet.

 Ask me what beauty is
 To the Acoli
 And I will tell you;
 I will show it to you
 If you give me a chance! You once saw
 me,
 You saw my hair style
 And you admired it,
 And the boys loved it
 At the arena
 Boys surrounded me
 And fought for me.

 My mother taught me
 Acoli hair fashions;
 Which fits the kind
 Of hair of the Acoli,
 And the occasion.

 Listen,
 Ostrich plumes differ
 From chicken feathers,
 A monkey's tail
 Is different from that of a giraffe,
 The crocodile's skin
 Is not like the guinea fowl's,
 And the hippo is naked, and hairless
 The hair of the Acoli
 Is different from that of the Arabs;
 The Indians' hair
 Resembles the tail of a horse;

It is like sisal strings
 And needs to be cut
 With scissors.
 It is black,
 And is different from that of a white
 woman.

 A white woman's hair
 Is soft like silk;

 It is light
 And brownish like
 That of a brown monkey,
 And is very different from mine.
 A black woman's hair
 Is thick and curly

 It is true
 Ring-worm sometimes eat up
 A little girl's hair
 And this is terrible;
 But when hot porridge
 Is put on the head
 And the dance is held
 Under the sausage-fruit tree
 And the youths have sung

 You, Ring worm
 Who is eating Duka's hair
 Here is your porridge,
 Then the girl's hair
 Begins to grow again
 And the girl is pleased.

Okot P B' TEK (Uganda)

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem about?
2. Who is the speaker
3. Explain the meaning of the statement "The graceful giraffe cannot become a monkey."
4. What message does the poet convey about African cultural identity?
5. How does the speaker show pride in her culture?
6. Identify one example of imagery used in the poem.

8.1 Meaning of theme and message in poetry

Learning activity 8.1.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

Double Tragedy

To us she came, just a brief encounter
We grew in her fame, such a great enchanter
Esther was her name, to us joy she could scatter
Never in her was shame, but the death ship she would charter
Four semesters of wonder, we didn't know she'd leave
In her love our hearts were fonder, Esther you were to live
In the maze of mediocrity we meander, Oh what pain we have.
At the pool of mourning we ponder, how you accepted to leave.
You killed each other, you and that young life
Never minding the father, in whose heart you put a knife
Now we turn against one another, tears not calming our grief
We will write of you Esther, never let your grave be of grief
Your fate was set to go, to be one with nature
Remembering you we'll never forego, your love we'll always nurture.

By Patricia K Murefu

From Echoes Across the Valley

Comprehension questions

1. Who is the speaker?
2. What is the poem about?
3. Who is Esther in this poem?
4. What are the two tragedies suggested in the poem?
5. What does the phrase "the death ship she would charter" suggest about Esther's fate?
6. What does the poet want us to learn from the poem?
7. In what way does the speaker's tone help the reader understand the poem?

Theme

A **theme** is the main idea or subject that a poem talks about. It shows what the poem is mainly about and often reflects human experiences and feelings.

Common themes in poetry include:

- Love
- Death or loss
- Friendship
- Identity
- Culture and tradition
- Hope
- Grief and suffering

Example from *Double Tragedy*

The poem discusses the death of Esther and the sadness experienced by those left behind.

Possible **themes** in the poem are:

Death and loss

Love and remembrance

Grief and sorrow

For example:

"At the pool of mourning we ponder, how you accepted to leave."

This line shows the **theme of grief and loss** because the speaker expresses pain and sadness after Esther's death.

2. Message

A **message** is the lesson, idea, or understanding that the poet wants readers to learn from the poem. It explains what the poet wants people to think about or remember.

Example from *Double Tragedy*

The poem teaches that:

Life is precious and can end unexpectedly.
People should value and appreciate others while they are alive.
Certain choices may have painful consequences for individuals and families. For example: "Remembering you we'll never forego, your love we'll always nurture."

This suggests the message that love and memories continue even after a person dies.

3. Difference between Theme and Message

Theme	Message
The main subject of the poem	The lesson or idea the poet wants readers to learn
Usually one or two words	Usually a full sentence
Example: Love	Example: Love should be sincere and caring

Application activity 8.1.2



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

Let's Stop Begging

When I walk aimlessly around the city streets
It's because you fly aimlessly around the West banks.

When I open my palms for a penny
It's because you open your portfolio for a pound.

When I sniff glue and beg with drooping eyes
It's because you sniff IMF soup and call it sap.

When I sleep hungry not having a meal for tomorrow
It's because you've bankrupted a fiscal year's budget.

And when in contempt you call me a street urchin
It's because in guilt you know you're a global urchin.

So please, let's stop begging.

Bantu Mwaura

From Echoes across the Valley

A. Comprehension questions

1. Who are the two beggars in the poem?
2. What is the poem mainly about?
3. According to the poem, why does the speaker sometimes **sleep hungry**?
4. "In the poem, who appears to be the worst beggar and why?"
5. Identify the use of poetic devices.

B. Language skills

1. What type of adverb is "aimlessly" in the extract? (Choose one: manner, place, time, frequency, degree)
2. Rewrite this sentence from the extract by replacing the adverb with a synonym:
3. "When I walk aimlessly around the city streets..."

Explain the meaning of the line **"you've bankrupted a fiscal year's budget."**

C. Oral presentation

Recitation

Carefully read and recite the following poem aloud. Ensure you use **clear pronunciation, appropriate tone, correct pauses, and expression** to convey the meaning of the poem.

8.2 Types of Themes

Learning activity 8.2.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

Let me sing you a song
Do not mind the frog in my throat
I sing you a melody of love

Let me dance you a dance
Do not mind the alcohol in my foot
I dance you a rhythm of love

Let me smile you a smile
Do not mind the curry on my breath
I smile you a warmth of love

Let me kiss you a kiss
Do not mind the bile on my tongue
I kiss you a taste of love
Let me sing you a song...

Patrick Mangeni

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem mainly about?
2. What does the phrase "frog in my throat" suggest about the speaker?
3. What message does the poet convey about love and acceptance?
4. How does the poem show that love can exist despite imperfections?
5. What feeling or mood does this poem create for the reader?
6. How does the repetition contribute to the rhythm and musical quality of the poem?

Types of themes in Poetry

Love

Love is a common theme in poetry because it is a **universal experience** shared by all humans across time and cultures. Poets use it to express emotions such as joy, desire, heartbreak, and connection. Writing about love allows them to explore relationships, passion, and vulnerability. Through poetry, love becomes a way to understand and celebrate the human experience.

Death

Death is a common theme in poetry because it is a universal experience that touches everyone. Poets use it to explore deep emotions like grief, fear, and loss, helping readers connect with their own feelings. It also encourages reflection on the meaning and fragility of life. Through poems about death, writers remind us to value life, love, and the time we have.

Religion and Spirituality

Religion and spirituality are common themes in poetry because they reflect humans' search for meaning, purpose, and connection with the divine or the universe. Poets explore faith, worship, morality, and the struggle between good and evil to express their beliefs and experiences. Poetry allows writers to reflect on life, death, and the soul in a personal and emotional way. Through these themes, readers are invited to think about spiritual values and the mysteries of existence.

Conflict and War

Conflict and war are common themes in poetry because they explore the **struggles, suffering, and courage** experienced during fights, battles, or personal disputes. Poets often write about **violence, heroism, loss, and the emotional and physical impact of war** on individuals and communities. Through vivid imagery and emotional language, poetry captures the tragedy and consequences of conflict. These poems encourage readers to **reflect on the cost of violence and the value of peace**.

Hope and Resilience

Hope and resilience are common themes in poetry because they explore the **human ability to endure difficulties and overcome challenges**. Poets celebrate courage, determination, and the strength to keep going despite hardship. Through uplifting imagery and inspiring language, poetry encourages readers to remain optimistic and persevere. These poems remind us that even in dark times, **hope and inner strength can lead to growth and renewal**.

Corruption and Disillusionment

Corruption and disillusionment are common themes in poetry because they explore the abuse of power, betrayal of trust, and failure of systems or leaders. Poets use these themes to criticize injustice, moral decay, and the gap between ideals and reality.

Through vivid imagery and emotional language, poetry exposes the pain and frustration caused by corruption. These poems encourage readers to reflect on ethical behavior, social responsibility, and the consequences of dishonesty.

Theme of Nature

The theme of **nature** in poetry explores the **beauty, power, and mystery of the natural world**. Poets write about landscapes, seasons, animals, rivers, mountains, and the sky to show **life's beauty, peace, and harmony** or to reflect on **human emotions and experiences**. Nature can also symbolize **freedom, change, growth, or the passage of time**. Through vivid imagery and sensory details, poetry allows readers to **connect with the environment and appreciate the world around them**.

Theme of Identity

The theme of **identity** in poetry explores a person's sense of **self, culture, and belonging**. Poets write about personal experiences, heritage, gender, ethnicity, or social roles to show how individuals understand who they are. Identity in poetry can reflect **pride, struggle, self-discovery, or the search for acceptance**. Through language and imagery, poets help readers **connect with their own sense of self and the experiences of others**.

Note: The themes we have studied in poetry such as love, death, nature, identity, time, religion, corruption, hope, conflict, and resilience are **some of the most common themes**, but they are **not the only ones**. Poetry can explore **any idea, emotion, or human experience**. Writers may write about family, friendship, freedom, injustice, culture, or even everyday life. Always remember that poets are creative, so the **themes in poetry are limitless** and can reflect anything the poet wants to express.

Application activity 8.2.2



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

I Saw
I saw
The window in her milky teeth
Her slender body
Her curled glittering
Glistening and glistening hair
On her godly head.

I saw
Her elegant look
From her round scintillating pupils
Casting nascent glances
Devoid of sympathy for my soul
And my struggle
With a heart taken captive.

I saw
God's masterpiece
An artifact of extreme care
Given tender touch
By the moulder
A heavenly queen
On her tour on Mother Earth.

I saw
A rose
Among the cactus

I saw
For I stole glances
Which met
Broad enchanting smiles
On a face dangling
On her giraffe neck
And sending to task my heart.
An' wanted to feel
Its buttered petals
But my hands
slowed
An' flinched

I saw
A dove
And I wanted to say
To say:
But only mumbles
With fear an' trembling
My manhood was no more.

I saw
But I wish
I could...

"Echoes across the Valley"

F. Kyateka Mondo

A. Comprehension questions

1. What is the main theme in the poem?
2. Who is the speaker?
3. How appropriate is the title?
4. Identify the use the sound devices in the poem.
5. How does the poem make you feel about the speaker's admiration and hesitation?
6. Recite the given poem clearly and with correct rhythm and tone.

B. Language focus

1. Continue the poem starting with 'I could...'
2. What does the phrase **"God's masterpiece"** tell you about how the speaker views her?

C. Oral presentation

Carefully read/recite the poem: "I saw". Read it aloud ensuring that you use clear pronunciation, appropriate tone, correct pauses, and expression to convey the meaning of the poem.

8.3 Language and style

Learning activity 8.3.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

LET ME NOT TO THE MARRIAGE OF TRUE MINDS (W. SHAKESPEARE (ENGLAND))

Let me not to the marriage of true minds Admit impediments. Love is not love Which alters when it alteration finds, Or bends with the remover to remove:

O, no! it is an ever-fixed mark,

That looks on tempests and is never shaken; It is a star to every wandering bark,

Whose worth's unknown, although his height be taken. Love's not Time's fool, though rosy lips and cheeks Within his bending sickle's compass come;

Love alters not with his brief hours and weeks, But bears it out even to the edge of doom.

If this be error, and upon me prov'd I never writ, nor no man ever lov'd

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem about?
2. Explain how the poet's choice of words contributes to the meaning of the poem.

3. Which words in the poem show that love is strong and permanent? Explain their meaning.
4. Identify two poetic devices used in the poem and explain their effect.
5. How does the poet's language show that love does not change with time?
6. Identify words or phrases in the poem that create strong images in the reader's mind.
7. Explain how the language used in the last two lines strengthens the poet's argument about love.

Meaning

Diction refers to the **choice and use of words by a writer or speaker to express ideas and create meaning in a text**. It shows how carefully selected words help communicate feelings, describe situations, and influence how readers understand the message. In literature, diction can make the language **formal or informal, simple or complex, emotional or neutral**, depending on the writer's purpose. Through diction, a writer or poet can create a particular **tone, mood, or effect** that helps readers better understand the message of the text.

Importance

1. **Clarifies meaning:** The choice of words helps the writer clearly express ideas so that readers understand the message.
2. **Creates tone and mood** – Specific words can make a text sound serious, joyful, sad, or formal.
3. **Emphasizes important ideas** – Carefully chosen words highlight the main message the writer wants the reader to remember.
4. **Creates vivid images** Strong descriptive words help readers imagine what is being described.
5. **Influences the reader's feelings:** The writer's choice of words can make readers feel emotions such as happiness, sympathy, or tension.
6. **Improves the beauty of language:** Good diction makes writing more interesting, powerful, and enjoyable to read.

In Sonnet 116 by William Shakespeare, the **diction** (word choice) is **formal, precise, and rich in figurative language**, chosen to convey the nature of **true love**.

Examples of diction in the poem:

7. **"Ever-fixed mark"** – The poet chooses these words to show that true love is **constant and unchanging**, like a permanent landmark.
8. **"Star to every wandering bark"** – The words **"star"** and **"wandering bark"** create a vivid image of love as a **guide and source of direction**, even in difficult times.
9. **"Tempests"** – This word emphasizes the **difficulties and challenges** that love can withstand.

10. **"Time's fool" and "sickle"** – These words give **human qualities to Time**, showing that love is stronger than aging or physical change.

Effect of diction

- The **formal and elevated word choice** reflects the seriousness of the topic.
- It **strengthens the poet's argument** that true love is **permanent, guiding, and powerful**.
- It **creates strong images and emotional impact**, helping the reader understand the ideal of unchanging love.
- In short, Shakespeare's diction in this poem is **carefully chosen to express the enduring and steadfast nature of true love**.

The role of poetic devices in conveying meaning is to **enhance the expression of ideas, emotions, and themes in a poem**. Poetic devices are tools that poets use to make their language more **vivid, memorable, and impactful**. They help the reader **understand and feel the message** the poet wants to communicate.

How poetic devices work:

1. **Imagery** – Creates mental pictures that help readers **visualize the poem's ideas**.
2. **Metaphor and Simile** – Compare one thing to another to **express abstract ideas more clearly**.
3. **Personification** – Gives human qualities to non-human things to **make ideas relatable and emotional**.
4. **Alliteration, Assonance, and Rhyme** – Add **musicality and rhythm**, making the poem more pleasing and easier to remember.
5. **Symbolism** – Uses objects or events to **represent deeper meanings** or themes.
6. **Repetition** – Emphasizes important ideas and **reinforces the poem's main message**.

In Sonnet 116 by William Shakespeare, **imagery** is used extensively to **create vivid mental pictures that help the reader understand the nature of true love**.

Examples of imagery in the poem:

1. **"Ever-fixed mark"** – This image makes readers **see love as a strong, unmovable landmark**, showing that true love is constant and reliable.
2. **"Star to every wandering bark"** – The star guides a lost ship (**bark**), giving a clear image of **love as a guiding light**, steady through life's challenges.
3. **"Tempests"** – This image of storms conveys the **difficulties and challenges love can face**, yet love remains unshaken.
4. **"Time's bending sickle"** – The sickle evokes **the passing of time and mortality**, showing that true love is not affected by aging or decay.

Effect of imagery:

- Helps the reader **visualize abstract ideas** like constancy, guidance, and endurance in love.
- Makes the **concept of true love more concrete and memorable**.
- Strengthens the poem's **emotional impact**, making the reader feel the power and steadfastness of true love.

In short: Imagery in this poem **paints clear pictures in the reader's mind**, helping them **understand and feel the qualities of true love**.

If you want, I can make a **small table of the images in the poem and what they symbolize**, which makes it very easy for learners to study. Do you want me to do that?

Example in a poem

In Sonnet 116, devices like **metaphor ("ever-fixed mark")**, **symbolism ("star")**, **personification ("Time's fool")**, and **repetition ("love")** all work together to **show that true love is constant, unchanging, and powerful**.

In short: Poetic devices **help poets to express ideas creatively and powerfully**, making the meaning of the poem clearer and more memorable for the reader.

Meaning

Poetic license is the freedom that poets (or writers in general) take to bend or break the usual rules of language, grammar, or facts to create a desired effect, evoke emotions, or enhance imagery in their work. Essentially, it allows creativity to take precedence over strict accuracy.

Importance

Poetic License: It allows poets to break language rules to enhance creativity, express emotions vividly, create striking imagery, improve rhythm and rhyme, and engage the reader's imagination, making poetry more expressive and memorable.

In Shakespeare's **"Let Me Not to the Marriage of True Minds,"** poetic license is used in several ways to enhance meaning, rhythm, and imagery:

1. Unusual Grammar and Word Order:

- Example: "Love is not love / Which alters when it alteration finds" – the phrasing is complex and inverted for emphasis and rhythm, which wouldn't be used in everyday speech.

2. Metaphor and Imagery Beyond Literal Sense:

- Example: "It is an ever-fixed mark / That looks on tempests and is never shaken" – love is compared to a constant lighthouse or star, which is figurative, not literal.
- Example: "It is a star to every wandering bark" – the "star" guiding ships (barks) is imaginative, not literal.

3. Personification:

- Example: "Love's not Time's fool" – Time is given human qualities, allowing Shakespeare to convey love's endurance.

4. **Exaggeration for Effect:** Example: "But bears it out even to the edge of doom" – emphasizes the eternal nature of true love.

Application activity 8.3.2



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

The Leopard

Your eyes struck me
Seeped through me
Tore me apart
Rekindled a fire.
Your beautiful fur coat,
Black highlighted spots
On a magnificent
Mustard richness.

Keen hunter

Steady in poise,
A loner-shy yet watchful,
Indeed puzzling.

Is it then a wonder
That against my will
You intrigued me
Making me your captive...

A. Comprehension questions

1. How appropriate is the title?
2. What is the poem about?
3. Identify the use of imagery and other poetic devices.
4. How do poetic devices help convey the poem's message?"
5. What impression do you get of the leopard's **character** from the poem?

B. Language skills

1. The leopard is described as a "Keen hunter / Steady in poise / A loner-shy yet watchful". This shows that it is:
a) Friendly and sociable b) Strong, cautious, and independent
c) Careless and lazy d) Playful and noisy
2. The tone of the poem is mostly:
a) Sad and regretful b) Humorous and playful
c) Admiring and fascinated d) Fearful and angry
3. In the line "Your eyes struck me", the word "struck" most nearly means:
a) Ignored b) Hit physically
c) Followed d) Impressed or amazed

4. The phrase "Seeped through me / Tore me apart / Rekindled a fire" shows that the speaker feels:
- a) Sleepy and bored b) Confused and lost
c) Angry and violent d) Emotionally affected and excited
5. The word "intrigued" in the poem most nearly means:
- a) Interested and fascinated b) Angry
c) Bored d) Confused
6. Which literary device is used in "Your eyes struck me / Seeped through me / Tore me apart"?
- a) Simile b) Metaphor
c) Personification d) Onomatopoeia
7. The last stanza "That against my will / You intrigued me / Making me your captive" suggests that the speaker feels:
- a) Indifferent to the leopard b) Happy to escape
c) Trapped by the leopard's charm d) Angry at the leopard

3. Oral presentation

Question: Add a Stanza and Recite

Task: Read the poem carefully. Then **write one original stanza** (4–8 lines) that continues the poem's theme of admiration for the leopard.

After writing your stanza:

1. **Recite the entire poem aloud**, including your new stanza.
2. Use **clear pronunciation, expression, and pauses** to convey the meaning and emotion.
3. Emphasize **descriptive words** such as *stealthy*, *magnificent*, *intrigued*, or any words from your stanza.

8.4 Reading and Interpreting a Poem

Learning activity 8.4.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

A tick on a Cow

You have seen those crawling larvae
In a pit latrine
They don't dig, they don't harvest,
Yet they just grow fat

You have been to a university
And seen those healthy wealthy-looking chaps
Who don't swot and don't sweat
Yet just pass exams.

You saw them in the church last Sunday
In what angelic robes:
More alms, more blessings, they say.
And yet drive.

Tomorrow this cow will be slaughtered
And its life cast into the pot of forgetfulness:
Where will the tick go?

By George Juma Abiola

From Echoes across the Valley

A. Comprehension questions

1. Explain the comparison between the **tick** and **some people in society**.
2. Describe the kind of people the poet talks about in the **university**.
3. Explain the meaning of the last line: **"Where will the tick go?"**
4. Describe the attitude of the poet toward the people mentioned in the poem.

B. Answer True or False

1. The poem praises people who live without working.
2. The tick depends on the cow for survival.
3. The poet describes hardworking students at the university.

4. The poem criticizes some people in society.
5. The cow symbolizes a source of support or wealth.

B. Open questions

1. Do you agree with the poet's view about people who benefit from others' work? Explain.
2. In your opinion, what lesson should society learn from this poem?
3. Give an example from real life that is similar to the situation described in the poem.

C. Multiple Choice Questions

1. The tick in the poem represents:
a) Hardworking people b) People who depend on others' efforts
c) Farmers d) Teachers
2. The poet describes some university students as people who:
a) Study very hard b) Teach others
c) Pass exams without working hard d) Fail all exams

The question **"Where will the tick go?"** suggests:

- a) The tick will become stronger
- b) The tick will find another cow immediately
- c) Those who depend on others may face problems when their support ends
- d) The cow will survive

1. Reading and Interpretation of a Poem

Meaning

Reading and Interpretation

Reading and interpretation of a poem is the process of **carefully reading a poem in order to understand its ideas, feelings, and message**. It involves looking beyond the surface meaning of the words to discover **what the poet is trying to communicate to the reader**. Interpretation helps readers explain the poem in their own words and understand the deeper meaning of the poet's message.

2. Steps in Reading and Interpreting a Poem

1. Read the poem carefully

Read the poem several times to understand the general idea. Pay attention to the tone, mood, and flow of the poem.

2. Identify unfamiliar words

Find the meaning of difficult words or expressions so that the poem becomes clearer.

3. Identify the speaker and situation and intention

Determine who is speaking in the poem and what situation or event is being described.

4. Examine the images and descriptions

Look at the pictures the poet creates in the reader's mind through words.

5. Identify poetic devices

Notice literary techniques such as **imagery, symbolism, metaphor, simile, rhyme, and repetition** because they help convey the meaning of the poem.

6. Determine the central idea or message

Think about what the poet wants readers to learn or understand from the poem.

3. Importance of Reading and Interpreting a Poem

- It helps readers **understand the deeper meaning of poetry**.
- It improves **critical thinking and imagination**.
- It helps learners appreciate **language, culture, and human experiences** expressed in poems.
- It enables readers to **connect the poem with real-life situations**.

4. Key Things to Consider When Interpreting a Poem

- The **title of the poem**
- The **choice of words (diction)**
- The **images created in the poem**
- The **tone and mood of the poet**
- The **message or lesson conveyed**

Application activity 8.4.2



A Pregnant School Girl
 He paid her seat in the matatu
 And walked away:
 She disappeared in the city crowd
 All her dream vanished

One more passenger squeezed in
 And lit a cigarette
 She opened the window
 And spat cold saliva out
 As the cigarette smoke intensified
 She wanted to vomit
 She remembered the warm nights
 When she was her man's pet

She remembered the promises
 The gifts, the parties, the dances
 She remembered her classmates
 at school

Who envied her expensive shoes
 Lipstick, wrist watch, handbag
 Which she brought to school
 After a weekend with him

The future stood against her
 Dark like a night without the moon
 And silent like the end of the world

As the matatu sped away from the city
 She began to tremble with fear
 Wondering what her parents would say

With all hope gone
 She felt like a corpse
 Going home to be buried

BY EVERETT STANDA

Anthology of East African Poetry

A. Comprehension questions

1. How appropriate is the title?
2. Describe the tone of the speaker?
3. Briefly, comment on the choices of words and poetic devices in this poem.
4. Describe what have influenced your interpretation of the poem.
5. Explain the poetic device used in this phrase "the future stood against her".

B. Language skills

1. In the line "***She disappeared in the city crowd / All her dream vanished***", what does "**vanished**" mean?
 a) Appeared b) Disappeared suddenly c) Grew stronger d) Changed
2. In "*She spat cold saliva out*", what does the word "**spat**" suggest about her feelings?
3. The phrase "***The future stood against her / Dark like a night without the moon***" – what does "**dark**" mean in this context?

C. Oral and presentation skills

Debate Questions

Should schools allow pregnant girls to continue their education, or should they be suspended?

8.5 Contextual analysis of a poem (historical, cultural, philosophical)

Learning activity 8.5.1



Old Woman's Prayer

I thank you, Lord

For a peaceful night

I thank you, Lord

For a good morning

The sun has come

Bright and warm

I am going to bask

And dry my millet

And spread my mat.

I thank you Lord

For the recent rain

My pumpkins are goof

My beans are well

The well is full

Grass has grown

My goat will feed

I will thatch my hut

And sleep like a queen

Let my daughters, Lord,

Have more sons

And my sons

More grandsons

And let them live, Lord,

That when I am dead

They put dust

Over my head

Amen.

By Jotham Tusingiirwe

From Echoes across the Valley

Comprehension questions

1. What is the main message or central idea of the poem?
2. Which cultural practices, traditions, or beliefs are reflected in the poem? Give examples from the text.
3. What does the poem reveal about the historical, social, or cultural background of the speaker or the community?
4. Identify and explain the philosophical, ethical, or moral values expressed in the poem.
5. How does understanding the context of the poem help the reader interpret its themes and message more effectively?

6. Which feelings or attitudes does the speaker express toward the subject of the poem?
7. Explain how the poet uses language and imagery to communicate ideas and emotions.
8. In your opinion, what lesson can modern society learn from the poem? Explain your answer.

Meaning

Contextual analysis refers to the examination of a poem in relation to the context in which it was written. It involves going beyond the literal meaning of the words to understand the historical, social, cultural, and personal factors that shape the poem's meaning and message.

Through contextual analysis, readers explore how the poet's background, society, beliefs, experiences, and historical period influence the themes, language, and ideas presented in the poem. This approach helps learners develop a deeper understanding and appreciation of the poem and its relevance to human life and society.

1. Types of Contexts in Poetry

a. Historical

Historical context in poetry refers to the **events, time period, and historical conditions that existed when a poem was written**. These events may influence the poet's ideas, feelings, and the message expressed in the poem. By understanding the historical context, readers can better understand **why the poem was written and what it is responding to**.

Contextual analysis of the poem 'Old woman's Prayer'

- The poem reflects the traditional **agrarian lifestyle** in rural societies, particularly in Africa. The references to millet, beans, pumpkins, goats, and thatching huts point to a **subsistence farming community** where life revolves around the land, crops, and livestock.
- The mention of **recent rain** and the well-being full highlights the dependence on **seasonal cycles** and natural resources for survival, showing how people historically lived closely with the environment.
- It also echoes a time when **large families and extended kinship structures** were important, as seen in her prayers for sons, grandsons, and generational continuity.

b. Cultural

Cultural context in poetry refers to the **beliefs, traditions, customs, values, and ways of life of the community in which the poem was written**. These cultural elements influence the poet's ideas, language, symbols, and messages in the poem.

Contextual analysis of the poem 'Old woman's Prayer'

- The poem embodies **traditional African values**, especially the importance of family, community, and respect for ancestors.
- The prayer for children and grandchildren underscores the cultural significance of **lineage, inheritance, and legacy**. Having male heirs was historically seen as ensuring the family name and property continuity.
- Daily activities like **drying millet, spreading mats, and thatching huts** illustrate cultural norms and domestic routines in rural African life.
- The act of **praying at daybreak** reflects the integration of **spirituality and daily life**, showing that gratitude and connection to a higher power are central in many traditional societies.

c. Philosophical

In poetry, **philosophy** refers to the exploration of **life's fundamental questions**—such as the meaning of existence, human nature, morality, time, death, and happiness—through poetic expression. It is about how a poet reflects on **human experiences, values, and the universe**, often encouraging readers to think deeply about **life, purpose, and the human condition**.

Contextual analysis of the poem 'Old woman's Prayer'

The poem reflects a philosophical view on **life, mortality, and fulfillment**. The old woman's **gratitude** for daily blessings shows **mindfulness** and appreciation of the **present**. Her reliance on **nature** and **divine providence** highlights **human vulnerability**. Prayers for her children and grandchildren emphasize **legacy** and **continuity**. The poem shows that **humble, reflective living** brings **peace** and understanding of **life's cycles**.

Application activity 8.5.2



Do Not Cry for Me

Spare me those piteous eyes
For too much, they mirror the depth of my concession
And you too know that we cannot live on morals.

Do not cry for me dad
When painfully you discover to your paternal dismay
That those long-cherished cows are misty illusions
Shaped by my burdensome daughterly presence here.
Bravely bear your frustrated expectations
For here I shall never return.

But I hope that whatever returns shall bring hope
And I pray that somehow it shall take the place of your daughter

Do not cry for me sons and daughters of my parents
When you learn of the family-joy's impending departure
Since craving as I do to stay here I cannot
And tears are too extravagant for a dying spirit.
Hopefully you will pardon my selfless debasement
For your lives are lives too
And a life less of a life is worth lives.

Do not cry for me my love
When I walk out of your door
Wishing I could carry that contagious affection
In my already lonely tormented heart.

Do not look in my eyes
For you might see the hungry yearning
For what might have been.

By Kitche O. Magak

A. Comprehension questions

1. Who is the speaker in the poem, and what role does she play in the society presented?
2. How does the poem portray family roles, responsibilities, and expectations within the society?
3. What cultural practices, traditions, or beliefs are reflected in the speaker's reference to "long-cherished cows"?
4. What does the speaker's relationship with her father reveal about cultural attitudes and values concerning daughters?
5. What historical or social realities might explain the speaker's reference to "misty illusions" in the poem?
6. In what ways can the poem be connected to issues such as migration, poverty, conflict, or social change?

7. How does the poem explore the themes of love, loss, identity, and personal choice?
8. How does the context of the poem help readers understand the speaker's emotions and experiences more deeply?

B. Language skills

Column A – Words/Phrases from the Poem	Column B – Meaning
A. Piteous	Strong desire or longing.
B. Concession	Showing sadness or pity.
C. Burdensome	Causing mental or emotional pain.
D. Debasement	Giving up or yielding.
E. Craving	Difficult to bear or heavy to carry.
F. Tormented	Loving feelings that spread easily to others.
G. Contagious affection	Humiliation or lowering of status.
H. Yearning	Deep longing for something lost or unattainable.

C. Oral presentation

Read the poem aloud with clear pronunciation, appropriate intonation, and meaningful expression. Pay careful attention to tone, rhythm, pauses, and the emphasis placed on emotionally significant words such as *piteous*, *burdensome*, *debasement*, and *yearning*.

8.6 Language Focus: Introduction to English Sounds

Learning activity 8.6.1



Match each sound with the correct word.

Sounds	
/i:/	
/æ/	
/ʌ/	

Count the Sounds

Instruction: How many sounds (phonemes) are in each word?

1. cat → _____
2. dog → _____
3. book → _____
4. sit → _____

Vowel or Consonant

Instruction: Write **V** for vowel sound and **C** for consonant sound.

1. /b/ → _____

2. /i:/ → _____

3. /t/ → _____

4. /æ/ → _____

Meaning

Introduction to English Sounds

English sounds are studied in a branch of linguistics known as Phonetics. These sounds play an important role in communication because they help speakers pronounce words accurately, distinguish meaning, and communicate effectively and clearly.

What are English Sounds?

English sounds are the basic units of speech produced when people speak the English language. These sounds are different from letters because sounds are spoken and heard, while letters are written and seen.

For example, the word *cat* has three letters and three sounds: /k/, /æ/, and /t/. However, some English words may contain more letters than sounds or more sounds than letters.

Types of English Sounds

In Phonetics, English sounds are generally divided into two main categories: vowel sounds and consonant sounds. These sounds help speakers pronounce words correctly and distinguish meaning in communication.

1. Vowel Sounds

Vowel sounds are produced when air flows freely through the mouth without being blocked by the tongue, teeth, or lips. While pronouncing vowel sounds, the vocal cords vibrate, making vowels usually voiced sounds.

English vowel sounds may be:

- **short vowels** — pronounced for a short duration,
- or **long vowels** — pronounced for a longer duration.

Examples of Short Vowel Sounds

Sound	Example Word	Pronunciation
/ɪ/	<i>Sit</i>	short "i" sound
/e/	<i>Pen</i>	short "e" sound
/ʌ/	<i>Cup</i>	short "u" sound
/ɒ/	<i>Hot</i>	short "o" sound
/ʊ/	<i>Book</i>	short "oo" sound

Examples of Long Vowel Sounds

Sound	Example Word	Pronunciation
/i:/	<i>Seat</i>	long "ee" sound
/a:/	<i>Car</i>	long "a" sound
/ɔ:/	<i>Door</i>	long "or" sound
/u:/	<i>Food</i>	long "oo" sound
/ɜ:/	<i>Bird</i>	long central vowel sound

❖ Important Note

The length of a vowel sound can change the meaning of a word. For example:

- sit /sɪt/ and seat /si:t/
- full /fʊl/ and fool /fu:l/

This shows why correct pronunciation is important in spoken English.

2. Consonant Sounds

Consonant sounds are produced when the flow of air is blocked, restricted, or partially obstructed by parts of the mouth such as the lips, teeth, or tongue.

Consonants can be classified into two groups:

a) Voiced Consonants

Voiced consonants are produced when the vocal cords vibrate during pronunciation.

Examples

Sound	Example Word
/b/	<i>Bat</i>
/d/	<i>Dog</i>
/g/	<i>Go</i>
/v/	<i>Van</i>
/z/	<i>Zoo</i>

b) Voiceless Consonants

Voiceless consonants are produced without vibration of the vocal cords.

Examples

Sound	Example Word
/p/	<i>Pat</i>
/t/	<i>Top</i>
/k/	<i>Cat</i>
/f/	<i>Fan</i>
/s/	<i>Sun</i>

Application activity 8.6.2



A. Identifying Short and Long Vowel Sounds

Read each phonetic sound carefully. From the four given words, **choose the word that contains the target sound**. Write the letter of the correct answer and pronounce the word aloud. Then identify whether the sound is a **short vowel sound** or a **long vowel sound**.

A. Short Vowel Sounds

Sound	A	B	C	D
/ɪ/	car	seat	food	sit
/e/	Pony	pin	pen	door
/ʌ/	cup	cap	car	food
/ɒ/	Hut	heat	hot	bird
/ʊ/	book	back	bake	car

B. Long Vowel Sounds

Sound	A	B	C	D
/i:/	Sort	sit	set	seat
/ɑ:/	kite	car	cut	cup
/ɔ:/	door	dog	dig	duck
/u:/	full	food	foot	fish
/ɜ:/	bed	bird	bad	bid

C. Distinguishing Voiced and Voiceless Consonant Sounds

Instruction: Choose the word that contains the given consonant sound. Pronounce the word aloud and identify whether the sound is voiced or voiceless.

Sound	A	B	C	D
/b/	Van	pat	fan	bat
/p/	mat	bat	pat	cat
/d/	dog	top	log	dog
/t/	top	dog	bog	job
/g/	so	zoo	go	show
/k/	van	bat	fan	cat
/v/	van	fan	can	sun
/f/	bag	van	ban	fan
/z/	zoo	sue	sun	fun
/s/	run	zoo	sun	van

C. Writing Words in Sounds

Write each word using phonetic symbols (sounds). Remember that sounds are written between slashes / / and represent pronunciation, not spelling.

1. Words with Short Vowel Sounds

Word	Sounds
fish	_____
bag	_____
pen	_____
cup	_____
hot	_____

2. Words with Long Vowel Sound

Word	Sounds
seat	_____
car	_____
food	_____
door	_____
bird	_____

D. Sound and Meaning Connection

Read each pair of words aloud. Identify the sound difference and explain how the change in sound affects meaning.

Word Pair	Sound Difference
sit / seat	_____
full / fool	_____
bat / pat	_____
fan / van	_____
zoo / sue	_____

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



I. Comprehension questions

Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

I REMEMBER

I remember, Countrymen,
The days of 'Dawn Over the Land'.
Of hopes and expectations
When I truly understood
Slavery was a thing of the past –
We, the people of the land,
Had been freed.
I was there when slowly
Darkness set in.
The gradual destruction
Was there in front of me,
But I did not see it.
I continued, Countrymen, to live in the past.
And when I finally looked

It was too late, and even
I Had become a scavenger.

From "Growing Up with Poetry" by Naomi Mnthali (Malawi)

A. CompreMultiple

i. Choice question

1. **What does "slowly Darkness set in" suggest about the poet's experience after freedom?**
 - A. Hope and happiness gradually faded, leading to sadness or struggle
 - B. The poet returned to slavery
 - C. Life immediately became easy and happy
 - D. The poet moved to a different country
2. **What does the line "I continued... to live in the past" reveal about personal responsibility?**
 - A. The poet avoids thinking about the past
 - B. The poet shows that clinging to the past can prevent personal growth and responsibility
 - C. The poet blames others completely for everything
 - D. The poet forgets all past experiences
3. **How does the poet show the hope and excitement that came with the end of slavery?**
 - A. By focusing only on past punishments
 - B. By ignoring the idea of freedom
 - C. By showing images of joy, freedom, and new beginnings
 - D. By describing fear and suffering in detail

ii. Think and answer:

1. What do the words **"Darkness"** and **"scavenger"** symbolize in the poem?
2. What is the central message or lesson of the poem about freedom and awareness?

B. Fill in the blanks using the words in the box:

1. _____ context in poetry refers to the events, time period, and conditions that existed when a poem was written.
2. _____ context deals with the beliefs, traditions, customs, and values of the society in which a poem was written.

3. _____ context explores life's fundamental questions, such as the meaning of existence, human nature, morality, and happiness.
4. Understanding the _____ context helps readers know why certain events, actions, or ideas appear in the poem.
5. Considering the _____ context enables readers to reflect on the poet's insights about life, purpose, and human experiences.

C. Answer True or False

1. Reading and interpretation of a poem involves looking only at the literal meaning of the words.
2. Reading a poem several times helps to understand its general idea, tone, and mood.
3. Identifying unfamiliar words is unnecessary for understanding the poem.
4. Knowing who the speaker is and the situation in the poem helps in interpreting its meaning.
5. Poetic devices such as imagery, metaphor, and rhyme are not important for understanding a poem.
6. Determining the central idea or message helps readers understand what the poet wants them to learn.
7. Interpreting a poem improves critical thinking and imagination.

D. Language structure

Identify the Sound

1. Underline the word that has a different **initial sound** in each group:
 - a) cat, car, dog, cup
 - b) ship, shoe, sun, shop
 - c) big, bag, bug, pig
 - d) thin, think, this, thumb
2. Using examples, explain how stress changes meaning in words, using examples such as REcord (noun) and reCORD (verb).

V. Project: Creative Writing and Oral Performance

Write a poem on a topic of your choice. In your poem, ensure that you:

- Express a clear theme and message
- Use at least two poetic devices (e.g., metaphor, simile, imagery, repetition)
- Show creativity and originality in your ideas
- Organize your poem clearly (lines and stanzas)
- Use appropriate language and tone

After writing, present your poem orally to the class using clear voice, expression, and confidence.

UNIT 9

CREATIVE WRITING: POETRY



Key Unit Competence:

To create original poems by using appropriate poetic devices, structure, and style to express personal and social themes and appreciate diverse voices and perspectives.

Learning objectives

At the end of this unit you should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

- ✓ Identify common poetic forms and literary devices used in poetry.
- ✓ Explain how imagery, rhythm, tone, and structure contribute to meaning in poems.
- ✓ Interpret themes and messages expressed in different types of poetry.

Skills

2

- ✓ Compose original poems using appropriate poetic devices and structure.
- ✓ Revise and refine poems to improve clarity, creativity, and emotional impact.
- ✓ Present and perform poems confidently using appropriate rhythm, tone, and expression.

Attitudes and values

3

- ✓ Appreciate poetry as a creative form of personal and cultural expression.
- ✓ Demonstrate confidence and responsibility when sharing creative work.
- ✓ Respect others' ideas and provide constructive feedback during poetry activities.

9.0 Introduction to the unit

Poetry is a powerful way to express personal feelings, experiences, and social concerns through words, rhythm, and imagery. In this unit, you will explore how poetic devices, diction, tone, and structure shape the meaning and emotional impact of poems. You will analyze poems to understand how writers communicate ideas about love, nature, heroism, and social issues, and learn to appreciate the craft behind each line.

Through this unit, you will develop the skills to write their own original poems, experimenting with rhyme, rhythm, tone, and imagery to convey emotion and meaning effectively. You will also practice revising, refining, and performing poems, gaining confidence in both written and spoken expression.

This unit encourages you to value poetry as a creative form of personal and cultural expression, to show discipline and enthusiasm, and to respect the creative work of others. By engaging with poetry, you not only develop literary skills but also explore their own voices, emotions, and perspectives while celebrating the diverse ways humans experience the world.

Introductory activity



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

Some Days

Some days I put the people in their places at the table.

Bend their legs and the knees

If they come with that feature.

And fix them into the tiny wooden chairs.

All afternoon they face one another,

The man in the brown suit,

The woman in the blue dress,

Perfectly motionless, perfectly behaved.

But other days, I am the one

Who is lifted up by the ribs,

Then lowered into the dining room of a dollhouse

To sit with the others at the long table.

Very funny,

But how would you like it

If you never knew from one day to the next

If you were going to spend it

Striding around like a vivid god,

Your shoulders in the clouds,

Or sitting down there amidst the wallpaper,

Staring straight ahead with your little plastic face?

Billy Collins

Comprehension questions

1. Who is the speaker in the poem, and what role do they play on "some days" versus "other days"?
2. What does the "dining room of a dollhouse" symbolize in the poem?
3. How does the speaker describe the people at the table? What effect does this description create?
4. What is the significance of the "man in the brown suit" and the "woman in the blue dress"? Why might the poet include these details?
5. How does the poem use imagery to show the contrast between power and powerlessness? Give examples.
6. What feelings does the speaker convey about the unpredictability of being "lifted up by the ribs" versus controlling others

9.1.Review of Forms of Poetry

Learning activity 9.1.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

In the future, the worst kind of crime,
Will be working the streets as a mime,
If you paint your face white,
They'll arrest you on sight,
An example of justice sublime

Comprehension questions

1. What is the speaker talking about in the poem?
2. Who is addressed in the poem?
3. What type of poem is this
4. Describe the structural features of the poem.

1. Limerick

- A limerick is a short, humorous poem made up of five lines. It often tells a funny or silly story and is meant to entertain the reader. The tone is usually playful, witty, or even absurd.
- It follows a specific rhyme scheme: **AABBA**. The first, second, and fifth lines are longer and rhyme with each other, while the third and fourth lines are shorter and share a different rhyme.

- The rhythm is also important. Limericks typically have a bouncy, musical beat, making them easy to recite aloud. This rhythm adds to their humorous effect.
- Common themes include nonsense situations, exaggeration, and clever wordplay. They are popular in children's poetry but are also enjoyed by adults.
- The above poem is an example of Limerick.

2. Haiku

- A haiku is a traditional Japanese poem that focuses on nature and simple moments. It is very brief but rich in meaning and imagery.
- It has three lines with a syllable pattern of **5-7-5**. This strict structure forces the poet to be precise and thoughtful with word choice.
- Haikus often capture a single moment in time, such as a season, weather, or a natural scene. They aim to evoke emotion through simplicity.
- The language is usually clear and direct, avoiding unnecessary words. Despite its short length, a haiku can carry deep meaning and reflection.

3. Tanka

- A tanka is another form of Japanese poetry, slightly longer than a haiku. It expresses personal feelings, emotions, and observations.
- It consists of five lines with a syllable pattern of **5-7-5-7-7**. The first three lines are similar to a haiku, while the last two expand the idea.
- Tanka poems often explore love, nature, and human emotions. They create a shift or contrast between the first and second parts.
- The tone is usually reflective and emotional. It allows more room for expression than a haiku while still maintaining structure.

4. Sonnet

- A sonnet is a formal poem with **14 lines**, traditionally written about love, beauty, or deep emotions. It is one of the most famous poetic forms.
- There are different types, including the Shakespearean and Petrarchan sonnets. Each has its own rhyme scheme, such as **ABAB CDCD EFEF GG**.
- Sonnets are often written in **iambic pentameter**, a rhythmic pattern that gives them a smooth and musical flow.
- They usually present a problem or idea and then resolve it, often with a shift in tone called a "volta." This makes them powerful for expressing complex thoughts.

5. Ode

- An ode is a poem that praises or celebrates a person, object, or idea. It is often serious and thoughtful in tone.
- Odes can be formal or informal. Some follow strict structures, while others are more flexible in style.

- They focus on admiration and deep appreciation, exploring the qualities that make the subject special or meaningful.
- The language is often rich and descriptive, using imagery and emotion to elevate the subject being praised.

6. Ballad

- A ballad is a narrative poem that tells a story, often involving love, adventure, or tragedy. It was traditionally passed down through oral storytelling.
- Ballads are written in quatrains (four-line stanzas) and often follow a simple rhyme scheme like **ABCB**.
- They use repetition and rhythm, making them easy to remember and perform. Dialogue is also commonly included to bring the story to life.
- Ballads often focus on dramatic events and strong emotions, making them engaging and vivid for the audience.

7. Epigram

- An epigram is a very short poem that expresses a clever or witty idea. It is usually brief but impactful.
- It often ends with a surprising or humorous twist. This makes it memorable and thought-provoking.
- Epigrams focus on a single idea or observation, using precise and sharp language.
- They are commonly used to express truths about life, human behavior, or society in a concise way.

8. Elegy

- An elegy is a poem that expresses sorrow, usually for someone who has died. It reflects on loss and grief.
- It often includes three stages: mourning the loss, expressing sorrow, and eventually finding comfort or acceptance.
- Elegies are emotional and reflective, using imagery and tone to convey deep feelings.
- They may also celebrate the life of the person who has passed, making them both sad and respectful.

9. Concrete Poem

- A concrete poem is shaped visually to match its subject. The layout of the words forms an image.
- The meaning comes not only from the words but also from how they are arranged on the page.
- This form combines poetry with visual art, making it creative and engaging.
- Concrete poems often use simple language, focusing on the visual impact as much as the message.

10. Free Verse

- Free verse is poetry without a fixed structure, rhyme scheme, or meter. It gives the poet complete freedom.
- It relies on natural speech patterns rather than strict rules. This allows for flexibility in expression.
- Free verse often uses imagery, repetition, and line breaks to create rhythm and meaning.
- It is commonly used in modern poetry to express personal thoughts, emotions, and experiences in a natural way.

Part A: Poetry Writing

Individually, choose **one type of poem** from the poetic forms studied (limerick, haiku, tanka, sonnet, ode, ballad, epigram, elegy, concrete poem, or free verse). Create your own original poem by applying the features, structure, and style of the selected poetic form. **Develop your poem fully by organizing your ideas into appropriate stanzas and lines according to the chosen poetic form.**

Your poem should include the following:

A suitable **title** that reflects the main idea or subject of the poem.

The **type of poem selected**.

A clear **theme or message** developed throughout the poem.

Appropriate **structure and features** of the chosen poetic form.

Effective use of **poetic language** such as imagery, figurative language, repetition, rhyme, rhythm, or symbolism where appropriate.

Proper arrangement of **lines and stanzas** according to the chosen poetic form.

Appropriate word choice that creates emotions, images, and meaning.

A creative and meaningful expression of ideas, experiences, or feelings.

A memorable ending that leaves a strong impression on the reader or audience.

Part B: Oral Performance

Perform your poem before the class using appropriate **voice projection, pronunciation, tone variation, facial expressions, gestures, body movement, and interaction with the audience** to effectively communicate the emotions, message, and artistic features of your poem.

After your performance, be ready to answer the following questions.

1. Which type of poem did I create? Give two features that show it belongs to that type of poem.
2. How did I follow the structure and conventions of the selected poetic form? (Mention aspects such as number of lines, rhyme scheme, syllable pattern, rhythm, or visual arrangement.)

3. What is the main theme or message of my poem, and how did I communicate it to the audience?
4. Which poetic devices did I use in my poem? Explain how they strengthened my message or emotional effect.
5. How did I use voice, tone, facial expressions, gestures, and body movement to enhance my performance?
6. Which part of my poem created the strongest effect during my performance? Explain why.
7. How did the structure of my chosen poetic form influence my performance?
8. What challenges did I experience while creating and performing my poem, and how did I address them?
9. How did I refine my poem based on feedback received from my teacher and classmates? Explain the improvements I made.
10. How can my improved poem contribute to a school poetry anthology or other literary publication?

Self-Assessment Checklist

Part A: Poetry Writing

After writing your poem, reflect on your work by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I choose an appropriate type of poem?	☐	☐
Did I give my poem a suitable title?	☐	☐
Did I follow the structure and features of the poetic form I selected?	☐	☐
Did I develop a clear theme or message in my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use creative and meaningful language?	☐	☐
Did I use poetic devices such as imagery, rhyme, rhythm, repetition, or figurative language appropriately?	☐	☐
Did I organize my ideas into appropriate lines and stanzas?	☐	☐
Did I express my thoughts, feelings, or experiences clearly?	☐	☐
Did I revise my poem to improve its quality?	☐	☐

Part B: Oral Performance

Instruction:

After performing your poem, evaluate your performance by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I project my voice clearly so that the audience could hear me?	☐	☐
Did I pronounce words correctly during my performance?	☐	☐
Did I use appropriate tone and voice variation to express meaning and emotions?	☐	☐
Did I use facial expressions, gestures, and body movements effectively?	☐	☐
Did I communicate the message and emotions of my poem clearly?	☐	☐
Did I perform confidently before the audience?	☐	☐
Did I respond appropriately to questions and feedback from my classmates and teacher?	☐	☐
Did I improve my poem based on the feedback I received?	☐	☐
Did I keep the improved version of my poem in my portfolio for future reference or publication?	☐	☐

9.2. Review of Basic Literary Devices

Learning activity 9.2.1



An African Thunderstorm
 From the west
 Clouds come hurrying with the wind
 Turning
 Sharply
 Here and there
 Like a plague of locusts
 Whirling
 Tossing up things on its tail
 Like a madman chasing nothing.

 Pregnant clouds
 Ride stately on its back
 Gathering to perch on hills
 Like dark sinister wings;
 The wind whistles by

An African Thunderstorm
From the west
Clouds come hurrying with the wind

Turning
Sharply
Here and there
Like a plague of locusts
Whirling
Tossing up things on its tail
Like a madman chasing nothing.

Pregnant clouds
Ride stately on its back
Gathering to perch on hills
Like dark sinister wings;
The wind whistles by
And trees bend to let it pass

In the village screams of delighted
children

Toss and turn
In the din of the whirling wind,
Women—
Babies clinging on their backs—
Dart about
In and out
Madly
The wind whistles by
Whilst trees bend to let it pass.
Clothes wave like tattered flags
Flying off
To expose dangling breasts
As jagged blinding flashes
Bumble, tremble, and crack
Amidst the smell of fired smoke
And the pelting march of the storm

by David Rubadiri

Source: A poetry course for KCSE. Edited by Paul Rubadiri

1. What is the poem mainly about?
2. What is the poem about, and how do **poetic devices** help to express its main idea?
3. Identify one **poetic device** used in the poem and explain its effect on the reader.
4. What emotions does the poem convey, and how does **rhythm** help to create those emotions?
5. Explain the meaning of a specific line and identify any **device or sound feature** used in it.
6. How do **imagery and sound devices** (like alliteration or onomatopoeia) make the poem more vivid and engaging?
7. In your opinion, how do **poetic devices, rhythm, and form together** help the reader understand and enjoy the poem?

Simile

A simile compares two things using “like” or “as”.
It helps create vivid images and clearer understanding.
Example: *“Her smile is like the sun.”*

Metaphor

A metaphor compares two things directly without “like” or “as”.
It shows deeper meaning by saying one thing *is* another.
Example: *“Time is a thief.”*

Personification

Personification gives human qualities to non-human things.
It makes objects or ideas feel alive and relatable.
Example: *“The wind whispered softly.”*

Alliteration

Alliteration is the repetition of consonant sounds at the beginning of words.
It creates rhythm and musical effect in poetry.
Example: *“Peter Piper picked...”*

Onomatopoeia

Onomatopoeia uses words that imitate natural sounds.
It helps the reader hear what is happening.
Example: *“Buzz,” “bang,” “splash.”*

Imagery

Imagery uses descriptive language to appeal to the senses.
It helps readers see, hear, feel, taste, or smell the scene.
Example: *“The golden sun warmed my skin.”*

Hyperbole

Hyperbole is deliberate exaggeration for emphasis or effect.
It is not meant to be taken literally.
Example: *“I’ve told you a million times.”*

Application activity 9.2.2



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow

IF it is true

If it is true

That the world talks too much

Then let's all keep quiet

And hear the eloquence

Of silence

If it is true

That the world sees too much

Then let's all close our eyes

And see the inner vision

Beneath the closed eyes

If it is true

That the world hears too much

Then let's wax our ears

And listen to the chastity of inner music

That defies betrayal

By the wayward wind

If it is true

That the world moves too much

Then let's stand statue still

And imitate the stubborn will

Of trees

That move without being peripatetic

For the dumb don't lie

For the blind can't be peeping-toms

For the deaf cannot eavesdrop

For the crippled can't trespass.

By Richard Ntiru

A. Comprehension questions

1. How appropriate and effective is the title of the poem in reflecting its themes and message?
2. Describe how rhythm is used in the poem and explain its effect on the reader or listener.
3. Identify and explain other poetic devices used in the poem. Support your answers with examples from the text.
4. Compose and present your own poem using rhythm and rhyme to communicate a clear theme or message. Recite your poem aloud to the class with appropriate expression and intonation.

B. Language skills

1. What is meant by:
 - a) The eloquence of silence
 - b) The chastity of inner music
 - c) Stand the statue still

C. Oral presentation

Read the poem *"If it is True"* carefully and recite it with attention to tone, pauses, and meaning. Discuss how the poet uses **silence, stillness, and sensory imagery** to communicate ideas of reflection and self-restraint. Support your discussion with clear examples from the poem, and present your ideas orally to the class in a structured and expressive manner.

9.3. Review of rhyme and Rhythm

Learning activity 9.3.1



Turn back the heart you've turned away.
Leave not my love as you have left
The broken hearts of yesterday.
But wait, be still, don't lose this way.

Give back your kissing breath,
Affection now, for what you guess
May be something more, could be less.
Accept my love, live for today.

Your roses wilted, as love spurned,
Yet trust in me, my love and truth.
Dwell in my heart, from which you've turned,
My strength as great as yours aloof.
It is in fear you turn away
And miss the chance of love today!

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem mainly about, and what central message does it communicate?
2. Identify the rhyme scheme of the poem and illustrate it using letters (e.g., AABB, ABAB).

3. To what extent does the rhyme contribute to the musicality of the poem? Explain your answer with examples.
4. How would you describe the rhythm of the poem? Is it regular, irregular, smooth, or varied? Justify your answer.
5. Read the poem aloud and identify the stressed and unstressed syllables in selected lines. What do you notice about the pattern of stress?

Recite the poem clearly, using appropriate rhythm, pauses, intonation, and expression to convey its meaning effectively.

Rhyme

Rhyme is the repetition of similar or identical sounds at the end of words, most often at the end of poetic lines. It is a key feature of sound patterning in poetry and contributes to its musical quality.

It is important to note that rhyme is based on **sound**, not spelling. Words may look different in writing but still rhyme when spoken.

Example

"Turn back the heart you've turned away
Leave not my love as you have left"

Here, words such as **away** and **left** do not form a perfect rhyme in this pair, but if the full poem includes matching end sounds (for example *away* / *yesterday*), then they create a rhyming pattern based on similar final sounds.

Types of Rhyme

Perfect rhyme: identical ending sounds (e.g., *day* / *away*)

Slant rhyme: similar but not identical sounds (e.g., *love* / *move*)

Internal rhyme: rhyme within the same line

Functions / Importance of Rhyme

Rhyme is not only decorative; it has important poetic functions:

Creates musicality: It gives the poem a song-like quality, making it pleasant to hear.

Enhances memorability: Rhyming patterns help readers remember lines easily.

Emphasizes meaning: Important ideas or emotions are often highlighted through rhyme.

Provides structure and unity: It connects lines together, giving the poem coherence and flow.

2. Rhythm in Poetry

Rhythm refers to the pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables in a line of poetry. In Phonetics, rhythm is closely linked to how spoken language is naturally organized in terms of stress and timing.

Simple Understanding

Rhythm can be understood as the **“heartbeat” or musical flow of a poem**. It determines how a poem should sound when read aloud and gives it its emotional movement.

A poem may sound **fast or slow**

It may feel **smooth, flowing, broken, or dramatic**

This depends on how the poet arranges stress patterns and pauses

Example

“Turn back the heart you’ve turned away”

When read aloud, the natural stress falls on key syllables:

turn BACK / the HEART / you’ve TURNED / a-WAY

This pattern creates a **regular rhythmic movement**, similar to an **iambic rhythm** (unstressed followed by stressed syllables), which gives the line a controlled and musical flow.

Importance of Rhythm

Creates musical flow in poetry

Shapes tone and mood (calm, serious, emotional, urgent)

Guides oral performance (reading aloud with expression)

Enhances meaning by slowing down or speeding up key ideas

Engages the listener emotionally

Both rhyme and rhythm are essential sound devices in poetry. While rhyme works mainly at the **end of lines**, rhythm operates throughout the **movement of each line**. Together, they transform poetry from ordinary language into a structured and expressive art form.

In poetry, **meter** refers to the structured and regular pattern of rhythm created by the repetition of units of sound called **feet**. Each foot is made up of a combination of **stressed (strong)** and **unstressed (weak)** syllables.

Meter is one of the most important elements in the study of poetic sound because it gives poetry its organized movement and musical quality.

What Meter Means

Meter can be understood as the **“measured heartbeat” of a poem**. Just as a heartbeat follows a steady pattern, meter provides a repeated rhythmic structure that guides how a poem is read aloud.

It is important to note that:

Meter is not random rhythm.

It is a **deliberate pattern chosen by the poet**.

It shapes the tone, mood, and musical flow of the poem.

Key Characteristics of Meter

It is based on **repetition of rhythmic units (feet)**

It organizes the **stress pattern of syllables**

It creates **musicality and predictability** in poetry

It influences **how a poem is performed orally**

It helps distinguish different poetic styles (e.g., formal vs free verse)

The Concept of a "Foot"

A **foot** is the smallest unit of meter. It usually contains two or three syllables, arranged in a pattern of stressed and unstressed beats.

For example:

- ✓ aWAY → (unstressed + stressed)
- ✓ TAble → (stressed + unstressed)

Common Types of Metrical Feet

1. Iamb (da-DUM)

An iamb consists of an **unstressed syllable followed by a stressed syllable**.

- ✓ Pattern: da-DUM
- ✓ Example: aWAY, reLAX, beGIN
- Example in a line: *"I **went** to **school** to **learn** to **read**"*
(The stress naturally falls on key syllables, creating a flowing rhythm.)

2. Trochee (DUM-da)

A trochee consists of a **stressed syllable followed by an unstressed syllable**.

- ✓ Pattern: DUM-da
- ✓ Example: TAble, WINter, DOctor
- Example in a line: *"TAble, WINter, DOctor call"*
(This gives a stronger, more forceful beginning to words.)

3. Anapest (da-da-DUM)

An anapest consists of two unstressed syllables followed by a stressed syllable.

- ✓ Pattern: da-da-DUM
- ✓ Example: in the NIGHT, in the DARK

- Example in a line: *"in the **NIGHT** when the world is asleep"*
(This creates a rising, flowing rhythm.)

4. Dactyl (DUM-da-da)

A dactyl consists of a stressed syllable followed by two unstressed syllables.

- ✓ Pattern: DUM-da-da
- ✓ Example: BEAU-ti-ful, EL-e-phant
- Example in a line: *"BEAU-ti-ful MOUN-tains are GLOW-ing at dawn"*
(This creates a falling, expressive rhythm.)

Importance of Meter in Poetry

- ✓ It gives poetry a structured musical flow
- ✓ It helps create tone and emotional effect
- ✓ It makes poems easier to recite and memorize
- ✓ It distinguishes formal poetry from free verse
- ✓ It enhances the artistic beauty of language

Meter is not only a technical feature of poetry; it is the hidden structure that shapes how meaning is felt as much as how it is understood. Through patterns of stress and sound, poets create rhythm that mirrors emotion, thought, and experience

TYPES OF METER

In poetry, **meter** refers to the structured rhythmic pattern of a line, created through the repetition of **metrical feet**. These feet determine how a poem sounds when read aloud and give it its musical flow and rhythm.

To understand meter clearly, it is important to first understand the idea of a **foot**.

1. What is a Foot in Poetry?

A **foot** is the basic unit of rhythm in a line of poetry. It is made up of a fixed pattern of **stressed (strong)** and **unstressed (weak)** syllables.

Each line of poetry is constructed using several feet, and the repetition of these feet creates the poem's overall rhythm.

Key Idea

- ✓ A foot = one rhythmic unit
- ✓ Several feet = one line of poetry
- ✓ The pattern of feet = the meter of the poem

2. Common Types of Metrical Feet

In Phonetics, rhythm and stress patterns are essential in understanding how spoken language forms structured patterns in poetry.

Application activity 9.3.2



Part A: Poetry Writing

Instruction:

Choose **one type of poem** from the poetic forms studied (limerick, haiku, tanka, sonnet, ode, ballad, epigram, elegy, concrete poem, or free verse). Create your own original poem by applying the sound features of poetry studied, including **rhyme, rhythm, stress patterns, and meter** where appropriate.

Your poem should include the following:

A suitable **title** that reflects the main idea or message of the poem.

The selected **type of poem** and its appropriate structure.

A clear **theme or message** developed throughout the poem.

Appropriate use of **rhyme** to create musical quality and connect ideas.

A clear **rhythmic pattern** that gives the poem a smooth and meaningful flow.

Effective arrangement of **stressed and unstressed syllables** to support the mood and meaning of the poem.

Appropriate use of **meter** where the selected poetic form requires a regular rhythmic pattern.

Creative use of poetic language such as imagery, repetition, and figurative expressions.

A meaningful expression of thoughts, feelings, experiences, or ideas.

Part B: Oral Performance

Instruction:

Perform your poem before the class using appropriate **voice projection, pronunciation, rhythm, stress, pauses, tone variation, facial expressions, gestures, and body movement** to communicate the meaning and musical quality of your poem effectively.

After your performance, answer the following questions:

1. Which type of poem did I create? Explain how my poem follows the features of that poetic form.
2. How did I use rhyme in my poem? Give examples of words or lines that create a rhyme pattern.
3. Which type of rhyme did I apply (perfect rhyme, slant rhyme, or internal rhyme)? Explain its effect on my poem.
4. How did I create rhythm in my poem? Explain how the arrangement of stressed and unstressed syllables influenced the flow of my poem.

5. Did I use a specific meter in my poem? If yes, identify the pattern of feet used and explain why I chose it.
6. How did rhyme, rhythm, and meter help me communicate the emotions and message of my poem?
7. How did I use stress and pauses during my performance to make the poem more effective?
8. Which sound feature of my poem was the most successful (rhyme, rhythm, meter, or stress pattern)? Explain.
9. What challenges did I experience when applying sound devices while creating my poem?
10. How did feedback from my teacher and classmates help **me improve my poem**?

Self-Assessment Checklist

Part A: Poetry Writing

Instruction:

After creating your poem, reflect on your work by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I choose an appropriate type of poem?	☐	☐
Did I follow the structure and features of my chosen poetic form?	☐	☐
Did I create a clear theme or message?	☐	☐
Did I use rhyme effectively to improve the sound of my poem?	☐	☐
Did I create a rhythm that supports the meaning and mood of my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use stressed and unstressed syllables appropriately?	☐	☐
Did I apply meter correctly where necessary?	☐	☐
Did I use poetic language creatively?	☐	☐
Did I revise my poem to improve its quality?	☐	☐

Part B: Oral Performance

Instruction:

After performing your poem, evaluate your performance by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I pronounce words clearly and accurately?	☐	☐
Did I maintain the rhythm and stress patterns of my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use appropriate pauses and emphasis?	☐	☐

Did I vary my tone to express emotions and meaning?	☐	☐
Did I use facial expressions, gestures, and body movements effectively?	☐	☐
Did I communicate the message of my poem clearly to the audience?	☐	☐
Did I perform confidently before my classmates?	☐	☐
Did I improve my poem based on the feedback received?	☐	☐

9.4. Review of tone and mood

Learning activity 9.4.1



Building the Nation

Today I did my share
In building the nation.

I drove the permanent secretary
To an important urgent function
In fact to a luncheon at the Vic.

The menu reflected its importance:
Cold beer with small talk,
Then fried chicken with niceties,
Wine to fill the hollowness of the laughs,
Ice-cream to cover the stereotype jokes,
Coffee to keep the PS awake on return journey.

I drove the permanent secretary back.
He yawned many times in the back of the car.
Then, to keep awake, he suddenly asked,
"Did you have any lunch, friend?"
I replied, looking straight ahead
And secretly smiling at his belated concern—
That I had not, but was sliming!

Upon which he said with seriousness
That amused more than annoyed me,
"Mwananchi, I too had none!
I attended to matters of state,
Highly delicate diplomatic duties, you know,
And friend, it goes against my grain,
Causes me stomach ulcers and wind."

Ah, he continued, yawning again—
So the PS had ulcers too!
My ulcers I think are equally painful
Only they are caused by hunger,
No sumptuous lunches!
So two nation builders
Arrived home this evening
With terrible stomach pains
The result of building the nation—
Different ways.

By Christopher H.M Barlow

Questions

1. What is the central **message or theme** of the poem? How does it comment on social hierarchy, inequality, or the idea of "building the nation"?
2. How does the repeated reference to **stomach pain** highlight the contrast between the speaker's and the PS's experiences?
3. What is the **tone** of the poem?
4. How does the Permanent Secretary's behavior, like yawning and talking about ulcers, influence the tone of the poem?
5. What is the overall **mood**? How does the interaction between the speaker and the PS create this mood?

In poetry, **tone** refers to the **poet's attitude toward the subject, the audience, or the situation**. It's not what happens in the poem, but *how the poet feels about it* and how that feeling comes across to the reader. Tone is conveyed through **word choice (diction), imagery, syntax, punctuation, and style**.

The poet (speaker) observes the PS taking his "important urgent function" very seriously, yet yawning repeatedly and complaining about ulcers, while the speaker himself is hungry. This contrast is noted with a **light, playful attitude**.

Lines like:

"Ah, he continued, yawning again— / So the PS had ulcers too!" show gentle **mockery and irony**, highlighting the absurdity of the situation without harsh criticism.

The tone stays **lighthearted and amused**, even while commenting on social hierarchy and the idea of "building the nation." The speaker isn't angry or bitter, just wryly observant.

In poetry, **mood** refers to the **feeling or atmosphere that the poem creates for the reader**. Unlike tone, which is the poet's attitude, mood is about **how the poem makes the reader feel**. It's created through **word choice, imagery, setting, and the emotions conveyed by characters or the narrator**.

The **mood** of your poem is the **feeling it creates for the reader**, and in this case, it is **humorous, lightly ironic, and reflective**.

Here's why:

1. The reader **feels amused** at the contrast between the Permanent Secretary's "important" duties and his yawning, while the speaker goes hungry. Lines like:
"Ah, he continued, yawning again— / So the PS had ulcers too!" make the situation funny and lightly ironic.
2. The repeated mention of **stomach pain for both the PS and the speaker** creates a **reflective mood**, making the reader think about social differences: both are "nation builders," but in very different ways.
3. The **humor** comes from everyday observations—cold beer, fried chicken, ice cream, and coffee—mixed with the absurdity of calling a luncheon "highly delicate diplomatic duties."

Application activity 9.4.2



Part A: Poetry Writing

Choose **one of the following topics** and create your own original poem. Your poem should communicate a clear **tone** (your attitude toward the subject, audience, or situation) and create a specific **mood** (the feeling or atmosphere experienced by the reader). Use appropriate **diction, imagery, syntax, punctuation, and style** to express your ideas effectively.

Topics:

1. Education as a Key to Changing Lives
2. Early Pregnancy and the Dreams of Young People
3. Protecting Children from Child Labour
4. The Power of Love, Friendship, and Human Bonds
5. Disappointment in Love and the Journey to Healing
6. The Wisdom of Parental Advice and Life Lessons

Your poem should include the following:

A suitable **title** that reflects the chosen topic and main idea.

A clear **tone** that shows your attitude toward the subject, audience, or situation.

A clear **mood** that creates a specific feeling or atmosphere for the reader.

Appropriate **word choice (diction)** to reveal emotions, attitudes, and ideas.

Effective use of **imagery** to help readers visualize the situation and experience the intended feelings.

Appropriate **syntax, punctuation, and style** to strengthen the tone and mood.

A meaningful **message** communicated through the poem.

Appropriate use of the **features and structure of the selected poetic form**.

Effective use of poetic techniques studied, including **rhyme, rhythm, stress patterns, and meter where appropriate**.

Part B: Oral Performance:

Perform your poem before the class using appropriate **voice projection, pronunciation, tone variation, pauses, facial expressions, gestures, and body movement** to communicate the tone, mood, and message of your poem effectively.

After your performance, answer the following questions:

1. What topic did I choose for my poem, and why did I choose it?
2. Which type of poem did I create? Explain how my poem follows the features of that poetic form.

3. What is the tone of my poem? Explain the attitude I expressed toward the subject, audience, or situation.
4. What mood does my poem create for the reader? Explain the feeling or atmosphere produced by the poem.
5. Which words or expressions in my poem reveal the tone? Explain how they show my attitude.
6. How did I use imagery to create the intended mood in my poem?
7. How did my use of diction, syntax, punctuation, and style strengthen the meaning of my poem?
8. How did I apply rhyme, rhythm, stress patterns, or meter to improve the sound and effectiveness of my poem?
9. How did my voice, pauses, facial expressions, and gestures help the audience understand the tone and mood of my poem?
10. What feedback did I receive from my teacher and classmates, and how did I use it to improve my poem?

Self-Assessment Checklist

Part A: Poetry Writing

Reflect on your poem by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I choose an appropriate topic for my poem?	☐	☐
Did I choose a suitable poetic form and follow its features?	☐	☐
Did I create a clear theme or message?	☐	☐
Did I create a clear tone that shows my attitude toward the subject?	☐	☐
Did I create a mood that influences how the reader feels?	☐	☐
Did I use diction effectively to express my ideas and emotions?	☐	☐
Did I use imagery to strengthen the mood of my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use syntax, punctuation, and style appropriately?	☐	☐
Did I apply rhyme, rhythm, stress patterns, or meter where necessary?	☐	☐
Did I revise my poem to improve its meaning and emotional impact?	☐	☐

Part B: Oral Performance

Evaluate your performance by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I pronounce words clearly and accurately?	☐	☐
Did I use my voice to communicate the tone of my poem?	☐	☐
Did I maintain the rhythm and stress patterns of my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use appropriate pauses and emphasis?	☐	☐
Did I use facial expressions, gestures, and body movements effectively?	☐	☐
Did I create the intended mood through my performance?	☐	☐
Did I communicate the message of my poem clearly to the audience?	☐	☐
Did I answer questions about my poem confidently?	☐	☐
Did I improve my poem based on feedback received?	☐	☐

9.5 Review of Themes and messages

Learning activity 9.5.1



Black Cry

I am coal!

You rip ruthlessly from the earth

You make me your mine, master

Yes I am coal!

You light me, master,

To serve you forever a moving force

But not forever, master.

I am coal

And I must burn, yes,

And consume all by the force of my combustion.

I am coal

I must burn in exploitation

Burn down to the very ashes of malediction

Burn like my brother coal-tar alive

Until I'm no longer your mine, master

Yes, I am coal!

I must burn

Consume all by the fire of my combustion.

Yes!

I shall be your coal, master

By Jose Craveirinha (Mozambique)

Source: An Anthology of East African Poetry. Edited by A.D. Amateshe.

Questions

1. What is the poet's attitude toward the "master" in the poem?
2. Does the tone change at any point, for example in the lines "*But not forever, master*"? What does this shift convey?
3. What is the central **theme** of the poem?
4. What message does the poem convey to leaders?
5. How does the poem reflect the **relationship between the exploited and the exploiter**?

1. Emotional Ideas in Poetry

These are the **feelings and moods** expressed by the poet or created in the reader.

Show **personal experiences and inner feelings**

Help the reader **connect emotionally** with the poem

Created through **imagery, tone, and word choice (diction)**

Common emotional ideas:

Love, joy, hope

Sadness, grief, loneliness

Anger, fear, frustration

2. Moral Ideas in Poetry

These are the **lessons or messages about right and wrong behavior**.

Teach values such as **honesty, kindness, respect, responsibility**

Often show **consequences of actions**

Encourage readers to **reflect on their behavior**

Common moral ideas:

Good vs evil
Justice and fairness
Importance of truth and integrity

3. Social Ideas in Poetry

These focus on **issues in society and human relationships**.

Address problems affecting people and communities
Promote **awareness and change**
Reflect **cultural, political, and economic realities**

Common social ideas:

Poverty and inequality
Corruption and leadership
Education and ignorance
Gender roles and discrimination
Freedom and oppression

1. Emotional Ideas

The poem expresses **strong and intense feelings** of the speaker (coal symbolizing an oppressed person/group).

Anger → "You rip ruthlessly..." shows bitterness toward the oppressor

Pain / Suffering → being taken, used, and burned

Pride / Identity → "I am coal!" shows self-awareness and strength

Rebellion → "I must burn... and consume all" shows desire to fight back

- These emotions make the reader feel the **injustice and tension** in the poem.

2. Moral (Common) Ideas

These are the **lessons about right and wrong behavior** shown in the poem.

Exploitation is wrong → using others for selfish gain is immoral

Abuse of power leads to destruction → the "master" misuses authority

Oppression has consequences → the coal will eventually destroy

Respect for others is important → no one should be treated as an object

3. Social Ideas

These reflect **real-life issues in society**, especially power and inequality.

Oppression and exploitation → the master vs the coal (worker/slave)

Class struggle → powerful people controlling the weak

Colonialism / forced labor (possible interpretation) → taking resources and people by force

Injustice in leadership → leaders abusing their authority

Application activity 9.5.2



Part A: Poetry Writing

Choose **one of the following topics** and create your own original poem. Your poem should communicate clear **emotional, moral, and/or social ideas** by expressing feelings, presenting lessons about human behaviour, or addressing issues affecting individuals and society.

Topics:

1. The Influence of Social Media on Young People
2. Artificial Intelligence and the Future of Humanity
3. Climate Change and the Protection of Our Planet
4. The Value of Peace and Unity in Society
5. The Struggle Against Poverty and Inequality
6. The Importance of Culture and Identity in a Changing World

Your poem should include the following:

A suitable **title** that reflects the main idea of the poem.

A clear **theme or message** developed throughout the poem.

Strong **emotional ideas** that express feelings such as hope, fear, anger, joy, sadness, or concern.

A clear **moral idea** that communicates lessons about values, responsibility, choices, or human behaviour.

A relevant **social idea** that reflects challenges, relationships, or issues affecting society.

Effective use of **imagery, tone, and diction** to create emotional connection with the reader.

Appropriate use of **poetic techniques** such as rhyme, rhythm, repetition, symbolism, and figurative language.

A meaningful reflection on human experiences, values, or social realities.

Appropriate use of the **features and structure of the selected poetic form**.

Part B: Oral Performance

Instruction:

Perform your poem before the class using appropriate **voice projection, pronunciation, tone variation, pauses, facial expressions, gestures, and body movement** to communicate the emotions, ideas, and message of your poem effectively.

After your performance, answer the following questions:

1. Which topic did I choose for my poem, and why did I choose it?
2. Which type of poem did I create? Explain how my poem follows the features of that poetic form.
3. What emotional ideas are expressed in my poem? Explain the feelings communicated by the speaker or created in the reader.
4. Which words, images, or expressions help communicate the emotions in my poem?
5. What moral idea or lesson does my poem communicate? Explain the values or behaviours presented.
6. What social idea does my poem address? Explain the issue affecting individuals or society.
7. How did I use imagery, tone, and diction to help the reader connect emotionally with my poem?
8. How did poetic techniques such as symbolism, repetition, rhyme, or rhythm strengthen the ideas in my poem?
9. How did my performance techniques (voice, facial expressions, gestures, and pauses) help communicate the emotions and message of my poem?
10. What feedback did I receive from my teacher and classmates, and how did I use it to improve my poem?

Self-Assessment Rubric

Part A: Poetry Writing

Reflect on your poem by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I choose a meaningful topic for my poem?	☐	☐
Did I create a suitable title that reflects my main idea?	☐	☐
Did I develop a clear theme or message?	☐	☐
Did I express emotional ideas clearly through my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use words and images that create feelings in the reader?	☐	☐
Did I communicate a moral lesson or value through my poem?	☐	☐

Did I address a social issue or human experience?	☐	☐
Did I use imagery, symbolism, and figurative language effectively?	☐	☐
Did I use rhyme, rhythm, repetition, or other sound devices appropriately?	☐	☐
Did I follow the structure and features of my chosen poetic form?	☐	☐
Did I revise my poem to improve its meaning and impact?	☐	☐

Part B: Oral Performance Rubric

Instruction:

Evaluate your performance by ticking (✓) the appropriate box.

Criteria	Yes	No
Did I pronounce words clearly and accurately?	☐	☐
Did I use my voice to express the emotions in my poem?	☐	☐
Did I use appropriate tone, pauses, and emphasis?	☐	☐
Did I communicate the moral and social messages effectively?	☐	☐
Did I use facial expressions and gestures to support my meaning?	☐	☐
Did I maintain the audience's attention during my performance?	☐	☐
Did I explain the emotional, moral, and social ideas in my poem clearly?	☐	☐
Did I respond confidently to questions from the audience?	☐	☐
Did I use feedback from others to improve my poem and performance?	☐	☐

9.6. Stages of poem composition

Learning activity 9.6.1



Read the poem below and answer the questions that follows

Solitary Spiritual Soldier

I shall not take my own life.

I shall, however, ask why

I have to keep telling myself

That I don't want to die.

They shall not make me take my own life,
Because sooner or later I shall find the light.

My soul is on the line here,
As if that is not enough to fear,
They are an army and I am one,
And they laugh in the presence of tears.

I know that there is a God,
I know that He loves me.
My kind is not odd,
Thousands around, below and above me.

I shall not take my own life.
I shall, however, ask when
I hope to find the light,
In place of darkness again and again?

Christian Awori

From Echoes across the Valley

Comprehension questions

1. Who is the speaker in the poem?
2. What is the poem about?
3. Explain the effect of using the first-person point of view in the poem.
4. What conflicting emotions does the speaker express about life and death?
5. What feeling is created by the phrase "my soul is on the line"?
6. How does the poem reflect the experience of isolation in society?

Idea generation

Idea generation in poetry is the process of finding **inspiration** and developing a **central theme** for a poem. Poets get ideas from **personal experiences, nature, society, imagination, culture, and spiritual beliefs**. They use techniques like **brainstorming, observation, free writing, and questioning** to explore and shape their thoughts. These ideas are then developed using **emotions, imagery, and diction** to create meaningful and expressive poems.

Drafting

Drafting in poetry is the stage where a poet **turns ideas into words** and begins shaping a poem. It starts with a **central theme** and the **emotion or message** to express, followed by **free writing** to let thoughts flow without worrying about grammar or rhyme. The poet then **organizes lines and stanzas**, experimenting with **structure, tone, and poetic devices** like imagery, metaphors, and alliteration. Finally, the draft is **revised and edited**, refining **word choice, clarity, and expression** to ensure the poem communicates its emotional, moral, and social ideas effectively.

Revising

Revising in poetry is the stage where a poet **reviews and improves** a draft to make it more **clear, expressive, and effective**. It involves checking the **structure, flow, and organization** of lines and stanzas, and ensuring that **tone, mood, and rhythm** match the intended message. Poets refine **word choice (diction), imagery, and poetic devices** like metaphors, similes, and alliteration to strengthen meaning. Finally, revising ensures that the poem communicates its **emotional, moral, and social ideas** clearly while engaging the reader.

Performing

Performing poetry involves **expressing a poem aloud** in a way that brings out its **meaning, emotion, and rhythm**. It requires attention to **tone, pace, volume, and pauses** to create the intended mood. Poets use **gestures, facial expressions, and body language** to enhance the audience's understanding and engagement. Effective performance ensures that the poem's **emotional, moral, and social ideas** are clearly communicated and felt by listeners.

Application activity 9.6.2



Read and answer the questions that follow

1. What is the first step a poet should take when composing a poem?
2. How does choosing a central theme influence the development of a poem?
3. Why is free writing important in the drafting stage?
4. How can poetic devices like imagery, metaphors, and alliteration enhance a poem?
5. Explain the importance of revising a poem before finalizing it.
6. How does word choice (diction) affect the meaning and emotion of a poem?
7. What role do line breaks and stanza structure play in conveying a poem's message?
8. Write a poem following all the stages of poem composition.

Comprehension questions

Read and answer the questions that follow

Once Upon a Time

Once upon a time, son,
they used to laugh with their hearts
and laugh with their eyes:
but now they only laugh with their teeth,
while their ice-block-cold eyes
search behind my shadow.
There was a time indeed
they used to shake hands with their hearts:
but that's gone, son.
Now they shake hands without hearts
while their left hands search
my empty pockets.

'Feel at home!' 'Come again':
they say, and when
I come again and feel

at home, once, twice,
there will be no thrice-
for then I find doors shut on me.

So I have learned many things, son.
I have learned to wear
many faces like dresses – homeface,
officeface, streetface, hostface,
cocktailface, with all their conforming
smiles like a fixed portrait smile.
And I have learned too
to laugh with only my teeth
and shake hands without my heart.
I have also learned to say, 'Goodbye',
when I mean 'Good-riddance':
to say 'Glad to meet you',
without being glad; and to say
'It's been nice talking to you', after being bored.

But believe me, son.
I want to be what
I used to be when
I was like you. I want
to unlearn all these muting things.
Most of all, I want to relearn
how to laugh, for my laugh in the mirror
shows only my teeth like a snake's bare fangs!

So show me, son,
how to laugh; show me how
I used to laugh and smile
once upon a time when
I was like you.

Gabriel Okara

A. Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem about?
2. Who is the speaker in the poem?
3. What does the speaker say people used to do "once upon a time"?
4. Why does the speaker feel unwelcome when he visits people repeatedly?
5. What steps do you follow when writing a poem? Describe each stage.
6. Why is **free writing** important in the drafting stage?
7. What role do **line breaks and stanza structure** play in conveying a poem's message?

B. Language skills

Vocabulary Questions

1. What does "**ice-block-cold eyes**" suggest about people's feelings?
2. Explain the meaning of "**search behind my shadow.**"
3. What is meant by "**empty pockets**"?
4. Give a synonym for "**muting**" as used in the poem.

C. Oral presentation

Recite the poem you have created in the question 8?

Tips for Presentation

- **Pause** at every colon, comma, or new line to allow meaning to sink in.
- Use **longer pauses** at stanza breaks and after impactful lines
- Make **eye contact** at key lines to engage your audience

9.7 Language focus: Adverbs of Time

Learning activity 9.7.1



Read the poem bellow and answer the questions that follow

"The Journey of Days"

Every morning, the sun will rise,
Quickly painting gold across the skies.
Yesterday's worries fade away,
Slowly melting into today.

Soon, the birds will start to sing,
Always welcoming the joys of spring.
Tomorrow waits with hopes anew,
Gently guiding everything we do.

Comprehension questions

1. What is the poem about?
2. Read the poem carefully and write down all the words that indicate time.
3. Explain how each one shows when something happens.

Meaning

Adverbs of time are words that tell us **when** an action happens, **how often**, or **for how long**. They help give more information about the timing of an event in a sentence.

1. Common Adverbs of Time

- **Specific time:** yesterday, today, tomorrow, now, then, tonight, this morning
- **Frequency:** always, often, sometimes, rarely, never
- **Duration:** briefly, long, for a while, forever
- **Sequence / order:** first, next, finally, afterward, immediately

2. Examples in Sentences

- I woke up early this morning.
- She has always loved reading.
- We will meet tomorrow.
- The teacher finished the lesson quickly.
- He went home and **then** started his homework.

3. Position in a Sentence

- **Beginning:** **Yesterday**, I went to the park.
- **Middle:** I **often** visit my grandmother.
- **End:** I will call you **tomorrow**.

4. Tips for Using Adverbs of Time

- They help make your writing **clearer** and **more precise**.
- They can **change the meaning** of a sentence depending on placement.
- Combine with adverbs of manner (how) or place (where) to give full information:
✓ Example: She sang beautifully yesterday at school.

Application activity 9.7.2



Read and answer the questions that follow

1. What is the first step a poet should take when composing a poem?
2. How does choosing a **central theme** influence the development of a poem?
3. Why is **free writing** important in the drafting stage?
4. How can **poetic devices** like imagery, metaphors, and alliteration enhance a poem?
5. Explain the importance of **revising** a poem before finalizing it.
6. How does **word choice (diction)** affect the meaning and emotion of a poem?
7. What role do **line breaks and stanza structure** play in conveying a poem's message?
8. Write a poem following all the stages of poem composition.

1. Identify the Adverbs of Time

Underline the adverbs of time in each sentence.

- a) I will visit my grandmother **tomorrow**.
- b) She has **always** loved reading poetry.
- c) We went to the park **yesterday**.
- d) The teacher will explain the lesson **later**.
- e) He calls his friend **every day**.

2. Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences with a suitable adverb of time from the box:

[yesterday, soon, always, now, later]

1. I am busy _____, but I will call you after.
2. She visits the library _____ to borrow books.
3. We went to the museum _____.
4. The bus will arrive _____.
5. He has _____ wanted to be a doctor.

END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT



I am near, Do not Live

When morning breaks with its colorless light,
New dreams arise with pride over the night.
Guys, he who learns, his mind never stunts,
Creates a future nobody can imagine.

The road may be slippery, the storms may stay,
But commitment guides us on the way.
Through our daily challenges reluctant to sway,
Hope whispers softly, "I am near, do not live."

The world may change, the years may fly,
Yet values make us eat from the same plate with kings.
With caring hearts and hands that serve,
We build the future we deserve.

A. Comprehension questions

1. What is the main message communicated in the poem?
2. Explain the meaning of the line: 'The road may be slippery, the storms may stay.'
3. Identify two values promoted in the poem and explain their importance.
4. How does imagery strengthen the message of the poem?
5. What type of poem is this? Give a reason.

B. Multiple Choice Questions

1. The dominant theme is
A. Fear B. Education and hope C. Technology D. Loneliness
2. Morning breaks symbolizes
A. End B. New beginning C. Disaster D. Darkness

3. The mood is
A. Hopeful B. Angry C. Fearful D. Confused
4. Storms may stay is mainly
A. Literal B. Symbolic challenge C. Joke D. Fact
5. The last stanza emphasizes
A. Service B. Wealth C. Power D. Revenge

SECTION I: COMPREHENSION

Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow.

SECTION II: FILL IN THE GAPS

Word box: theme, elegy, diction, rhyme, rhythm, revision, imagery, tone, metaphor, haiku

1. After reading a poem about a young person who overcomes challenges through education and perseverance, Aline explains that the poet's main message is hope and determination. She has correctly identified the poem's _____.
2. During a school memorial ceremony, a learner presents a poem expressing sorrow, love, and respect for a beloved teacher who passed away. This type of poem is called an _____.
3. While discussing a poem, the teacher points out that the poet deliberately uses words such as 'darkness,' 'silence,' and 'broken dreams' to express sadness. This careful choice of words is known as _____.
4. During a poetry recital, learners notice that several lines end with words that have similar sounds, giving the poem a musical effect. This sound pattern is called _____.
5. As Emmanuel recites his poem aloud, he carefully follows the pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables to create a smooth flow. He is demonstrating the poem's _____.
6. After receiving feedback, Keza rewrites several lines and improves her poem. This stage is called _____.

SECTION III: TRUE OR FALSE

1. A sonnet traditionally has fourteen lines. _____
2. Free verse must follow a fixed rhyme scheme. _____
3. Imagery appeals to the senses. _____
4. Tone is the poet's attitude. _____
5. A limerick follows an AABBA rhyme scheme. _____
6. Rhythm depends on stressed and unstressed syllables. _____

7. A concrete poem uses visual arrangement. _____
8. An epigram is usually very short and witty. _____
9. Metaphors compare two things directly. _____
10. Revision only corrects spelling. _____
11. Drafting is the stage where you write your poem for the first time without worrying about mistakes. _____
12. Revising involves checking spelling and punctuation errors. _____
13. Planning a poem includes brainstorming ideas, themes, and words before writing. _____
14. Editing is the stage where you improve word choice, clarity, and sentence structure. _____
15. Publishing is the final stage where your poem is shared with others or submitted. _____

SECTION IV: LANGUAGE FOCUS

Fill in the blanks with suitable words:

yesterday – usually – immediately – tomorrow – first – afterward – sometimes – for a while – finally – never – this morning

Last week, Aline decided to improve her reading habits. _____, she created a reading schedule and selected interesting books from the library. She _____ reads for thirty minutes before going to bed, but she _____ reads when she is very tired.

One day, she found an old storybook in her classroom. She opened it and _____ discovered that it contained traditional stories from Rwanda. She read the book _____ before returning it to the library.

_____, Aline shared the stories with her classmates. She promised that she would bring another interesting book _____. Her friends were excited because they had _____ experienced such an enjoyable reading activity.

SECTION V: CREATIVE WRITING PROJECT

- A. Write an original poem on ONE of the following topics: Education, Protecting Nature, Unity and Peace, Responsible Technology, Culture and Identity, or Hope and Determination.
- B. Your poem should have a suitable title, clear theme, appropriate structure, effective poetic devices, imagery, and a memorable ending.
- C. Perform your poem orally before the class using appropriate pronunciation, tone, gestures, facial expressions, rhythm, and pauses.

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